THE GHISSU MODEL ANSWER SERIES



With a foreword by BHARGAVA V

IRMS, UPSC CSE 2024 · FORMER ASST. COMMISSIONER, APPSC GROUP-I 2023

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS

Paper III

Polity, Constitution, Governance, Law and Ethics

MODEL ANSWERS TO PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

2008 *to* 2025

140 questions · in handwriting style

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

FOUNDER · GHISSU.COM

FOREWORD

When I sat for APPSC Group-I Mains, I noticed that most aspirants in the hall knew the content. What separated the final list was how each answer met the exact demand of the question within the time and the pages available. That is why understanding the syllabus, analysing previous year questions (PYQs) and following the trends in the pattern matter so much.

During my own preparation, I worked extensively with the APPSC Mains PYQs. I answered each question myself, working on how I presented the answer and on the value additions I could bring to it. This improved the presentation of my content, and with it, my confidence. Technology gave me an extra edge as well: I used AI to refine my answers.

This book brings together previous year questions with model answers written to the demand of the exam. It analyses the examination from every angle, which makes the aspirant's journey simpler and more focused. Attempt each question yourself before you read the model answer, and then compare. You can also get your written answer evaluated on ghissu.com. Practicing these questions year by year will sharpen your sense of the demand, the structure and the depth that score marks.

I hope this book helps aspirants prepare with clarity and confidence, and succeed in realising their goals.

All the best,

BHARGAVA V
Indian Railway Management Service (IRMS)
UPSC Civil Services Examination 2024
Former Assistant Commissioner of State Tax, Andhra Pradesh
(APPSC Group-I, 2023)

A FREE RESOURCE FROM GHISSU

Preface

APPSC Group-I Mains is a writing exam. The syllabus tells you what to study. The previous papers show you what the commission actually asks, how it words each question and how much it expects for ten marks. This book gives you every question from eight sittings, 2008 to 2025, each with an answer written the way an aspirant can write it in the exam hall.

How this book is arranged

Each paper is a separate book. Inside it, the questions run year by year, newest first, with the same order and numbering as the official question papers. The arrangement follows the latest APPSC syllabus. Questions from the older sittings, when the papers were organised differently, are placed in the paper they belong to today, and their label shows where they were first printed. Every answer fits in three pages, the space the 44-page answer booklet allows per question. The answers are drafted with Ghissu's Model Answer engine, then checked and edited, and set in a handwriting style so you can see exactly what three pages in the exam hall look like.

Why this book

After graduating in Mathematics and Computing Engineering from DTU, New Delhi, I spent years as an aspirant myself. I wrote two UPSC Civil Services Mains, two APPSC Group-I Mains and one APPSC Group-II Mains. I am still a learner, walking the same path as you.

Then, for nearly two years, I worked on the other side as Mentor-cum-Head Reviewer at Vajiram & Ravi, New Delhi, where I headed the evaluation of its Mains Test Series. I reviewed more than 10,000 answer copies, trained over 600 evaluators and mentored more than 100 aspirants. One lesson stayed with me: marks are rarely lost because of too little reading. They are lost when the demand is only half answered, the structure wanders or the conclusion says nothing. These are habits, and habits change only through writing and honest feedback.

This book is half of the method

A model answer shows you where to reach. It cannot show you how far your own answer is from it. That is what ghissu.com is for. There you will find the same questions arranged subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise. Alongside them are UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 that match the APPSC syllabus, and more practice questions that cover each topic fully. You can write an answer, get it evaluated within minutes, and compare it with the exam-hall thinking, toppers' answers and value additions for that question.

> **To use the topic-wise PYQs and resources:** sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist. Requests are usually approved within one or two days. The next pages explain how to use this book and the website together.

An apology, in advance

Every question and every answer has been checked with care. Even so, some errors may remain. If you find anything that could be clearer or more accurate, please write to **hello@ghissu.com**. Every correction makes the book better for the next reader.

With best wishes,

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

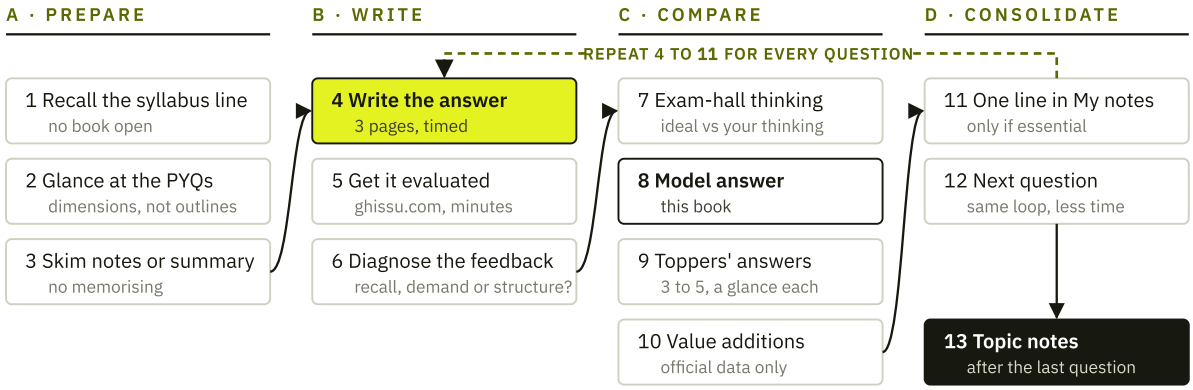
Founder, ghissu.com

READ THIS BEFORE THE FIRST QUESTION

How to use this book with ghissu.com

Keeping a book of model answers open in front of you feels like preparation, but it is passive reading, and passive reading fades. The method below keeps you active at every stage: you recall before you read, you write before you compare, and you compare in order to find the half mark you left behind in each part of the answer, from the introduction to the conclusion.

It assumes you have covered the syllabus once from a standard book or a coaching programme. Work topic by topic, using the topic-wise view of these questions on ghissu.com, and keep a time limit for every step.



Where the website comes in. Every answer page in this book carries a QR code at the bottom right, and every question in the index has a Practice link. Both open that exact question on ghissu.com, where you can upload a handwritten answer, type it against a running timer, or dictate it by voice.

SUGGESTED TIME FOR THE FIRST QUESTIONS OF A TOPIC	MINUTES
Recall, glance at the PYQs and skim your notes (steps 1 to 3, once per topic)	10 to 15
Write the answer at exam pace (step 4)	12
Read the feedback and the exam-hall thinking (steps 5 to 7)	8 to 10
Model answer, toppers' answers and value additions (steps 8 to 10)	8 to 10

A beginner may need 30 to 45 minutes for each of the first one to three questions of a sub-topic. That is expected. The time falls with every question, and what you gain is the confidence to attempt any question from the topic, at any time.

PHASE A Prepare, without opening the answers

1 **Recall the syllabus line.** Read the line from the syllabus and brainstorm everything you remember about it, on paper.

2 **Glance at the previous questions.** See which questions were asked and along which dimensions. Do not outline or think deeply yet. This shows the gaps in what you recalled and where the marks in this topic usually lie.

3 **Skim your notes.** If you have notes, skim them without trying to memorise. If not, read the summary, strategy, value addition and toppers' answers for the topic on ghissu.com, just enough to attempt the first question with confidence.

PHASE B Write and get feedback

4 **Write the first question.** Do not wait for the perfect moment; there is none. Answer writing is the skill the examiner tests most, more than reading or revision. If the topic has few APPSC questions, ghissu.com adds the related UPSC questions and practice questions.

5 **Get it evaluated.** Submit a full answer, or only a quick outline, on ghissu.com. Feedback returns in two to three minutes. Upload a handwritten page, type with the timer running, or dictate, whichever suits your day.

6 **Diagnose before you read further.** Find the one major issue. If it is only recall, move on; it disappears as you finish the topic. If it is a missed demand or a weak structure, slow down and understand it with the exam-hall thinking for that question. Ask Ghissu and the Ghissu bull can explain further, in your own language.

PHASE C Compare with the ideal

7 **Exam-hall thinking.** See how the question is broken down: its demand and structure, how to open the introduction, how to generate points, which frameworks and value additions to use and how to conclude. Measure the distance between your thinking and the ideal. By the end of a topic, your own thinking will often go further.

8 **The model answer in this book.** Note new terms, data and value additions, and see how a complete answer fits three pages. Do not memorise it.

9 **Toppers' answers.** Glance through three to five toppers' answers on ghissu.com, drawn from more than 1.5 lakh answers, mostly by UPSC toppers. The APPSC syllabus overlaps heavily with UPSC, so they apply directly. Spend little time on each. Your mind will start to notice how they earn the extra half mark in each part, and their keywords will come back to you in the hall.

10 **Value additions.** For the latest figures and data, use the value additions on the question or the topic. They are taken from official government sources, ready to quote in an answer.

PHASE D Consolidate

11 **Hold back the notes.** Do not write short notes after a single question; you will end up copying everything. If something is essential, add it to My notes on that question. Your notes collect topic by topic on their own, so nothing is written twice.

12 **Next question, same loop.** Repeat steps 4 to 11 for every question in the topic, keeping to the time limits so that no step runs away with your day.

13 **Write your topic notes last.** When every question is done, write one to three ways to open and close an answer on this topic, a few multi-dimensional points each for positives, negatives and the way forward, and the keywords and frameworks you will break a question into. Fifteen to twenty points and a diagram are enough to reproduce in the exam. The strategy section of each topic on ghissu.com helps, but your own versions matter more.

APPSC Group-I Mains · Paper III

Model answers in handwriting style, 2008 to 2025, numbered as in the official papers · latest-syllabus arrangement

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).
Click a question to open its model answer. "Practice" opens the same question on ghissu.com.

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2025	30 answers		
1(a)	What are the emergency functions of the Union Government of India? Describe how they impact the legislative powers of Parliament and State Legislatures.	16	Practice →
1(b)	The Indian Constitution favours a federal type of government. Considering this, what duties does the Constitution place on State Governments to ensure the smooth...	19	Practice →
2(a)	The procedure of enacting a law from a bill differs at the Union and State levels, primarily to safeguard the interests of the Union Government in state legislation....	22	Practice →
2(b)	Although States have their separate list for law-making, this authority is not beyond the overarching legislative powers of the Parliament. Examine.	25	Practice →
3(a)	The Finance Commission is considered the backbone of fiscal federalism in India. Examine its role and significance in maintaining the financial balance between the...	28	Practice →
3(b)	Discuss the significance of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in strengthening grassroots democracy in India.	31	Practice →
4(a)	What are the steps followed by the Indian Parliament in transforming a Bill into an Act?	34	Practice →
4(b)	In what aspects is the Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) different from the Rajya Sabha, considering its role at the state level?	37	Practice →
5(a)	The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protectio...	40	Practice →
5(b)	Discuss any two constitutional amendments that have significantly affected the powers or functioning of the Indian judiciary.	43	Practice →
6(a)	The administrative system of the Gupta dynasty was, in many ways, similar to that of the Mauryan Empire. Discuss the key similarities and differences between the two...	46	Practice →
6(b)	What features of British administration have influenced the Indian administrative system?	49	Practice →
7(a)	Education is a vital sector for boosting the development of any nation. Highlight the recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government.	52	Practice →
7(b)	Although policies formulated by departments are prepared by experts, the results often fall short of expectations. What are the major issues responsible for this gap between...	55	Practice →
8(a)	What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and the limitations it faces in a democratic system.	58	Practice →
8(b)	In what ways can the role of NGOs be enhanced in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, with a focus on the key challenges they encounter.	61	Practice →
9(a)	Under which Act was the National Commission for Women (NCW) established? Describe its main features and limitations.	64	Practice →
9(b)	Which constitutional provisions empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities in India? Explain with suitable examples.	67	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
10(a)	Social audit helps to narrow gaps between vision and reality. Examine the statement and also discuss the impediments in the institutionalisation of social audit in India.	70	Practice →
10(b)	Define good governance. How does the Right to Information (RTI) Act promote the principles of good governance in India?	73	Practice →
11(a)	Public servants often face situations where personal values conflict with public responsibilities. Examine how a strong ethical foundation can help resolve such...	76	Practice →
11(b)	Whistleblowers are guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Discuss the ethical and institutional importance of whistleblower protection in ensuring integrity in...	79	Practice →
12(a)	What ethical values are essential to ensure peaceful coexistence in a diverse society? Illustrate your answer with suitable examples.	82	Practice →
12(b)	How does early value education in the family influence ethical decision-making in adulthood?	85	Practice →
13(a)	Define attitude. How does attitude affect the behaviour of public servants?	88	Practice →
13(b)	Explain the difference between cognitive, affective and behavioural components of attitude with suitable examples in the public service context.	91	Practice →
14(a)	In what ways can the implementation of a code of ethics in public administration help in resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decision-making?	94	Practice →
14(b)	Discuss the significance of integrity, transparency and accountability in leadership. How can public leaders demonstrate these values in their decision-making process?	97	Practice →
15(a)	What do you understand by cyberstalking? What are the various other cyber offences recognised under Information Technology Act, 2000?	100	Practice →
15(b)	What is GST? Discuss the regulatory framework of GST in India, including Constitutional provisions applicable to GST.	103	Practice →
2023	30 answers		
1(a)	Examine the scope of 'reasonable restrictions' and the 'test of reasonableness' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution.	107	Practice →
1(b)	Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council and discuss its relevance in the context of Centre-State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in India.	110	Practice →
2(a)	The office of the Governor in certain situations carries with it the exercise of 'discretionary functions' and 'special responsibilities'. Discuss this statement in view of...	113	Practice →
2(b)	The National Education Policy (2020) has been criticized as denuding the autonomy of states. In this connection, examine the rationale behind the transfer of matters from th...	116	Practice →
3(a)	Discuss the scope and challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj. Briefly suggest on how to enhance women empowerment...	119	Practice →
3(b)	The Finance Commission, though not being a permanent body, has still maintained its credibility by promoting fiscal democracy in India' — Comment.	122	Practice →
4(a)	Briefly discuss the different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament. Comment on the difference between motions and resolutions.	125	Practice →
4(b)	Describe the matters in which the Legislative Council stands equal with the Legislative Assembly along with the matters in which it stands unequal with the Legislative...	128	Practice →
5(a)	Discuss the scope of Judicial review in reviewing administrative action, legislative enactments and judicial decisions.	131	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
5(b)	What is meant by Public Interest Litigation (PIL) ? Describe the nature of court orders that are passed by courts in PIL cases.	134	Practice →
6(a)	"The concept of the welfare state had been crystallised in Kautilya's ideas long before it came to be envisioned in Western Europe' — Examine this statement.	137	Practice →
6(b)	It is observed that much of present-day Indian bureaucracy is a result of British administration. In this connection, explain the evolution of Civil Service in India.	140	Practice →
7(a)	Government's intervention in development has seen a long way of impressive outcomes in India. In this connection, discuss the 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' mission aimed...	143	Practice →
7(b)	Explain the scope of civil service reforms in India with a brief note on Mission Karmayogi.	146	Practice →
8(a)	"The making of the Right to Information Act, 2005 in India has been largely attributed to the success of civil society movement." Comment.	149	Practice →
8(b)	"NGOs play a critical role in promoting human rights, defending the marginalized, and creating a more just and equitable society." Comment on the role of NGO's in India.	152	Practice →
9(a)	Explain the quasi-judicial nature of Administrative Tribunals. Examine whether writs and appeals are available against the decisions of the Administrative Tribunals.	155	Practice →
9(b)	What are the reasons for decline of integrity in civil services ? Also, discuss the institutional mechanism to check corruption in India.	158	Practice →
10(a)	Discuss the Indian experience of Citizen Charter movement and suggest solutions to improve its impact in India.	161	Practice →
10(b)	What are the different dimensions of governance? Briefly explain the administrative dimension of governance and its key components.	164	Practice →
11(a)	"Ethics in public service is an essential component of parliamentary democracy" — In this connection, discuss the pathway towards a 'Naitik Bharat'.	167	Practice →
11(b)	Define 'Accountability'. Discuss the factors that have led to weakening of accountability in civil services. Suggest ways to improve the mechanisms for accountability in civil...	170	Practice →
12(a)	Discuss the significance of values in the development of personality and socio-cultural systems. Add a brief note on the hierarchy of values in India.	173	Practice →
12(b)	Vinoba Bhave's reform ideology had helped to nurture an ethical atmosphere in Indian public life. In this connection, evaluate the relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in...	176	Practice →
13(a)	Do attitudes influence behaviour? Discuss the polarization of political attitudes in India.	179	Practice →
13(b)	Define Persuasion and its constructs. Can the power of persuasion be used by civil servants in order to realize the ends and objectives of a 'New India'? Substantiate.	182	Practice →
14(a)	Does popular democracy breed distrust in the public towards their representatives ? Discuss the scope of ethical leadership in democracy and politics.	185	Practice →
14(b)	What is meant by 'International Ethics' ? Explain the significance of ethics in international dispute resolutions and environmental cooperation among nations.	188	Practice →
15(a)	Define Substantive Law and Procedural Law. Discuss the interrelationship and differences between Substantive Law and Procedural Law.	191	Practice →
15(b)	Are Direct Taxes transferable or non-transferable? Explain the recent Direct Tax Reforms undertaken in India.	194	Practice →

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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2020	30 answers		
1(a)	How was the Constituent Assembly formed that framed the Indian constitution? Critically evaluate the Constitution of India as framed by the Constituent Assembly.	198	Practice →
1(b)	Define Judicial Review with special reference to the classification given by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri. Describe the importance and scope of Judicial Review.	201	Practice →
2(a)	Why did we adopt federalism with a strong central government? Explain the important provisions that create a strong central government.	204	Practice →
2(b)	Define Privileges of state legislature and classify it into two broad categories.	207	Practice →
3(a)	Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendment of the Indian Constitution.	210	Practice →
3(b)	Explain the role of Governor in states by focusing on its powers and functions.	213	Practice →
4(a)	Differentiate between the powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of the following parameters: functions and control over election. Explain, with reasons,...	216	Practice →
4(b)	Explain any five salient features of the Indian Constitution.	219	Practice →
5(a)	Define judicial activism with special reference to PIL and SAL. Judicial activism has had manifold impact on the political system. Justify the statement adding suitable...	222	Practice →
5(b)	Describe the salient features of the Rural and Urban Local Governance under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Act.	225	Practice →
6(a)	Define public administration and explain its evolution in India.	228	Practice →
6(b)	Differentiate between the administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashashtra and the Mughal administration.	231	Practice →
7(a)	Define 'development' as explained by Prof. Amartya Sen. Explain the characteristics of the new development thinking, and also mention the four areas where the governmen...	234	Practice →
7(b)	Describe the role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy.	237	Practice →
8(a)	Give the reason for the UN to partner with the civil society. Explain the importance of civil societies. Under which Acts are the NGOs in India legally registered?	240	Practice →
8(b)	What is RTI? What rights are available under RTI Act 2005? If RTI is a Fundamental Right, then why do we need an Act to give us this Right?	243	Practice →
9(a)	Describe the work of the statutory bodies with example and mention in which countries they are set up. Explain quasi-judicial bodies, providing two examples from India.	246	Practice →
9(b)	What is social audit? What are its objectives and advantages?	249	Practice →
10(a)	Why does the Indian Government make use of the e-governance strategy? Mention the several initiatives in the journey from e-governance vision to implementation. How...	252	Practice →
10(b)	Explain the major governmental interventions in the social sector with special reference to Health and education.	255	Practice →
11(a)	Define ethics, with reference to ethics in Indian tradition. Mention five principles to manage ethics in public service.	258	Practice →
11(b)	What are the necessity and importance of labour laws? Are India's labour law reforms only a gift for factories or do workers benefit too?	261	Practice →
12(a)	What do you understand by the values of an entity? What is the need for value education? Discuss how gender inequality came to be recognised as inequality in the...	264	Practice →
12(b)	Explain the Lokpal and Lokyukta Act.	267	Practice →

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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
13(a)	Define moral attitude and explain the four qualities of moral attitude. What are the factors that shape political attitude?	270	Practice →
13(b)	Explain the concept of emotional intelligence with special reference to the three main models of emotional intelligence. How are emotional intelligence applied in...	273	Practice →
14(a)	Define public service broadly. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. Suggest three preventive...	276	Practice →
14(b)	What is the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating values?	279	Practice →
15(a)	Explain the different types of cybercrimes and the importance of cyber laws in India.	282	Practice →
15(b)	How does time and space effect ethics in private and public relationships? Illustrate.	285	Practice →
2017	10 answers		
P-II 11(a) old P-II	The Indian Constitution provides for a democratic system in India. In this backdrop, briefly analyse the constitutional provisions with regard to tyranny of majority and...	289	Practice →
P-II 11(b) old P-II	"In spite of unitary features of the Constitution, federalism survived in India." Comment.	292	Practice →
P-II 12(a) old P-II	What is office of profit ? Critically analyse the developments in India on this issue.	295	Practice →
P-II 12(b) old P-II	Distinguish between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism and also cite the important decisions of the Supreme Court on the two subjects.	298	Practice →
P-II 13(a) old P-II	Describe the formation and functions of Inter-State Council. State some of the important decisions taken by the Inter-State Council in the last 3 years.	301	Practice →
P-II 13(b) old P-II	Briefly describe the recommendations of 14th Finance Commission with regard to devolution of funds to rural local bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions). What measures...	304	Practice →
P-II 14(a) old P-II	What is the difference between a National party and a Regional party, in case of parties recognised by the Election Commission of India ? Explain the features of the Indian...	307	Practice →
P-II 14(b) old P-II	Mention the important events in usage of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) in elections in India. Analyse the recent allegations on tampering of EVMs and suggest...	310	Practice →
P-II 15(a) old P-II	"The Right to Information Act is meant only for providing information but not grievance redressal." Comment.	313	Practice →
P-II 15(b) old P-II	What are the functions of the National Commission for Women ?	316	Practice →
2016	10 answers		
P-II 11(a) old P-II	"The Indian constitution is federal in form but unitary in spirit" - Discuss.	320	Practice →
P-II 11(b) old P-II	Analyze the effectiveness of implementation of the Directive Principles of State Policy and suggest ways to improve it.	323	Practice →
P-II 12(a) old P-II	What is concept of cooperative federalism? Does it exist in Indian polity?	326	Practice →
P-II 12(b) old P-II	Comment briefly on the financial relations between the Union and the States in India. What are irritants generally encountered?	329	Practice →
P-II 13(a) old P-II	What is meant by "judicial activism"? What is its impact on Indian polity?	332	Practice →
P-II 13(b) old P-II	What is the relative position of the Rajya Sabha as compared to the Lok Sabha in our political system?	335	Practice →
P-II 14(a) old P-II	Describe the procedure for amending the constitution? What is the criticism against it?	338	Practice →
P-II 14(b) old P-II	What according to the Supreme Court constitutes "the basic structure" of our constitution? Please name a couple of important judgements of the Supreme Court o...	341	Practice →

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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 15(a) old P-II	Describe the various special provisions in the constitution relating to scheduled castes, scheduled tribes, backward classes and Anglo-Indians.	344	Practice →
P-II 15(b) old P-II	Explain the concept of minorities with reference to the Indian constitution and the safeguards available for protection of their rights.	347	Practice →
2012	10 answers		
P-II 11(a) old P-II	Explain the Right to Equality guaranteed under the Constitution of India in the light of the doctrine of reasonable classification.	351	Practice →
P-II 11(b) old P-II	Analyse the concept and importance of Directive Principles of State Policy. Explain the relationship and difference between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive...	354	Practice →
P-II 12(a) old P-II	Discuss the administrative relations between the Union and the States. How are the Inter State Water Disputes resolved in India?	357	Practice →
P-II 12(b) old P-II	Discuss the powers and functions of the Election Commission of India and explain its role in protection of representative democracy in India.	360	Practice →
P-II 13(a) old P-II	Explain the privileges and immunities of legislature under the Constitution of India. How far can the judiciary interfere with such privileges and immunities?	363	Practice →
P-II 13(b) old P-II	Discuss the grounds on which administrative action may be reviewed by the judiciary, and the various modes of such judicial review.	366	Practice →
P-II 14(a) old P-II	Analyse the Constitutional Amendments made so far in relation to the Fundamental Rights guaranteed under Part III of the Constitution.	369	Practice →
P-II 14(b) old P-II	Write a critical note on the Emergency Powers under the Constitution and their misuses, if any.	372	Practice →
P-II 15(a) old P-II	Analyse the aims and objectives of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 Explain whether such objectives have been...	375	Practice →
P-II 15(b) old P-II	What are the Constitutional guarantees given to women? Explain the role of the National Commission for Women in protecting the rights of the women.	378	Practice →
2011	10 answers		
P-II 11(a) old P-II	The constitution postulates in its Preamble that India shall be a Secular Republic. What are the constitutional provisions consistent this declaration?	382	Practice →
P-II 11(b) old P-II	Trace the genesis and development of Uniform Civil code in India. Cite authoritative judgments on this issue.	385	Practice →
P-II 12(a) old P-II	What are the principles adopted by the Courts in an irreconcilable conflict between a law made by the Parliament and a law made by the State legislature?	388	Practice →
P-II 12(b) old P-II	Give instances wherein the Constitution provides control of the Union over the States.	391	Practice →
P-II 13(a) old P-II	Explain the conflict resolution mechanism in case of deadlock between the two houses of a State legislature on a piece of legislation.	394	Practice →
P-II 13(b) old P-II	"There is no constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings." Explain with reference to leading cases.	397	Practice →
P-II 14(a) old P-II	Explain the Constitutional guarantee to the Right to property in the light of the 44th Amendment Act.	400	Practice →
P-II 14(b) old P-II	"The basic structure of the Constitution in effect limits the amending power of the Parliament." – Discuss.	403	Practice →
P-II 15(a) old P-II	Explain the powers and functions of the Human Rights Commission.	406	Practice →

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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 15(b) old P-II	Examine the classification of Scheduled Castes within the constitutional scheme.	409	Practice →
2008	10 answers		
P-II 11(a)	"Preamble is a part of the Indian Constitution." — Comment.	413	Practice →
P-II 11(b) old P-II	Is India a Federation ?	416	Practice →
P-II 12(a) old P-II	Do you agree with the view that functions are given to the States while resources are with the Centre ?	419	Practice →
P-II 12(b) old P-II	"The Comptroller and Auditor-General of India is a friend, philosopher and guide of Public Accounts Committee." — Discuss.	422	Practice →
P-II 13(a)	Comment on the declining trend of legislative debates.	425	Practice →
P-II 13(b) old P-II	What are the novel trends in Judicial Review ?	428	Practice →
P-II 14(a) old P-II	"Article 356 is more misused than used." — Comment.	431	Practice →
P-II 14(b) old P-II	Panchayati Raj is a "God that failed." — Evaluate.	434	Practice →
P-II 15(a) old P-II	Bring out the politics of Women's Reservation Bill.	437	Practice →
P-II 15(b) old P-II	Analyse the functions and functioning of National Commission for Scheduled Castes.	440	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

PAPER III AT A GLANCE

Trend analysis

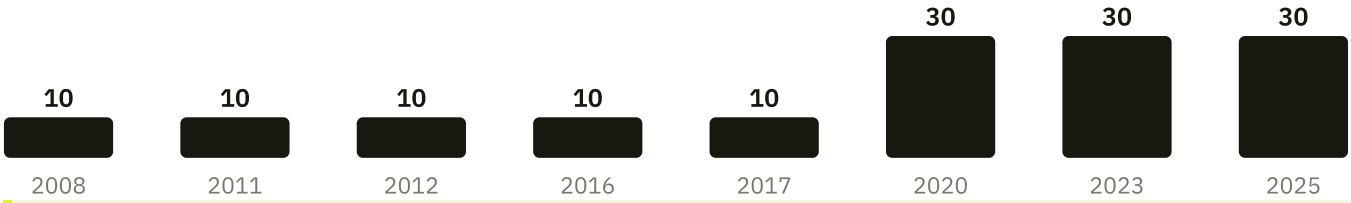
140
APPSC QUESTIONS

8
SITTINGS, 2008 TO 2025

15
CHAPTERS

55
SUB-TOPICS ASKED

QUESTIONS BY SITTING



Darker cells mark the sub-topics the commission returns to most. Older sittings (2008 to 2017) are counted under today's syllabus.
To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
1. Indian Constitution, Fundamental Rights, DPSP and Union-State functions	**1**	**4**	**3**	**4**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**2**	**18**
1.1 Indian Constitution and its salient features	1	1	·	1	·	2	·	·	5
1.2 Functions and duties of the Indian Union and the State Governments	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
1.3 Fundamental Rights	·	2	2	2	1	·	1	1	9
1.4 Directive Principles of State Policy	·	1	1	1	·	·	·	·	3
2. Federal structure, Governor and distribution of powers	**2**	**2**	**1**	**3**	**2**	**2**	**3**	**2**	**17**
2.1 Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure	1	1	·	2	2	1	1	·	8
2.2 Role of Governor in States	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	1	3
2.3 Distribution of powers between the Union and States (Union list, State list and...	1	1	1	1	·	·	1	1	6
3. Local governance (73rd/74th) and Constitutional Authorities	**3**	**·**	**1**	**·**	**3**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**13**
3.1 Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amen...	1	·	·	·	1	2	1	1	6
3.2 Constitutional Authorities and their Role	2	·	1	·	2	·	1	1	7
4. Parliament and State Legislatures	**2**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**13**
4.1 structure	1	1	·	1	·	1	1	1	6
4.2 functioning	1	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	3
4.4 powers & privileges	·	1	1	·	1	1	·	·	4
5. Judiciary in India	**2**	**1**	**3**	**2**	**1**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**15**
5.2 important provisions relating to emergency	1	·	1	·	·	·	·	1	3
5.3 constitutional amendments	·	1	1	1	·	·	·	1	4
5.4 judicial review	1	·	1	1	1	2	1	·	7
5.5 Public Interest Litigation	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
6. Public Administration: meaning and evolution in India	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**6**
6.1 Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
6.2 Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2
6.3 Mughal administration	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
6.4 Legacy of British rule	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2

PAPER III TREND ANALYSIS, CONTINUED

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
7. Government policies and interventions for development	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2	4
7.1 Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	1	3
7.2 issues and problems of implementation	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
8. Development processes: civil society and NGOs	·	·	·	·	·	3	2	2	7
8.1 Development processes	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
8.2 the role of civil society, NGOs and other stakeholders	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
9. Statutory, regulatory, quasi-judicial bodies and Civil Services	·	1	1	·	1	1	3	2	9
9.1 Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial authorities	·	1	1	·	1	1	1	2	7
9.2 Role of Civil Services in Democracy	·	·	·	·	·	·	2	·	2
10. Good governance, e-governance, RTI and Social Audit	·	·	·	·	1	3	2	2	8
10.1 Good governance	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
10.2 e-governance	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
10.4 Citizen's Charter	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
10.5 RTI	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	1	3
10.7 Concept of Social Audit and its importance	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	2
11. Ethics and Human Interface	·	·	·	·	·	2	1	1	4
11.2 dimensions of Ethics	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
11.3 Ethics in Private and Public relationships	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
11.4 Ethics-integrity and Accountability in Public Service	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2
12. Human values	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
12.1 Understanding the Harmony in existence Human relationships in the society ...	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2
12.2 Gender Equability in the relationships	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
12.3 Role of family, society and Educational Institutions in imparting values to citi...	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	2
12.4 lessons from the lives and teachings of great leaders, reformers and adminis...	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
13. Attitude and Emotional intelligence	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
13.1 Content, Functions	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
13.2 its influence and relation with thought and behaviour	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
13.3 Moral and Political attitudes	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	2
13.4 role of Social influence and persuasion	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
13.5 Emotional intelligence- Concepts and their utilities and application in Admini...	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
14. Public Service ethics, codes, corruption and Lokpal	·	·	·	·	·	2	3	3	8
14.1 Concept of Public Service	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
14.4 Codes of Ethics, codes of Conduct	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
14.5 Leadership Ethics	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2
14.7 Ethical principles with in an Organizational content	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
14.8 Ethical and moral values in governance	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
14.9 Ethical issues in international relations	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
14.11 Lokpal, Lokayukta	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
15. Basic Knowledge of Laws in India	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
15.2 difference between substantial and procedural laws	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
15.6 changing trends in employment and necessity for new labour laws	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
15.8 Cyber Security and Cyber Crime	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	2
15.10 Laws relating to income, Profits, Wealth Tax, Corporate Tax	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
15.11 GST	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
Paper III total	**10**	**10**	**10**	**10**	**10**	**30**	**30**	**30**	**140**

1 question 2 3 or more · not asked that year

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APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2025

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) What are the emergency functions of the Union Government of India? Describe how they impact the legislative powers of Parliament and State Legislatures.

10

Introduction

The emergency provisions in Part XVIII (Articles 352 to 360) empower the Union to respond decisively to war, external aggression, armed rebellion or financial crisis. By centralising authority to protect sovereignty and unity, they temporarily transform India's federal structure into a unitary system.

Emergency Functions of the Union

1. Legislative authority: Under a National Emergency (Article 352), Parliament can legislate on any subject, including the State List, as during the 1971 Indo-Pak war.

2. Executive control over states: Under Article 356, the Union can take over state administration when constitutional machinery fails, directing state executives and overriding their policies.

3. Suspension of rights: Certain fundamental rights can be suspended and judicial review limited, during the 1975 Emergency, judicial scrutiny of executive action was curtailed.

Practice 1(a) on Ghissu →
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4. Financial powers: Under a Financial Emergency (Article 360), the Union can direct financial propriety, cut salaries of state officials and reserve money bills for the President, restricting the fiscal autonomy of states like Andhra Pradesh.

Impact on Parliament's Legislative Powers

Impact of Emergency on Legislative Powers

Parliament	State Legislatures
Legislates on State List	Lose exclusive power over subjects
Overrides state laws	Suspended or dissolved (Article 356)
Controls state taxation, grants	Reserve financial bills for President

1. Expanded lawmaking: Parliament legislates on all subjects, including state ones, ensuring a unified response but concentrating lawmaking power at the Centre.
2. Override of state laws: It can override state legislation, as during the 1975–77 Emergency.
3. Financial legislation: It gains control over state taxation and grants, increasing fiscal dependency.

Impact on State Legislatures

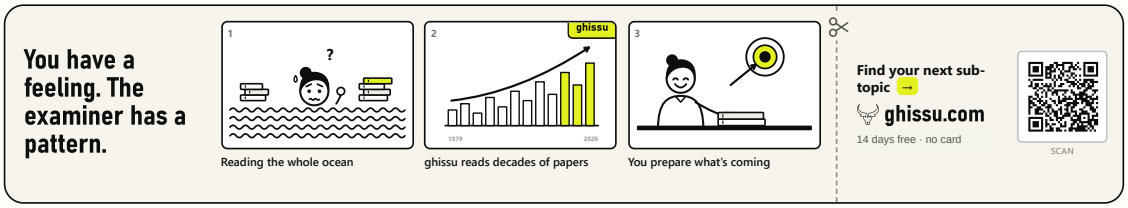
1. **Suspension or dissolution:** Under President's Rule, they can be suspended or dissolved, halting lawmaking entirely.
2. **Loss of autonomy:** Even when functioning, they lose exclusive power over their subjects as Parliament assumes concurrent or exclusive powers.
3. **Financial constraints:** They must reserve financial bills for presidential assent and follow Union directives.

Way Forward

Prior consultation before President's Rule, parliamentary review of proclamations and dialogue through the Inter-State Council can protect federal balance.

Conclusion

Emergency functions are vital for national security but sharply curtail state legislative powers, making strong federal safeguards essential.



1(b) The Indian Constitution favours a federal type of government. Considering this, what duties does the Constitution place on State Governments to ensure the smooth functioning of the nation?

10

Introduction

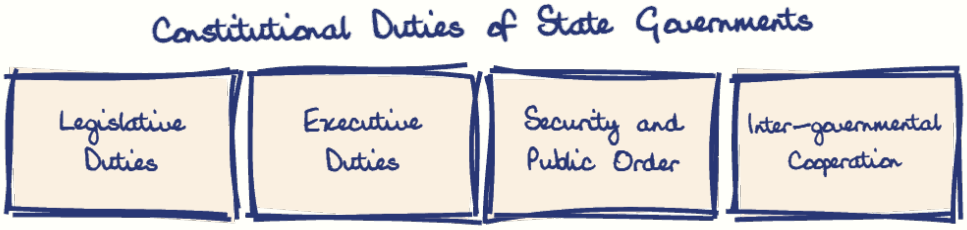
The Constitution establishes a federal system to manage India's size and diversity, describing India as a "Union of States" under Article 1. It entrusts State Governments with specific duties to balance national unity with regional autonomy.

Constitutional Duties of State Governments

1. **Legislative:** Legislate on the State List and share the Concurrent List under Schedule VII, respecting Union supremacy on overlapping matters.
2. **Executive:** Implement laws of both the State Legislature and Parliament, as in Andhra Pradesh's management of NREGA.
3. **Public order:** Under Article 355, help protect the Union against internal disturbance, as when Andhra Pradesh managed localised Covid-19 lockdowns.
4. **Cooperation:** Join inter-state councils and comply with Union directives during emergencies.

Practice 1(b) on Ghissu →
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Contribution to Smooth National Functioning

1. Regional autonomy: Local policies, like agrarian policy for the Rayalaseema drought belt, prevent alienation.
2. Cooperative federalism: Coordinated crisis management ensures national stability.
3. Internal security: State policing lets the Union focus on external threats.
4. Trust: Adherence to duties lets the Finance Commission share resources equitably.

Federal Nature and State Responsibility

1. Dual polity: States are autonomous in their domain, but the Centre's overriding powers make it quasi-federal.
2. Harmonious construction: This Supreme Court doctrine lets State and Union laws coexist without conflict.
3. Fiscal interdependence: GST and Finance Commission transfers require prudent state finances,

as Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status shows.

Way Forward

Strengthen inter-state councils for better dialogue, and empower state institutions to discharge their legislative, executive and security duties effectively.

Conclusion

These duties make States accountable partners in Dr. Ambedkar's vision of a strong yet flexible federation, keeping the nation united and functioning smoothly.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

Measure progress, don't guess it

Writing more is not the same as writing better. This is how to know which one you're doing.

1. **Score everything** — Even a rough attempt gets a number.
2. **Rewrite** — The same question, one week later.
3. **Compare** — Intro, dimensions, conclusion — side by side.
4. **One fix at a time** — Track a single weakness until it's gone.

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SCAN

2(a) The procedure of enacting a law from a bill differs at the Union and State levels, primarily to safeguard the interests of the Union Government in state legislation. Elucidate this aspect.

10

Introduction

India's legislative process balances state autonomy with Union supremacy. The procedure for enacting laws differs at the Union and State levels to safeguard the Union's interests, through Articles 200, 254 and 356, as reinforced by the Sarkaria Commission.

Union Level Procedure

1. Introduction: A bill may start in either House, but Money Bills must originate in the Lok Sabha.
2. Committee Scrutiny: Parliamentary committees act as miniature legislatures, vetting bills technically and politically.
3. Bicameral Approval: Deadlocks are resolved in a joint session, where the Lok Sabha usually prevails.
4. Presidential Assent: The President can approve, withhold or return a bill, except Money Bills.

State Level Procedure

1. **Introduction:** Money Bills originate in the Legislative Assembly.
2. **Council's Limited Role:** The Legislative Council can delay a Money Bill for only 14 days.
3. **Governor's Role:** Under ~~Article~~ 200, the Governor may assent, withhold or reserve a bill; bills affecting High Court powers or certain taxes must be reserved.
4. **President's Assent:** For a reserved bill the President cannot return it for reconsideration.

Union and State law-making

Union	State
Money Bills start in Lok Sabha	Money Bills start in Assembly
Joint sitting ends deadlock	Council delays only 14 days
President may return a bill	Governor may reserve, Article 200
Bill returned can be reconsidered	President cannot return reserved bill

How the Differences Safeguard the Union

1. **Power to Reserve:** The Union can scrutinise and

veto state laws that undermine national unity, as the Sarkaria Commission stressed.

2. Article 254: In concurrent matters, Union law prevails over repugnant state laws.

3. Emergency Provisions: During a national emergency (Article 352) or President's Rule (Article 356), Parliament can legislate on state subjects, and such laws continue even after the emergency.

4. Deadlock Resolution: Joint sessions have no state equivalent, reflecting the Union's need for decisive legislative action.

Conclusion

These procedural differences let states make laws on their own subjects while ensuring, through reservation, repugnancy and emergency provisions, that their laws do not conflict with national priorities, preserving the unity and integrity of the federation.

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

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SCAN

2(b) Although States have their separate list for law-making, this authority is not beyond the overarching legislative powers of the Parliament. Examine.

10

Introduction

The Indian Constitution demarcates legislative powers between the Union and States through separate lists. However, provisions empowering Parliament to legislate on State subjects under specific conditions reflect a strong centralising tendency, balancing national unity with regional autonomy.

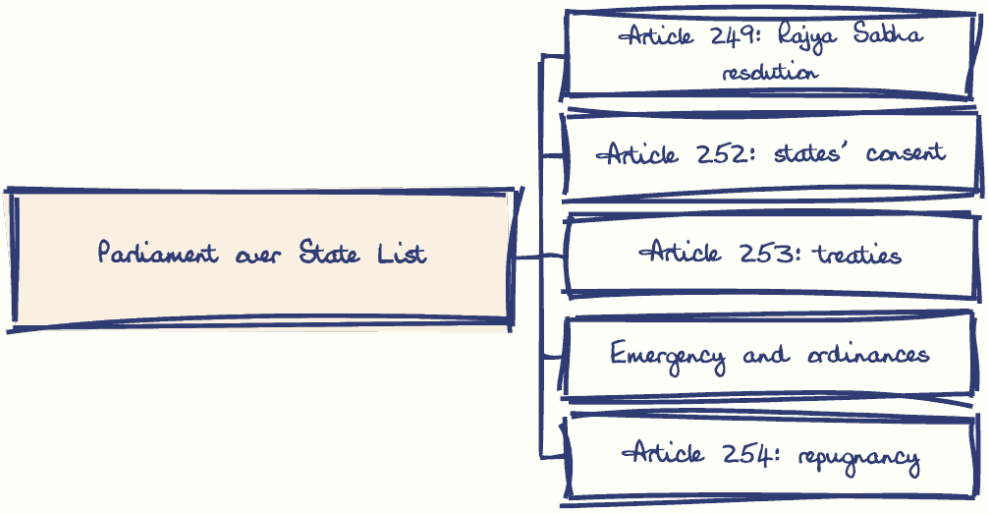
States' Separate Legislative Domain

1. **State List:** The Seventh Schedule assigns (61) subjects to States, including public order, police, agriculture and local governance.
2. **Concurrent List:** On (52) subjects such as criminal law and marriage, Union law prevails in conflict unless a State law has presidential assent.
3. **Andhra Pradesh Context:** Irrigation and water management, vital to its agrarian economy, are State subjects, yet national projects like Polavaram involve Union legislation.

Parliament's Overarching Powers

1. **Residuary Powers:** Article 248 vests unenumerated subjects in Parliament.
2. **Article 249 National Interest:** A two-thirds Rajya Sabha resolution lets Parliament legislate on State subjects temporarily.
3. **Article 252 Consent:** Parliament may legislate for two or more consenting States, as relevant to Krishna and Godavari basin disputes.
4. **Article 253 Treaties:** Parliament can legislate on any subject to implement international treaties.
5. **Emergency and Ordinances:** In a national emergency Parliament's domain covers the State List, and the President and Governors can promulgate ordinances.

Parliament's reach into the State List



Judicial Interpretation and Checks

1. Article 246 Framework: It defines the subject-matter jurisdiction of both legislatures.
2. Harmonious Construction: Courts balance powers, as in State of West Bengal v. Union of India.
3. Judicial Review: Courts can strike down laws by either level that breach the Constitution.

Way Forward

1. Clear Criteria: Define guidelines for invoking Article 249.
2. Dialogue: Use the Inter-State Council to build consensus on legislative overlaps such as water disputes.
3. Judicial Capacity: Equip courts to resolve Centre-State legislative conflicts swiftly.

Conclusion

States enjoy real autonomy in their list, but it coexists with Parliament's residuary, national interest, consent, treaty and emergency powers, designed for national cohesion.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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SCAN

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Scan to practice

3(a) The Finance Commission is considered the backbone of fiscal federalism in India. Examine its role and significance in maintaining the financial balance between the Union and the States.

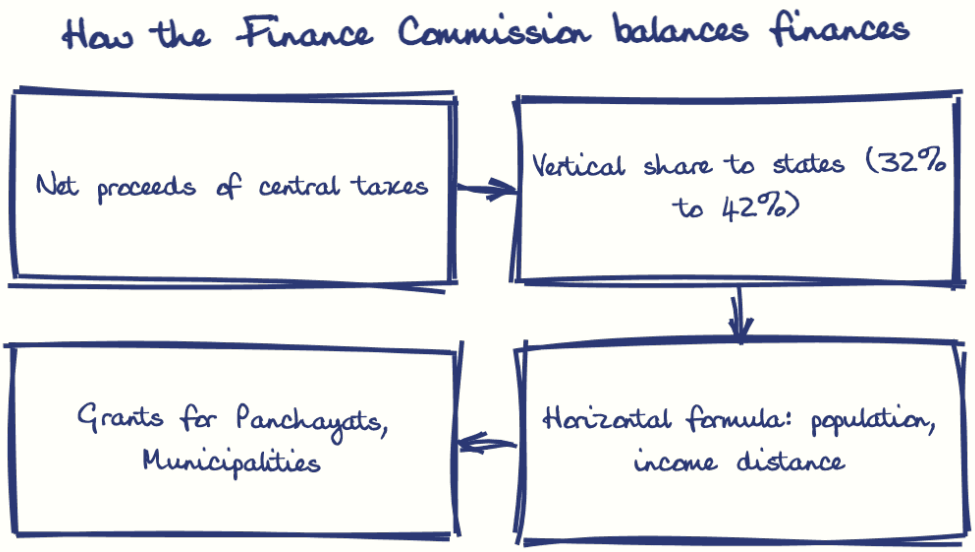
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Introduction

The Finance Commission under Article 280 recommends how financial resources are shared between the Union and the States. Its importance grew after the Fourteenth Commission raised states' share of central taxes from 32% to 42%, vital for states like Andhra Pradesh facing post-bifurcation challenges.

Role in Fiscal Federalism

1. Vertical Equity: Under Article 280(3) it recommends sharing of central taxes, bridging the gap between Union revenue powers and state spending duties.
2. Quasi-Judicial Function: Its expert recommendations every five years, generally accepted, make transfers regular and reduce arbitrariness.
3. Horizontal Balance: It allocates among states using population, income distance and fiscal capacity.
4. Local Governments: Based on State Finance Commission reports, it augments resources for Panchayats and Municipalities.



Significance for Financial Balance

1. Fiscal Autonomy: Higher devolution lets states plan development with greater autonomy.
2. Cooperative and Competitive Federalism: Performance-based incentives reward governance and fiscal discipline.
3. Debt Risks: Its assessment of deficits and debt guides grants; the Sixteenth Commission's focus on fiscal consolidation suits states like Andhra Pradesh with large liabilities.
4. Challenges: Delayed State Finance Commission reports, weak coordination with the GST Council and population data disputes.

Way Forward

1. State Finance Commissions: Timely constitution and

capacity building.

2. Inclusive Terms of Reference: Involve states in framing them so concerns like climate change are covered.

3. Coordination: Institutionalise links between the Finance Commission, GST Council and states.

4. Performance Incentives: Expand performance metrics in transfers.

Conclusion

By correcting vertical and horizontal imbalances, supporting local bodies and guiding states towards fiscal discipline, the Finance Commission is rightly the backbone of fiscal federalism. Better coordination and inclusive Terms of Reference will keep Union–State finances balanced and predictable.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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SCAN

3(b) Discuss the significance of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in strengthening grassroots democracy in India.

10

Introduction

The 73rd Amendment Act, 1992 was a watershed, recognising Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) as the third tier of government. Enacted amid demands for decentralisation and governance deficits, it embedded local self-government in the Constitution to make rural governance inclusive and participatory.

Key Features

1. Constitutional Status: Part IX made Panchayats permanent institutions with a fixed five-year tenure, ensuring continuity.
2. Elections and Reservation: Direct elections at all levels, with seats for SCs, STs and not less than one-third for women.
3. Gram Sabha Empowerment: Gram Sabhas approve development plans and hold Panchayats accountable.
4. Devolution: States must devolve powers for economic development and social justice, with grants and assigned taxes.

Strengthening Grassroots Democracy

1. Political Participation: Women now form nearly

49.75% of representatives, a transformative shift in rural empowerment.

2. Democratic Deepening: Gram Sabhas allow direct citizen engagement, enhancing transparency.
3. Less Bureaucratic Monopoly: Officials became facilitators and elected representatives the primary agents of development.
4. Fiscal Empowerment: State Finance Commissions institutionalise transfers, enabling independent planning.

Limitations

1. Proxy Representation: Patriarchal and caste hierarchies sometimes make women proxies for male relatives.
2. Incomplete Devolution: Inadequate powers and resources, bureaucratic interference and patronage dilute impact.
3. Uneven Implementation: States like Andhra Pradesh hold timely elections and empower Panchayats, while others lag, so decentralisation varies across India.

Way Forward

1. Gram Sabha Capacity: Raise awareness to ensure active participation and oversight.

73rd Amendment: gains and limits

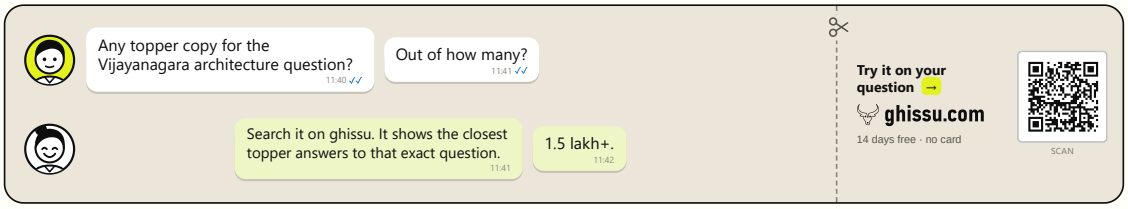
Gains	Limits
Women, marginalised included	Proxy representation
Empowered Gram Sabhas	Law awareness, attendance
SFC-backed grants	Dependence on state funds

2. Full Devolution: States must transfer adequate functions, funds and functionaries as the Constitution mandates.

3. Social Change: Pair legal safeguards with efforts against patriarchal and caste barriers so women lead in their own right.

Conclusion

The 73rd Amendment created the constitutional foundation of grassroots democracy. Its promise will be fully realised when devolution is complete and social change matches legal reform.



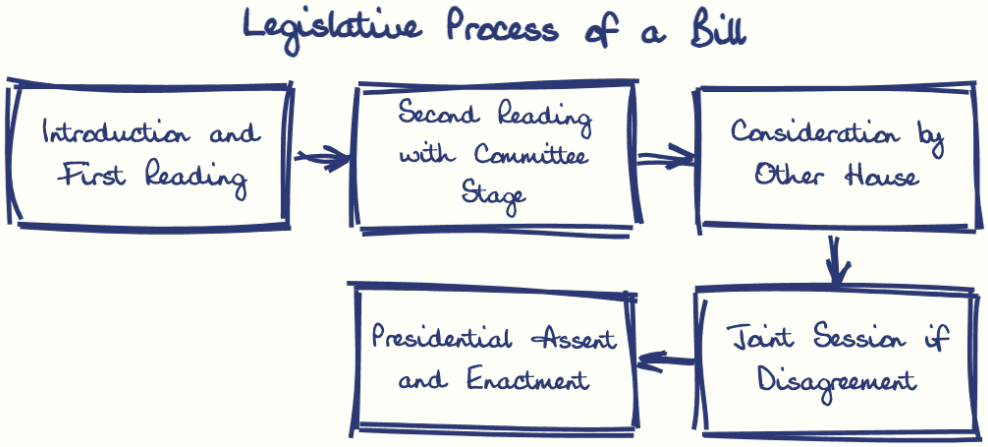
4(a) What are the steps followed by the Indian Parliament in transforming a Bill into an Act?

10

Introduction

The transformation of a Bill into an Act is a detailed constitutional procedure involving several stages and actors, balancing thorough scrutiny with political accountability. The Monsoon Session 2025, in which 14 Bills were passed and several referred to committees, shows its continuing relevance.

Sequential Steps



1. Introduction and first reading: A minister or member moves for leave to introduce the Bill in either House, its title and objectives are read without debate and it is published in the Gazette of India.

2. Second reading: This involves general discussion on principles, referral to a Select Committee for clause-by-clause examination, and consideration, where the House votes on provisions.
3. Other House: After passage, the Bill undergoes similar readings and scrutiny in the other House, both must agree on the text.
4. Joint Session: If the Houses disagree, a Joint Session may resolve the deadlock, usually favouring the Lok Sabha.

Roles of the Houses and the President

1. Co-equal Houses: Both pass ordinary and constitutional amendment Bills equally, except Money Bills.
2. Committees: Select and Joint Committees act as miniature legislatures, adding expertise.
3. Presidential assent: The President may assent, withhold assent or return a Bill (except Money Bills); if Parliament passes it again, assent must be given. Acting on ministerial advice, this is largely formal.

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Special Procedures

1. **Money Bills:** Introduced only in the Lok Sabha; the Rajya Sabha must pass them within (14) days without amendments.
2. **Constitution Amendment Bills:** Need a special majority in both Houses and sometimes ratification by half the state legislatures.
3. **Private Members' Bills:** Rarely passed but useful for raising issues.
4. **Ordinances:** When Parliament is not in session, the President may promulgate an ordinance under Article (123,) which lapses unless replaced by a Bill within six weeks of Parliament's reassembly.

Conclusion

At every stage the process allows debate, amendment and consensus, and Presidential assent finally turns a Bill into an Act.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

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Scan to practice

4(b) In what aspects is the Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) different from the Rajya Sabha, considering its role at the state level?

10

Introduction

The Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) and the Rajya Sabha are both upper houses, but their roles differ sharply. The Rajya Sabha represents states at the national level and sustains federal balance, while the Council works within a state legislature with a subordinate and advisory character, as debated in ~~Andhra Pradesh~~ after bifurcation.

Differences in Design and Composition

Legislative Council vs Rajya Sabha

Legislative Council	Rajya Sabha
Optional, can be abolished	Permanent body (~~Article~~ 80)
Local bodies, graduates, teachers, nominees	Elected by MLAs
Delays ordinary bills four months	Near-equal legislative powers
No joint sitting	Joint sitting for deadlocks
No national role	Protects states at Union level

1. Constitutional status: The Rajya Sabha is a permanent body (~~Article~~ 80) with staggered

six-year terms. The Council is an optional chamber (Article 169), existing only through an Assembly resolution and Parliament's approval, so it can be abolished.

2. Membership: Rajya Sabha members are elected by MLAs through proportional representation, giving homogeneous state representation. The Council's members are elected by local authorities, graduates and teachers, or nominated by the Governor, a heterogeneous mix.
3. Federal role: The Rajya Sabha protects state interests at the Union level, the Council has no role in national policymaking.

Differences in Powers and Functioning

1. Legislative powers: The Rajya Sabha has near-equal powers except on money bills, with joint sittings for deadlocks. The Council can only delay ordinary bills for four months, cannot amend or reject money bills, and has no joint sitting.
2. Limited influence: Its recommendations are not binding, reducing it to a delaying body.
3. Executive accountability: The state Council of Ministers answers only to the Assembly, unlike

the Rajya Sabha's role in national scrutiny.

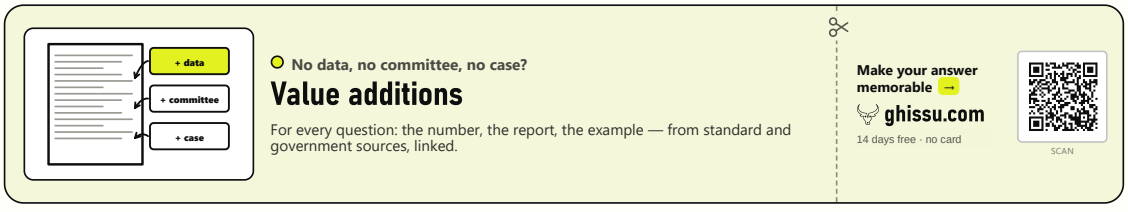
4. Cost and utility: States like Andhra Pradesh have debated its financial cost and perceived redundancy.

Reforms

1. Electoral base: More representation from local bodies, as the Second Administrative Reforms Commission recommended.
2. Clearer role: Defined scrutiny powers on non-money bills and mechanisms to resolve deadlocks can improve effectiveness without undermining the Assembly's primacy.
3. Expertise and evaluation: Nominating experts, like the Rajya Sabha's nominated members, and periodic state-specific review of its utility and cost can enrich deliberation.

Conclusion

The Council is a weaker, state-level revising body, while the Rajya Sabha is a strong federal chamber. Targeted reform can make the Council more relevant.



5(a) The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights?

10

Introduction

The Constitution, adopted in 1950, enshrines a comprehensive framework to protect citizens' rights, reflecting the framers' vision of justice, liberty and equality. Judgments like K.S. Puttaswamy (2017), which recognised privacy under Article 21, show its living nature.

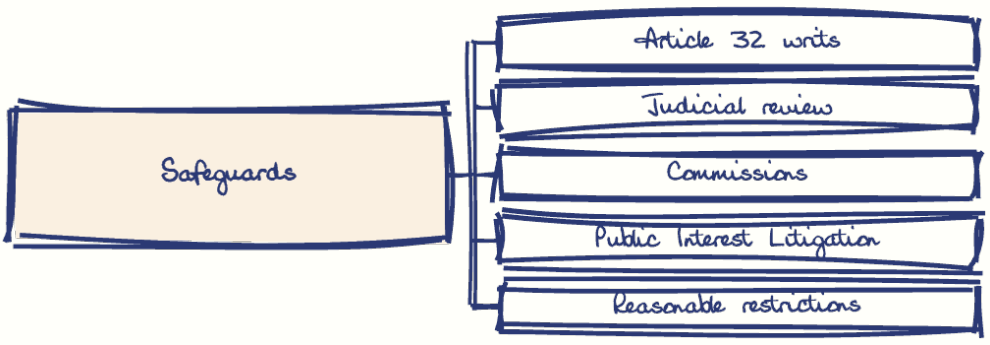
Rights Granted to Citizens

1. Fundamental Rights: Equality (Articles 14–18), freedom of speech (Article 19), life and liberty (Article 21) and cultural rights (Article 29), a broad spectrum of civil liberties.
2. Religious freedom: Articles 25 to 28 protect profession, practice and propagation of religion.
3. Citizens versus others: Some rights, like equal opportunity in public employment (Article 16), are for citizens only.
4. Text-based rights: Unlike the US Constitution, India does not recognise unenumerated natural rights; rights flow from the text and judicial interpretation.

Constitutional Safeguards

1. Article 32: The Supreme Court issues writs to enforce rights; Maneka Gandhi (1978) broadened Article (21) to living with dignity.
2. Reasonable restrictions: Rights may be limited only for sovereignty, public order, morality and health, balancing freedom with societal needs.
3. Emergency provisions: Articles (352) and (359) allow suspension, a power misused during 1975–77.
4. Directive Principles: Though non-justiciable, they guide the state to frame welfare laws that supplement rights, creating inclusive governance.

Safeguards of citizens' rights



Institutional Mechanisms

1. Judicial review: As the "jealous guardian", the judiciary strikes down violating laws; Kesavananda Bharati (1973) set the basic

structure doctrine.

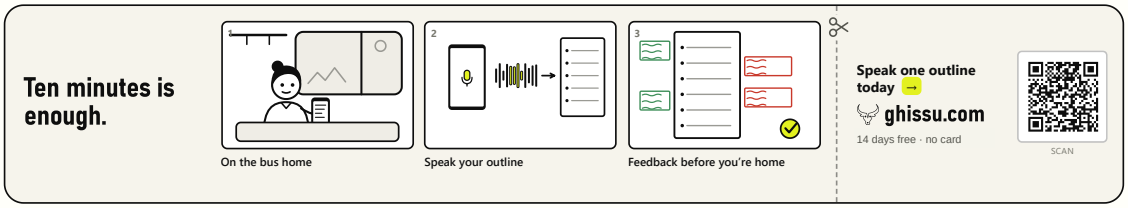
2. Commissions: The NHRC and Information Commissions under the RTI Act 2005; Andhra Pradesh's commission actively handles grievances.
3. PIL: Public Interest Litigation has democratised access to justice, advancing environmental and social causes in Andhra Pradesh.
4. Fundamental Duties: Added by the 42nd Amendment to balance rights with responsibilities.

Way Forward

1. Judicial capacity: Better infrastructure and lower pendency for timely enforcement of rights.
2. Rights awareness: Civic education campaigns in Andhra Pradesh to empower citizens.

Conclusion

Courts, commissions and PIL turn rights into reality, making the Constitution's promise of justice, liberty and equality effective for every citizen.



5(b) Discuss any two constitutional amendments that have significantly affected the powers or functioning of the Indian judiciary.

10

Introduction

The judiciary upholds constitutional governance and fundamental rights, yet certain amendments have reshaped its powers, reflecting tension between legislature and judiciary. Two landmark amendments, the First Amendment (1951) and the 42nd Amendment (1976), profoundly affected judicial authority.

First Amendment (1951)

1. Provisions: Enacted after courts struck down land reform laws and restrictions on free speech, it introduced Articles 31A and 31B and the Ninth Schedule to protect certain laws from judicial review.
2. Effect on powers: It curtailed the judiciary's ability to strike down socio-economic laws on fundamental rights grounds, enabling land reforms.
3. Concerns: It raised fears about judicial independence and checks and balances.
4. Andhra Pradesh: Land reform laws that had faced judicial scrutiny could be implemented

without legal hurdles.

42nd Amendment (1976)

1. Provisions: Called the "mini-Constitution", it changed (59) articles. Article 32A restricted the Supreme Court from examining the validity of state laws, Article 131A gave it exclusive jurisdiction over central laws, and a larger bench and two-thirds majority were required to declare laws unconstitutional.
2. Effect on powers: It weakened judicial review and gave Directive Principles primacy over Fundamental Rights.
3. Context: Enacted during the Emergency, it reflected executive dominance over the judiciary.
4. Reversal: In Minerva Mills (1980), the Court struck down several provisions, reaffirming the basic structure doctrine of Kesavananda Bharati (1973).

Way Forward

1. Safeguard the basic structure: Amendments affecting the judiciary must respect the basic structure, so that judicial independence and federalism are not eroded.
2. Transparency: Parliamentary committees with

Two Amendments that Curbed the Judiciary

First Amendment (1951)	42nd Amendment (1976)
Added Articles 31-A, 31B	Added Articles 32-A, 131-A
Ninth Schedule shields laws	Two-thirds majority to strike laws
Protected land reforms	Weakened judicial review
Concerns over judicial independence	Minerva Mills struck provisions

judicial experts should scrutinise such amendments.

3. Cooperative federalism: Amendments should consider their impact on states like Andhra Pradesh, whose autonomy was affected by the 42nd Amendment's Article 257-A.

Conclusion

Both amendments sought to curb the judiciary, but the basic structure doctrine restored judicial review, keeping the judiciary a guardian of rights and judicial independence.

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6(a) The administrative system of the Gupta dynasty was, in many ways, similar to that of the Mauryan Empire. Discuss the key similarities and differences between the two administrative structures.

10

Introduction

The Mauryan and Gupta empires represent two significant phases of ancient Indian governance. Both rested on strong kingship, but the centralized Mauryan bureaucracy gave way to a decentralized, feudal Gupta order, reshaping regional administration.

Key Similarities

1. Imperial Sovereignty: In both, the king was the ultimate source of law and order.
2. Provincial Division: Both divided the empire into provinces; the Guptas used bhuktis and vishayas.
3. Shared Officialdom: Both employed amatyas or kumaramatyas as ministers and provincial governors.
4. Guilds and Local Elites: Both recognized guilds and local elites in urban administration.

Key Differences

1. Nature of Authority: The Mauryan emperor directly controlled a vast bureaucracy; Gupta

rulers took titles like maharajadhiraja, signifying overlordship over vassal kings who paid tribute and gave military support.

2. Officials: Mauryan officers were salaried bureaucrats; Gupta officials combined roles and their posts became hereditary.

3. Revenue System: Mauryan samahartas managed budgets under state control of agriculture, trade and industry, while the Guptas granted tax-free agrahara land grants to Brahmanas and officials.

4. Justice: The Mauryan emperor ruled through a formal legal code and state judges; Gupta justice blended royal authority with Brahmanical dharma.

5. Local Participation: Gupta villages and towns involved elders, headmen and guilds, unlike the top-down Mauryan approach.

Mauryan vs Gupta Administration

Mauryan Empire	Gupta Empire
Centralization	Feudal decentralization
Salaried bureaucrats	Hereditary officials
Direct economic control	Land grants, tax exemptions
Formal legal code	Royal-religious justice
Limited local autonomy	Guilds and elders

Outcomes

The Mauryan bureaucracy enabled efficient tax collection and law enforcement, but its vast size strained communication and required a large standing army. Gupta land grants, in contrast, diluted imperial revenue and central control.

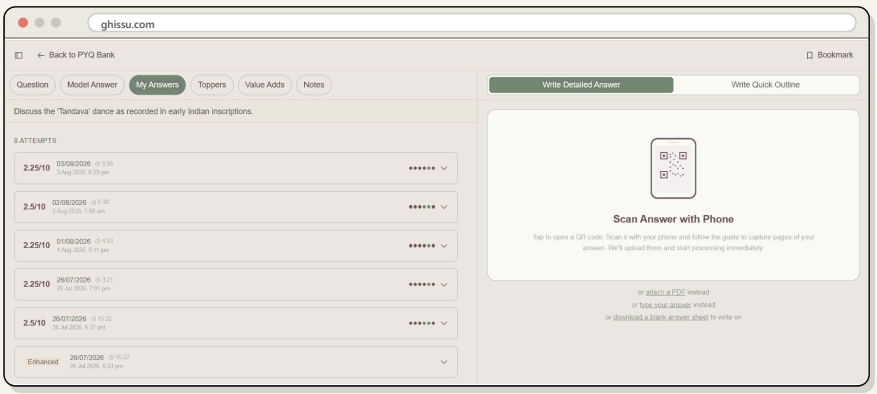
Conclusion

The Guptas kept the Mauryan frame of kingship, provinces and ministers but diluted its centralism through land grants and hereditary offices, marking a shift towards localized governance.

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6(b) What features of British administration have influenced the Indian administrative system?

10

Introduction

British administration laid the foundational framework of the modern Indian administrative system, blending colonial imperatives with governance needs. This legacy shapes how India balances an efficient bureaucracy with democratic accountability and welfare orientation.

Key Features of British Administration

1. **Centralized Bureaucracy:** A clear hierarchy from the Governor-General to district officers ensured uniform control for law and order and revenue.
2. **Rule of Law:** A codified legal system based on Anglo-Saxon and common law principles replaced customary and religious laws.
3. **Merit-Based Civil Service:** The ICS recruited through open competitive exams, setting a precedent for a professional bureaucracy.
4. **Revenue Focus:** Systematic assessment made land revenue the main source of income and district officers its collectors.
5. **Judicial-Executive Fusion:** District officers

combined magisterial and executive roles.

Influence on the Indian Administrative System

British Legacy in Indian Administration

British feature	Influence today
Centralized hierarchy	District Collector's central role
Codified common law	Backbone of constitutional judiciary
ICS open competition	Merit-based IAS
Land revenue focus	Revenue anchors district governance
Judicial-executive fusion	Largely separated now

1. Enduring Centralization: India retained the structure for unity, as seen in the District Collector, though it concentrates power; Andhra Pradesh seeks decentralization through Panchayati Raj.
2. Rule of Law as Pillar: The legal framework became the backbone of the constitutional judiciary, though its order-first orientation can conflict with welfare goals.
3. IAS as Backbone: The IAS continues merit recruitment and generalist training, but its colonial detachment has prompted reforms for responsiveness and inclusion.

4. Fiscal Legacy: Revenue collection still anchors district governance, while the welfare state adds development work, such as Andhra Pradesh's direct benefit transfers.
5. Separation of Powers: The judiciary has largely been separated from the executive, though administrative influence over law and order persists.

Way Forward

1. Decentralization: Capacity building and fiscal devolution to local governments can reduce inherited over-centralization.
2. Judicial Reforms: Law Commission recommendations can improve accountability and reduce executive interference.
3. Inclusive Services: Recruitment and training reforms can foster diversity and citizen-centric attitudes.

Conclusion

The British legacy embedded centralized bureaucracy, rule of law and merit-based services in Indian administration. Reformed for decentralization and citizen-centricity, it can serve a welfare democracy.

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Notes that live with the question.
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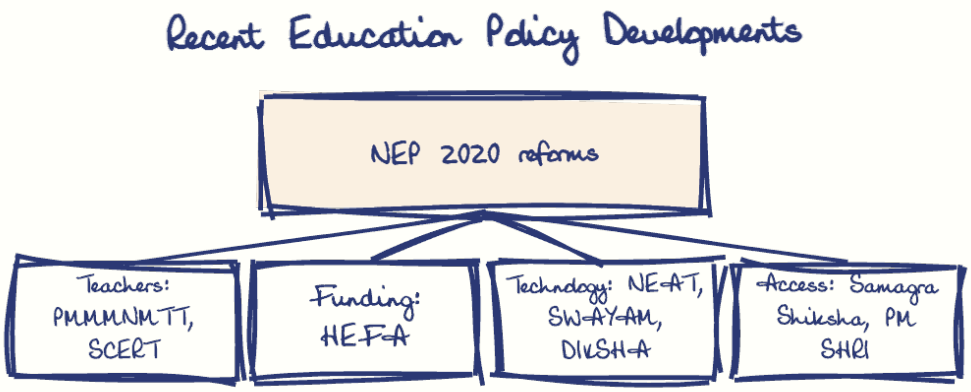
7(a) Education is a vital sector for boosting the development of any nation. Highlight the recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government.

10

Introduction

Education is a cornerstone of national development, fostering economic growth, social equity and technological progress. The National Education Policy 2020, aligned with SDG4 for inclusive and equitable quality education by 2030, marks a historic shift towards making India a global knowledge superpower.

Recent Policy Developments



1. **NEP 2020 Framework:** Replacing the 1986 policy, it stresses holistic, multidisciplinary learning and skills, targeting 100% school GER by 2030 and 50% GER in higher education by 2035.
2. **Teacher Professionalism:** The Pandit Madan Mohan

Malaviya National Mission on Teachers and Teaching sets performance standards, with SCERT as the nodal body for teacher training.

3. Financing Infrastructure: The Higher Education Financing Agency (HEFA) provides sustainable funding for infrastructure in higher education.
4. Technology in Learning: The National Educational Alliance for Technology (NEAT) uses artificial intelligence to personalize learning.
5. Access and Equity Schemes: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and PM SHRI schools have expanded enrolment and infrastructure.
6. Digital Education: COVID-19 accelerated platforms like SWAYAM 2.0 and DIKSHA, while the edtech sector, projected to reach USD 4 billion by 2025, is expanding fast.

Implementation Challenges

1. Learning Outcomes: ASER reports show stagnant reading and maths skills, so NEP stresses outcome-based education and accountability.
2. Equity Gaps: Gender and socio-economic gaps persist in secondary and higher education.
3. Digital Divide: Rural and gender gaps limit online learning.

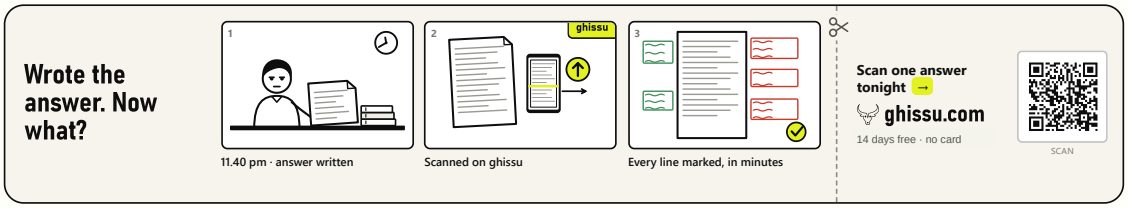
4. State Gaps: Audits in Andhra Pradesh reveal teacher vacancies and infrastructure deficits.

Way Forward

1. Teacher Accountability: Expand capacity building with robust evaluation of teacher effectiveness.
2. Digital Inclusion: Invest in affordable internet and devices for rural and marginalized communities.
3. Data-Driven Policy: Use regular assessments to target specific learning gaps.
4. Regulated Partnerships: Leverage private innovation while protecting equity and quality.

Conclusion

Anchored in NEP 2020 and supported by financial and technological innovation, India's education policy aims at an inclusive, equitable and high-quality system. Implemented well, it will empower citizens with knowledge and skills and make education a true catalyst for national growth.



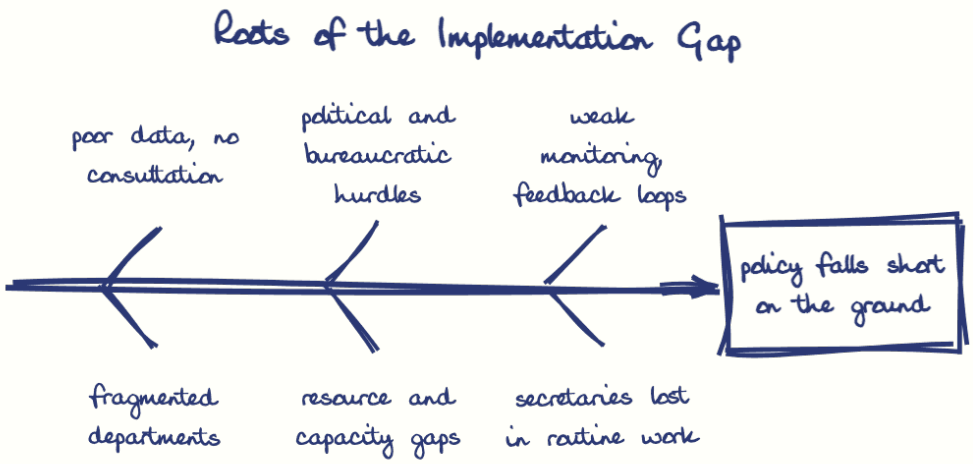
7(b) Although policies formulated by departments are prepared by experts, the results often fall short of expectations. What are the major issues responsible for this gap between policy formulation and implementation?

10

Introduction

Expert departments often frame technically sound policies, yet outcomes fall short. The implementation gap arises from problems of data, coordination, resources and political economy, and it undermines citizen trust and development goals.

Issues in Policy Design



1. Inadequate Data: Urban planning often overlooks informal settlements for lack of reliable data, weakening poverty alleviation.
2. Stakeholder Exclusion: The Farm Acts 2020 faced massive protests because marginalized farmers were not consulted.

3. Limited External Consultation: Departments engage too little with outside specialists and affected communities.

Issues in Execution

1. Fragmented Administration: Transport policy is split among five ministries, unlike integrated departments in the US, causing conflicting agendas and delays.
2. Political and Bureaucratic Hurdles: The prolonged passage of the Women's Reservation Act and slow e-governance adoption across states show how consensus and inertia delay reform.
3. Resource and Capacity Gaps: Andhra Pradesh faces a 22% vacancy in specialist posts, with health spending at only 3.11% of its budget against an 8% target.
4. Ground Realities Missed: The Right to Education Act suffers from a lack of infrastructure and trained teachers.
5. Coordination Failures: Under AMRUT only a fraction of sanctioned water treatment capacity was completed.
6. Weak Monitoring: Poor oversight leaves the Public Distribution System prone to leakage and

corruption.

Role of Departments

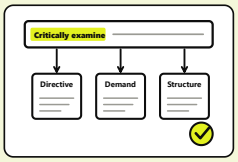
1. Role Confusion: Secretaries meant to advise on policy spend excess time on routine administration.
2. Capacity Deficits: The Andhra Pradesh CAG audit found revenue losses from compliance gaps and inefficiency.

Way Forward

1. Data and Inclusion: Invest in robust data systems and involve marginalized groups in policy design.
2. Integration: Rationalize overlapping departments and foster inter-ministerial coordination.

Conclusion

Closing the gap between expert formulation and implementation needs reliable data, adequate resources and coordinated, accountable governance, so that technically sound policies deliver real results and restore citizen trust.



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8(a) What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and the limitations it faces in a democratic system.

10

Introduction

Civil society in India is the space between the state and the individual, comprising formal and informal groups that articulate citizens' interests and hold power to account. Its role has grown since the 1990s through economic liberalisation, the 74th Amendment and the Right to Information Act, which empowered civil society organisations to take part in governance.

Key Features of Indian Civil Society

Civil Society: Features and Limits

Key features	Limitations
Diverse NGOs, unions, media	Elite capture
74th Amendment, RTI backing	Fragmentation, unequal voice
Gandhian, Lokayat roots	Internal democracy deficit
Works within state framework	Co-optation by patronage

1. Diverse Composition: NGOs, professional associations, media, trade unions, religious groups and informal citizen collectives reflect India's social heterogeneity.

2. Constitutional and Legal Backing: The 74th Amendment institutionalised decentralisation and participatory governance, while the RTI Act (2005) enhanced transparency and accountability.
3. Indigenous Roots: It draws on traditions like the Lokayat movement and Gandhian volunteerism, evolving through post-independence movements on caste, gender, environment and rights.
4. Linkage with the State: It operates within a state framework that can enable or constrain it, as in post-1990s urban reforms and disaster management partnerships.

Limitations in a Democratic System

1. Elite Capture: Many leaders come from privileged, educated backgrounds, which can alienate grassroots communities and weaken authentic representation.
2. Fragmentation and Inequality: Well-financed organisations dominate discourse, while rural and marginalised groups struggle to reach decision-making platforms.
3. Internal Democracy Deficits: Some organisations lack transparency and democratic functioning, contradicting their own goals.

4. Co-optation and Misuse: State funding and political patronage can divert actors to partisan agendas, and extremist groups may exploit civil society space.

Way Forward

1. Grassroots Inclusion: Draw marginalised communities into forums like Andhra Pradesh's Ward Committees.
2. Internal Accountability: Adopt financial disclosure and democratic decision-making.
3. Regulated Funding: Oversee foreign funding under the FCRA and curb patronage.
4. Capacity Building: Training and legal support help grassroots groups engage the state, as in Andhra Pradesh's social audits.

Conclusion

Civil society is a vital pillar of Indian democracy, bridging citizens and the state to promote accountability, rights and participatory governance. When inclusive and transparent, it strengthens social justice and, in line with SDG (16), makes democracy more responsive and equitable.

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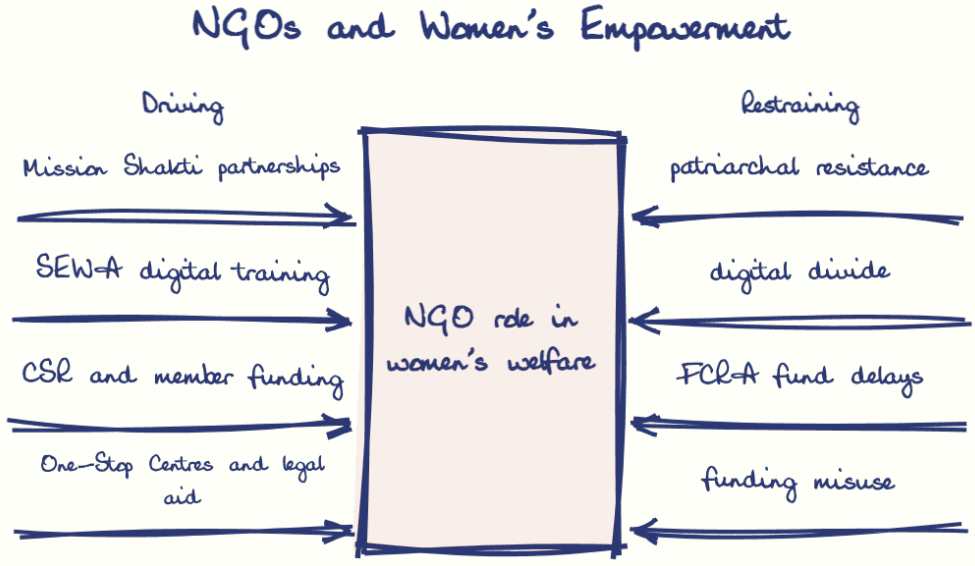
8(b) In what ways can the role of NGOs be enhanced in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, with a focus on the key challenges they encounter.

10

Introduction

NGOs have become critical agents of women's empowerment as women now outnumber men in the population and female labour force participation has risen to 41.7% in 2023–24. Yet funding constraints, patriarchal resistance and regulatory hurdles limit their effectiveness.

Key Challenges Faced by NGOs



1. **Patriarchal Resistance:** Societal pushback limits women's leadership, especially in rural areas and Panchayati Raj Institutions.

2. Digital Divide: Only about 30% of NGOs use digital tools effectively, with rural women's groups lagging.
3. Funding Dependence: Reliance on restrictive government and foreign funds constrains scale, and post-2010 FCRA amendments delayed fund flows.
4. Accountability Concerns: A reported 20% funding misuse among NGOs has eroded public trust.
5. Weak Political Will: The long pendency of the Women's Reservation Bill since 2008 and low budgets reflect structural barriers.

Ways to Enhance the Role of NGOs

1. Government-NGO Partnerships: Mission Shakti's engagement with NGOs in Andhra Pradesh shows how aligned policy amplifies impact.
2. Capacity Building: Training in digital literacy and leadership, like SEWA's training of 1.5 million women in digital financial skills.
3. Transparent Accountability: Financial reporting and social audits can rebuild trust.
4. Diversified Funding: CSR, microfinance and member contributions, as in SEWA, build resilience.

5. Legal and Support Services: Scaling One-Stop Centres and legal aid, as the Justice Verma Committee recommended, helps survivors of violence.

6. Economic Empowerment: NGOs can link women to Mudra Yojana and Stand Up India for skills and enterprise.

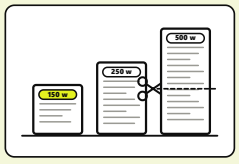
7. National Networks: Federations like MAKAAM enable resource sharing and collective bargaining.

Way Forward

Digital drives for rural women's NGOs using platforms like UMANG, dedicated government funds with simple disbursal, FCRA reform for autonomy and community gender sensitization can scale NGO impact.

Conclusion

Enhancing NGOs' role requires stronger institutions, sustainable funding, transparent accountability and grassroots outreach. With these, NGOs can move women's empowerment from policy to lived reality.



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9(a) Under which Act was the National Commission for Women (NCW) established? Describe its main features and limitations.

10

Introduction

The National Commission for Women (NCW) was established in 1992 as a statutory body to address persistent challenges faced by women and promote gender justice. It bridges the gap between constitutional guarantees and their implementation.

Legal Foundation

1. The Act: It was constituted under the National Commission for Women Act, 1990, which came into force in 1992.
2. Statutory Backing: The Act empowers it to investigate, review and recommend measures on women's welfare.
3. Composition and Tenure: The Centre appoints a Chairperson, five expert members and a Member-Secretary, usually an IAS officer, for three years.

Main Features

1. Watchdog Mandate: It safeguards constitutional and legal rights of women and reviews laws to

NCW: Features and Limitations

Features	Limitations
Civil court powers	Recommendations not binding
Suo moto inquiries	Cannot prosecute offenders
Inspects jails, remand homes	Thin staff and funds
Parivarik Mahila Lok Adalat	Overlap with WCD Ministry

suggest amendments.

2. Quasi-Judicial Powers: With civil court powers, it summons individuals, examines witnesses on oath, requisitions records and receives affidavits.

3. Complaints and Suo Moto Action: It inquires into domestic violence, dowry and sexual harassment, and takes suo moto cognizance of media reports.

4. Advisory Role: It recommends policy and legislative reforms to central and state governments.

5. Inspection: It inspects jails and remand homes holding women.

6. Research and Advocacy: It studies trafficking

and workplace harassment and runs the Parivarik Mahila Lok Adalat for speedy disputes.

7. State Support: In Andhra Pradesh it backs Mission Shakti and One Stop Centres.

Limitations

1. No Binding Authority: Its recommendations are only advisory.
2. No Prosecution Power: It cannot penalise offenders, so it relies on other agencies, delaying justice.
3. Resource Shortages: Thin staff and funds limit reach, including in rural Andhra Pradesh.
4. Overlap: Overlap with the Ministry of Women and Child Development and State Commissions dilutes impact.
5. Informal Sector Gaps: Its reach among women in the informal economy stays limited.

Conclusion

The NCW is a vital institution for gender justice, but binding powers, adequate resources and better coordination would make it far more effective.

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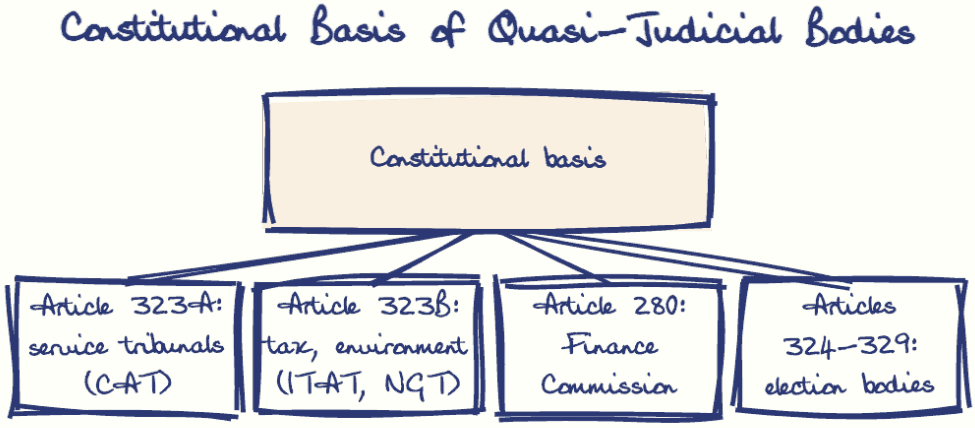
9(b) Which constitutional provisions empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities in India? Explain with suitable examples.

10

Introduction

The growing complexity of governance and an overburdened judiciary have necessitated quasi-judicial authorities that resolve disputes quickly and with expertise. They hold court-like powers in specialised domains, and the Constitution explicitly empowers their creation.

Constitutional Provisions



1. **Article 323-A:** Empowers Parliament and state legislatures to set up tribunals exclusively for public service disputes, relieving ordinary courts.
2. **Article 323B:** Permits tribunals for wider matters such as taxation, foreign exchange, industrial and labour disputes and land reforms.

3. 42nd Amendment Act, 1976: Inserted Part XIV-A, containing Articles 323A and 323B, formalising the framework for tribunals.

4. Other Articles: Article 280 (Finance Commission), Articles 324–327 (Election Commission) and Article 329 (election disputes) create bodies with quasi-judicial functions.

How These Provisions Work

1. Legislative Empowerment: Legislatures enact laws giving tribunals defined jurisdiction and powers.
2. Specialised Jurisdiction: Tribunals focus on technical disputes needing expert knowledge.
3. Procedural Flexibility: They have civil court powers like summoning witnesses but are not bound by strict procedural codes, which speeds resolution.
4. Judicial Supervision: Their decisions are subject to judicial review by High Courts or the Supreme Court.

Examples

1. Central Administrative Tribunal: Set up under Article 323A, it adjudicates service matters of government employees, including those from Andhra Pradesh.
2. Income Tax Appellate Tribunal: Enabled by Article

323B, it handles tax disputes.

3. National Green Tribunal: Also under Article 323B, the National Green Tribunal hears environmental disputes across India.

4. State Information Commissions: Empowered by the RTI Act, they resolve transparency disputes.

Way Forward

Better tribunal infrastructure, regular member training, harmonised laws that reduce jurisdictional overlap and digital adjudication can cut pendency, especially in remote districts of Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

Articles 323A and 323B, inserted by the 42nd Amendment, give a robust foundation for specialised, efficient and accessible justice. Quasi-judicial authorities built on them reduce judicial backlog and strengthen the rule of law and democratic governance.

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SCAN

10(a) Social audit helps to narrow gaps between vision and reality. Examine the statement and also discuss the impediments in the institutionalisation of social audit in India.

10

Introduction

A social audit is a tool through which citizens check whether public programmes deliver what policy promised. Institutionalised under MGNREGA, it promotes transparency, accountability and participation, bridging the gap between policy intentions and ground realities. Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan have built formal mechanisms for regular audits.

How Social Audit Narrows the Gap

1. **Legal Mandate:** The MGNREGA Act (2005) makes social audits a core accountability mechanism rather than an optional exercise.
2. **Dedicated Institutions:** Andhra Pradesh's SSAAT supports systematic audits with trained staff, and its data-driven audits have refined policy and improved welfare delivery.
3. **Standard Frameworks:** CAG guidelines standardise audit processes, and Meghalaya's (2017) social audit law offers a state-wide legal model.
4. **Grassroots Democracy:** Audits empower Gram Sabhas and Panchayati Raj Institutions, embedding

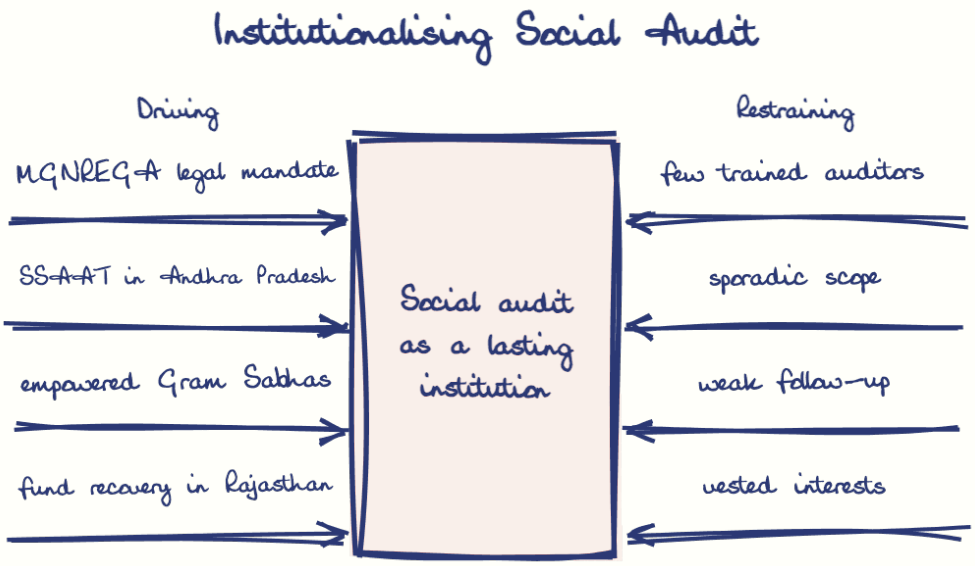
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them in local governance.

5. Tangible Outcomes: In Rajasthan, NREGA audits uncovered fraud, leading to fund recovery and stricter management.

Impediments to Institutionalisation



1. Capacity Constraints: A shortage of trained auditors limits quality, especially in complex programmes.
2. Sporadic Application: Audits focus on specific schemes; a (2021) CAG report found Andhra Pradesh's MGNREGA audits overlooked work quality and labour law compliance.
3. Weak Follow-up: Findings often do not lead to corrective action, owing to poor monitoring and enforcement.

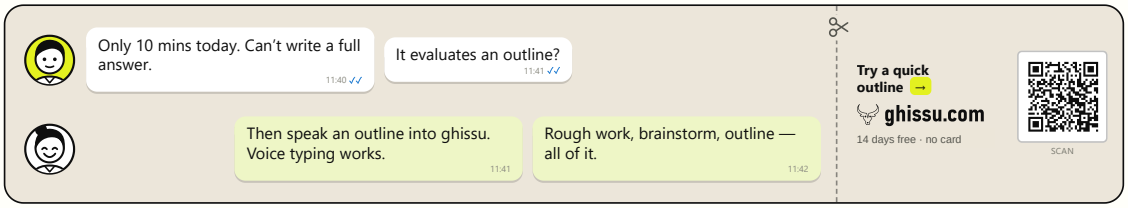
4. Resistance and Data Gaps: Vested interests among local officials resist scrutiny, and tracking migrants in adult literacy programmes is hard.

Way Forward

1. National Law: A national social audit law drawing on Meghalaya's model, for uniform legal backing.
2. Training and Technology: Specialised auditor training, stronger PRIs and online portals for reports.
3. Enforcement: Periodic compliance checks, penalties for non-adherence and whistleblower protections, so findings lead to meaningful action.

Conclusion

Social audits are a bridge between governance vision and ground reality. They foster transparency, accountability and citizen empowerment. Institutionalised well, as with Andhra Pradesh's SSAAT, they improve service delivery and democratic participation, advancing citizen-centric governance and SDG (16.)



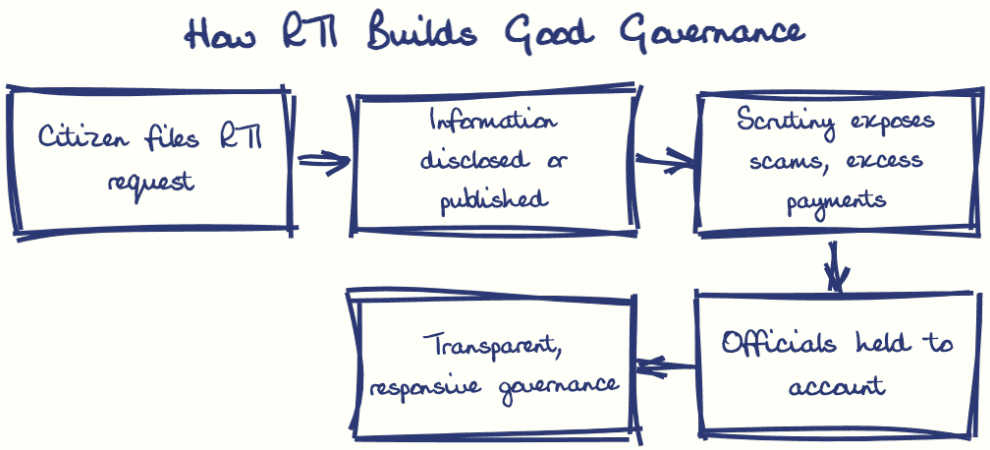
10(b) Define good governance. How does the Right to Information (RTI) Act promote the principles of good governance in India?

10

Introduction

Good governance is the foundation of a democratic society, ensuring transparency, accountability, responsiveness and inclusiveness in public administration. In India, the RTI Act, 2005 is a pivotal tool for these principles, as it lets citizens access government information and helps curb corruption and inefficiency.

How RTI Promotes Good Governance



1. **Transparency:** Grounded in Article 19(1)(a), which the Supreme Court read to include the right to information, the Act makes transparency a constitutional mandate.

2. **Open Government:** The proactive disclosure mandate

requires authorities to publish policies, decisions and financial data, reducing individual requests.

3. Accountability: Central and State Information Commissions act as independent bodies that decide appeals and enforce compliance.

4. Curbing Corruption: RTI helped expose the Adarsh Housing Society scam, deterring arbitrary bureaucratic decisions.

5. Fiscal Scrutiny: RTI-enabled scrutiny strengthens oversight where Andhra Pradesh CAG audits found Rs 968 crore in excess payments and gaps in welfare schemes.

6. Participation and Responsiveness: Nearly 60 lakh applications are filed a year, empowering millions; Andhra Pradesh citizens use RTI to question welfare scheme implementation and demand better service delivery.

Challenges

1. Delays and Resistance: Delayed responses and reluctance among officials sometimes undermine timely accountability.

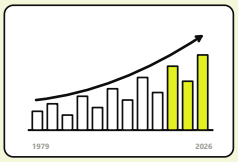
2. Uneven Reach: Uneven awareness and the digital divide, especially in rural areas, limit its reach and impact.

Way Forward

1. **Capacity Building:** Regular training for officials and Information Commissioners to cut delays in sharing information.
2. **Autonomy:** Protect Information Commissions from executive interference to keep public trust.
3. **Digital Access:** Expand digital literacy in Andhra Pradesh's rural and semi-urban areas.
4. **E-Governance:** Automate proactive disclosures through e-governance platforms to reduce bureaucratic opacity.

Conclusion

The RTI Act is a cornerstone of good governance, fostering transparency, accountability and citizen empowerment. Effectively implemented, it turns governance into a participatory and responsive process, in line with the constitutional vision of an informed citizenry and Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas. Protecting the autonomy of the commissions will keep this promise alive.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

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SCAN

11(a) Public servants often face situations where personal values conflict with public responsibilities. Examine how a strong ethical foundation can help resolve such dilemmas while maintaining accountability.

10

Introduction

Public servants frequently face conflicts between personal values and public responsibilities. Rising public scrutiny and complex socio-political dynamics in a diverse society like India sharpen this tension. A strong ethical foundation is crucial to navigate such dilemmas while staying accountable and upholding constitutional morality.

Nature of the Dilemmas

1. Conflict of Interest: Personal relationships or finances may clash with duty, as in awarding contracts to relatives.
2. Whistleblowing: Officers must choose between organisational loyalty and exposing wrongdoing, risking retaliation.
3. Transparency versus Confidentiality: The right to information competes with protecting sensitive data in health or security matters.
4. Competing Pressures: Departmental directives, political pressure and social expectations blur loyalties.

How a Strong Ethical Foundation Helps

Resolving a Value Conflict Ethically



1. Values-Based Reasoning: Core values like integrity and selflessness, stressed by the 2nd ARC, help put public interest above personal gain.
2. Balancing Duties: Kantian deontology and Gandhi's Nishkama Karma reconcile personal conscience with professional obligation.
3. Professionalism and Probity: Codes such as the AIS Conduct Rules keep personal bias from compromising public trust.
4. Courageous Leadership: Ethics helps officials resist undue pressure, as Lal Bahadur Shastri did.

Maintaining Accountability

1. Checks and Balances: Upward, downward and horizontal accountability subject ethical choices to scrutiny.

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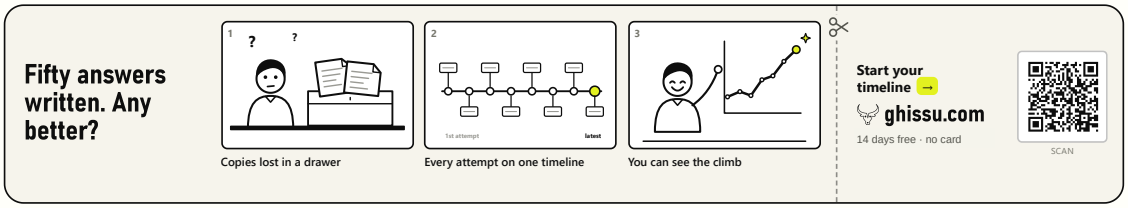
2. Citizen Engagement: Citizen report cards and grievance redressal in Andhra Pradesh involve stakeholders in monitoring.
3. Legal Frameworks: The Prevention of Corruption Act and CCS Conduct Rules ensure consequences for violations.

Way Forward

1. Ethics Education: Scenario-based training for officials in Andhra Pradesh to build moral reasoning.
2. Whistleblower Protection: Robust safeguards so wrongdoing is reported without fear of retaliation.
3. Ethical Leadership: Senior officials modelling integrity across the hierarchy.

Conclusion

Anchored in constitutional morality and backed by institutions, ethics lets officials resolve dilemmas while keeping governance transparent, just and responsive, in the spirit of Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.



11(b) Whistleblowers are guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Discuss the ethical and institutional importance of whistleblower protection in ensuring integrity in public service.

10

Introduction

Whistleblowers expose corruption and unethical practices, safeguarding the public interest. With rising demands for transparency, and after cases like Satyendra Dubey, protecting them is both a moral imperative and an institutional mechanism for ethical governance.

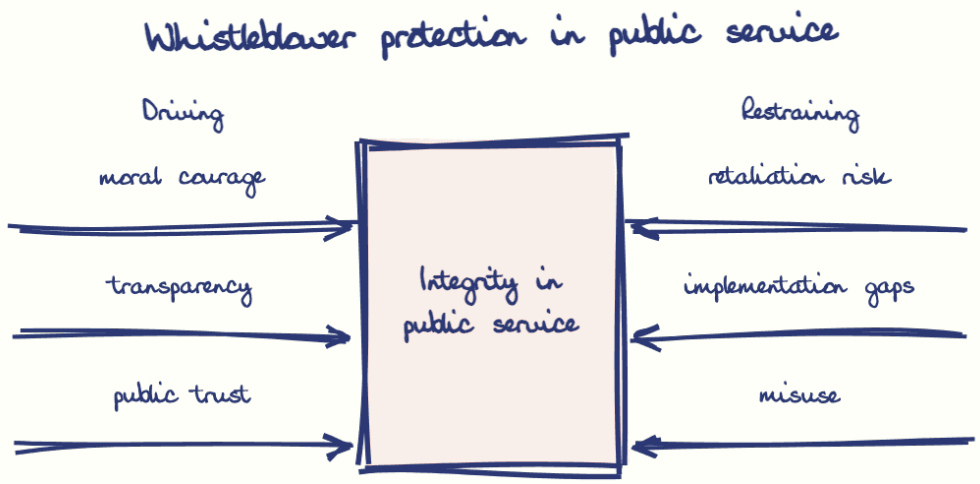
Ethical Importance of Protection

1. **Moral Courage and Duty:** Whistleblowers put public interest above personal safety, reflecting Kantian ethics. Dubey exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project despite fatal risk.
2. **Safeguarding Conscience:** Protection affirms integrity, which the Ndan Committee defines as consistency between belief and action.
3. **Loyalty versus Moral Obligation:** Whistleblowing sets loyalty to the employer against a higher duty; protection resolves this by treating it as civic responsibility, not disloyalty.
4. **Risks Faced:** Whistleblowers face ostracism, harassment or worse, as the case of Manjunath Shanmugam shows; ethical frameworks must let

them act without fear.

Institutional Importance for Accountability

1. Transparency and Oversight: The Whistleblowers Protection Act, 2014 provides internal and external reporting channels for timely detection of corruption.
2. Accountability: Protected disclosures compel public bodies to investigate misconduct, and the Central Vigilance Commission ensures institutional follow-up of complaints.
3. Preventing Retaliation: Without protection, retaliation silences reporting, anonymity provisions and penalties for victimisation keep people coming forward.
4. Implementation Gaps: Many organisations lack policies, training and enforcement, so channels remain underused.

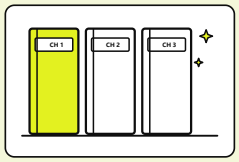


Ensuring Integrity in Public Service

1. Ethical Culture: Protection fosters a climate of probity, in line with the AIS Conduct Rules, and deters corrupt practices.
2. Public Trust: Exposing wrongdoing and ensuring corrective action restores citizens' faith in institutions, vital for democratic legitimacy.
3. Systemic Reform: Disclosures reveal systemic failures, healthcare whistleblowers exposing negligence led to better service standards.
4. Guarding against Misuse: False reporting wastes resources and damages reputations, so the Act penalises knowingly false complaints.

Conclusion

Strengthening anonymity, extending coverage to all public servants and building organisational awareness and training will make whistleblowers true guardians of accountability and integrity in public service. Protection honours individual conscience while building systems that detect and correct wrongdoing.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

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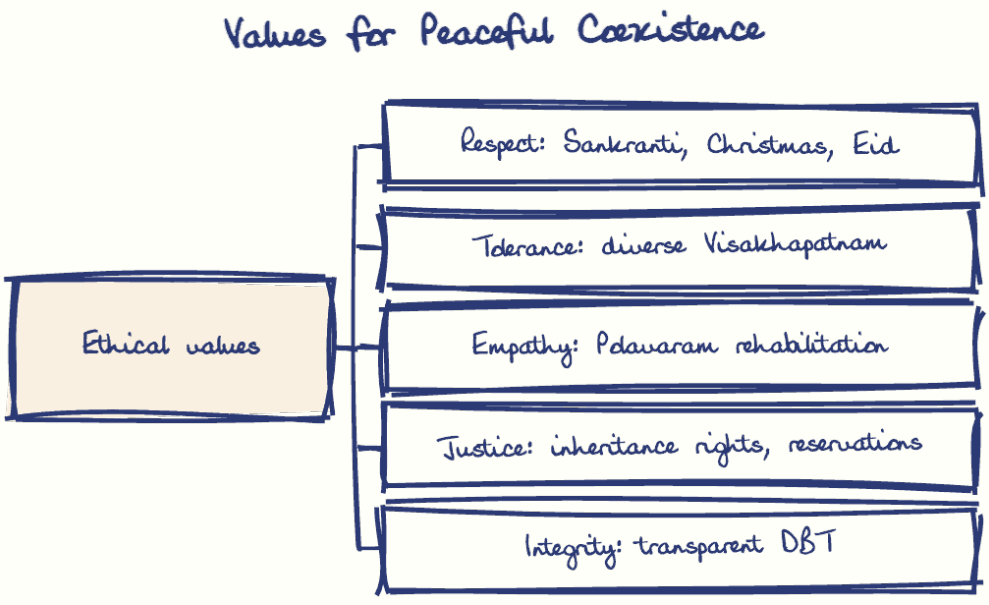
12(a) What ethical values are essential to ensure peaceful coexistence in a diverse society? Illustrate your answer with suitable examples.

10

Introduction

In an era of growing cultural, religious and linguistic diversity, peaceful coexistence is both a moral imperative and a governance challenge. Ethical values help manage differences without conflict, especially in pluralistic settings like Andhra Pradesh, by building mutual respect and trust so diverse groups live with dignity and equity.

Essential Ethical Values with Examples



1. **Respect for Diversity:** Valuing distinct identities, traditions and beliefs is fundamental. Andhra Pradesh celebrates Sankranti alongside Christmas

and Eid.

2. Tolerance and Acceptance: Accepting differences without prejudice or discrimination, as in Visakhapatnam, a port city where religious groups coexist peacefully.

3. Empathy and Compassion: Understanding others bridges divides, as in the rehabilitation of people displaced by the Polavaram project.

4. Justice and Fairness: Equal treatment prevents grievances; upholding the Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act, 2005 strengthened women's inheritance rights.

5. Integrity and Honesty: Transparent Direct Benefit Transfer by honest civil servants builds confidence across communities.

How These Values Sustain Coexistence

1. Respect Builds Cohesion: Communities whose identities are acknowledged participate constructively; policies accommodating Telugu, Urdu and tribal languages help.

2. Tolerance Lowers Conflict: School initiatives on secular ethics and interfaith dialogue build tolerance among youth.

3. Empathy Drives Inclusion: Welfare schemes for

drought-hit Rayalaseema reduce alienation of marginalised groups.

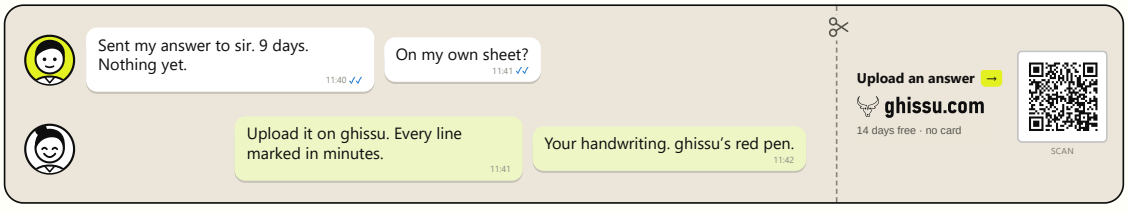
4. Justice Ensures Opportunity: Reservations for SCs and STs prevent exclusion.
5. Integrity Builds Trust: UM-ANG and DigiLocker raise transparency in public systems.

Way Forward

1. Civic Education: Teach respect and tolerance in schools across the state.
2. Inter-Community Dialogue: Forums and cultural exchanges in districts like Anantapur and Chittoor to build empathy and reduce stereotypes.
3. Legal Awareness: Campaigns on rights and justice mechanisms among marginalised communities to empower them and prevent conflict.

Conclusion

Respect, tolerance, empathy, justice and integrity are indispensable for coexistence. Anchored in constitutional morality they foster unity without erasing diversity, embodying Unity in Diversity.



12(b) How does early value education in the family influence ethical decision-making in adulthood?

10

Introduction

In an era of rapid social change, the moral values laid in early childhood within the family assume critical importance. Early value education shapes the ethical compass that guides individuals through complex adult decisions, influencing personal integrity and social responsibility.

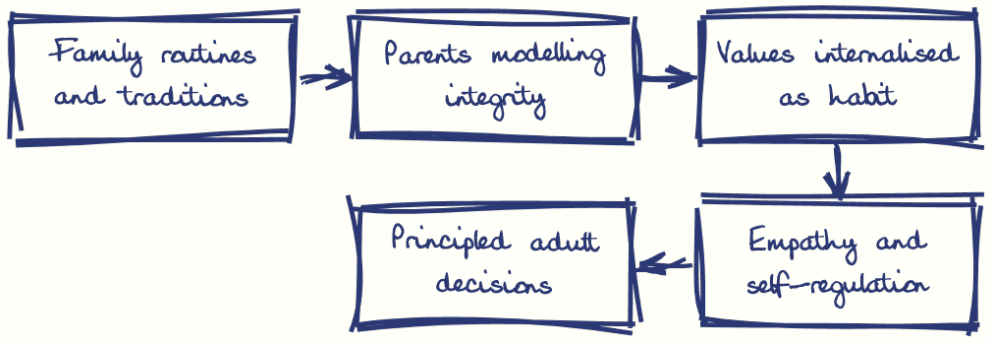
Role of Early Value Education in the Family

1. Primary Socialisation: Children learn honesty, empathy and responsibility through interaction with parents and elders. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam called father, mother and teacher the pillars of a corruption-free society.
2. Role Modelling: Children imitate parents, so parents who show integrity and fairness instil these traits.
3. Informal Learning: Routines, chores and traditions build duty and belonging. In Andhra Pradesh, family participation in festivals reinforces respect for heritage.
4. Challenges: Generation gaps, busy working parents and conflicting social values can dilute this

education.

Influence on Ethical Decision-Making in Adulthood

From Family Values to Adult Choices



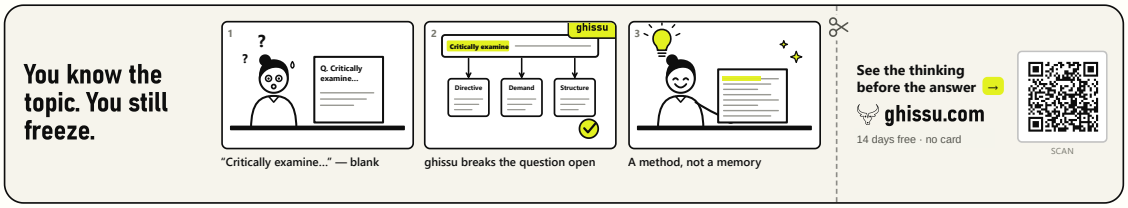
1. **Internalised Standards:** As Aristotle held, virtue formed by habit becomes a settled disposition, helping adults balance self-interest with social good.
2. **Emotional Intelligence:** Empathy and self-regulation, stressed in Daniel Goleman's framework, sharpen ethical sensitivity and judgment.
3. **Moral Anchor:** The family continues to offer guidance and accountability in personal and professional life; in Andhra Pradesh, family and community networks sustain ethical norms despite modernisation.
4. **Conflicts:** Traditional hierarchical values may clash with modern egalitarian principles, requiring adults to evaluate and adapt.

Way Forward

1. Parental Training: Community workshops in Andhra Pradesh to bridge generational gaps.
2. Family–Schod Links: Initiatives like the CBSE Parenting Calendar for consistent value education.
3. Reflective Practices: Family dialogues and conflict resolution exercises that build critical thinking and adaptability.

Conclusion

Early family value education is indispensable for ethical adult decision-making. It provides the moral foundation and emotional intelligence for principled choices, and, anchored in constitutional morality and supported by the National Education Policy, it can produce citizens whose choices serve both conscience and society.



13(a) Define attitude. How does attitude affect the behaviour of public servants?

10

Introduction

Attitude is a fundamental psychological construct that shapes how people perceive and respond to their environment. In public service, it influences motivation, decision-making and interaction with citizens. As governance grows complex and stressful, understanding attitude is essential for effective administration and public trust.

Defining Attitude

1. **Learned Readiness:** Gordon Allport defined attitude as a learned mental readiness, an enduring predisposition that directs responses to people, objects or ideas.
2. **CAB Model:** It combines cognitive (beliefs), affective (emotions) and behavioural (action tendencies) components.
3. **Positive Attitude:** Optimism, resilience and commitment to public welfare; on Civil Services Day the Prime Minister urged empathy for the underprivileged.
4. **Contrasting Attitudes:** Bureaucratic attitudes stress rules and hierarchy, while democratic ones stress responsiveness and participation.

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How Attitude Affects the Behaviour of Public Servants

How Attitude Shapes Conduct

Positive, democratic attitude	Negative, rigid attitude
Empathy, citizen engagement	Red-tapism
Perseverance under stress	Blame-shifting
Builds public trust	Resists innovation
Attitude matches behaviour	Dissonance, rationalisation

1. **Cognitive Dissonance:** Per Leon Festinger, when attitude and behaviour conflict, discomfort leads to attitude change or rationalisation, causing inconsistent policy enforcement.
2. **Motivation and Stress:** A positive attitude fosters emotional intelligence, perseverance and self-regulation, sustaining dedication under extreme stress.
3. **Public Trust and Accountability:** Empathy, integrity and a democratic attitude lead officers to engage citizens and address their needs, improving legitimacy.
4. **Negative Attitudes:** Bureaucratic inflexibility and externalising blame produce red-tapism, alienate citizens and resist innovation, undermining efficiency

and public confidence.

Way Forward

1. Emotional Intelligence Training: Regular programmes for self-awareness and self-regulation.
2. Democratic Governance: Participative models in Andhra Pradesh that balance bureaucratic efficiency with citizen responsiveness to build trust and inclusivity.
3. Role Models: Senior officers showing integrity and empathy to shape attitudes across ranks.
4. Continuous Feedback: Systems to monitor attitude-behaviour alignment and address dissonance through counselling.

Conclusion

Attitude, as a learned mental readiness, profoundly shapes how public servants act, influencing their effectiveness and public engagement. A positive attitude aligned with constitutional morality and the civil service code of conduct makes governance responsive and accountable. It strengthens public trust and speeds inclusive development, embodying Lokasangraha, the welfare of all.

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13(b) Explain the difference between cognitive, affective and behavioural components of attitude with suitable examples in the public service context.

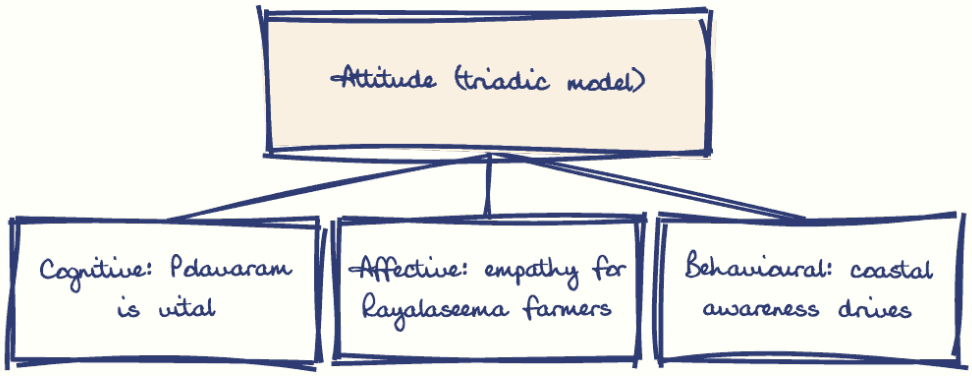
10

Introduction

Attitude shapes how civil servants perceive, feel and act, influencing governance and service delivery. The triadic model explains how knowledge, emotions and intended actions combine to form attitudes that guide public service behaviour.

Cognitive Component

Three Components of Attitude



1. **Meaning:** The beliefs, knowledge and thoughts held about an issue, such as understanding policies, laws and duties.
2. **Distinction:** It is the rational, informational side, such as recognising the value of transparency or a welfare scheme.

3. Example: An Andhra Pradesh officer convinced the Polavaram project is vital for regional development, or one using evidence from the Jal Shakti Abhiyan to promote water conservation.

Affective Component

1. Meaning: The feelings and emotions linked to policies, colleagues or public issues.
2. Distinction: Unlike rational cognition, feelings like empathy, pride or frustration can motivate or hinder engagement.
3. Example: A district collector in Rayalaseema feeling empathy for drought-hit farmers drives compassionate welfare outreach; Swachh Bharat Abhiyan used emotional appeals to inspire participation.

Behavioural Component

1. Meaning: The intended or actual actions, the observable outcome of beliefs and feelings.
2. Example: An officer regularly running awareness drives in Visakhapatnam for coastal protection.
3. Significance: Consistent conduct, guided by LBSNAA ethical guidelines, builds public trust and effective governance.

Way Forward

1. Emotional Intelligence Training: Modules in Andhra Pradesh civil service training to deepen empathy.
2. Evidence-Based Learning: Continuous access to data, such as updates on Polavaram and water conservation outcomes.
3. Behavioural Accountability: Monitoring frameworks that link attitudes to measurable actions.

Conclusion

Understanding the three components helps civil servants align knowledge, emotions and actions. When they harmonise, officers deliver ethical and effective governance.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON MODEL ANSWERS IN 150 · 250 · 500

Write to the word limit, not past it

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1. **150 words** — A definition, two dimensions, a one-line verdict.
2. **250 words** — Add a line of context, a third dimension, one example each.
3. **500 words** — Add a diagram, a second example each, a way forward.
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SCAN

14(a) In what ways can the implementation of a code of ethics in public administration help in resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decision-making?

10

Introduction

In recent years the demand for transparency and accountability in public administration has intensified. A code of ethics has emerged as a vital mechanism to address conflicts of interest and foster ethical decision-making. This is especially relevant in Andhra Pradesh, where rapid development projects and welfare schemes require officials to balance competing interests with integrity.

Role in Resolving Conflicts of Interest

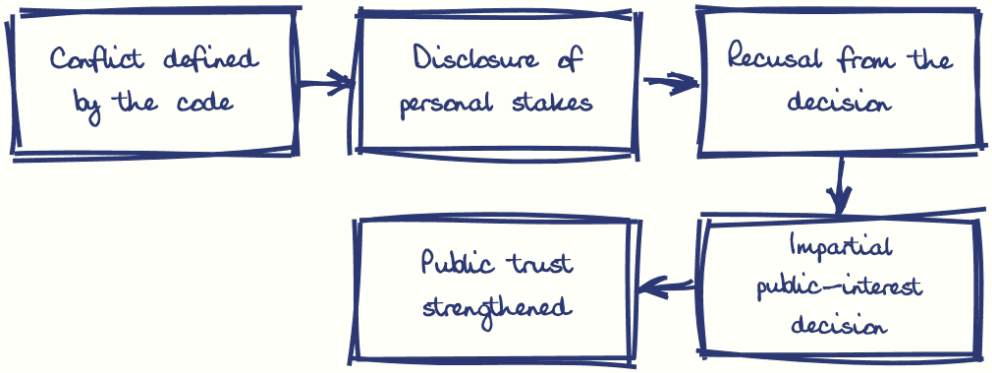
1. **Clarifying Ethical Boundaries:** The code defines what a conflict is; the 2nd ARC noted that it arises when personal interest overrides public interest.
2. **Transparency through Disclosure:** Mandatory disclosure of personal stakes, as in implementing the Polavaram project, reduces favouritism and corruption.
3. **Recusal and Risk Management:** Officials recuse themselves where conflicts exist, which keeps procurement in Visakhapatnam port-led industrial corridors impartial.

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4. Limitations: A code cannot cover every scenario and cannot be enforced like a law; it depends on officials' sincere commitment.

How a code resolves a conflict



Promoting Ethical Decision-Making

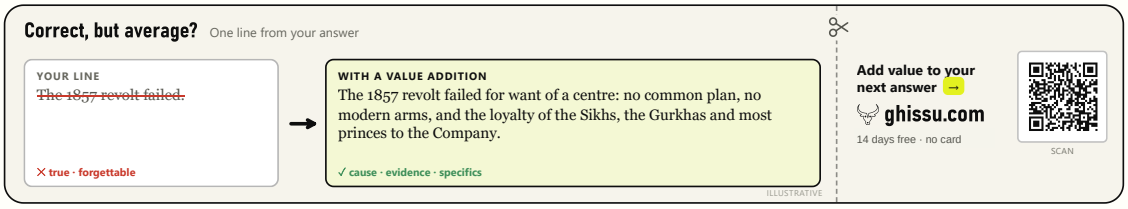
1. Foundational Values: It instils integrity, fairness and responsibility; the Ndan Committee's Seven Principles remain a global benchmark.
2. Contextual Judgement: It encourages situational ethics, weighing social impact rather than following rules mechanically, as in Rayalaseema drought relief.
3. Public Trust: Ethical conduct codes have complemented the RTI Act in Andhra Pradesh, improving citizen engagement and trust.
4. Navigating Dilemmas: Political interference and delays remain, but the code gives a framework for moral courage and prudence.

Way Forward

1. Ethics Training: Periodic, state-specific sensitisation of public servants.
2. Ethics Officers: Confidential counselling and monitoring within departments.
3. Accountability: Reporting channels with whistleblower protection and timely redressal.
4. Participatory Drafting: Involving public servants at all levels in revising the code builds ownership and relevance to ground realities.

Conclusion

A code of ethics is indispensable for resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decisions, safeguarding constitutional morality and public trust. Embedded in governance frameworks and complemented by training and accountability, it will ensure officials act with integrity and dedication, serving justice, transparency and inclusive development.



14(b) Discuss the significance of integrity, transparency and accountability in leadership. How can public leaders demonstrate these values in their decision-making process?

10

Introduction

In an era of complex governance challenges, integrity, transparency and accountability have become indispensable for democratic legitimacy. They foster public trust and keep decision-making ethical, inclusive and oriented to the common good.

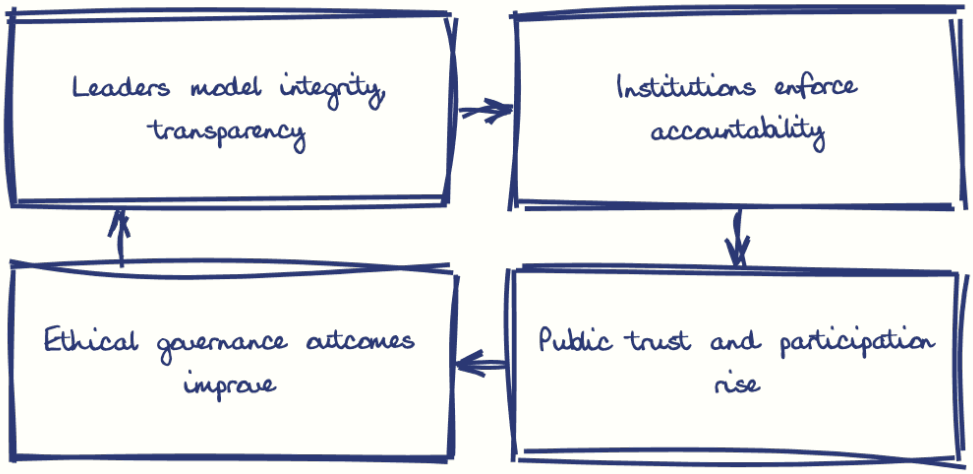
Significance in Leadership

1. Integrity: Consistency between values and actions is the bedrock of trust, Andhra Pradesh's Vigilance Awareness Week and integrity pledge embed it in the civil service.
2. Transparency: The RTI Act, 2005 and social audits in Andhra Pradesh's welfare schemes enhance openness and reduce corruption.
3. Accountability: Oversight bodies such as the Andhra Pradesh Lokayukta investigate maladministration.
4. Role Modelling: Verghese Kurien's leadership of Amul inspires values-based leadership in cooperatives.

Challenges

1. Political Interference: Frequent politicisation and

Institutional integrity cycle



insecure tenure for senior civil servants undermine impartial leadership.

2. Compliance over Culture: Ethics programmes are often optional and lack follow-up, so behaviour barely changes.

3. Opacity: Despite RTI and digitisation, secrecy persists in infrastructure projects like Polavaram.

4. Diluted Accountability: Responsibility diffused across agencies breeds tick-box compliance.

Demonstrating Values in Decision-Making

1. Codes of Conduct: Following the All India Services Conduct Rules keeps decisions free of conflicts of interest.

2. Evidence and Consultation: Decisions on data and stakeholder views, as in Andhra Pradesh's

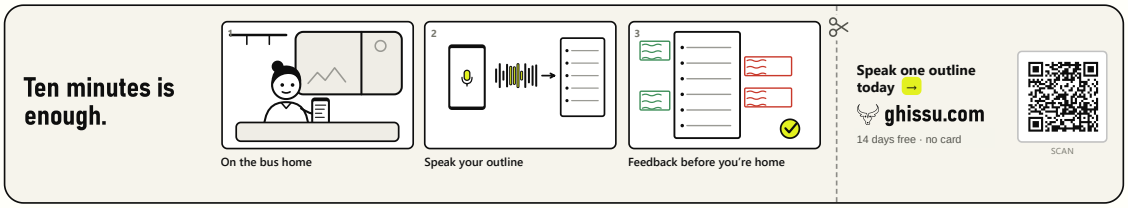
participatory coastal management planning.

3. Proactive Disclosure: Timely sharing of policies, as on the state's digital platforms for welfare schemes, builds transparency.

4. Feedback and Redressal: Andhra Pradesh's Public Grievance Redressal System keeps leaders answerable.

Conclusion

Integrity, transparency and accountability are the cornerstones of ethical leadership. When leaders model them in every decision and institutions reinforce them, public trust grows and governance delivers equitable outcomes. Mandatory ethics training, tenure security, e-governance and empowered Panchayats will help leaders practise them and uphold constitutional morality.



15(a) What do you understand by cyberstalking? What are the various other cyber offences recognised under Information Technology Act, 2000?

10

Introduction

India's digital transformation, with over 969 million internet users by March 2025, has made cybercrime a major governance challenge. The pandemic shift online widened vulnerabilities, especially for women and children. The IT Act, 2000 remains the primary law on cyber offences.

Understanding Cyberstalking

1. **Definition:** Persistent monitoring or harassment through email, social media or messaging apps, causing fear and psychological trauma. Section 354D of the IPC criminalises stalking by electronic means.
2. **Gendered Impact:** It mostly targets women, causing reputational harm and self-censorship; fear and low faith in redressal keep it underreported.
3. **Enforcement Gaps:** Vague terms hamper enforcement, and the striking down of Section 66A for vagueness shows the need for precise definitions balancing free speech and protection.

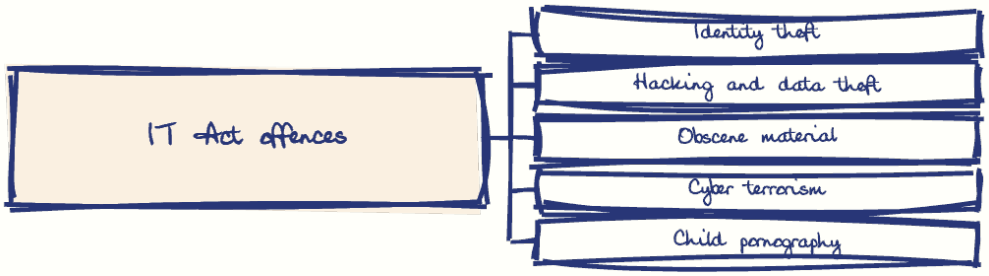
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Scan to practice

Other Cyber Offences under the IT Act, 2000

1. **Identity Theft:** Fraudulent use of another's digital identity, including fake profiles; Andhra Pradesh police increasingly report such cases linked to financial fraud.
2. **Hacking and Data Theft:** Sections 65 and 66 punish unauthorised access, protecting infrastructure and data.
3. **Obscene Material:** Sections 67, 67A and 67B cover obscene content, including revenge porn and deepfake videos.
4. **Cyber Terrorism:** Section 66F targets digital threats to India's sovereignty and security.
5. **Child Pornography:** Its creation, distribution and possession are punished, the CCPWC scheme supports prevention.
6. **Cyber Defamation and Bullying:** These cause reputational damage and distress, gender-based vitriol online calls for better redressal and initiatives like CyberDost.

Offences under the IT Act, 2000

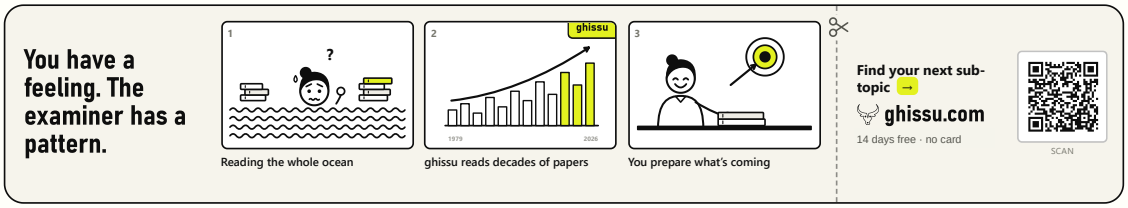


Way Forward

1. Legal Clarity: Amend the IT Act and IPC to close definitional gaps and cover emerging threats.
2. Reporting: Scale up awareness and simplify reporting through the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, especially in rural Andhra Pradesh.
3. Capacity: Train police personnel and cyber forensic labs in Andhra Pradesh for better investigation.
4. Digital Literacy: Teach safe online behaviour to women and children.

Conclusion

Cyberstalking and other offences need clear law, capable enforcement and digital literacy, so that cyberspace is safe and inclusive, especially for women and children.



15(b) What is GST? Discuss the regulatory framework of GST in India, including Constitutional provisions applicable to GST.

10

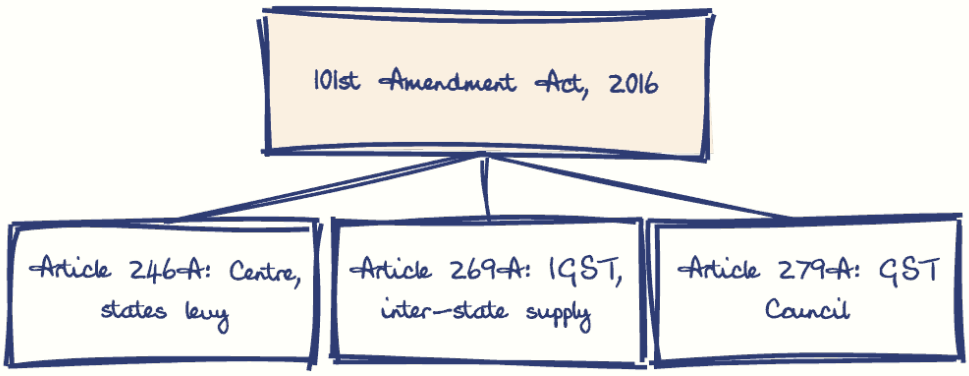
Introduction

The Goods and Services Tax, introduced on (1) July (2017), is a landmark indirect tax reform. It subsumed multiple central and state taxes into one destination-based tax on the supply of goods and services, creating a single common market. It eases business, improves compliance and harmonises Centre-State fiscal relations.

Constitutional Provisions

1. 101st Amendment Act, 2016: It inserted Articles 246A, 269A and 279A, giving the legal foundation for GST.
2. Article 246A: Empowers both Parliament and state legislatures to levy GST.
3. Article 269A: Governs GST on inter-state supply through IGST.
4. Article 279A: Creates the GST Council as a constitutional body on rates and policy, chaired by the Union Finance Minister, with states holding two-thirds of the voting power.

Constitutional basis of GST



Statutory and Administrative Framework

1. Laws: The CGST Act, State GST Acts, IGST Act and the GST (Compensation to States) Act standardise administration.
2. Secretariat and CBIC: The GST Secretariat, headed by the Union Revenue Secretary, supports the Council; CBIC gives technical inputs and enforces compliance.
3. Technology: GSTN offers a unified platform for registration, returns and payment.
4. Dispute Resolution: The GST Appellate Tribunal improves efficiency.

Working and Outcomes

1. Rate Structure: Slabs of 5%, 12%, 18% and 28% were simplified by GST 2.0 to mainly 5% and 18%.

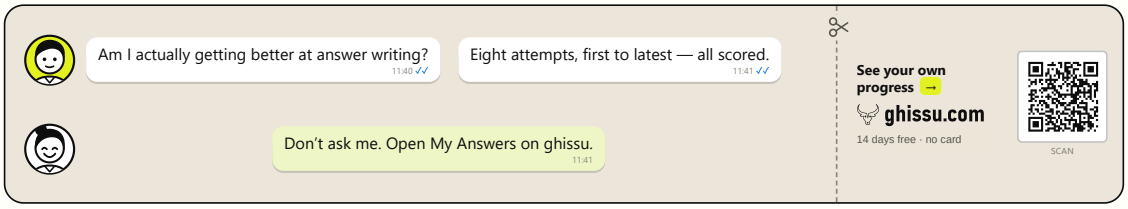
2. Compensation: States were assured 14% annual revenue growth, easing fears of revenue loss for manufacturing states.
3. Formalisation: Input tax credit draws textiles and MSMEs into the tax net, widening the base and reducing evasion.

Way Forward

1. Wider Coverage: Bring petroleum and electricity under GST to cut embedded taxes, benefiting industrial states like Andhra Pradesh.
2. Compliance: Use data analytics and widen audit coverage, already up from 62% to nearly 89%.
3. Federal Cooperation: Keep Council decisions transparent and participatory.

Conclusion

GST has unified India's market through its constitutional design and fostered cooperative federalism, advancing the vision of "One Nation, One Tax".



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2023

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1(a) Examine the scope of 'reasonable restrictions' and the 'test of reasonableness' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution.

10

Introduction

The freedoms of Article 19 are not absolute: the State may impose " reasonable restrictions ". The judiciary checks these through a test of reasonableness, reaffirmed in Shreya Singhal v. UOI (2015), which held that restrictions must be proportionate and not arbitrary.

Scope of Reasonable Restrictions

1. Constitutional grounds: Articles 19(2) to (6) permit limits on speech, assembly, association, movement, residence and profession for sovereignty, security, public order, morality and friendly relations with foreign states. Speech may be restricted to prevent defamation or incitement to an offence.

2. Balancing interests: Restrictions prevent misuse of freedom that could harm order or security. Shreya Singhal struck down Section 66A of the IT Act as vague and excessively broad.

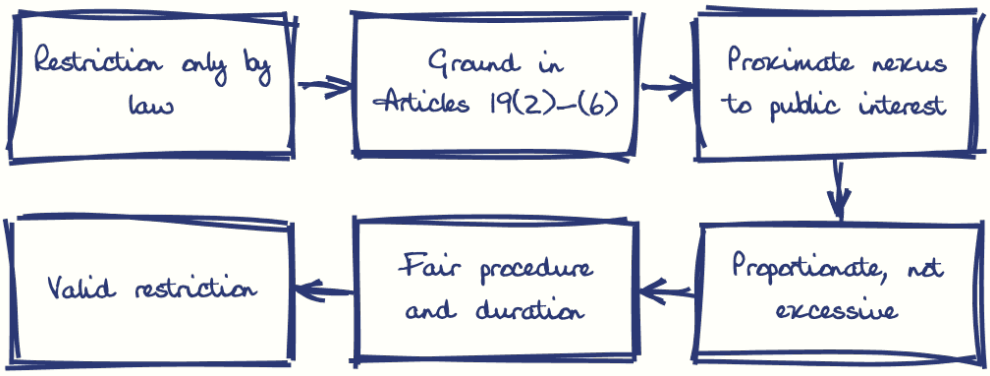
3. Protecting vulnerable groups: Limits on movement and settlement preserve the culture of Scheduled Tribes.

4. Legislative limits: Only law can restrict, and the State must prove reasonableness, as Chintaman Rao (1950) held.

Test of Reasonableness

1. Proportionality and nexus: Restrictions need a "proximate" relation to public interest, not hypothetical concerns.
2. Substance and procedure: N.B. Khare (1950) held that procedural aspects, like duration, are reviewable.
3. Contextual evaluation: The test is case-specific: courts consider the right infringed, the urgency of the evil and prevailing social conditions.
4. Judicial restraint: V.G. Row (1952) noted courts must respect the legislature while upholding constitutional morality.

Test of reasonableness under Article 19

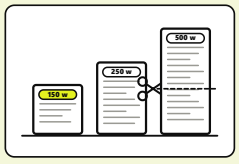


Wider Framework

1. **Judicial review:** The Supreme Court and High Courts act as guardians of rights, reviewing restrictions and preventing arbitrary or excessive state action.
2. **Harmony with Article 21:** Restrictions are read with the rights to life and privacy. Puttaswamy recognised reasonable limits on privacy too.
3. **Democratic legitimacy:** Only laws made by the legislature can restrict rights, ensuring democratic legitimacy and accountability in limiting freedoms.

Conclusion

Reasonable restrictions let the State protect public order, security and morality, while the test of reasonableness keeps those limits proportionate, procedurally fair and tied to a real public interest. Together they balance liberty with social control.



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SCAN

1(b) Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council and discuss its relevance in the context of Centre-State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in India.

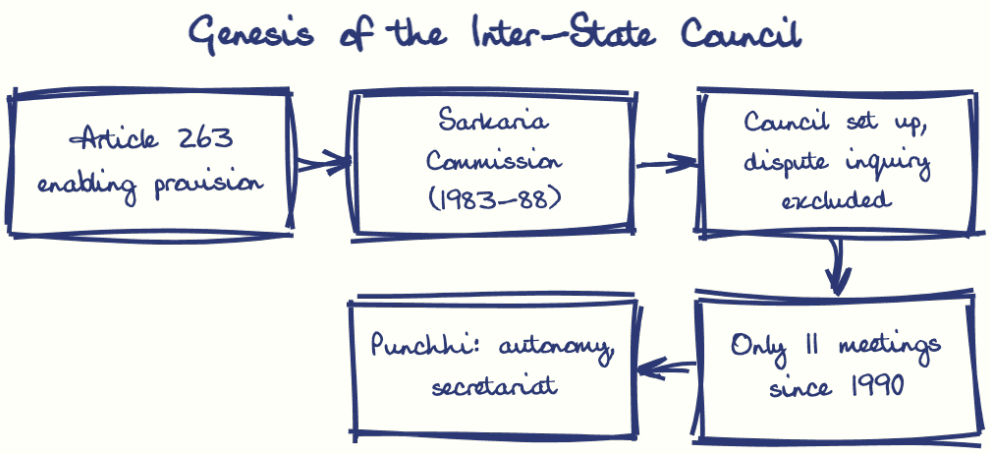
10

Introduction

The Inter-State Council (ISC) is a constitutional mechanism to enhance coordination between the Union and States and among States. Established in 1990 under Article 263, its relevance has grown amid GST implementation and inter-state water disputes.

Genesis of the Inter-State Council

1. **Article 263:** It empowers the President to establish a council for coordination when public interest demands it.
2. **Sarkaria Commission:** The Sarkaria Commission (1983–88) recommended a permanent council for dialogue, leading to a Presidential Order in 1990.
3. **Composition:** Chaired by the Prime Minister, it includes Chief Ministers of States and UTs with legislatures, Governors of States under President's Rule and nominated Union Ministers.
4. **Limitation at Birth:** The Presidential Order excluded the dispute-inquiry function, making the Council only recommendatory.



Relevance in Centre-State Coordination

1. **Platform for Dialogue:** It lets the Centre and States discuss fiscal policies and welfare schemes, and helped align fiscal policies during the GST rollout.
2. **Bridging Trust Deficit:** It acts as a safety valve, as in Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status after bifurcation.
3. **Infrequent and Non-Binding:** With only (11) meetings since (1990) and non-binding recommendations, it could not enforce consensus, weakening coordination even during COVID-19.
4. **Need for Strengthening:** The Punchhi Commission recommended more autonomy, resources and an independent secretariat to monitor decisions.

Relevance in Inter-State Cooperation

1. **Inter-State Dialogue:** It has deliberated on Krishna

and Godavari water sharing involving Andhra Pradesh.

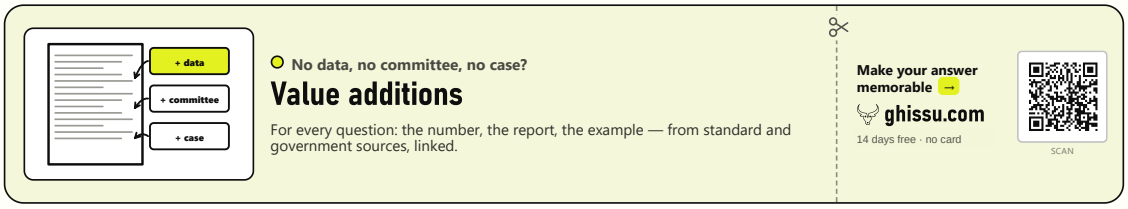
2. Policy Harmonisation: It helps States coordinate development strategies for integrated regional growth, as in the Visakhapatnam–Chennai industrial corridor.

3. Limits in Dispute Resolution: Lack of binding authority and infrequent meetings reduce its ability to give timely, enforceable interventions.

4. Complementing Other Bodies: Article 262 tribunals and zonal councils handle narrower issues, while the ISC's broader mandate remains underutilised.

Conclusion

The ISC is central to cooperative federalism, but its potential is unrealised. Following the Punchhi Commission, regular meetings, an independent secretariat and greater autonomy would turn it from an underused forum into an effective institution for cooperation.



2(a) The office of the Governor in certain situations carries with it the exercise of 'discretionary functions' and 'special responsibilities'. Discuss this statement in view of the constitutional provisions.

10

Introduction

The Governor combines the roles of constitutional head and the Centre's representative in the states. While the Governor generally acts on the advice of the Council of Ministers, the Constitution envisages discretionary functions and special responsibilities in exceptional circumstances, such as hung assemblies or President's Rule.

Discretionary Functions

1. **Constitutional Basis:** Article 163(2) provides that the Governor's decision on discretionary matters is final and cannot be questioned.
2. **Reservation of Bills:** Under Article 200, the Governor may reserve bills for the President, a check on state legislation affecting Centre–State relations or rights.
3. **Recommending President's Rule:** Under Article 356 the Governor reports a constitutional breakdown, a power misused at times, as the S.R. Bommai case showed.
4. **Situational Discretion:** Appointing a Chief

Minister without a clear majority, dismissing a ministry that loses confidence, or dissolving the assembly, as during Andhra Pradesh's fragile 2014 bifurcation.

Special Responsibilities

1. Administrator of Union Territories: When in charge of an adjoining UT, the Governor acts independently.
2. Tribal Areas: Under the Sixth Schedule the Governor fixes royalties for autonomous district councils in Assam and Meghalaya, protecting tribal rights.
3. Constitutional Conventions: The Governor acts as a stabilising force during uncertainty, as the Punchhi Commission recommended.
4. Law and Order: Special provisions give the Governor responsibility for law and order in Nagaland and Assam.

Discretion and special responsibility

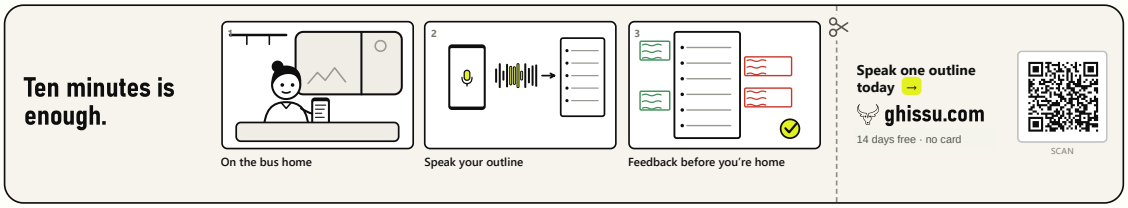
Discretionary functions	Special responsibilities
Reserve bills, Article 200	Administer adjoining UT
Recommend President's Rule	Sixth Schedule tribal royalties
Choose CM in hung assembly	Law and order, Nagaland, Assam

Way Forward

1. **Fixed Tenure:** A fixed five-year term with transparent removal, as the Sarkaria Commission advised.
2. **Clear Guidelines:** Strict guidelines on dissolution and President's Rule to prevent misuse and uphold constitutionalism.
3. **Codified Conventions:** Legislative or judicial clarification of conventions would help Governors act impartially in hung assemblies and government formation.

Conclusion

These powers are vital tools for the federal structure and parliamentary democracy. Exercised with constitutional morality and restraint, they ensure stability and protect the democratic process at the state level, strengthening cooperative federalism.



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2(b) The National Education Policy (2020) has been criticized as denuding the autonomy of states. In this connection, examine the rationale behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list.

10

Introduction

NEP 2020 aims to make education holistic, inclusive and fit for the 21st century. Education has been a Concurrent List subject since the 42nd Amendment (1976), and NEP's central frameworks have drawn criticism that it denudes state autonomy.

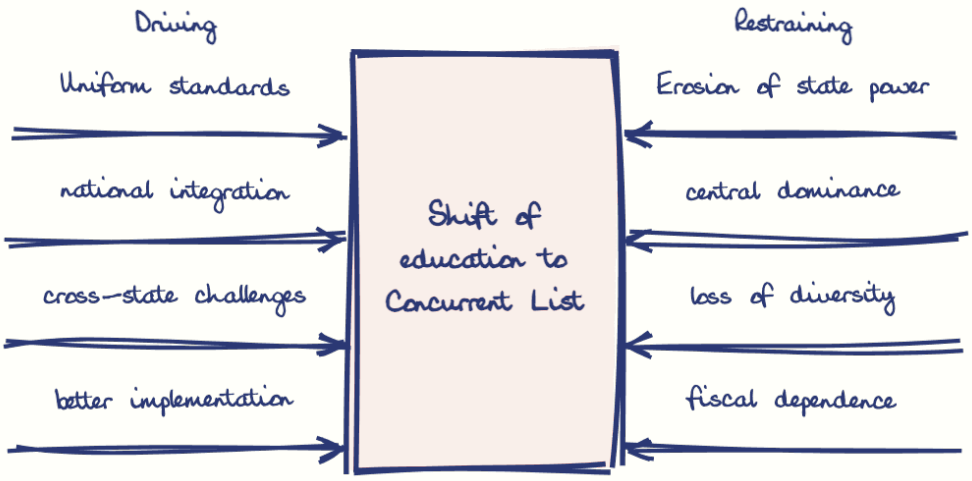
Rationale for Moving Subjects to the Concurrent List

1. **Uniform Standards:** To ensure equitable quality and access and reduce disparities in learning outcomes.
2. **National Integration:** A common framework, such as the National Curriculum Framework 2020–21, fosters unity while respecting diversity.
3. **Cross-State Challenges:** Digital education, vocational training and teacher development need joint Centre–State action.
4. **Implementation:** Schemes like NIPUN Bharat and PM SHRI rely on shared governance, including in Andhra Pradesh.

Impact on State Autonomy

1. **Erosion of Legislative Power:** States once had exclusive rights over school education, and the shift limits their ability to tailor policy to local socio-cultural contexts.
2. **Central Dominance:** Bodies like the HECI and PARAKH centralise regulatory authority, potentially marginalising state education departments.
3. **Uniformity vs Diversity:** A "monolithic" framework risks sidelining regional languages, histories and pedagogy that states like Andhra Pradesh have championed.
4. **Fiscal Dependence:** Reliance on central funding and guidelines reduces state discretion in resource allocation and innovation.

Education in the Concurrent List



Implications for Centre–State Relations

1. Cooperation at Risk: Power asymmetry may turn cooperative federalism into central dominance.
2. Resistance: States may resist perceived encroachment, risking uneven reforms across the country.
3. Need for Mechanisms: The Inter-State Council or a strengthened Education Council can mediate conflicts and harmonise policy.
4. National Goals, Local Realities: Doubling the Gross Enrolment Ratio by 2035 needs flexible Centre–State arrangements.

Way Forward

1. Intergovernmental Dialogue: Hold regular dialogue through the Inter-State Council so states shape education policy.
2. Contextual Flexibility: Allow states to adapt national frameworks to local needs.

Conclusion

The transfer has a sound rationale in national standards and integration, but NEP 2020 must leave states room to adapt it to local realities.

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Scan to practice

3(a) Discuss the scope and challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj. Briefly suggest on how to enhance women empowerment in rural and urban local governance.

10

Introduction

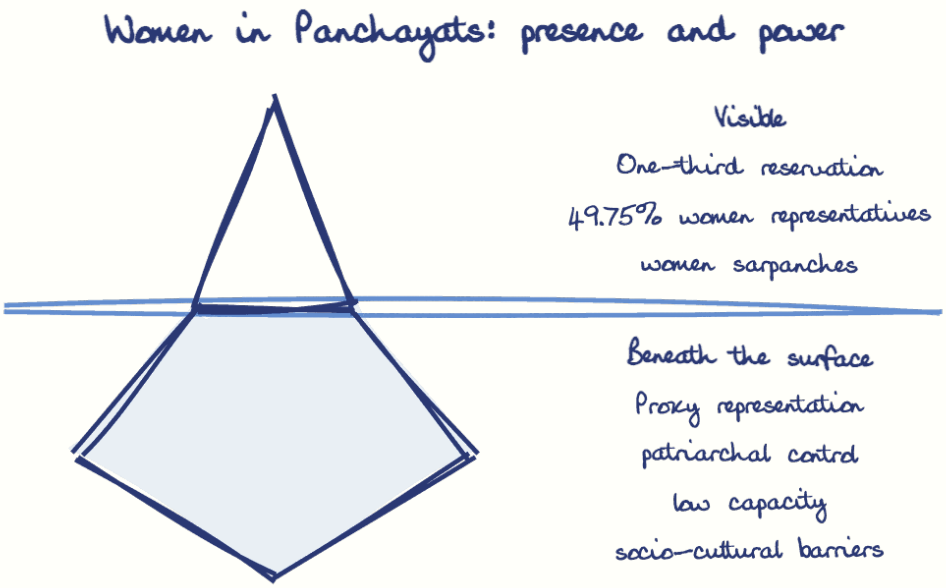
The 73rd Amendment mandated at least one-third reservation for women in Panchayati Raj Institutions, opening political spaces traditionally dominated by men. Women's grassroots participation has grown greatly, but empowerment still faces socio-cultural, institutional and capacity challenges.

Scope of Political Empowerment

1. **Constitutional Mandate:** Reservation of one-third of seats and chairperson posts ensures women's formal entry into local governance.
2. **Scale of Representation:** Women form nearly 49.75% of representatives. Uttarakhand has over 35,000 women in 7,485 panchayats.
3. **Better Public Goods:** Empirical studies show villages led by women sarpanches often see better delivery on health, education and sanitation, which is substantive empowerment beyond mere presence.
4. **Social Change:** Women leaders challenge patriarchal stereotypes and become role models.

Challenges

1. Proxy Representation: Many women act as proxies for husbands, as documented in states including Andhra Pradesh.
2. Capacity Gaps: Illiteracy, lack of training and limited knowledge of rights hinder participation.
3. Socio-Cultural Barriers: Purdah, mobility restrictions and doubts about women's leadership restrict engagement.
4. Institutional Constraints: Male dominance, political interference and weak devolution of funds produce rubber stamp candidates.



Measures for Rural and Urban Local Governance

1. Capacity Building: Regular, context-specific

leadership training at block and district levels.

2. Institutional Support: Devolve funds, functions and functionaries, with gender-sensitive administrative support.

3. Collectives: Use self-help groups and mahila gram sabhas to raise awareness and collective agency.

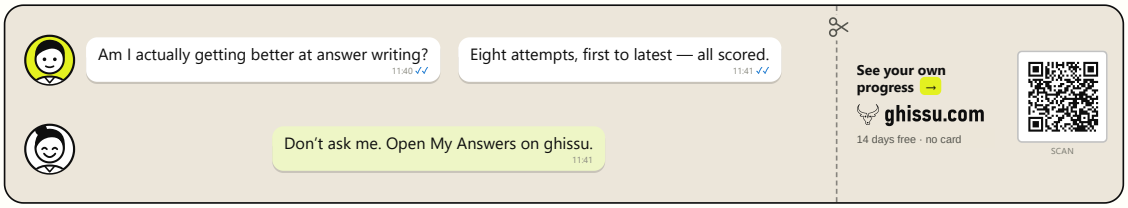
4. Addressing Social Barriers: Sensitisation campaigns and legal safeguards against political violence.

Assessment

Reservation has secured numbers; capacity building and institutional support must turn that presence into real decision-making power in both rural and urban bodies.

Conclusion

Women's political empowerment through Panchayat Raj needs sustained effort beyond reservation. It advances Article (40) and SDG (5) on gender equality, making rural and urban local governance more inclusive and democratic.



3(b) The Finance Commission, though not being a permanent body, has still maintained its credibility by promoting fiscal democracy in India' — Comment.

10

Introduction

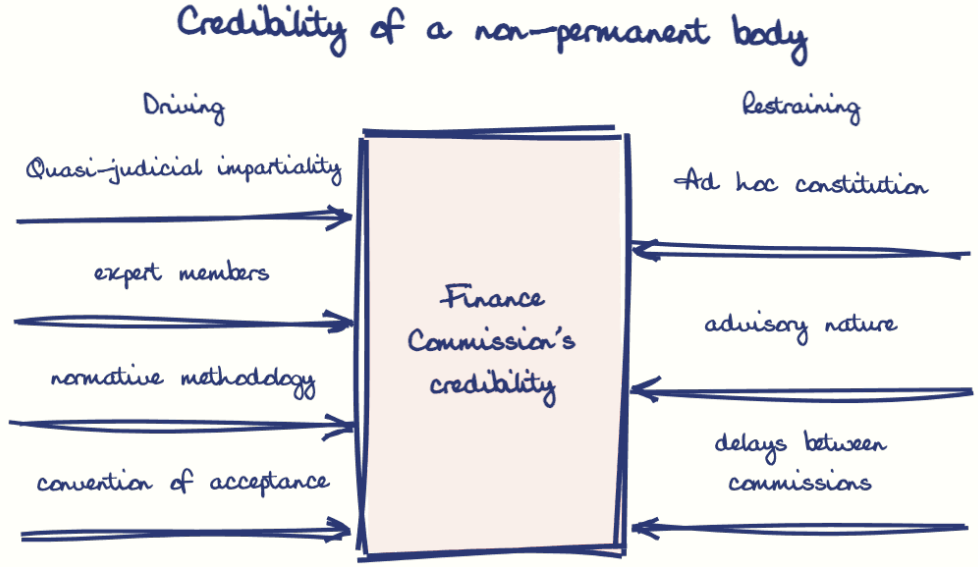
The Finance Commission under ~~Article~~ 280 recommends how resources are shared between the Union and the states. Though non-permanent, constituted every five years or earlier, it has consistently shaped fiscal governance and promoted fiscal democracy, relevant after GST and amid demands such as Andhra Pradesh's.

Non-Permanent Status and Its Implications

1. Ad Hoc Constitution: Without continuous presence it may lack policy continuity, but it gains flexibility to address new realities.
2. Advisory Nature: Its advice is not binding, though convention expects acceptance barring exceptional reasons.
3. Uncertainty: Fresh commissions can delay allocations, as with Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit grants.
4. Expert Composition: Members from finance, economics and the judiciary ensure technical rigour.

How It Has Maintained Credibility

1. Quasi-Judicial Impartiality: Evidence-based recommendations make it a neutral arbiter.
2. Evolving Methodology: Since the Ninth Commission it moved from gap-filling to normative approaches.
3. Acceptance: Most reports, including the Fifteenth Commission's during COVID-19, were largely implemented.
4. Regional Balance: Weighing population, income and fiscal discipline addresses concerns of states like Andhra Pradesh.



Promoting Fiscal Democracy

1. Equitable Distribution: Tax devolution and grants-in-aid give states a fair share.

2. Local Governments: After the 73rd and 74th Amendments it augments resources for Panchayats and Municipalities.
3. Performance Grants: They foster accountability and responsiveness.
4. Gaps: Delayed transfers and conditionalities, and compliance issues flagged in Andhra Pradesh's audits, limit real autonomy.

Way Forward

1. Continuity: A permanent secretariat across cycles.
2. Binding Advice: Legal provisions making recommendations binding, with limited exceptions, to reduce political arbitrariness.
3. State Consultations: Deeper consultation with states, including Andhra Pradesh, to reflect regional fiscal realities.

Conclusion

The Finance Commission's credibility rests on expertise, impartiality and consistent acceptance rather than permanence. By sharing resources fairly with states and local bodies, it has become a pillar of fiscal democracy.

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Notes that live with the question.
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4(a) Briefly discuss the different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament. Comment on the difference between motions and resolutions.

10

Introduction

Parliamentary motions and resolutions are vital tools for deliberation and executive accountability. Their importance has grown amid concerns over declining debate quality, as in the 16th Lok Sabha's reduced functioning and shorter discussions.

Kinds of Motions

1. **Substantive motions:** Self-contained proposals on an issue, such as an impeachment proposal.
2. **Substitute motions:** Offer an alternative to an original motion.
3. **Subsidiary motions:** Depend on a principal motion; they include ancillary motions for routine business, superseding motions that replace an ongoing debate, and amendments that modify the original motion.
4. **Debate-regulating motions:** Closure and guillotine manage debate time, though dilatory motions can delay business.
5. **Accountability motions:** Adjournment, privilege and no-confidence motions let members raise urgent issues and check the executive.

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Motions vs Resolutions

Motions vs Resolutions

Motions	Resolutions
May or may not be substantive	Always substantive
Not always put to vote	Always require voting
Procedural and substantive types	Express formal decisions or policies
Can be moved by any member	Often moved by ministers, private members

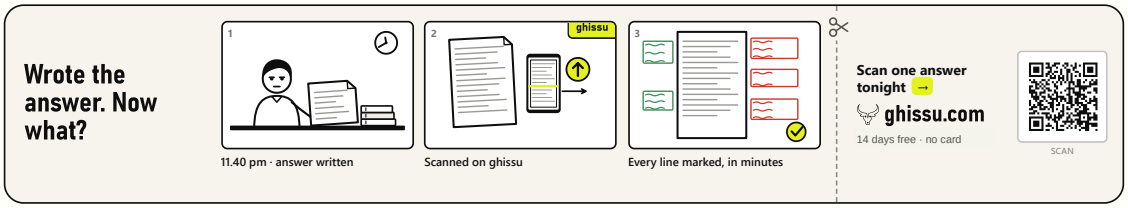
1. Nature: Resolutions are a category of substantive motions expressing the House's formal opinion, such as policy declarations.
2. Voting: Every resolution needs a formal vote, while many motions are not put to vote.
3. Institutional role: Motions help Parliament control its agenda; resolutions formalise its stance on constitutional or statutory matters.
4. Impact: Implementation depends on the executive, resolutions on Andhra Pradesh's Krishna and Godavari water disputes need sustained follow-up.

Challenges and Way Forward

1. **Limited debate time:** Many key bills and motions get under two hours of discussion, limiting scrutiny of issues like the Polavaram project.
2. **Political dynamics:** No-confidence and adjournment motions are often shaped by party politics, leading to theatrical disruptions.
3. **Reform:** Clearer procedural guidelines, more debate time, non-partisan use of motions and follow-up committees for resolutions can improve accountability.

Conclusion

Used effectively, motions and resolutions enable discussion, decision-making and government accountability, strengthening federal balance.



4(b) Describe the matters in which the Legislative Council stands equal with the Legislative Assembly along with the matters in which it stands unequal with the Legislative Assembly.

10

Introduction

The Legislative Council, the upper house in some states, shares lawmaking with the Legislative Assembly, but its powers differ significantly, reflecting its advisory and revising character. Knowing where it is equal and unequal clarifies its position in states like Andhra Pradesh, where bicameralism is active.

Matters Where the Council Is Equal

Council vis-a-vis the Assembly

Equal with Assembly	Unequal with Assembly
Ordinary bills	Money Bills only in Assembly
Approving Gavernor's ordinances	Delays ordinary bills four months
Ministers from either House	Cannot vote on grants
Examining CAG and PSC reports	Cannot remove ministers
Enlarging State PSC jurisdiction	Assembly can seek its abolition

1. Ordinary bills: The Council can introduce and pass ordinary bills like the Assembly.

though in disagreement the Assembly's view prevails.

2. Governor's ordinances: Both Houses equally approve ordinances, ensuring oversight of executive action during recess.
3. Selection of ministers: Ministers, including the Chief Minister, may be members of either House.
4. Reports of constitutional bodies: Both examine reports of the State Finance Commission, State Public Service Commission and the CAG.
5. State PSC jurisdiction: Both can deliberate on enlarging the State PSC's powers.

Matters Where the Council Is Unequal

1. Origination of Money Bills: A Money Bill can be introduced only in the Assembly.
2. Limited role on Money Bills: The Council cannot amend or reject one and must return it within (14) days; the Assembly may ignore its recommendations.
3. Speaker's final say: The Assembly Speaker decides whether a bill is a Money Bill.
4. Delaying power only: The Council can delay

ordinary bills for at most four months (three months, then one).

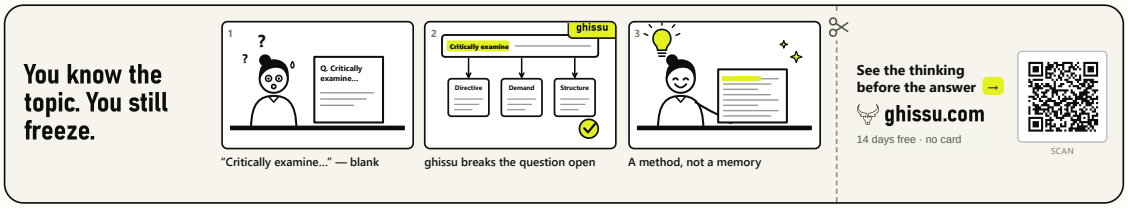
5. Demands for grants: It may discuss the budget but cannot vote on grants.
6. No-confidence motion: Ministers are responsible only to the Assembly, so the Council cannot remove them.
7. Dependence for existence: The Assembly can pass a special resolution for its abolition, which Parliament can enact.

Way Forward

1. Stronger revising role: Expert committees and research support can improve scrutiny without undermining Assembly supremacy.
2. Deadlock mechanisms: Provisions to manage disagreements can reduce legislative delays.

Conclusion

The Council is equal in routine legislative and oversight matters but clearly subordinate in finance, executive control and its very survival, serving as a revising chamber.



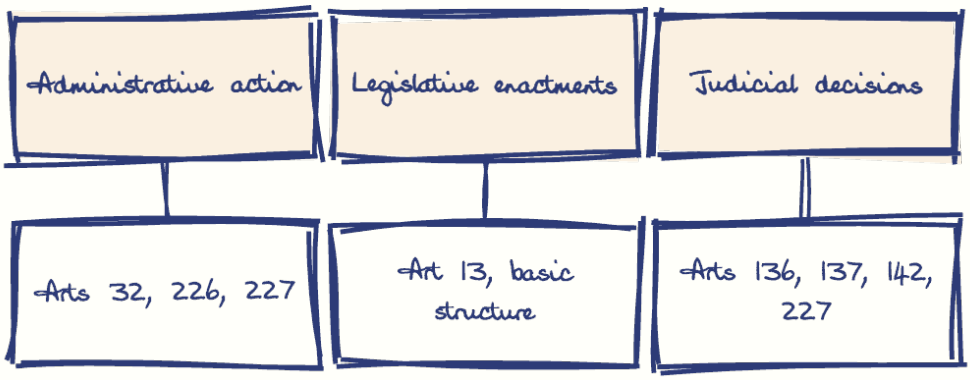
5(a) Discuss the scope of Judicial review in reviewing administrative action, legislative enactments and judicial decisions.

10

Introduction

Judicial review empowers courts to ensure that legislative, executive and judicial actions conform to the Constitution. The striking down of the 99th Amendment and NJAC Act shows its role in constitutional supremacy, though charges of judicial overreach keep its scope under debate.

Scope of judicial review



Review of Administrative Action

1. **Basis:** Articles 32, 226 and 227 let the Supreme Court and High Courts test executive orders and decisions for legality and constitutionality.
2. **Grounds and limits:** Courts intervene when

action violates fundamental rights or exceeds delegated powers, but review is not an appellate function, they examine jurisdiction, fairness and reasonableness, not merits.

3. Balance: Interim rulings on the Waqf law show vigilance without micromanaging policy.

Review of Legislative Enactments

1. Basis: Articles 13, 32 and 131–136 allow courts to invalidate laws violating rights or exceeding competence, Kesavananda Bharati (1973) made review a basic feature.

2. Tensions: Courts may appear to substitute policy preferences for legislative intent, Parliament's enactment of Section 18A after the ruling on the SC/ST Atrocities Act reflects friction over judicial overreach.

Review of Judicial Decisions

1. Review and curative petitions: Under Articles 137 and 142, courts correct legal errors or prevent miscarriage of justice without re-litigating facts.

2. Superintendence: High Courts supervise subordinate courts under Article 227, and the Supreme Court grants special leave under Article

136.

3. Finality: The doctrine of finality limits endless litigation, balancing justice with efficiency, a concern given pendency in Andhra Pradesh's courts.

4. Andhra Pradesh High Court: It has actively used Article 226 to review administrative and judicial actions, protecting fundamental rights in the state.

Conclusion

Judicial review spans administration, legislation and adjudication. In each sphere it works within limits, examining legality rather than merits, which preserves separation of powers while upholding constitutional supremacy and citizens' rights.

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SCAN

5(b) What is meant by Public Interest Litigation (PIL) ? Describe the nature of court orders that are passed by courts in PIL cases.

10

Introduction

Public Interest Litigation (PIL) emerged in India in the early 1980s as a judicial innovation to widen access to justice for disadvantaged groups. Rooted in the activism of Justices V.R. Krishna Iyer and P.N. Bhagwati, it relaxes the traditional locus standi rule.

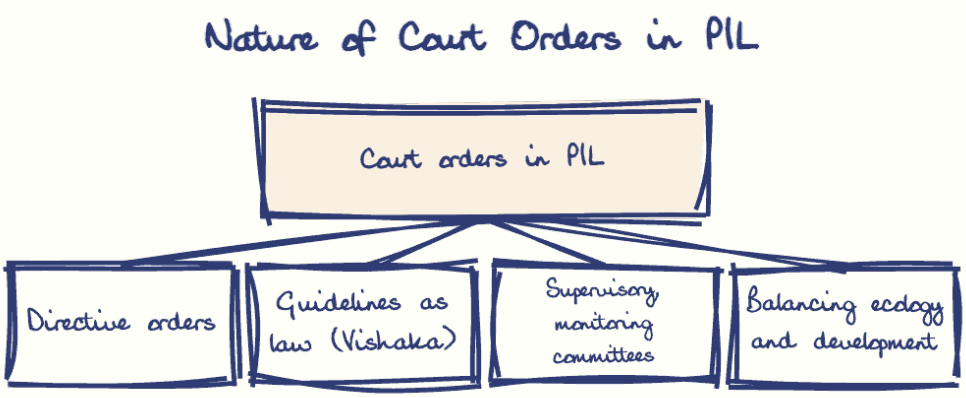
Meaning and Framework of PIL

1. **Relaxation of Locus Standi:** Unlike ordinary cases filed only by the person wronged, PIL permits any public-spirited individual or organization to file for collective rights, democratizing access to justice.
2. **Judicial Activism as Foundation:** The Supreme Court's proactive reading of Articles 32 and 226 institutionalized PIL for issues like bonded labour, environmental degradation and rights of undertrial prisoners.
3. **Defined Categories:** The Court has listed categories such as neglected children, non-payment of minimum wages and environmental protection to filter genuine cases

from frivolous ones.

4. Collaborative Role: Petitioners, the State and the judiciary form a cooperative triad to secure justice for the marginalized.

Nature of Court Orders in PIL



1. Assertive and Creative Role: Courts go beyond mere adjudication and issue innovative, wide-ranging orders to enforce public duties.
2. Directive Orders: Courts mandate specific government action where the executive has failed.
3. Guidelines as Law: Courts frame guidelines for policy implementation, as in the Vishaka guidelines on workplace sexual harassment.
4. Supervisory and Structural Orders: Courts appoint monitoring committees and keep cases open to ensure compliance.

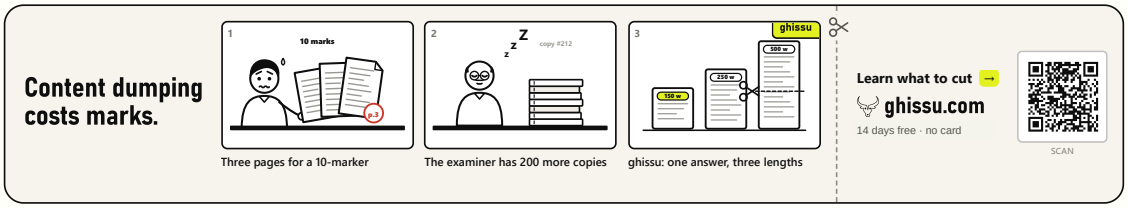
5. Balancing Orders: Courts prioritize public welfare over individual property or administrative convenience, as ecological PILs weigh environmental rights against developmental needs.

Challenges and Way Forward

1. Overreach and Backlog: The surge in PILs has added to case backlogs and raised fears of judicial overreach.
2. Reforms: Stronger preliminary screening, wider pro bono legal aid and dedicated bodies to monitor PIL orders can keep PIL focused on genuine public interest.

Conclusion

PIL has turned the judiciary into a proactive guardian of constitutional morality and social justice. Used with restraint, it strengthens the rule of law and inclusive governance.



6(a) "The concept of the welfare state had been crystallised in Kautilya's ideas long before it came to be envisioned in Western Europe' — Examine this statement.

10

Introduction

The welfare state is usually associated with modern Western Europe, but its roots reach back to Kautilya's ~~Arthashastra~~ in the Mauryan Empire (4th century BCE). Kautilya made the well-being of subjects central to statecraft, though within a monarchical frame.

Welfare State Ideas in the ~~Arthashastra~~

1. **People-Centric Governance:** "In the happiness of his subjects lies his happiness; in their welfare, his welfare" ties the king's legitimacy to subjects' welfare.
2. **Comprehensive Duties:** The king must ensure protection and welfare, rakshana and palana, covering economic security, social order and justice.
3. **Regulated Market:** Kautilya accepted private land ownership but wanted state regulation for a free and fair market.
4. **Public Goods:** State ownership of forests and mines and heavy expenditure on public projects show resources managed for collective benefit.

5. Yoga Kshema: Welfare and security were linked, tying social welfare to political stability.

How It Differs from the Western Welfare State

Kautilya and the Western Welfare State

Kautilya's state	Western welfare state
Mauryan statecraft, 4th century BCE	After industrialisation
Monarchical, realist	Democratic, citizen rights
Regulated fair markets	Social insurance, redistribution
Welfare as statecraft tool	Welfare as an end

1. Context: Kautilya wrote for Mauryan statecraft and social order, while the European welfare state emerged in the late 19th and 20th centuries in response to industrialisation and market failures.

2. Governance Model: Kautilya's state was monarchical and realist; Western states are democratic, built on citizen rights and social contract.

3. Economic Approach: Kautilya regulated markets, while Europe built social insurance and redistribution covering health, unemployment

and old age.

4. Purpose: For Kautilya welfare was a tool of statecraft; in Europe it became an end in itself, rooted in liberal democracy and Keynesian ideas.

Assessment

The statement is largely valid: Kautilya recognized state responsibility for social protection and public goods long before Europe. Yet his hierarchical, monarch-centric model lacked democratic inclusiveness and universal rights.

Conclusion

Kautilya crystallised the ethical core of the welfare state through rajdharma, blending morality with pragmatism, even if its democratic form came later in Europe. His vision of a duty-bound ruler remains relevant to Indian governance traditions, as India revisits its intellectual heritage amid present governance challenges.

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SCAN

6(b) It is observed that much of present-day Indian bureaucracy is a result of British administration. In this connection, explain the evolution of Civil Service in India.

Introduction

The Indian civil service is deeply rooted in its colonial past. Its evolution from a colonial instrument of control to development-oriented machinery explains why present-day bureaucracy still carries British legacies despite reforms.

Evolution of the Civil Service

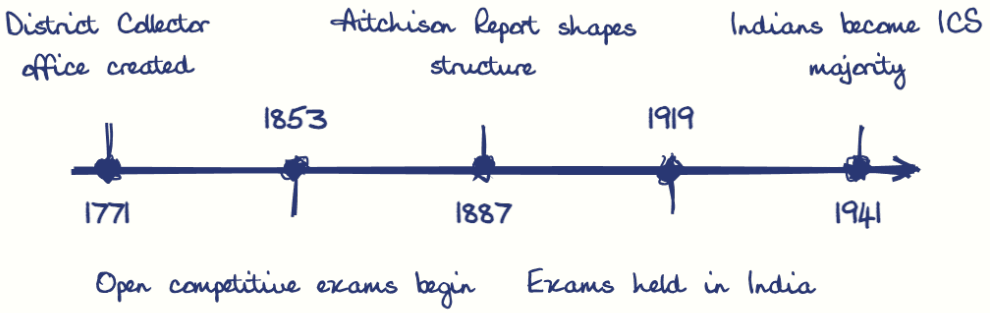
1. Mughal and Company Foundations: Akbar built a welfare-oriented land revenue system. The East India Company coined "Civil Service" to separate administrators from the military and created the District Collector in 1771.
2. Cornwallis's Role: Regarded as architect of the Indian Civil Service, he introduced police, judicial and revenue services with strict codes of conduct.
3. Open Competition: The 1853 Charter Act ended Company patronage and introduced competitive exams, though held only in London.
4. Indianisation: The Macaulay Committee (1854) and Aitchison Report (1887) shaped the ICS. The 1919 Act brought exams to India, and by

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(1941) Indians outnumbered Europeans.

Evolution of Civil Service in India



British Influence on Present Bureaucracy

1. Weberian Legacy: The IAS inherits permanence of tenure, generalist character, hierarchy and merit-based recruitment, with continued stress on law, order and revenue.
2. Elitism: Officers still come largely from urban, English-educated backgrounds, limiting representativeness.
3. Paternalistic Culture: The colonial focus on control lingers, keeping bureaucrats distant from the masses.
4. Neutrality vs Politicization: Conduct rules keep the British principle of neutrality, though ties with elected representatives have grown complex.

Changes after Independence

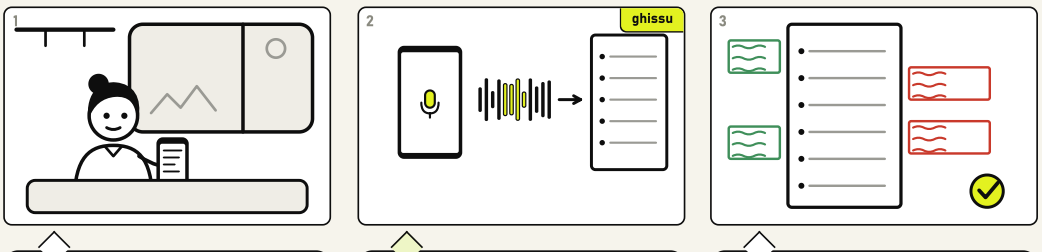
Bureaucracy now implements development plans and welfare, as in Andhra Pradesh's DBT schemes, though seniority-based promotion leaves an "aluminium frame" rather than a steel one. Civil servants now also answer to elected governments, courts and citizens through the RTI Act 2005 and social audits.

Conclusion

The civil service has moved from colonial despotism to democratic accountability. Yet rigidity, proceduralism and a closed corporate culture show that its British inheritance still needs reform to become truly citizen-centric.

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SCAN

7(a) Government's intervention in development has seen a long way of impressive outcomes in India. In this connection, discuss the 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' mission aimed at making India Self-Reliant.

Introduction

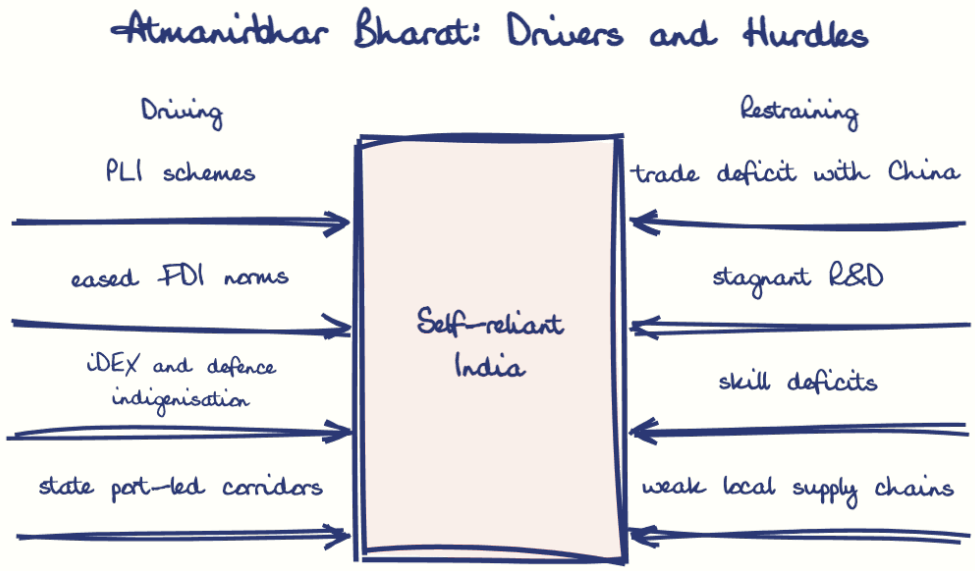
Government intervention has played a pivotal role in shaping India's economic and social landscape. Launched in 2020, the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission renewed the focus on self-reliance, aiming to reduce dependence on global supply chains and boost domestic capability in the post-pandemic era.

Institutional Framework of the Mission

1. **Centralised Coordination:** The Commerce, Industry and Defence ministries work with NITI Aayog, whose Output-Outcome Framework monitors results for accountability.
2. **Defence Self-Reliance:** iDEX and the Technology Development Fund helped achieve record indigenous defence production of 1.27 lakh crore in 2023-24.
3. **Financial and Regulatory Reforms:** Eased FDI norms in strategic sectors and PLI schemes have enabled private participation and innovation.
4. **State Implementation:** Andhra Pradesh promotes aquaculture and port-led industrial corridors,

contributing to GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average.

Outcomes and Challenges



1. Supply Chains and Trade: The mission seeks to cut the trade deficit with China through domestic manufacturing, but local supply chains and global trade tensions remain hurdles.
2. Social Impact: It complements Ayushman Bharat and Jan Dhan Yojana; lower infant mortality and cheaper medicines through Jan Aushadhi Kendras show inclusive gains.
3. Technology and Skill Gaps: Stagnant R&D investment and skill deficits, including in defence, slow full self-reliance.
4. Monitoring Limits: The Output–Outcome

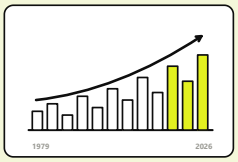
Framework has improved governance, but weak real-time data and inter-agency coordination delay timely course correction.

Way Forward

1. R&D Investment: Raise public and private research funding in defence and high-tech manufacturing.
2. Skilling: Align Skill India with industry needs.
3. Centre-State Synergy: Use regional strengths of states like Andhra Pradesh for balanced growth.
4. Digital Infrastructure: Expand the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission to improve service delivery, transparency and citizen participation.

Conclusion

Atmanirbhar Bharat is a transformative approach stressing economic sovereignty, technological advancement and inclusive growth. Implemented well, it can build a resilient economy that balances global integration with domestic strength, fulfilling the vision of "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas".



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SCAN

7(b) Explain the scope of civil service reforms in India with a brief note on Mission Karmayogi.

Introduction

Civil service reforms in India have gained urgency amid rapid technological change and rising demands for citizen-centric administration. The focus is on efficiency, accountability and domain expertise. Mission Karmayogi, launched in 2020, epitomises this drive by stressing continuous learning for over 46 lakh central employees.

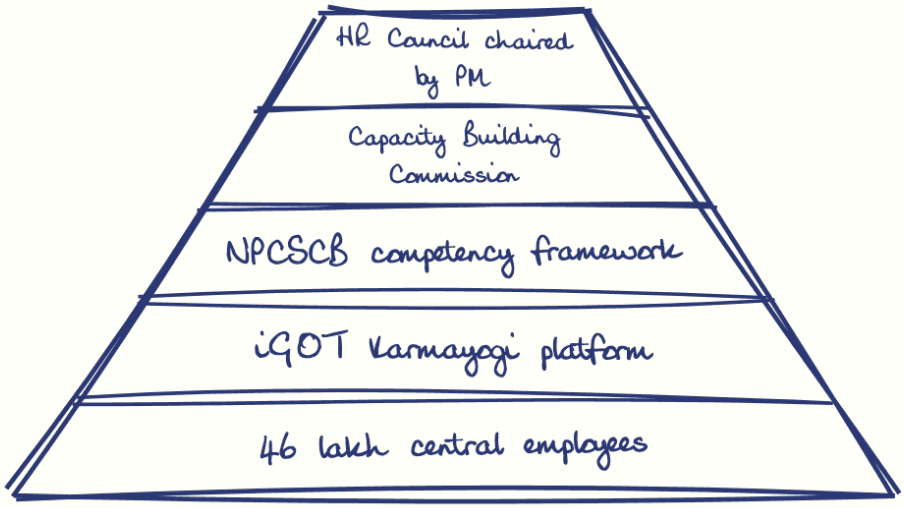
Scope of Civil Service Reforms

1. Rule to Role: Reforms move from traditional rule-based training to role-based HR management, linking competencies with job roles in postings, transfers and promotions.
2. Specialists and Lateral Entry: Specialist recruitment and lateral entry address the dominance of elite services and the lack of specialist representation.
3. Behavioural Change: Beyond skills, reforms seek creativity, proactiveness and citizen-centric attitudes among officers.
4. Accountability: Capacity building is linked to performance management through 360-degree

feedback and data-driven assessments.

Mission Karmayogi: A Brief Note

Mission Karmayogi Structure



1. **NPCSCB:** The National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building integrates behavioural, functional and domain competencies for future challenges.
2. **iGOT Karmayogi:** This online platform offers over 4,600 courses in multiple languages for self-paced learning and competency tracking across cadres and states, including Andhra Pradesh.
3. **Strategic Oversight:** A Human Resources Council chaired by the Prime Minister gives apex guidance, while the Capacity Building Commission harmonises training standards and supervises implementation.

4. Scale: By 2026, over 1.5 crore learners had registered on iGOT, with more than 8 crore course completions.

5. Challenges: Uneven access in resource-constrained regions and resistance to change in entrenched bureaucratic cultures remain.

Way Forward

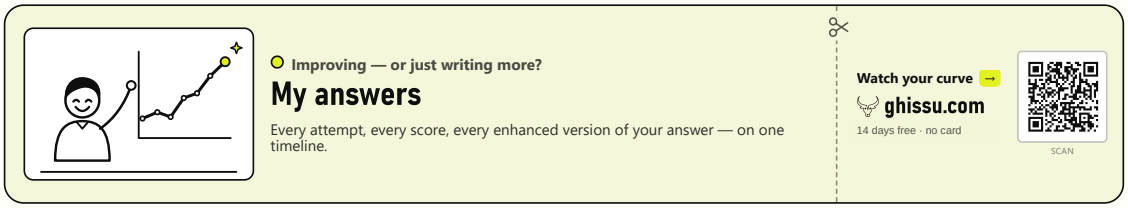
1. State Customisation: Tailor modules to the priorities of states like Andhra Pradesh.

2. Digital Access: Expand internet connectivity and digital literacy for civil servants in remote and rural areas to maximise the benefits of iGOT.

3. Continuous Feedback: Build real-time feedback mechanisms so training content adapts to ground realities and evolving governance needs.

Conclusion

Anchored by Mission Karmayogi, these reforms mark a shift towards a competent, accountable bureaucracy, advancing SDG 16 on effective institutions. Their success will show in a civil service that is agile, transparent and aligned with a changing society.



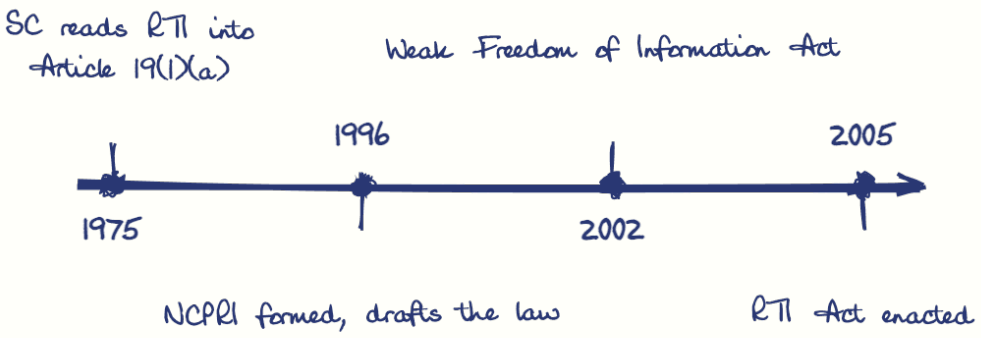
8(a) "The making of the Right to Information Act, 2005 in India has been largely attributed to the success of civil society movement." Comment.

Introduction

The Right to Information Act, 2005 is a landmark in India's democratic governance. It broke decisively with the colonial culture of secrecy under laws like the Official Secrets Act, and it empowers citizens to demand transparency and accountability, making it a vital tool against corruption.

Civil Society as the Primary Catalyst

Road to the RTI Act



1. Grassroots Mobilisation: The Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) in Rajasthan demanded transparency in local governance through the slogan "Hamara Paisa, Hamara Hisab", sparking a national discourse.

2. Drafting and Lobbying: The National Campaign for People's Right to Information (NCPRI), formed in 1996, drafted the legislation and lobbied Parliament, so the law reflected citizens' demands rather than bureaucratic interests.

3. Ethical Methods: Public hearings or Jan Sunwaii exposed corruption and infused the campaign with values of accountability.

4. Mass Demand: The movement turned a technical legal right into a mass democratic demand, compelling the government to act.

Other Contributing Factors

1. Judicial Recognition: In 1975 the Supreme Court recognised the right to information as part of ~~Article~~ Article 19(1)(a).

2. Legislative Evolution: The Freedom of Information Act, 2002 lacked effective implementation, prompting a stronger law with Information Commissions.

3. Political Will and Global Norms: The government's acceptance in 2005 reflected both internal pressure and international governance trends.

4. Technology and Media: IT and investigative

journalism eroded traditional secrecy, and the Act's mandate of proactive disclosure and computerised records modernised administration.

Assessment

The statement is largely valid, but enactment was a confluence of civil society pressure, political endorsement, judicial interpretation and international trends. Bureaucratic resistance delayed the law and still hampers it, with inadequate staffing and law awareness; in Andhra Pradesh, however, RTI has exposed excess payments and project delays.

Conclusion

Civil society was the foundational but not the only force behind RTI. Its legacy lives on in citizens' active use of the law, and mass awareness campaigns, better staffed and funded Information Commissions and proactive disclosure of key government data can sustain its promise of open governance.

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SCAN

8(b) "NGOs play a critical role in promoting human rights, defending the marginalized, and creating a more just and equitable society." Comment on the role of NGO's in India.

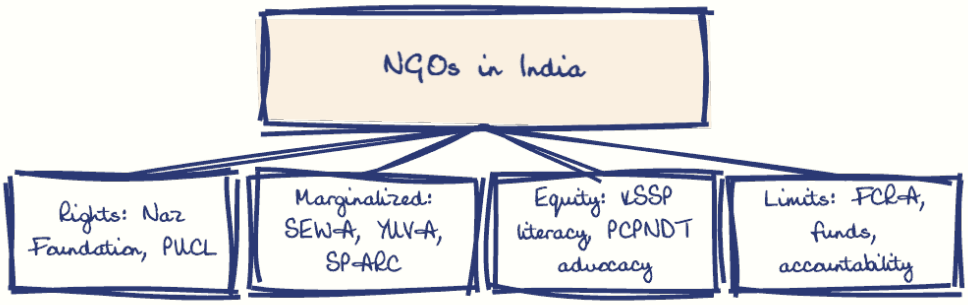
10

Introduction

With over 3.2 million NGOs operating nationwide, India's voluntary sector is a vital intermediary between the state and citizens. Grounded in Article 19(1)(c) on freedom of association and Article 43, NGOs are indispensable to human rights and social justice.

NGOs as Promoters of Human Rights

Role of NGOs in India



1. **Advocacy and Legal Reform:** The Naz Foundation, through persistent efforts, contributed to decriminalising homosexuality under Section 377.
2. **Awareness and Empowerment:** The People's Union for Civil Liberties raised awareness of civil liberties violations, helping marginalized groups seek redress.

3. Grassroots Watchdogs: NGOs document abuses in remote areas; Aid India's COVID-19 outreach in rural Andhra Pradesh is an example.

Defending Marginalized Communities

1. Tribal Land Rights: In Andhra Pradesh, NGOs partnered with Gram Panchayats to implement the Forest Rights Act against corporate encroachment.
2. Last-Mile Welfare: SEWA bridges gaps in welfare schemes for women and informal workers.
3. Community Voice: YUVA and SPARC organised resistance to forced slum demolitions, strengthening grassroots democracy.

Building a Just and Equitable Society

1. Social Equity: The Kerala Sastra Sahitya Parishad's literacy campaigns achieved near-universal literacy.
2. Policy Influence: NGO advocacy strengthened the PCPNDT Act against female foticide, an example of transformative constitutionalism.
3. Environmental Justice: The Centre for Science and Environment champions protection vital for equitable resource use.

Limitations

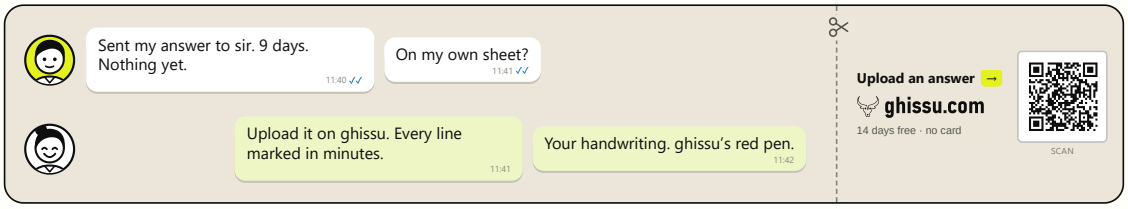
1. Regulatory Constraints: Recent FCRA amendments limit foreign funding and capacity.
2. Resources and Interference: Limited funds, bureaucratic hurdles and political interference restrict long-term support.
3. Accountability: Rapid growth has raised concerns of transparency and misuse.

Way Forward

Simpler FCRA norms, institutional state-NGO partnerships in welfare delivery, capacity building with digital tools and community-led governance that empowers marginalized groups can deepen their impact.

Conclusion

The statement holds largely true: NGOs advance rights, defend the marginalized and build equity, acting as vital intermediaries between state and citizens. Balanced regulation that preserves their autonomy while ensuring accountability will sustain this role.



9(a) Explain the quasi-judicial nature of Administrative Tribunals. Examine whether writs and appeals are available against the decisions of the Administrative Tribunals.

10

Introduction

Complex governance and an overburdened judiciary led to administrative tribunals that deliver speedy, expert justice in public service, taxation and environmental matters. Their quasi-judicial nature, however, raises the question of how far writs and appeals lie against their decisions.

Quasi-Judicial Nature of Tribunals

1. Statutory Creation: Established by statutes like the Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 under Article 323-A, they have jurisdiction limited to specific sectors.
2. Natural Justice with Flexibility: They must act judicially and impartially and give a fair hearing, but are not bound by the strict rules of the Civil Procedure Code.
3. Hybrid Character: Combining judicial and administrative functions, with experts sitting alongside judicial members, they decide technical disputes efficiently, though this raises concerns about independence.

4. Impact: Central Administrative Tribunal benches serving Andhra Pradesh, including Hyderabad, resolve service disputes quickly and reduce court pendency.

Are Writs Available?

Remedies against Tribunal Decisions

Writs	Appeals
Articles 226 and 227	Provided by tribunal statutes
L. Chandra Kumar (1997)	Substantial questions of law
Jurisdiction, natural justice errors	NGT internal appeals
Supervisory, used sparingly	Overlaps cause forum shopping

1. Judicial Review Affirmed: In L. Chandra Kumar v. Union of India (1997), the Supreme Court held that tribunal decisions are subject to review under Articles 226 and 227.

2. Grounds: Writs lie for jurisdictional errors, violation of natural justice or arbitrariness.

3. Sparing Use: Courts act as a supervisory check, not a routine appellate forum.

4. Practical Delays: Writs before the Andhra

Pradesh High Court in service and land disputes sometimes delay speedy justice.

Are Appeals Available?

1. **Statutory Appeals:** Tribunal statutes provide appeals to appellate authorities or High Courts on substantial questions of law.
2. **Layered Structure:** The National Green Tribunal has internal appeals, while others rely on High Courts or the Supreme Court.
3. **Overlaps:** Varied appeal routes cause delay and forum shopping.
4. **Reform:** The Tribunal Reforms Act, 2021 aims to streamline appointments and enhance transparency, improving the quality of decisions.

Conclusion

Writs and appeals both remain available, preserving judicial oversight while respecting tribunal expertise. Clearer appeal routes and stronger tribunal independence would protect the goal of speedy, expert justice for which tribunals were created.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

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SCAN

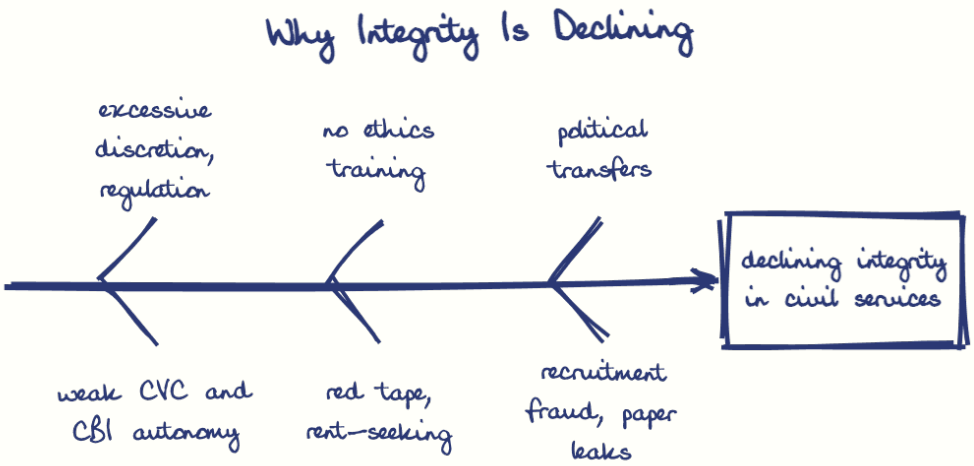
9(b) What are the reasons for decline of integrity in civil services ? Also, discuss the institutional mechanism to check corruption in India.

10

Introduction

The integrity of civil services is fundamental to good governance and public trust. India has witnessed a decline in ethical standards in its bureaucracy, seen in corruption scandals and inefficiency, which erodes service delivery and the rule of law.

Reasons for Decline of Integrity



1. **Excessive Discretion and Regulation:** Wide discretionary powers invite misuse, the Santhanam Committee (1962) identified excessive regulation, cumbersome procedures and opacity as drivers of corruption.

2. **Weak Accountability:** The CVC (1964) and CBI suffer from limited autonomy and political

interference.

3. Lack of Ethical Training: No formal system builds values, so results are prized over ethical means.

4. Red Tape: Multiple clearances for infrastructure projects in Andhra Pradesh stall development and invite rent-seeking.

5. Political Transfers: Frequent transfers demotivate honest officers, as with Ashok Khemka, transferred over (57) times.

6. Recruitment Fraud: Recurring paper leaks let unethical candidates in.

7. Weak Financial Oversight: The Andhra Pradesh CAG audit (2021-22) found revenue losses of over 1,800 crore from underassessment and compliance gaps.

Institutional Mechanisms to Check Corruption

1. Vigilance Bodies: The Central Vigilance Commission monitors central services, while states like Andhra Pradesh have vigilance commissions to investigate and prosecute.

2. Legal Framework: The Prevention of Corruption Act provides the basis for prosecution, backed by judicial oversight.

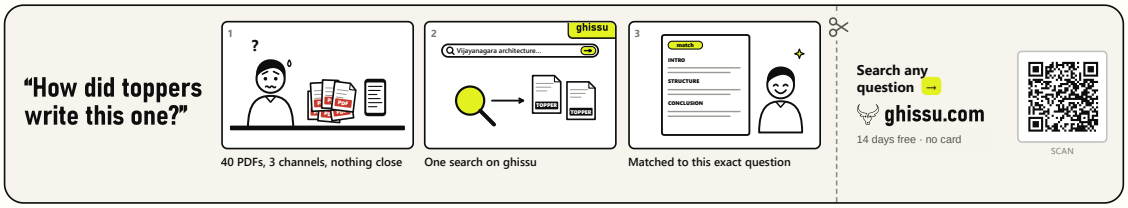
3. E-Governance: Andhra Pradesh's CFMS reduces human interface in public finance, though audits show gaps.

4. Capacity Building: Mission Karmayogi and the NCGG foster ethical competence.

5. Stable Tenure and Whistleblowers: Fixed tenures through civil services boards, the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 and fully functional Lokpal and Lokayuktas can shield honest officers.

Conclusion

Restoring integrity needs vigilance bodies with functional and financial autonomy, ethics-focused training on platforms like iGOT, and transparent, technology-driven administration.



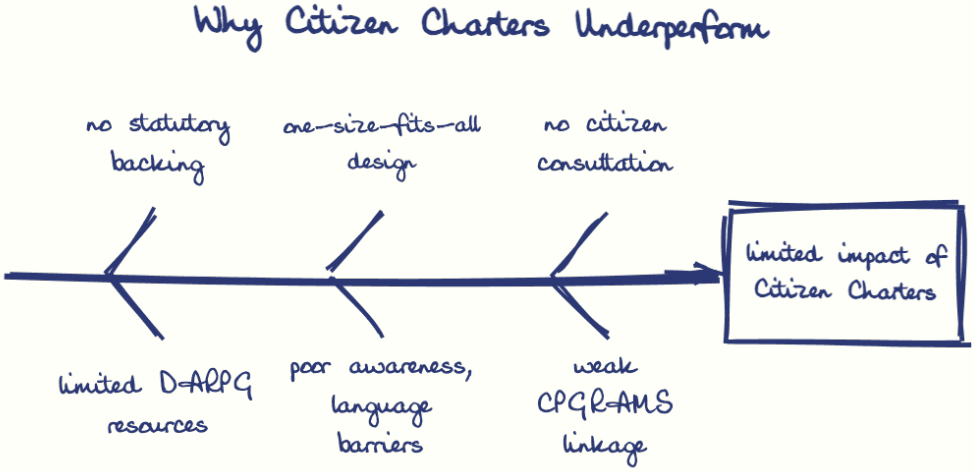
10(a) Discuss the Indian experience of Citizen Charter movement and suggest solutions to improve its impact in India.

10

Introduction

The Citizen Charter movement in India, initiated in 1997, aimed to enhance transparency, accountability and citizen-centric service delivery. Despite its promise as a tool of good governance, weak implementation has limited its impact on service quality and citizen empowerment. Its record shows why design matters as much as intent.

Indian Experience: Institutional Constraints



1. **No Statutory Backing:** After the Citizens Charter Bill, 2011 lapsed, compliance remained voluntary and inconsistent across ministries.
2. **Limited D-ARPG Resources:** D-ARPG coordinates Charters but lacks dedicated funds for

awareness and training.

3. Uniformity over Localisation: One-size-fits-all Charters ignore local conditions, as in Andhra Pradesh's varied agro-climatic zones.
4. Weak Staff Orientation: Service providers are often unaware of Charter commitments, weakening ownership.

Implementation Outcomes

1. Poor Awareness: Little publicity and language barriers exclude non-Hindi or English speakers and persons with disabilities.
2. No Citizen Consultation: Charters miss ground realities, as in Andhra Pradesh's Gram Panchayats whose priorities differ from generic standards.
3. Outdated Charters: Without periodic revision and systematic monitoring, Charters lose relevance.
4. Weak Redressal: Integration with CPGRAMS is poor.

Solutions to Improve Impact

1. Legal Framework: A statutory law like State Right to Public Services Acts, with clear timelines and penalties, to make compliance mandatory across departments.

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2. Localised Formulation: Consult citizens, civil society and experts so Charters match regional needs in rural and urban areas.

3. Capacity and Awareness: Dedicated budgets for staff training and awareness drives in regional languages, using digital platforms and community outreach.

4. Grievance Linkage: Link Charters firmly with CPGRAMS to improve responsiveness.

Conclusion

With legal backing, localised design and effective redressal, Citizen Charters can make service delivery a right, build trust between government and citizens and advance SDG (16.) This would truly reflect the ethos of Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas in public service delivery.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

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SCAN

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10(b) What are the different dimensions of governance? Briefly explain the administrative dimension of governance and its key components.

10

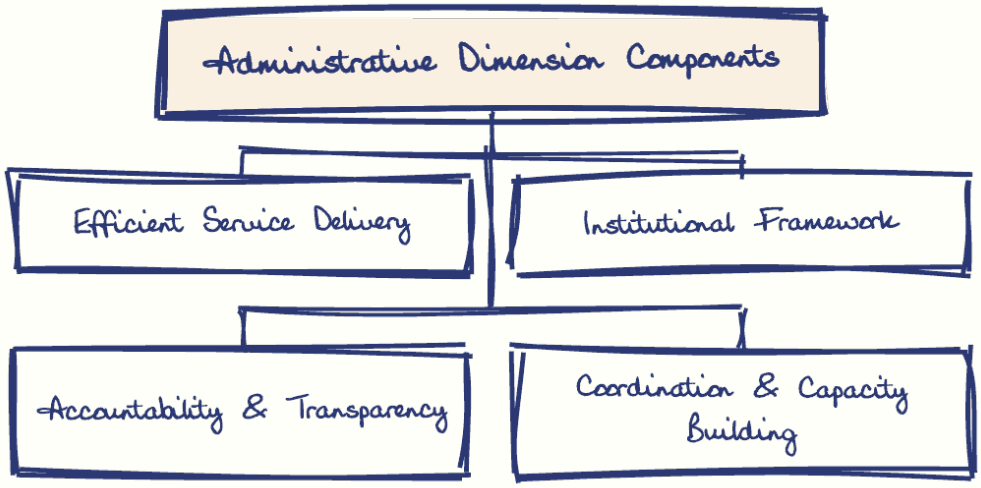
Introduction

Governance is the set of mechanisms, processes and institutions through which a society manages its political, economic and social affairs. The DARPG identifies five dimensions: political, legal and judicial, administrative, economic, and social and environmental. Grasping them is key to transparent and accountable governance.

Dimensions of Governance

1. Political: Covers free and fair elections, integrity of representatives, autonomy of bodies like the Election Commission and RBI, and decentralisation through the 73rd and 74th Amendments.
2. Legal and Judicial: Ensures rule of law, fundamental rights and access to justice, though delays and case backlogs erode citizen trust.
3. Economic: Creates a stable macroeconomic environment supporting agriculture and industry, investment and equitable distribution.
4. Social and Environmental: Focuses on social equity, welfare of vulnerable groups and ecological sustainability with civil society participation.

Administrative Dimension: Key Components



1. **Efficient Service Delivery:** Organising government machinery to deliver services transparently, cutting red tape and responding to citizens.
2. **Institutional Framework:** Civil services, departments and regulators that implement policy. Andhra Pradesh's e-Seva centres improved delivery and reduced corruption.
3. **Accountability and Transparency:** The Right to Information Act and social audits empower citizens; the Second ARC stressed Weberian principles of ethics and professionalism.
4. **Coordination and Capacity Building:** Coordination among administrative units, continuous training and reforms, and the use of technology and data-driven decisions raise efficiency.

Challenges

Bureaucratic inertia, legacy systems that slow welfare schemes, capacity constraints and corruption persist despite citizen charters and grievance redressal systems, which need stronger enforcement and public awareness.

Conclusion

A strong administrative dimension, backed by capacity building, e-governance and decentralisation, turns policy into effective and accountable governance. Empowering local bodies with resources and autonomy will carry these gains to the grassroots.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON VALUE ADDITIONS

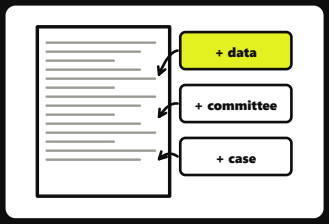
The authority ladder

An assertion with nothing behind it is an opinion, and opinions aren't marked. Anchor claims — highest rung first.

1. **Constitution** — Articles, Schedules, Amendments.
2. **Courts & commissions** — Supreme Court judgments; Sarkaria, Punchhi, ARC, Law Commission.
3. **Government data** — Economic Survey, NFHS, PLFS, NCRB, Census, PIB.
4. **International** — IPCC, UNDP, World Bank, FAO — then expert opinion, last.

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Every question comes with its value additions — the data, the report, the case — from standard and government sources, linked.



Add value to your next answer →

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SCAN

11(a) "Ethics in public service is an essential component of parliamentary democracy" — In this connection, discuss the pathway towards a 'Naitik Bharat'.

10

Introduction

Ethics in public service is the backbone of parliamentary democracy, keeping governance accountable, transparent and oriented to the common good. With corruption and political instability persisting, building a Naitik Bharat, an ethical India, is imperative to restore public trust and uphold constitutional values.

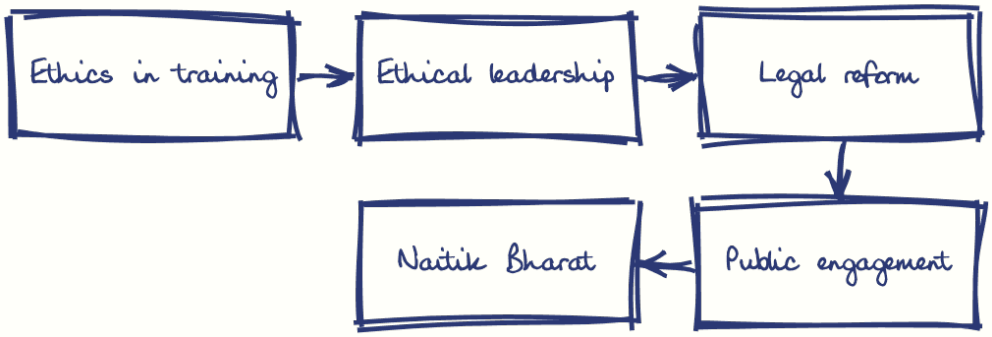
Institutional Foundations

1. **Constitutional Morality:** The Preamble and Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) enshrine justice, liberty, equality and fraternity as the compass for officials and legislators.
2. **Codes of Conduct:** The CCS (Conduct) Rules, disclosure of interests and the Lok Sabha Ethics Committee's scrutiny of MPs mandate integrity.
3. **Oversight Bodies:** The CVC, Lokpal and CAG detect and deter unethical practices.
4. **Capacity Building:** Mission Karmayogi embeds values-based training, including through Andhra Pradesh's state modules.

Challenges

1. Weak Accountability: Without a stable party system, coalition expediency often overrides principle and administrative neutrality.
2. Corruption and Nepotism: Bribery and cronyism in contracts and appointments erode meritocracy.
3. Complacency: Poor recognition and incentives push officials towards personal gain.
4. Opacity and Insensitivity: Excessive secrecy and lack of empathy produce unjust outcomes for the vulnerable.

Pathway towards Naitik Bharat



Pathway towards Naitik Bharat

1. Ethical Leadership: Leaders of integrity and moral courage inspire subordinates.
2. Legal Reform: A Public Services Bill with enforceable codes and performance indicators.
3. Public Engagement: RTI, social audits and

community participation.

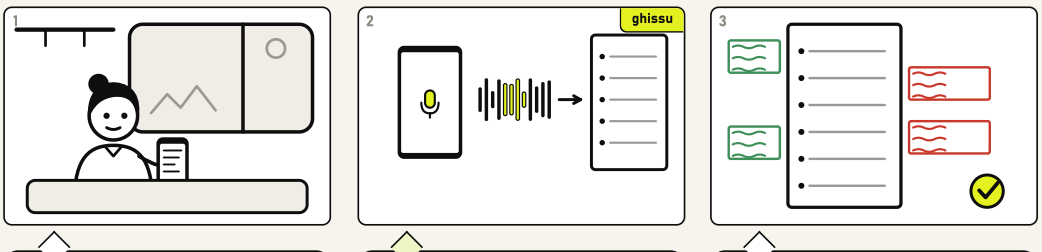
4. Ethics in Training: Values in LBSNAA and Andhra Pradesh state training institutes help future administrators internalise Naitik Bharat from the outset.

Conclusion

Ethics safeguards constitutional morality and public trust. Naitik Bharat needs stronger institutions, closed implementation gaps and an ethical culture nurtured through leadership and education. Then governance becomes transparent, accountable and citizen-centric, fulfilling the democratic promise of justice and equity for all.

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SCAN

11(b) Define 'Accountability'. Discuss the factors that have led to weakening of accountability in civil services. Suggest ways to improve the mechanisms for accountability in civil services.

10

Introduction

Accountability is a cornerstone of democratic governance, making public officials answerable to the citizens they serve. Rising citizen expectations have intensified the demand for transparency and responsibility, and stronger accountability is crucial to restore public trust and improve service delivery.

Defining Accountability

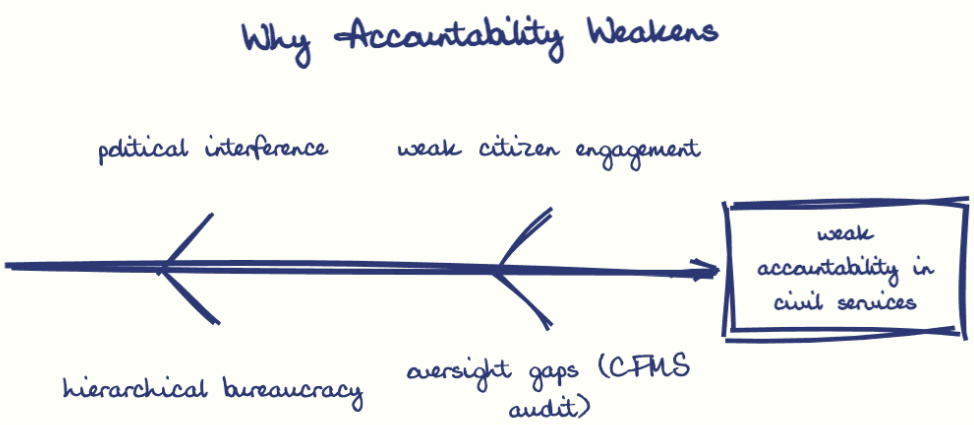
1. Obligation to Answer: Officials must explain and justify decisions to the public and oversight institutions.
2. Responsibility for Outcomes: They answer for results, not just duties performed.
3. Enforcement: Sanctions and corrective measures follow misconduct or inefficiency.
4. Citizen Focus: Accountability should run to citizens, not only to political executives.

Factors Weakening Accountability

1. Political Interference: Excess political control diverts officials from service, IAS officers as municipal

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commissioners can neutralise elected representatives, against the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

2. Hierarchical Bureaucracy: The top-down structure centralises power and limits transparency, so policies made without citizen input may not reflect public needs.

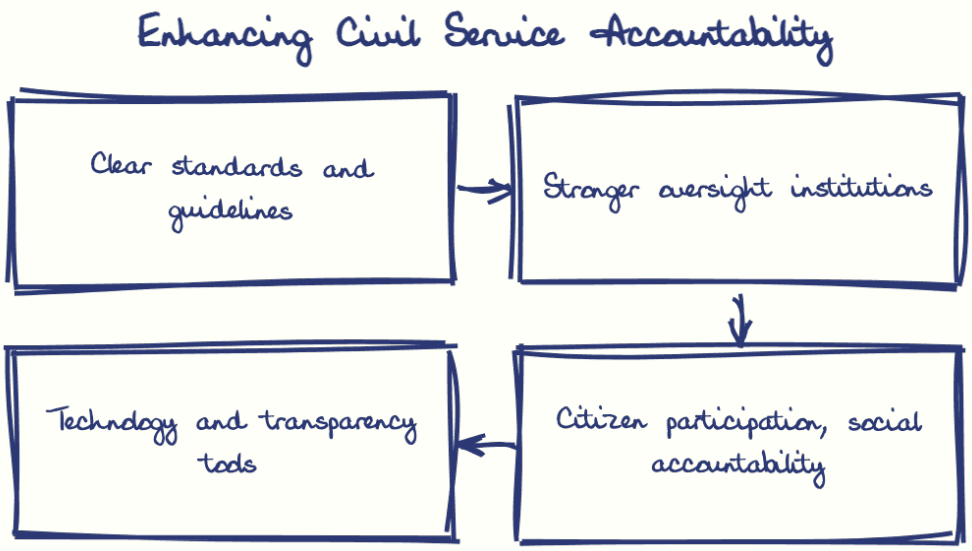
3. Weak Citizen Engagement: Without social accountability tools, citizens cannot access information or participate.

4. Oversight Gaps and Corruption: The Andhra Pradesh CFMS audit found Rs 968 crore in excess payments and delayed receipt notifications.

Improving Accountability Mechanisms

1. Clear Standards: Ethical and performance benchmarks aligned with constitutional morality.

2. Stronger Oversight: Autonomy and resources for



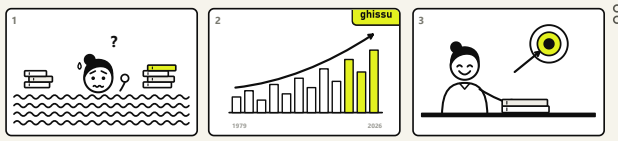
vigilance commissions, audit agencies and parliamentary committees.

3. Social Accountability: Citizen charters, RTI and community monitoring as in the Bhagidari scheme.
4. Technology: Digital platforms for real-time monitoring and quicker grievance redressal, fixing gaps like those in CFMS.

Conclusion

Accountability must move from hierarchical, politically influenced models to citizen-centric frameworks, built on transparency and ethical governance, so governance remains a trust discharged for the people.

You have a feeling. The examiner has a pattern.



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SCAN

12(a) Discuss the significance of values in the development of personality and socio-cultural systems. Add a brief note on the hierarchy of values in India.

10

Introduction

Values form the bedrock of individual character and collective identity, shaping how personalities evolve and how societies function. In a diverse and rapidly changing India, they are crucial for resilient personalities and harmonious socio-cultural systems. India's hierarchy of values blends universal ethics with culturally rooted priorities.

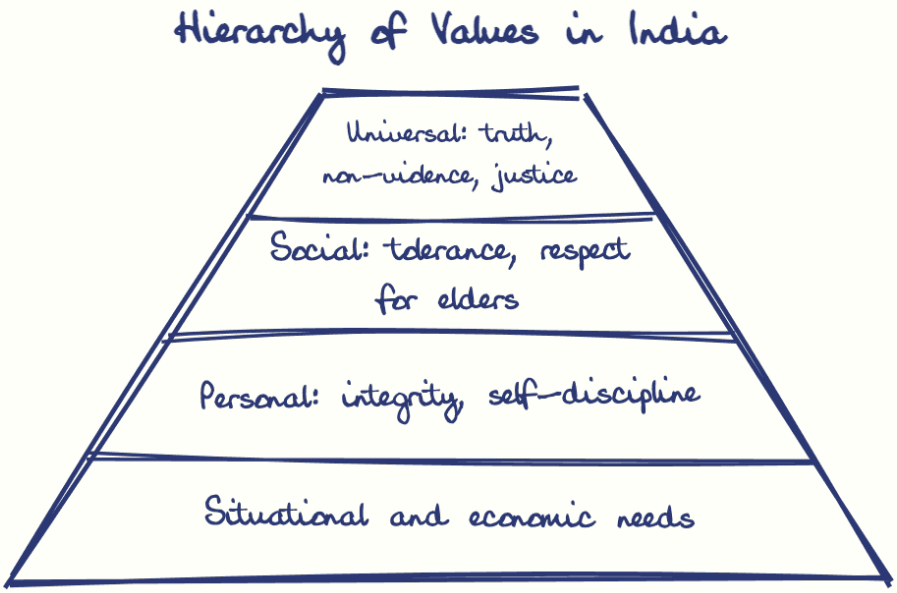
Significance in Personality and Socio-Cultural Systems

1. **Family and Education:** Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam saw father, mother and teacher as the key value-makers who pass on honesty, discipline and empathy.
2. **Socialisation:** Cultural norms create shared expectations; individuals internalise respect, duty and community welfare, which fosters social harmony.
3. **Constitutional Morality:** Ambedkar's ideals of justice, liberty and equality give a legal scaffold for ethical governance and social justice.
4. **Spiritual Heritage:** Gandhian trusteeship and Nishkama Karma offer a moral compass beyond self-interest.

Challenges

1. **Value Conflicts:** Collectivism and emerging individualism clash, as agrarian tradition and urban growth coexist in Andhra Pradesh.
2. **Short-Term Orientation:** Situational values chasing immediate gains undermine sustainable development.
3. **Value Pluralism:** Multiple value systems sometimes clash, so cultural specificity must be balanced with universal values to keep unity.
4. **Education Gaps:** Despite NEP 2020 stressing value-based education, weak teacher training and socio-economic disparities limit value inculcation.

Hierarchy of Values in India



1. **Universal Human Values:** Truth, non-violence, justice

and compassion sit at the apex.

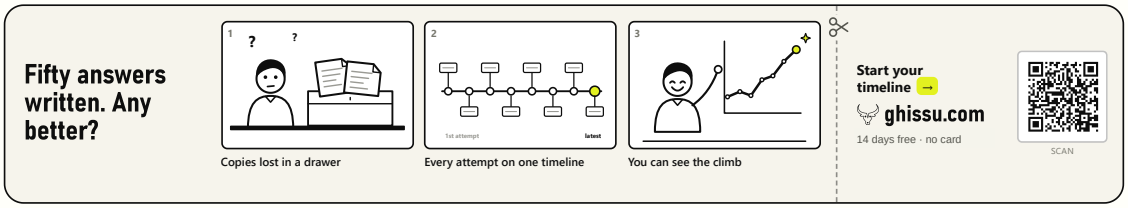
2. Social and Cultural Values: Respect for elders, community welfare and religious tolerance reflect a collectivist, pluralist ethos.

3. Personal Values: Integrity, self-discipline and perseverance build personality.

4. Situational and Economic Values: Fluid, context-bound needs and aspirations, ideally aligned with higher-order values for sustainable progress.

Conclusion

Values are the moral compass of individuals and society. India's layered hierarchy, from universal ethics to situational priorities, mirrors its complex social fabric. Upheld through education, institutions and cultural dialogue, values realise constitutional ideals and Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.



Write your own answer to 12(a) and get it evaluated →

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12(b) Vinoba Bhave's reform ideology had helped to nurture an ethical atmosphere in Indian public life. In this connection, evaluate the relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in modern times.

10

Introduction

Vinoba Bhave, a prominent disciple of Mahatma Gandhi, pioneered the Bhoodan Movement and spread the ideals of Sarvodaya and trusteeship. His reforms infused public life with non-violence, social justice and selfless service. Amid rapid socio-economic change, his ideology remains a useful guide for ethical governance.

Nurturing an Ethical Atmosphere in Public Life

1. **Sarvodaya and Trusteeship:** Sarvodaya sought the welfare of all, and trusteeship held wealth and land for society. Voluntary land donations under Bhoodan put collective good above greed and corruption.

2. **Moral Leadership:** Ahimsa and Satya taught that power is a trust, not a tool for enrichment, a value echoed in the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.

3. **Gram Swaraj:** Village self-governance promoted participatory democracy, later reflected in the 73rd Amendment.

4. Social Harmony: Tackling landlessness and inequality reduced exploitation and built cohesion.

Relevance in Modern Times

Bhave's Ideas Today

Bhave's idea	Modern echo
Sarvodaya, welfare of all	SDGs, Mission Antyodaya
Power as a trust	Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013
Gram Swaraj	73rd Amendment, Panchayati Raj
Selfless service	Mission Karmayogi
Bhoodan land gifts	Fair land management

1. Inclusive Development: Equitable resources and self-reliance align with the SDGs and Mission Antyodaya. Andhra Pradesh's push to strengthen Panchayati Raj echoes his vision.
2. Ethical Civil Service: His call for selfless service lives on in Mission Karmayogi, though it needs systemic support beyond individual morality.
3. Land and Social Justice: Bhoodan's direct impact has waned, but in Andhra Pradesh, with agrarian distress and land disputes, his ideas guide equitable resource management.

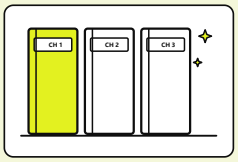
4. Modern Limits: Globalisation, technology, consumerism and materialism strain voluntary, trust-based models.

Way Forward

1. Empower Local Bodies: Capacity building and financial autonomy for panchayats in Andhra Pradesh to deepen grassroots democracy.
2. Values Training: Expand Mission Karmayogi's values-based training for civil servants.
3. Complementary Institutions: Pair his ideals with modern legal and institutional mechanisms for effective implementation, since goodwill alone cannot run a complex state.

Conclusion

Bhave's ideology nurtured an ethical atmosphere by linking power with service and wealth with trusteeship. It remains a moral compass for public life and, backed by modern legal and institutional mechanisms, can sustain ethical, inclusive governance today.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

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SCAN

13(a) Do attitudes influence behaviour? Discuss the polarization of political attitudes in India.

10

Introduction

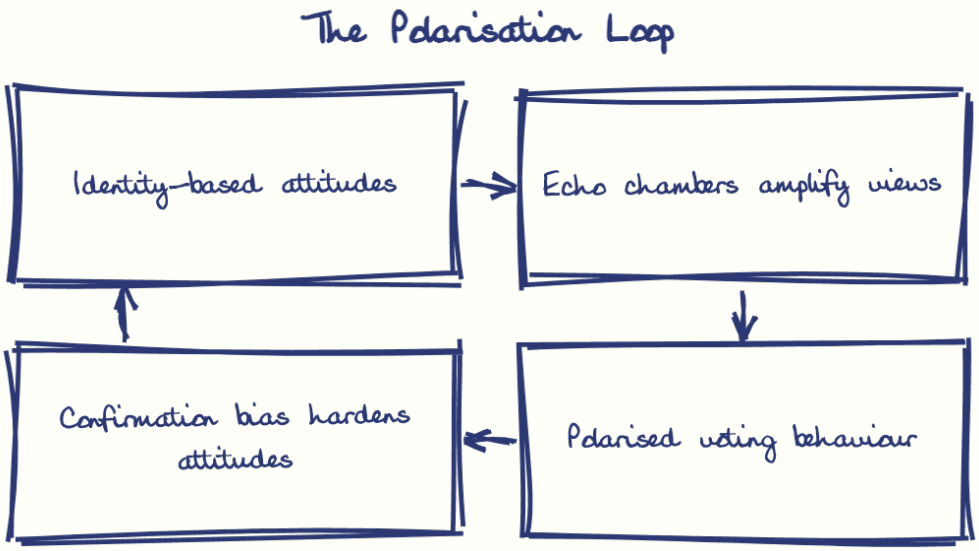
Political polarisation has become a defining feature of India's democracy, visible in elections and public discourse. With a 65.79% turnout in the 18th Lok Sabha elections (2024), political attitudes clearly shape electoral behaviour and social cohesion. Attitudes do influence behaviour, and understanding this is vital for civil servants maintaining democratic harmony.

How Attitudes Influence Behaviour

1. **Voting Choices:** Beliefs and values about parties, policies and leaders guide consistent support for ideologically aligned parties.
2. **Socialisation and Media:** Family, education and media shape attitudes that drive campaigning or protest; social media in the 2019 and 2024 elections mobilised voters by reinforcing nationalist sentiment.
3. **Cognitive and Emotional Drivers:** Habitual opinions and emotional appeals produce stable preferences or sudden shifts, such as widespread protests in Andhra Pradesh.

4. Regional Factors: The rise of the Telugu Desam Party reflects linguistic and regional aspirations.

Polarisation of Political Attitudes in India



1. Caste and Religion: As Rajni Kothari noted, parties mobilise voters along these lines, including in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Social Media: Echo chambers and targeted messaging sharpen ideological divides.
3. Regionalism: Sub-national identity parties empower regional voices but can fragment national consensus.
4. Electoral Evidence: Muslim vote consolidation in Bihar and caste coalitions in Andhra Pradesh show entrenched polarisation.
5. Feedback Loop: Polarised behaviour reinforces

attitudes through confirmation bias, eroding trust in institutions.

Way Forward

1. Civic Education: Programmes in Andhra Pradesh schools that build critical thinking and respect for diverse views.
2. Social Media Regulation: Monitor platforms to curb misinformation and hate speech.
3. Dialogue Across Divides: Community forums that bring diverse groups together to reduce stereotypes.

Conclusion

Attitudes profoundly shape behaviour and lie at the heart of polarisation, yet they can evolve through education, exposure to diversity and inclusive governance, as reconciliation efforts in Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation show. Nurturing pluralism and dialogue upholds constitutional morality.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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SCAN

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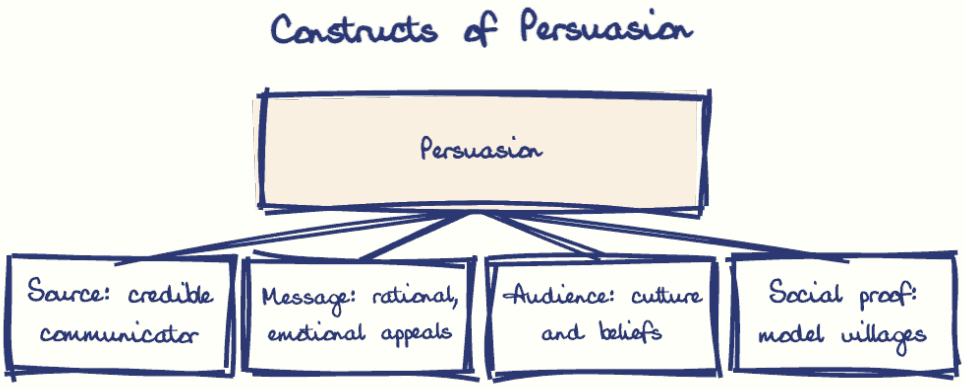
13(b) Define Persuasion and its constructs. Can the power of persuasion be used by civil servants in order to realize the ends and objectives of a 'New India'? Substantiate.

10

Introduction

Persuasion is a vital governance tool in a rapidly evolving democracy like India, where changing public attitudes is key to development. For a New India, civil servants must use it ethically to align citizen aspirations with policy goals. Wielded transparently, it bridges the gap between government initiatives and public acceptance.

Persuasion and Its Constructs



Persuasion is intentional, transparent communication aimed at changing attitudes or behaviour without coercion.

1. Source Credibility: Expertise and trust in the communicator; Dr. Randeep Guleria's authoritative

communication shaped COVID-19 compliance.

2. Message: Clarity, relevance and a mix of rational and emotional appeals.
3. Target Characteristics: Culture and existing beliefs; Andhra Pradesh customised financial literacy programmes for rural and urban audiences.
4. Social Proof: Showing peers adopting a behaviour, as in model villages under the Aadarsh Gram Yojana in Andhra Pradesh.

Can Civil Servants Use It for New India?

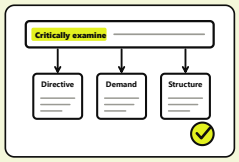
1. Mass Mobilisation: Swachh Bharat Abhiyan achieved mass participation through persuasive messaging.
2. Overcoming Prejudice: Rational and emotional appeals by local leaders helped resolve caste-based conflicts over school midday meals in Rayalaseema.
3. Ethical Safeguards: The Model Code of Conduct and IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics) Rules, 2021 keep persuasion free of misinformation.
4. Limits: Digital spread risks misinformation, and persuasion must respect autonomy, relying on informed consent rather than manipulation.

Way Forward

1. Communication Training: Train officers in ethical persuasion, emotional intelligence and audience analysis.
2. Institutional Oversight: Monitor persuasive communication on digital platforms for transparency.
3. Localised Strategies: Context-specific health and education campaigns drawing on Andhra Pradesh's examples.
4. Participatory Governance: Make persuasion a two-way dialogue through citizen involvement in policy design and feedback.

Conclusion

Grounded in constitutional morality, persuasion is a powerful tool for civil servants to realise a New India. Used with integrity and respect for autonomy, it fosters informed participation and social transformation while advancing justice, equality and dignity.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

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SCAN

14(a) Does popular democracy breed distrust in the public towards their representatives ? Discuss the scope of ethical leadership in democracy and politics.

10

Introduction

Popular democracy empowers citizens through electoral participation, yet it often coincides with growing distrust of elected representatives. This stems from corruption, governance failures and unfulfilled promises that strain the social contract. In India and Andhra Pradesh, where participation remains robust, the real culprits are institutional and ethical deficits rather than democracy itself.

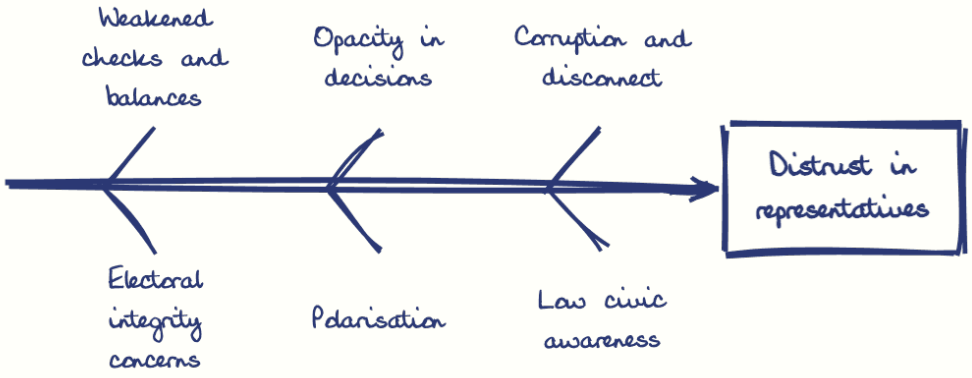
Why Popular Democracy Faces Distrust

1. Weakened Checks and Balances: Politicisation of the Election Commission, judiciary and legislature has eroded their effectiveness, fostering scepticism.
2. Electoral Integrity: Despite high voter turnout, criminalisation and money power undermine the legitimacy of representatives.
3. Opacity: Delays and opacity in governance limit the value of RTI and audit bodies.
4. Polarisation: Post-bifurcation politics in Andhra Pradesh turned adversaries into enemies, reducing collaborative governance.

5. Corruption and Disconnect: Irregularities in welfare schemes and neglect of rural and drought-affected regions alienate citizens.

6. Law Awareness: Weak political education lets populist leaders exploit public sentiment.

Roots of public distrust



Scope of Ethical Leadership in Democracy and Politics

1. Setting Moral Standards: Leaders like E. Sreedharan and reform-minded officials show how principle restores faith.

2. Accountability and Transparency: Openness, supported by the 2nd ARC's emphasis on citizen participation, bridges the trust gap.

3. Equity and Public Interest: Gandhi's trusteeship keeps policy focused on the vulnerable and on social justice.

Practice 14(a) on Ghissu →
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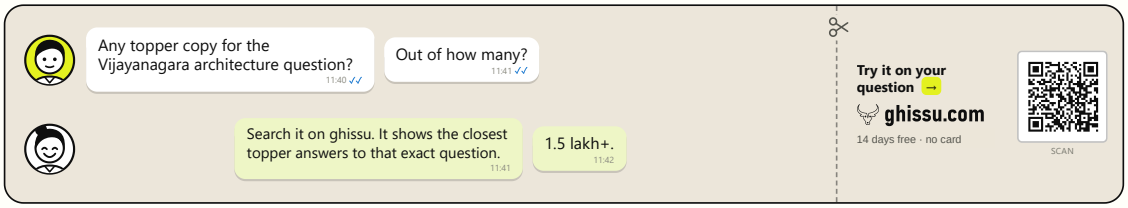
4. Institution Building: Embedding probity in institutions creates trust that outlasts individual leaders.

Way Forward

1. Institutional Autonomy: Strengthen the State Election Commission and anti-corruption bodies.
2. Ethics Training: Leadership programmes for politicians and civil servants.
3. Citizen Engagement: Expand Gram Sabhas and digital feedback tools to deepen oversight.
4. Transparency Measures: Robust disclosure so that citizens can judge their representatives on facts, not perception.

Conclusion

Popular democracy does not inherently breed distrust; institutional weakness and ethical failure do. Ethical leadership, backed by strong institutions and engaged citizens, can restore faith in democratic governance and uphold constitutional morality. Civil servants, too, must model this integrity in daily administration.



14(b) What is meant by 'International Ethics' ? Explain the significance of ethics in international dispute resolutions and environmental cooperation among nations.

10

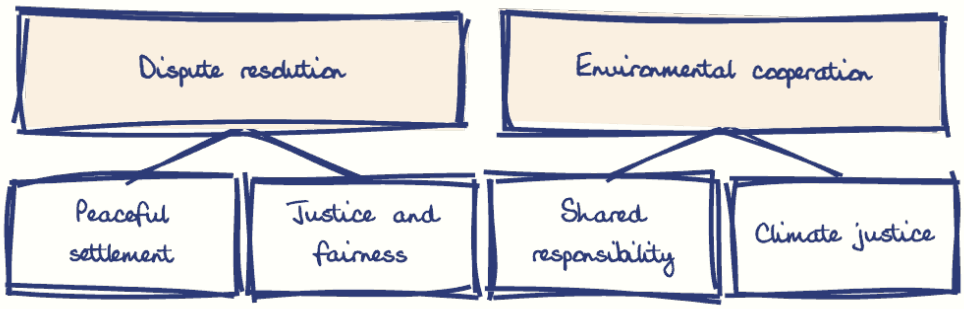
Introduction

In an era of global interdependence, international ethics has gained unprecedented importance. COVID-19, climate change and geopolitical conflicts show that state behaviour needs ethical principles beyond mere power politics, to foster cooperation, peace and sustainable development.

Meaning of International Ethics

1. **Principles for State Conduct:** Moral principles and duties governing relations among nations, stressing fairness, justice, respect for sovereignty and human rights.
2. **Beyond Power Politics:** Unlike realism, it values cooperation and international law, as in the UN Charter and Geneva Conventions.
3. **Normative Framework:** It guides states to act responsibly, treating peace and justice as moral imperatives, as in Kant's Perpetual Peace.
4. **Indian Practice:** India's vaccine diplomacy during COVID-19 and humanitarian aid to neighbours reflect ethical leadership.

Significance of international ethics



Significance in Dispute Resolution

1. **Peaceful Settlement:** Dialogue, negotiation and international law replace coercion or war, reducing human suffering and fostering long-term peace.
2. **Justice and Fairness:** Equitable outcomes respect all parties, as the Krishna and Godavari water tribunals involving Andhra Pradesh balanced regional interests.
3. **Trust and Cooperation:** Ethical conduct builds mutual trust and future stability in tense contexts like the South China Sea or border tensions.
4. **Institutional Accountability:** It lends legitimacy to the International Court of Justice and UN Security Council.

Significance in Environmental Cooperation

1. **Shared Responsibility:** Stewardship and intergenerational equity, as in the Stockholm

Declaration and Paris Agreement.

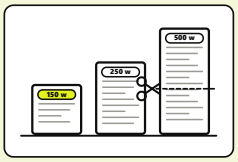
2. Global Commons: Climate change and biodiversity loss cross borders, as along Andhra Pradesh's 974 km coastline.

3. Climate Justice: Developed and developing nations must share burdens fairly, recognising historical emissions and capacities, for inclusive and effective action.

4. Preventing Harm: Protection for vulnerable communities, such as drought-hit Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

International ethics is indispensable for a just and peaceful global order. Ethical training for diplomats, stronger multilateral institutions and inclusive climate diplomacy will help nations resolve disputes amicably and act together on the environment. Civil society engagement can build a wider culture of global responsibility.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

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15(a) Define Substantive Law and Procedural Law. Discuss the interrelationship and differences between Substantive Law and Procedural Law.

10

Introduction

The distinction and link between substantive law and procedural law are fundamental to the legal system. One defines rights and duties, the other provides the mechanism to enforce them, so that justice reflects fairness, accountability and the rule of law.

Substantive Law

1. Core Legal Norms: It establishes rights, duties and liabilities, such as the IPC defining crimes and punishments.
2. Constitutional Foundation: It rests on fundamental rights and must conform to the Basic Structure Doctrine.
3. Social Order: By prescribing lawful and unlawful conduct, it guides citizen behaviour and state action.
4. Example: The Andhra Pradesh Land Grabbing (Prohibition) Act defines offences of illegal land acquisition, protecting property rights.

Procedural Law

1. **Enforcement Mechanism:** It sets the processes, such as the CrPC governing investigation, trial and adjudication.
2. **Fairness:** It embodies natural justice, recognised in Maneka Gandhi vs Union of India (1978) under Article 21.
3. **Efficiency:** It regulates procedure, evidence and appeals, vital amid pendency in Andhra Pradesh courts.
4. **Example:** The Andhra Pradesh Lok Adalat system expedites dispute resolution and widens access to justice.

Interrelationship

1. **Mutual Dependence:** Without procedure, substantive rights cannot be enforced.
2. **Complementary Functions:** Procedure makes rights practically accessible, not merely theoretical.
3. **Checks and Balances:** Due process prevents misuse, as in Special Leave Petitions under Article 136.

Differences

1. **Nature:** What the law is versus how it is

Substantive Law vs Procedural Law

Substantive Law	Procedural Law
Defines rights and duties	Defines methods to enforce rights
Focuses on content of law	Focuses on process of law
Examples: IPC, Contract Act	Examples: CrPC, Civil Procedure Code
Concerned with justice outcomes	Concerned with fairness in procedure

applied.

2. Scope: One shapes the substance of legal relationships, the other governs the steps to resolve disputes arising from them.
3. Consequences: Violation brings penalties or remedies versus dismissal or retrial.
4. Reform: Procedure is reformed more readily, as with e-courts in Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

Substantive and procedural law are distinct yet inseparable: substance gives justice its content, procedure gives it fairness and reach.

Correct, but average?
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15(b) Are Direct Taxes transferable or non-transferable? Explain the recent Direct Tax Reforms undertaken in India.

10

Introduction

Direct taxes are central to India's fiscal architecture, contributing over 55% of total tax revenue and embodying progressive taxation based on ability to pay. As the economy and middle class grow, recent reforms aim to simplify laws, enhance compliance and broaden the base.

Nature of Direct Taxes: Non-Transferable

1. **Burden on the Payer:** Income and corporation tax are levied on income or profits and cannot be shifted, reflecting ability to pay.
2. **Contrast with Indirect Taxes:** GST or excise can be passed to consumers through prices, direct taxes cannot.
3. **Redistributive Role:** Higher income groups bear more, reducing inequality and funding public services.
4. **Compliance Matters:** A CAG audit found ₹1,806 crore revenue impact from compliance gaps in Andhra Pradesh (2021-22).

Direct vs indirect taxes

Direct taxes	Indirect taxes
Income tax, corporation tax	GST, excise
Burden cannot be shifted	Passed on through prices
Higher incomes bear more	Burden falls on consumers

Recent Direct Tax Reforms

1. Decriminalisation and Digitisation: The Jan Vishwas Act (2023) decriminalises minor offences, and online filing with Centralized Processing Centres improves efficiency.
2. DTC Proposals: Though the DTC bill of 2010–11 was not fully enacted, GAAR and rate rationalisation entered the Income Tax Act, (1961) aiming at simpler laws with fewer exemptions.
3. Rate Adjustments: Slab changes ease the middle-class burden, and tighter NRI norms widen the base.
4. Anti-Evasion: TDS on perquisites and scrutiny of high-value transactions plug leakages.
5. Trust-Based Governance: Transparent Taxation,

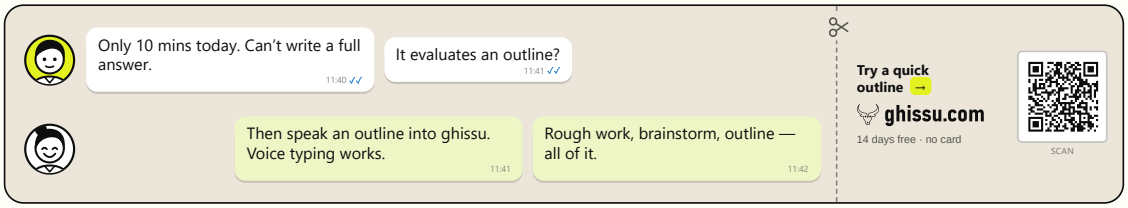
Honouring the Honest promotes voluntary compliance and reduces the adversarial nature of tax administration.

Way Forward

1. Taxpayer Education: Awareness campaigns and user-friendly digital platforms for new taxpayers.
2. Tech Enforcement: Data analytics and AI tools to detect evasion and underreporting.
3. Inclusive Base: Bring untaxed sectors in without burdening the vulnerable.
4. Cooperative Federalism: Align reforms with state fiscal needs, including post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

Direct taxes are non-transferable, which makes them a fair tool of redistribution. Recent reforms make the system simpler and more trust-based; consistent enforcement and Centre-State coordination will make it buoyant and equitable, raising revenue without shifting burdens unfairly.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2020

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) How was the Constituent Assembly formed that framed the Indian constitution? Critically evaluate the Constitution of India as framed by the Constituent Assembly.

10

Introduction

The Constituent Assembly, formed in 1946, framed the Constitution that marked India's transition from colonial rule to sovereign democracy. Its formation under the Cabinet Mission Plan and the Indian Independence Act, 1947 reflected compromises between the British, the Congress and other political groups.

Formation of the Constituent Assembly

1. Indirect election: Members were elected by provincial legislative assemblies, themselves chosen on a limited franchise under the Government of India Act, 1935, which excluded over 70% of adults.
2. Communal representation: Seats were allocated among Muslims, Sikhs and the General category through proportional representation by single transferable vote.
3. Princely states: Their members were nominated by the rulers, ensuring pan-Indian representation.
4. Consensus-driven deliberation: Nearly three years of debate accommodated socialists, moderates and minorities, enriching the social justice and federal provisions.

Critical Evaluation of the Constitution

1. **Restricted franchise:** Large rural and marginalised sections were excluded, raising questions about democratic legitimacy.
2. **Congress dominance:** With over 80% of seats after partition, one-party dominance arguably limited political pluralism.
3. **British influence:** Though declared sovereign, the Assembly worked within British legal frameworks, a transitional rather than fully autonomous process.
4. **Legalistic nature:** The dominance of lawyers produced a voluminous, detailed Constitution, seen as hard for ordinary citizens to follow.

Way Forward

1. **Deeper participation:** Strengthen direct citizen participation and representation of marginalised communities, fulfilling the original vision of inclusive governance.
2. **Federal balance:** Reinforce cooperative federalism, addressing aspirations like Andhra Pradesh's post-bifurcation demands and water disputes.
3. **Simpler provisions:** Periodic review can make the Constitution more accessible and adaptable, reducing legal complexity for citizens.

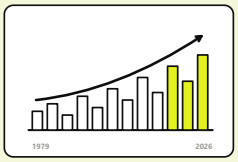
4. Consensus-building: Amendments should follow the Assembly's tradition of dialogue among diverse stakeholders.

Constituent Assembly: formation and critique

How it was formed	Criticism
Indirect election by provincial assemblies	Limited franchise excluded many
Communal seats, single transferable vote	Congress held 80% seats
Princely states' nominees	Shaped by British frameworks
Consensus-driven debate	Lengthy, legalistic text

Conclusion

The Assembly's formation was a landmark democratic exercise shaped by historical constraints. Though its indirect election and Congress dominance limited its representativeness, the Assembly's deliberative spirit produced a Constitution balancing unity with diversity and sovereignty with federalism, a robust foundation for India's democracy.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

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SCAN

1(b) Define Judicial Review with special reference to the classification given by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri. Describe the importance and scope of Judicial Review.

10

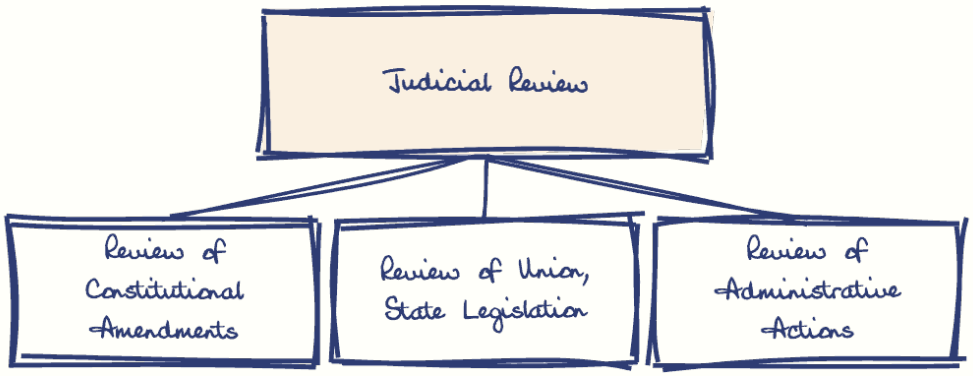
Introduction

Judicial review ensures that all laws and executive actions conform to the Constitution's supreme authority. Conferred on the Supreme Court and High Courts and affirmed as part of the basic structure, it safeguards constitutional morality and the rule of law.

Definition and Constitutional Basis

1. Meaning: It is the judiciary's power to examine legislative enactments and executive orders of the Union and States; those found ultra vires are declared null and void.
2. Foundation: Though the term is not used, Articles ~~13, 32, 131, 136, 226~~ and 227 empower courts to invalidate unconstitutional laws and actions.
3. Basic structure: Kesavananda Bharati (1973) held it cannot be abrogated even by amendment.

Justice Quadri's Classification



1. Constitutional amendments: Amendments are tested against the basic structure, as when the 99th Amendment and NJAC Act, 2014, were struck down.
2. Legislation: Laws of Parliament and State Legislatures, including subordinate legislation, are checked for conformity, as in Golaknath (1967) and Minerva Mills (1980).
3. Administrative action: Decisions of Union and State authorities are reviewed for legality, protecting citizens from arbitrary action.

Importance

1. Constitutional supremacy: All laws and actions must conform to the Constitution.
2. Rights protection: It guards fundamental rights

against infringement.

3. Federal balance: It settles disputes between the Centre and states like ~~Andhra Pradesh~~.

Scope

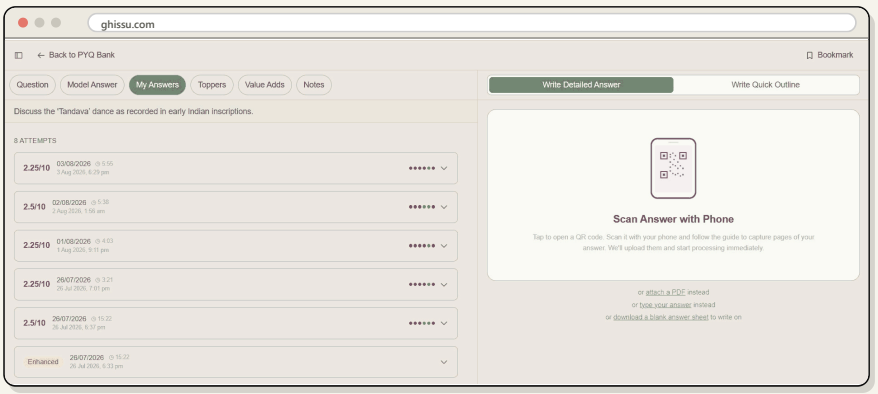
It extends to all laws and amendments, subject to the basic structure, and to executive orders, subordinate legislation and policies, applied where they violate rights or exceed authority.

Conclusion

Judicial review, in its three forms, keeps every organ within constitutional limits and upholds the rule of law.

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1 Eight attempts at one question, first to latest.

2 Every one scored — the curve is visible.

3 Enhanced versions kept beside your own.

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SCAN

2(a) Why did we adopt federalism with a strong central government? Explain the important provisions that create a strong central government.

10

Introduction

India's adoption of federalism with a strong Centre was a deliberate choice. The trauma of partition, vast diversity of languages, religions and cultures and the urgent need for economic development led the framers to balance regional autonomy with national unity.

Why a Strong Centre Was Adopted

1. Preventing disintegration: After the trauma of partition, the framers prioritised national unity and integrity above all.
2. Diversity: Many languages, religions and cultures needed a strong Centre to hold them in one framework.
3. Development: Urgent economic development needed coordinated planning and central resource allocation.

Provisions Creating a Strong Centre

1. Union of States: As Dr. Ambedkar explained, the federation is not an agreement of sovereign states but a permanent Union of States.

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2. Distribution of powers: The Seventh Schedule puts defence, foreign affairs and currency in the Union List.

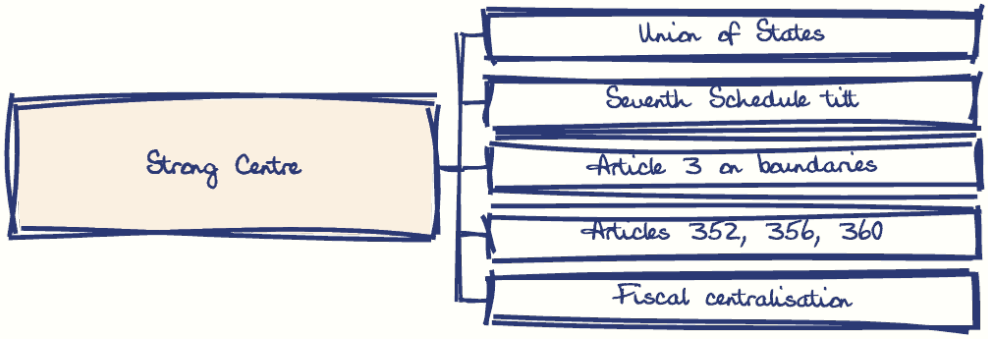
3. Territorial control: Under Article 3, Parliament can create states and alter boundaries or names, after consulting the state legislature.

4. Emergency provisions: Articles 352, 356 and 360 let the Centre override state autonomy temporarily.

5. Fiscal centralisation: The Centre controls major revenues, distributed via the Finance Commission.

6. Planning: The Planning Commission, now NITI Aayog, centralised development priorities, affecting projects like Polavaram.

Provisions for a strong Centre



Outcomes and Safeguards

1. Unity with tension: The strong Centre preserved

national integrity after partition, but Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status after bifurcation and the Krishna and Godavari water disputes show friction.

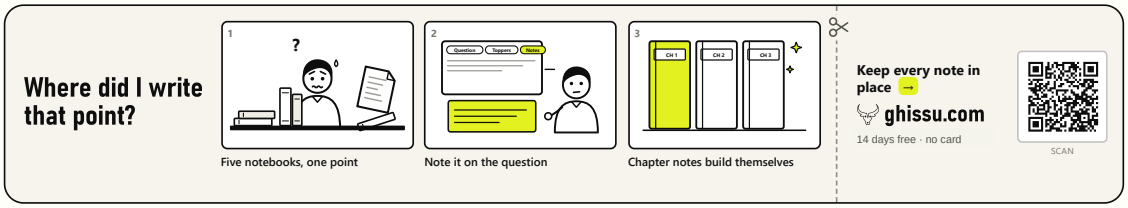
2. Judicial check: S.R. Bommai curbed misuse of Article 356.

3. Cooperation: The Inter-State Council and GST Council balance central authority with state interests.

4. Decentralisation: Panchayati Raj under Articles 243 to 243ZG brings governance closer to people.

Conclusion

Federalism with a strong Centre was a pragmatic response to India's diversity and history, ensuring unity while allowing regional autonomy. Stronger cooperative federalism and fiscal autonomy can keep it balanced.



2(b) Define Privileges of state legislature and classify it into two broad categories.

10

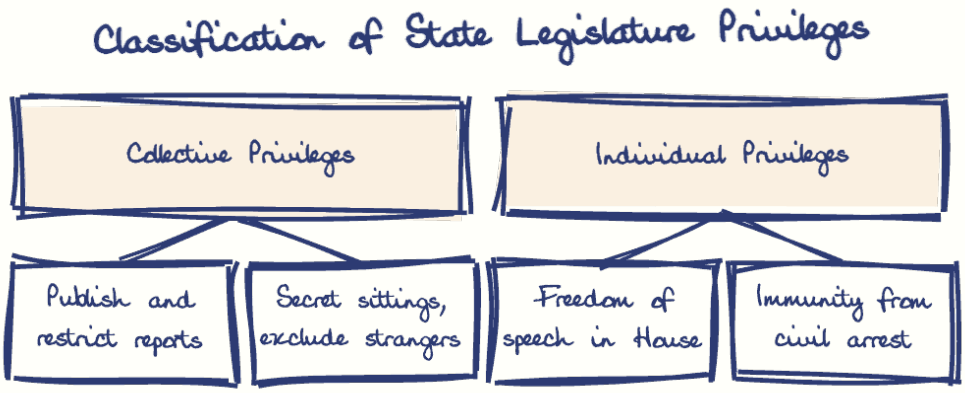
Introduction

Privileges of the state legislature safeguard the independence and effective functioning of legislative bodies in India's federal structure. They ensure that the Houses and their members can perform their duties without undue interference, preserving legislative dignity.

Defining Privileges

1. Special rights and immunities: Privileges are special rights, immunities and exemptions granted to the Houses, their committees and members.
2. Protection from obstruction: They protect members in discharging their duties and maintain the authority and honour of the legislature.
3. Wider coverage: They extend to persons entitled to participate in proceedings, such as the Advocate-General and state ministers, but not to the Governor.
4. Constitutional backing: Articles 194 and 212 provide their legal foundation.

Two Broad Categories



1. Collective privileges: Enjoyed by each House as a whole: publishing its debates and barring unauthorised publication, excluding outsiders and holding secret sittings, framing rules of procedure, and punishing members or outsiders for contempt. The Andhra Pradesh Assembly uses these powers to maintain order.
2. Individual privileges: Enjoyed by members: freedom of speech in the House, immunity from arrest in civil cases during the session and (40) days before and after, exemption from jury service, and protection from proceedings for acts done in duty.
3. Balance with accountability: Privileges are subject to judicial review where they violate fundamental rights.

Way Forward

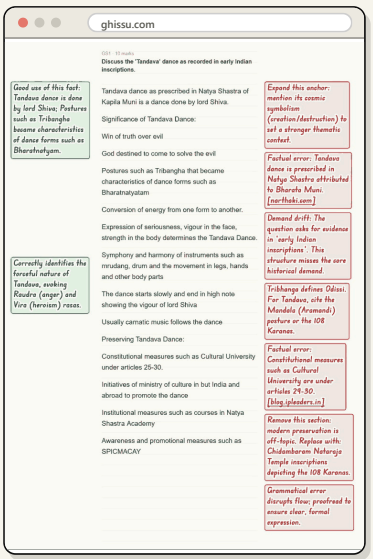
1. Codification: Codifying privileges, as the Second Administrative Reforms Commission recommended, would prevent arbitrary use.
2. Ethics and transparency: Stronger ethics committees and reasoned orders in privilege cases would build public trust.

Conclusion

Privileges are indispensable for the dignity and autonomy of state legislatures; exercised responsibly and balanced with judicial oversight, they uphold democratic governance.

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Nine days waiting for feedback on one answer?



1. Green notes: what you did well — keep doing it.
2. Red notes: the missing dimension, the better data, the sharper intro.
3. Handwritten or typed — scanned with your phone, marked in minutes.

Upload an answer →

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SCAN

3(a) Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendment of the Indian Constitution.

10

Introduction

The 73rd and 74th Amendments, enacted in 1992, strengthened grassroots democracy by constitutionally empowering rural and urban local bodies. They institutionalised Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies as self-governing entities, decentralising governance.

Main Features of the 73rd Amendment

1. **Constitutional Status:** It added Part IX, declaring Panchayats institutions of self-government.
2. **Three-Tier System:** Village, intermediate and district Panchayats, with two tiers in states below two million population.
3. **Direct Elections and Reservation:** All seats filled by direct election, with seats reserved for SCs, STs and women (one-third of seats and chairperson posts).
4. **Fixed Term:** A five-year term, with elections within six months of dissolution.
5. **State Commissions:** A State Election Commission conducts polls and a State Finance Commission

recommends resource sharing.

6. Functions: Planning for development and social justice on (29) subjects in the Eleventh Schedule.

Main Features of the 74th Amendment

1. Constitutional Status: It inserted Part IX-A for Municipal Corporations, Municipal Councils and Nagar Panchayats.
2. Classification: Bodies vary by population size and urban character, suiting diverse urban settings.
3. Elections and Reservation: Direct elections with reservation for SCs, STs and one-third for women.
4. Fixed Term: A five-year term with timely elections after dissolution.
5. State Commissions: State Election and Finance Commissions for urban bodies.
6. Functions: (18) subjects in the Twelfth Schedule, and a Metropolitan Planning Committee for metropolitan areas.

Comparison of the Two

1. Scope: The 73rd covers rural Panchayats in a three-tier structure under Part IX; the 74th covers varied urban bodies under Part IX-A.

2. Subjects: (29) subjects in the Eleventh Schedule against (18) in the Twelfth.

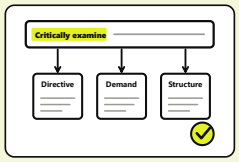
3. Common Features: Both share one-third reservation for women, SC/ST reservation, fixed terms and state commissions.

73rd and 74th Amendments compared

73rd Amendment	74th Amendment
Part IX	Part IX-A
Three-tier Panchayats	Three types of urban bodies
Eleventh Schedule, 29 subjects	Twelfth Schedule, 18 subjects
One-third seats for women	One-third seats for women
SEC and SFC	SEC, SFC, Metropolitan Planning Committee

Conclusion

Together the amendments made local government a constitutional reality for villages and towns, deepening participatory democracy. Challenges like urban solid waste management in Andhra Pradesh show that these bodies need continued strengthening.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

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SCAN

3(b) Explain the role of Governor in states by focusing on its powers and functions.

10

Introduction

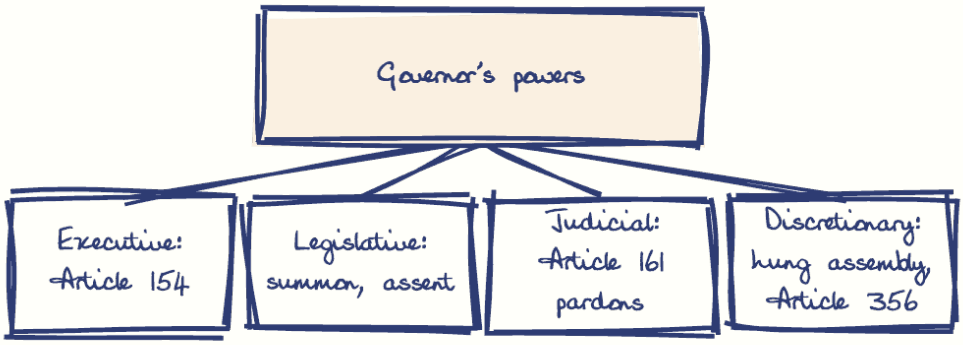
The Governor's role has drawn renewed attention due to political instability and Centre–State tensions, especially in Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation and in Tamil Nadu and Kerala. Under Articles 153 to 162, the Governor is the constitutional head of the state and a link between the Centre and the state.

Powers of the Governor

1. **Executive Powers:** Under Article 154 all executive action is taken in the Governor's name; the Governor appoints the Chief Minister and ministers and makes rules of business.
2. **Legislative Powers:** The Governor summons, prorogues and dissolves the legislature, addresses it, and must recommend money bills before introduction.
3. **Judicial Powers:** Article 161 allows pardons, reprieves and remissions; the Governor is consulted on High Court judges and appoints district judges with the High Court.
4. **Discretionary Powers:** Appointing a Chief Minister in a hung assembly, recommending

President's Rule under Article 356 and reserving bills for the President, all requiring impartiality as stressed in the S.R. Bommai case (1994).

Powers of the Governor



Functions of the Governor

1. Constitutional Head: Keeps the government within constitutional limits, as during Andhra Pradesh's post-bifurcation transition.
2. Link Between Centre and State: Conveys concerns both ways, aiding cooperative federalism.
3. Guardian of Constitutional Order: Can recommend President's Rule in a breakdown.
4. Legislative Facilitator: Gives assent to bills, though delays like Tamil Nadu (2023) show tension.

Concerns over Discretion

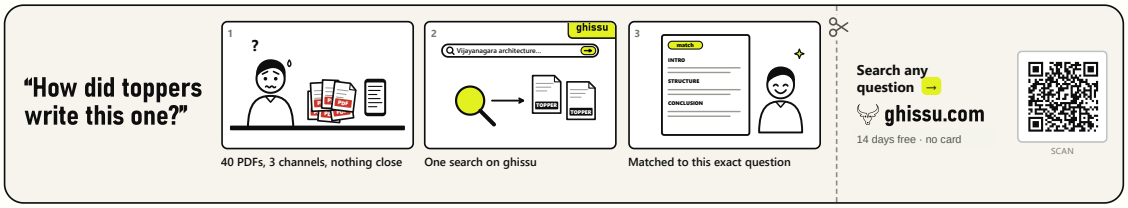
1. **Federal Balance:** Discretion checks misuse of power by state governments, but perceived bias causes friction, as in Kerala.
2. **Judicial Oversight:** Nabam Rebia (2016) and S.R. Bommai limited arbitrary use of discretion.
3. **Impact on Governance:** Over 50 instances of Governors returning bills between 2011 and 2021 show delays.

Way Forward

1. **Fixed Tenure:** A fixed term with clear removal procedures, similar to the President, would enhance independence and reduce political interference.

Conclusion

The Governor is a vital constitutional link in state governance. Impartial use of discretion and a secure tenure will keep the office a guardian of federal balance.



4(a) Differentiate between the powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of the following parameters: functions and control over election. Explain, with reasons, the powers that are exercised only by the Lok Sabha.

10

Introduction

The Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha are designed to balance popular representation with federal interests. Both share many legislative and electoral functions, but the Lok Sabha holds greater authority in financial matters and executive control, reflecting its direct electoral mandate.

Differences in Functions

Functions of Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha

Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Exclusive control over Money Bills	Cannot introduce or reject Money Bills
Removes government by no-confidence	Indirect control via questions, resolutions
Equal role in constitutional amendments	Equal role in constitutional amendments

1. Legislative authority: Both Houses pass ordinary and constitutional amendment bills, but only the Lok Sabha introduces Money Bills. The Rajya Sabha can only suggest

amendments, which the Lok Sabha may accept or reject (Article 109).

2. Control over executive: The Council of Ministers is responsible only to the Lok Sabha (Article 75(3)); the Rajya Sabha can question and debate but cannot dismiss the government.
3. Deadlocks: On non-money bills a joint sitting is held, where the Lok Sabha's larger numbers generally prevail.
4. Special powers of Rajya Sabha: It alone can authorise Parliament to legislate on State List matters (Article 249) and create All-India Services (Article 312), showing its federal character.

Differences in Control over Elections

1. Electoral mandate: Lok Sabha members are directly elected by the people; Rajya Sabha members are elected by elected members of State Legislative Assemblies.
2. President and Vice-President: Both Houses elect them equally, but only the Rajya Sabha can initiate the removal of the Vice-President.
3. Indirect influence: Party strength in State

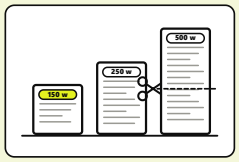
Assemblies, such as in Andhra Pradesh, shapes Rajya Sabha membership; the Rajya Sabha has no role in Lok Sabha elections, which the Election Commission conducts.

Powers Exercised Only by the Lok Sabha, with Reasons

1. Money Bills: Taxation and public expenditure need the consent of directly elected representatives, ensuring democratic accountability.
2. No-confidence motion: Collective responsibility to the Lok Sabha keeps the executive answerable to the people, upholding majority rule.
3. Disapproval of National Emergency: Only the Lok Sabha can pass this resolution, being the House closest to the people.

Conclusion

The Lok Sabha's primacy reflects popular sovereignty, while the Rajya Sabha safeguards federal balance.



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SCAN

4(b) Explain any five salient features of the Indian Constitution. 10

Introduction

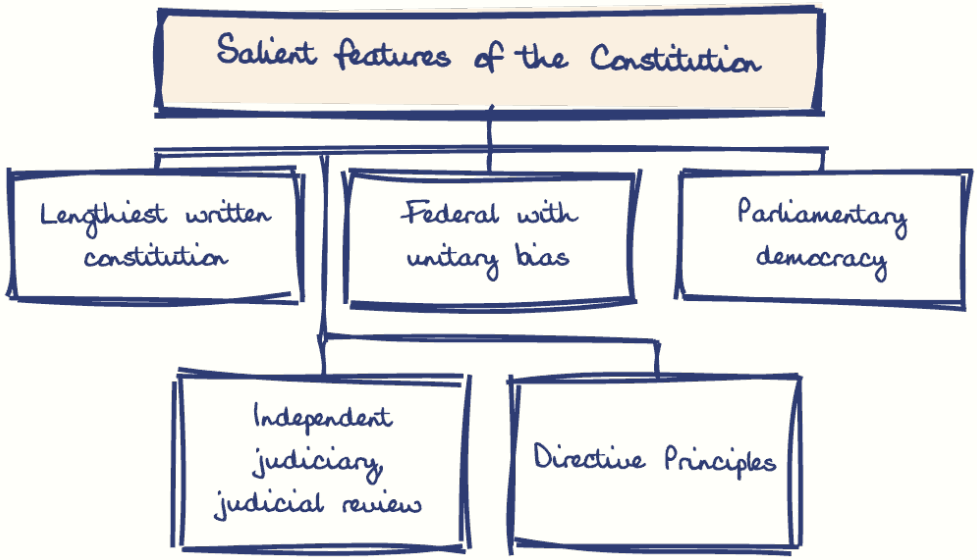
The Indian Constitution, adopted in 1950, is the supreme legal document underlying India's democratic governance. It blends global constitutional ideas with India's social and historical context, and has evolved through amendments and landmark judgments over seventy-five years.

Five Salient Features

1. Lengthiest written constitution: It originally had 395 articles and 12 schedules and now has about 470 articles, reflecting the complexity and diversity of India's governance needs.
2. Federal structure with unitary bias: Powers are divided between the Centre and states, but provisions like Article 356 and the All India Services give a strong centralising tilt to preserve unity.
3. Parliamentary democracy: Inspired by the British model, it has an elected President as head of state and a Council of Ministers responsible to the Lok Sabha.
4. Independent judiciary and judicial review: The Supreme Court, under Articles 32 and 136,

protects Fundamental Rights and constitutional supremacy through judicial review.

5. Directive Principles of State Policy: Borrowed from the Irish Constitution, these non-justiciable guidelines direct the state towards social and economic justice and a welfare state.



Features in Practice

1. Rigidity and flexibility: Article 368 permits amendment, while Kesavananda Bharati protects the basic structure.

2. Rights-based culture: Justiciable rights in Part III let citizens challenge state action, though socio-economic gaps remain.

3. Centre-state relations: The Centre's overriding powers cause tensions, as in Andhra Pradesh's

post-bifurcation demand for Special Category Status.

4. Judicial activism: Puttuswamy shows the Constitution driving progressive social change.

Way Forward

1. Cooperative federalism: Strengthen the Inter-State Council and respect state autonomy.
2. Judicial reform: Technology-driven case management to reduce pendency.
3. Directive Principles: Better implementation of socio-economic rights to bridge the gap with Fundamental Rights.
4. Parliament: Better committees and transparency to raise accountability.

Conclusion

The Constitution is a resilient framework balancing diversity, democracy and development. Its ability to adapt while protecting core values makes it a living document of transformative constitutionalism.

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5(a) Define judicial activism with special reference to PIL and SAL. Judicial activism has had manifold impact on the political system. Justify the statement adding suitable arguments.

10

Introduction

Since the 1970s, judicial activism has defined India's constitutional democracy, as courts took a proactive role in protecting rights and ensuring accountability. Linked to Public Interest Litigation (PIL) and suo motu action (SAL), it has widened access to justice and deeply affected the political system.

Definition with Reference to PIL and SAL

PIL and SAL

PIL	SAL
Filed by public-spirited person	Court acts suo motu
Relaxes locus standi	No petition needed
Pioneered by Justice Bhagwati	Targets executive inaction

1. Proactive role: Courts interpret laws and the Constitution assertively to protect rights and influence governance, unlike judicial restraint.

2. PIL: Pioneered by Justice P.N. Bhagwati in the 1980s, it lets public-spirited persons approach courts for groups who cannot; Bandhua Mukti Morcha extended Article (21) to humane conditions for bonded labourers.

3. SAL: Courts initiate proceedings suo motu, without a petition, in cases of public interest, executive inaction or gross injustice.

4. Link with review: Activism extends judicial review; Maneka Gandhi broadened personal liberty under Article (21) of the Constitution.

Manifold Impact on the Political System

1. Democratic accountability: The ADR case mandated disclosure of candidates' criminal records and assets, improving electoral transparency.

2. Rights and social justice: PILs and suo motu actions protected vulnerable groups, enforced socio-economic rights and closed polluting industries, reinforcing sustainable development.

3. Blurred separation of powers: Overreach into executive and legislative functions has caused tensions, as in water disputes involving Andhra Pradesh.

4. Judicial overburden: The surge in PILs and suo motu cases adds to backlogs, including in the

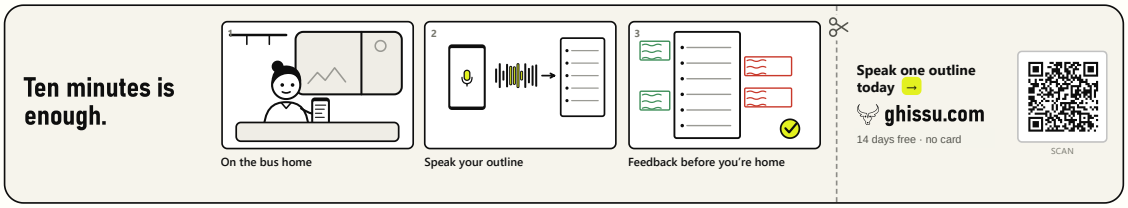
Andhra Pradesh High Court, delaying justice.

Arguments Justifying the Statement

1. Filling governance voids: The Vishaka guidelines on workplace harassment later shaped national law.
2. Transformative constitutionalism: Reading the Constitution as a living document advances social change.
3. Voice for the marginalised: PIL lets disadvantaged communities seek justice, making democracy participatory beyond elections, vital for states like Andhra Pradesh with diverse socio-economic challenges.

Conclusion

Through PIL and SAL, judicial activism has reshaped accountability, rights and institutional balance, proving its manifold impact, though restraint is needed to avoid overreach.



5(b) Describe the salient features of the Rural and Urban Local Governance under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Act.

10

Introduction

The 73rd and 74th Amendments of (1992) transformed Indian governance by constitutionally empowering rural and urban local bodies. They decentralised power, enhanced grassroots participation and made local self-governance a constitutional mandate, vital amid rapid urbanisation and rural development challenges.

Rural Local Governance under the 73rd Amendment

1. **Three-Tier System:** Gram Panchayats at village, Panchayat Samitis at intermediate and Zilla Parishads at district level.
2. **Status and Elections:** Article 243B mandates Panchayats with elections every five years, ending state discretion.
3. **Reservation:** Not less than one-third of seats for women, plus SC and ST reservation.
4. **Functions:** (29) subjects in the Eleventh Schedule, such as agriculture, health and sanitation.
5. **Finance and Planning:** State Finance Commissions share resources; District Planning Committees consolidate plans.

6. Andhra Pradesh: After bifurcation the state strengthened Panchayati Raj to improve rural infrastructure and welfare.

Urban Local Governance under the 74th Amendment

1. Three Types of Bodies: Article 243Q provides Nagar Panchayats, Municipal Councils and Municipal Corporations by urban size.
2. Status and Elections: Five-yearly elections supervised by State Election Commissions.
3. Functions and Finance: 18 functions in the Twelfth Schedule, including urban planning, land use and water supply, with devolved taxes and grants.
4. Reservation: At least one-third of seats for women, with SC and ST provisions.
5. Participation and Planning: Ward Committees in municipalities above 300,000 population; District and Metropolitan Planning Committees coordinate plans.

Way Forward

1. Financial Autonomy: Implement State Finance Commission recommendations and raise own revenues.
2. Capacity Building: Institutionalise training for elected representatives and officials to improve service

Rural and urban local bodies

Rural (73rd)	Urban (74th)
Gram Panchayat, Samiti, Zilla Parishad	Nagar Panchayat, Council, Corporation
Article 243B	Article 243Q
Eleventh Schedule, 29 subjects	Twelfth Schedule, 18 functions
Gram Sabhas	Ward Committees
District Planning Committees	Metropolitan Planning Committees

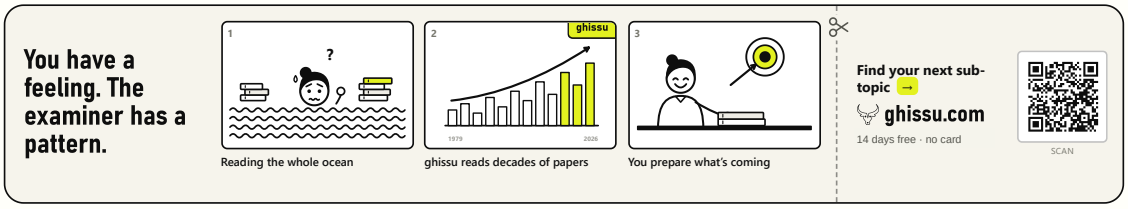
delivery.

3. Citizen Participation: Make Ward Committees and Gram Sabhas effective platforms for decision-making.

4. Integrated Planning: Strengthen planning committees to bridge rural-urban divides.

Conclusion

The amendments built a constitutional framework for local democracy, but inadequate devolution persists, as Andhra Pradesh's audit of solid waste gaps across (123) ULBs shows; stronger finances and capacity will make it work.



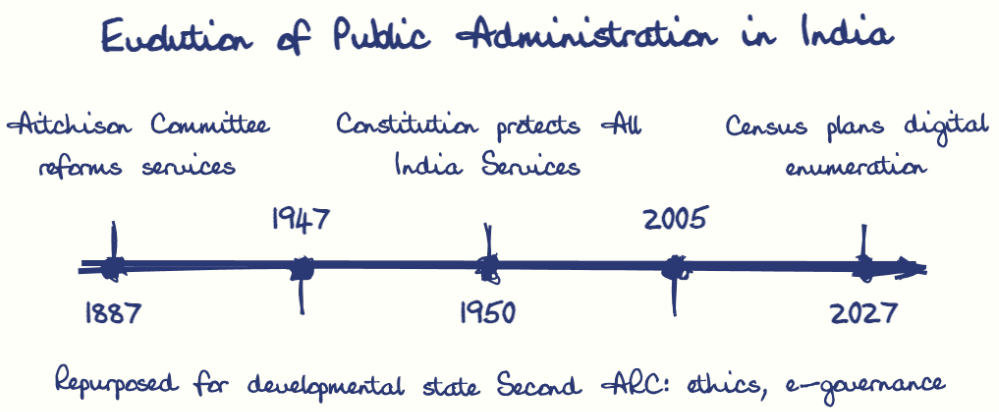
6(a) Define public administration and explain its evolution in India.

10

Introduction

Public administration is the backbone of governance, responsible for implementing policies and delivering public services efficiently. In India its evolution mirrors the transition from colonial rule to a democratic welfare state.

Evolution of Public Administration in India



1. **Colonial Legacy:** British administration, typified by the Indian Civil Service, was a rigid hierarchy for law and order and economic exploitation, stressing control over citizen-centric governance.

2. **Post-Independence Transformation:** After (1947) the inherited framework was repurposed for a developmental state, adding flexibility and decentralization while retaining Weberian hierarchy and legal immunity under Article (311).

3. Constitutional Embedding: The (1950) Constitution protected the All India Services for stability, while federalism required Centre–State coordination through Article (355) and the Seventh Schedule.

4. Reform Committees: The Aitchison Committee (1887) and the Second Administrative Reforms Commission (2005) shaped reforms on ethics, citizen-centricity and e-governance.

Changing Role and Challenges

1. Regulator to Facilitator: Citizen charters and performance pledges reflect a shift towards customer orientation.

2. Bureaucratic Rigidity: Procedural delays persist; Andhra Pradesh audits revealed excess payments and delayed transactions.

3. Globalization: New actors blur public–private boundaries and demand more transparent, accountable and participatory governance.

4. Digital Governance: Digital service platforms and Census 2027's digital enumeration mark progress, though analogue-era processes remain.

Way Forward

1. Capacity Building: Train adaptive, ethical bureaucrats, drawing on the Second ARC's emphasis

on professionalization and integrity.

2. Decentralization: Empower local governments and administrative units, especially in Andhra Pradesh, to improve responsiveness and reduce bottlenecks in service delivery.

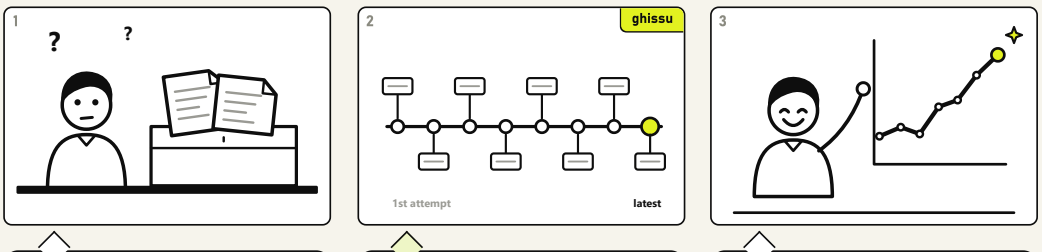
3. Accountability: Strengthen RTI, social audits and grievance redressal to build public trust.

Conclusion

Public administration in India has evolved from colonial control to an adaptive system central to development. With decentralization and fuller use of technology it can realize " minimum government, maximum governance ".

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6(b) Differentiate between the administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashashtra and the Mughal administration.

10

Introduction

Kautilya's Arthashastra, composed around the 4th century BCE, is the earliest comprehensive treatise on statecraft and reflects the Mauryan Empire's centralized governance. The Mughal administration of the 16th to 18th centuries evolved a complex imperial bureaucracy blending Persianate traditions with indigenous practices.

Administrative Ideas in the Arthashastra

1. **Saptanga Rajya:** The state had seven limbs: swami, amatya, janapada, durga, kosha, danda and mitra, forming a tightly integrated centralized monarchy.
2. **Hierarchical, Ethical Bureaucracy:** Clearly defined roles and a rigorous code of conduct ensured discipline and integrity.
3. **Surveillance:** Spies monitored officials and detected corruption, an early but authoritarian form of oversight.
4. **Welfare and Regulation:** Through arthaniti, administration was tied to people's welfare, trade regulation and public order.

Mughal Administrative Structure

1. **Mansabdari System:** Ranks or mansabs fused military service with civil duties to control a vast, diverse empire.
2. **Provincial Governance:** Subahs were run by subahdars with considerable autonomy, aided by revenue, justice and military officials.
3. **Revenue and Justice:** Land surveys and the zabt system ensured revenue, while a dual judiciary combined Sharia with customary law.
4. **Pluralism:** Akbar's religious tolerance brought diverse elites into administration.

Arthashastra vs Mughal Administration

Kautilya's Arthashastra	Mughal Administration
Saptanga centralized monarchy	Mansabdari military–civil ranks
Hierarchy with ethical codes	Autonomous provincial subahdars
Spies for surveillance	Land surveys, zabt system
Economic welfare, regulation	Pluralism, legal dualism

Key Differences

1. **Centralization vs Decentralization:** Kautilya stressed

the king's direct control, the Mughals gave subahdars autonomy suited to a larger empire.

2. Ethics vs Institutions: Kautilya relied on ethical codes and spies, the Mughals on revenue audits and judicial processes.

3. Economic Focus: Kautilya's administration aimed at welfare and regulated trade, whereas Mughal administration centred on efficient land revenue.

4. Shared Feature: Both integrated military and civil power, through danda and the mansabdari system.

Conclusion

Kautilya offered centralized welfare statecraft, the Mughals a plural, revenue-driven bureaucracy. Together they shaped the evolution of Indian administrative thought.

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Scan to practice

7(a) Define 'development' as explained by Prof. Amartya Sen. Explain the characteristics of the new development thinking, and also mention the four areas where the government has to play a crucial role.

10

Introduction

Development has evolved beyond economic growth to encompass human well-being and freedom. In the late 20th century Prof. Amartya Sen redefined it as the expansion of human freedoms rather than income alone, a view vital for India and Andhra Pradesh, where disparities persist.

Sen's Definition of Development

1. **Development as Freedom:** Sen defines development as the removal of unfreedoms that restrict people's choices; freedom is both the means and the end.
2. **Capabilities Approach:** Development enhances people's real freedoms to lead lives they value, with health, education and social participation as key functionings.
3. **Role of Institutions:** Legal systems, markets and democratic processes enable people to exercise agency.

Characteristics of New Development Thinking

1. **Multidimensionality:** It integrates economic, social, political and environmental dimensions, since growth

Old and New Development Thinking

Old thinking	New thinking (Sen)
Income and growth alone	Expansion of freedoms
Aggregate indicators	Human rights and well-being
Top-down models	Bottom-up participation
Growth as sole goal	Multidimensional, sustainable progress

alone does not ensure quality of life.

2. Participatory and Rights-Based: Bottom-up participation and accountability replace top-down models, as in Andhra Pradesh's strengthening of Panchayati Raj institutions.

3. Sustainability and Equity: Progress must not compromise future generations and must reduce regional disparities, as in drought-prone Rayalaseema.

4. Human-Centric Focus: Attention shifts from aggregate indicators to human rights and well-being.

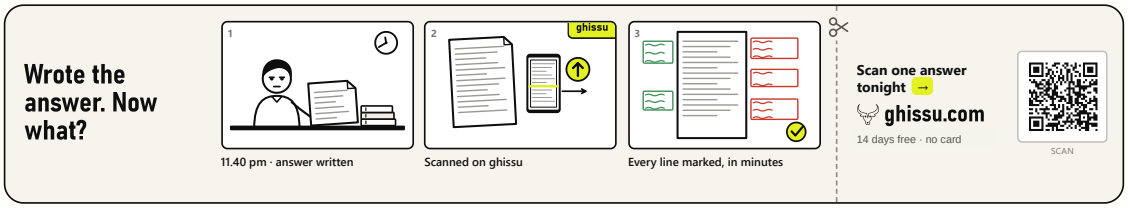
5. Implementation Hurdles: Unequal resources, governance deficits and social exclusion demand capacity and political will.

Four Areas of Crucial Government Role

1. **Social Justice and Equity:** Affirmative and welfare policies reduce inequality, as in Andhra Pradesh's welfare DBT system.
2. **Building Institutions:** Effective institutions safeguard rights and deliver health and education services.
3. **Economic Opportunities:** The state must enable skills, jobs and market access, leveraging Visakhapatnam's port-led corridor.
4. **Sustainable Development:** Policy must balance growth with conservation, as in water management in the Krishna and Godavari basins through Polavaram.

Conclusion

Sen's paradigm reorients governance towards expanding freedoms and capabilities, making development holistic and inclusive. A state focused on justice, institutions, opportunity and sustainability paves the way for equitable growth, advancing the SDGs and "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas".



7(b) Describe the role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy.

10

Introduction

NGOs and civil services are vital pillars of democracy, supporting transparency, accountability and participatory governance. In Andhra Pradesh, where decentralization and the DBT welfare template are prominent, their interplay shapes policy delivery and social empowerment.

Role of Civil Services in Democracy

Civil Services and NGOs in Democracy

Civil services	NGOs
Part XIV, Articles 308–323	Article 19(1)(c) association
Continuity and neutrality	Local innovation (Gooj, Barefoot College)
Adapt schemes like MGNREGA	Social audits, Panchayati Raj
Rule of law, service delivery	Watchdog and advocacy
Political interference, transfers	FCRA limits, transparency gaps

1. **Constitutional Foundation:** Part XIV (Articles 308–323) mandates civil services, ensuring administrative continuity and neutrality. Articles 309–311 secure accountability.
2. **Merit-Based Expertise:** The IAS, IPS and state

services form a trained bureaucracy; the NCGG trained (958) civil servants in 2024–25.

3. Bridging Policy and People: Officers adapt national schemes like MGNREGA to local needs, as in drought-prone Rayalaseema.

4. Guardians of Constitutional Values: They uphold the rule of law and equitable service delivery, building institutional trust.

Role of NGOs in Democracy

1. Freedom of Association: Article 19(1)(c) and laws like the Societies Registration Act, (1860) enable NGOs as democratic agents.

2. Local Innovation: Gooj's community-driven rural development and Barefoot College's training of women solar engineers show grassroots expertise.

3. Participation: NGOs involve citizens in social audits and support Panchayati Raj; Aid India led health outreach in Andhra Pradesh during COVID-19.

4. Watchdog and Advocacy: They expose corruption and environmental violations, influencing reforms like a stronger PCPNDT Act.

Challenges

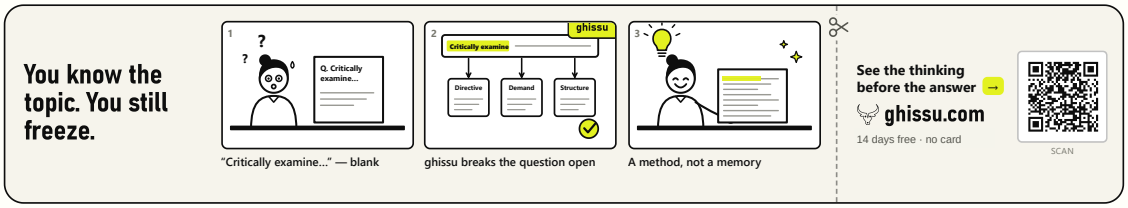
1. Civil Services: Political interference and arbitrary transfers undermine efficiency.
2. NGOs: Transparency deficits, misuse of funds and stringent FCRA amendments limit their capacity.
3. Representativeness: Many NGOs are led by technical experts rather than elected representatives, raising doubts about internal democracy.

Way Forward

1. Transparency: Publish NGO finances and civil service performance metrics on digital platforms.
2. Collaboration: Build district-level partnerships through NITI Aayog's NGO-DARPAN portal.
3. Balanced Regulation: Calibrate FCRA to protect national interests without stifling NGO outreach.

Conclusion

NGOs and civil services are complementary pillars of democracy, ensuring effective governance, citizen participation and social justice. Their synergy can realize participatory democracy and advance SDG (16.)



8(a) Give the reason for the UN to partner with the civil society. Explain the importance of civil societies. Under which Acts are the NGOs in India legally registered?

10

Introduction

The United Nations increasingly partners with civil society to enhance the reach and effectiveness of its development and humanitarian goals. Civil society organisations act as vital intermediaries between governments and communities, especially where state capacity is limited.

Reasons for the UN to Partner with Civil Society

1. Grassroots Reach: CSOs reach communities where grassroots engagement is essential and states are weak.
2. Shared Values: Their work for inclusive development, social justice and sustainable progress aligns with the UN's mandate of global cooperation and human rights.

Importance of Civil Society

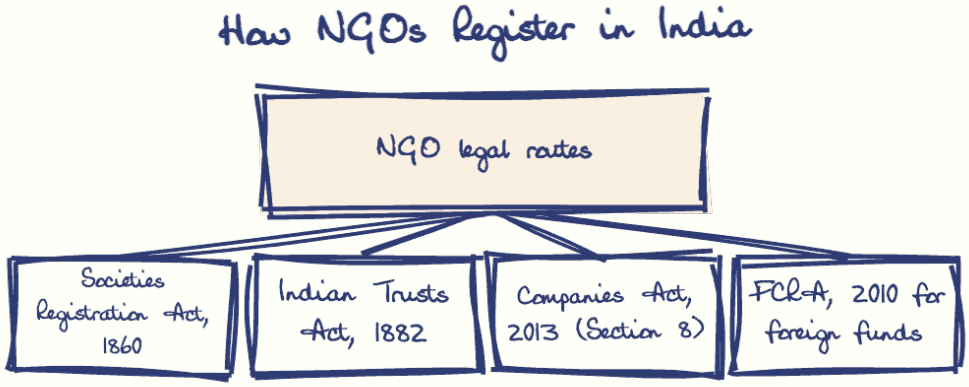
1. Bridging Governance Gaps: They reach marginalised populations missed by state programmes, as local NGOs do in Andhra Pradesh's rural development.
2. Social Inclusion: They empower women, Scheduled

Castes and Scheduled Tribes, fostering participatory democracy and supporting the SDGs.

3. Transparency and Accountability: By monitoring schemes and advocating rights, they hold institutions accountable and raise public trust.

4. Innovation and Disaster Response: They pioneer local solutions and supplemented state efforts in post-cyclone rehabilitation in eastern India.

Legal Registration of NGOs in India



1. Constitutional Basis: Article 19(1)(c) guarantees the right to form associations, and Article 43 encourages cooperative societies.

2. Societies Registration Act, 1860: Most NGOs register as societies, such as SEWA, active in 18 states including Andhra Pradesh.

3. Indian Trusts Act, 1882: Private trusts register under it, while public trusts follow state laws.

4. Companies Act, 2013 (Section 8): Charitable companies like the Akshaya Patra Foundation, which serves school meals under PM POSHAN, use this route.

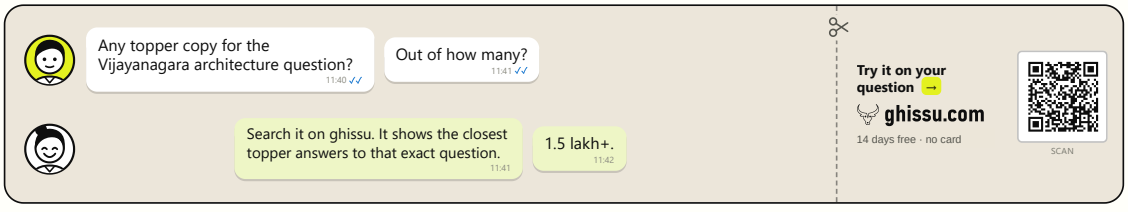
5. FCRA, 2010: It regulates foreign funding with mandatory disclosures.

Challenges

Strict FCRA norms have cancelled thousands of registrations, while weak financial transparency and urban–rural disparities limit NGOs. Expanding NITI Aayog's NGO-DARPAN portal can improve accountability.

Conclusion

Civil society is an indispensable partner for the UN and the state alike. Transparent, well-regulated and adequately resourced, it can bridge governance gaps and drive inclusive development.



8(b) What is RTI? What rights are available under RTI Act 2005? If RTI is a Fundamental Right, then why do we need an Act to give us this Right?

10

Introduction

The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 is a landmark reform that strengthens democracy by ensuring transparency and accountability. It gives citizens a practical way to access information from public authorities, ending historical secrecy and enabling active participation in governance.

Rights under the RTI Act

1. Right to Seek Information: Every citizen may file a written application and must receive information within 30 days, or 48 hours where life or liberty is involved.
2. Proactive Disclosure: Section 4 requires authorities to publish budgets, decisions and records, reducing the need for individual requests.
3. Right to Appeal: A multi-tier appeal process ends at the Information Commissions, and officials face penalties up to Rs 25,000 for delay or misinformation.
4. Wide Coverage: The Act covers all public authorities, including NGOs substantially

financed by government.

Why an Act for a Fundamental Right

Why the Right Needed an Act

Article 19(1)(a) alone	With the RTI Act
Implicit, judge-made	Written statutory procedure
No procedure to claim	PIOs in every authority
No deadlines	30 days, or 48 hours
No penalties	Fines up to Rs 25,000
Limits undefined	Section 8 exemptions

1. **Implicit, Not Operational:** The Supreme Court read the right into Article 19(1)(a) and Article 21, but a judicial right has no procedure for claiming it.
2. **Enforceable Machinery:** The Act creates Public Information Officers in every authority and Information Commissions to oversee and decide appeals.
3. **Timelines and Penalties:** Only a statute can fix deadlines and punish non-compliance, turning a principle into a usable entitlement.
4. **Balancing Interests:** Section 8 exemptions on

sovereignty, security and privacy reconcile openness with legitimate state interests, a balance only a detailed statute can define.

Impact and Challenges

1. Impact: RTI disclosures have exposed corruption in public distribution and welfare schemes in Andhra Pradesh, improving delivery to marginalised groups.
2. Challenges: Low awareness, untrained PIOs, understaffed commissions with backlogs (as in Andhra Pradesh's State Information Commission) and threats to RTI activists limit its reach.

Conclusion

By operationalising a constitutional right, the RTI Act has made governance transparent and accountable, empowering citizens to hold public authorities answerable. Awareness drives in local languages, adequately funded Information Commissions, trained PIOs and proactive digital disclosure will help it curb corruption and deepen participatory democracy. The Act thus gives practical life to a right the Constitution only implied.

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Index · page 6

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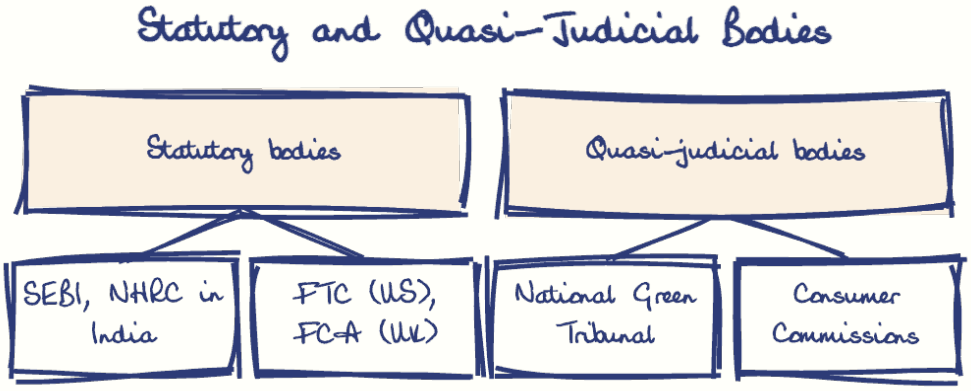
9(a) Describe the work of the statutory bodies with example and mention in which countries they are set up. Explain quasi-judicial bodies, providing two examples from India.

10

Introduction

Statutory and quasi-judicial bodies have become vital to modern governance as disputes grow in number and complexity. By providing specialized, expert-driven adjudication and regulatory oversight, they decongest courts, ensure timely justice and sustain public trust.

Work of Statutory Bodies



1. **Legal Foundation:** They are created by specific Acts of Parliament or State Legislatures, which give them authority and autonomy. SEBI, set up under the SEBI Act, 1992, regulates securities markets.

2. **Focused Mandate and Expertise:** Working in

defined domains like human rights, environment or finance, they build expertise; the NHRC, under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, investigates rights violations.

3. Independence with Accountability: Operational independence guards against political interference, while reporting to the legislature keeps them accountable.

4. Oversight of Public Resources: In Andhra Pradesh, statutory regulation governs State Public Sector Enterprises, whose turnover in 2023–24 was 88,176.83 crore.

Countries Where They Are Set Up

Statutory bodies are common across democracies: the Federal Trade Commission in the United States, the Financial Conduct Authority in the United Kingdom and the Australian Human Rights Commission in Australia.

Quasi-Judicial Bodies

1. Meaning: They perform judicial-like functions such as adjudicating disputes, imposing penalties and regulating conduct, without being formal courts. They follow natural justice but are not bound by strict procedural codes, the Income Tax Appellate

Tribunal is one example.

2. Example 1: The National Green Tribunal adjudicates environmental disputes under the NGT Act, 2010.

3. Example 2: Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions handle consumer grievances and penalise defective goods or services.

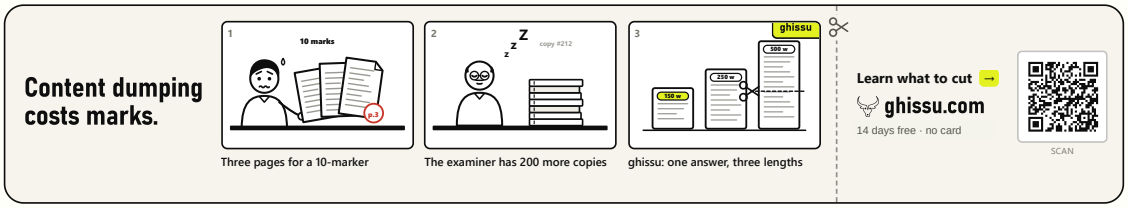
4. Effectiveness and Limits: They resolve specialized disputes faster, but vacancies, uneven procedures and occasional encroachment on judicial powers weaken them.

Way Forward

A National Tribunals Commission, specialist recruitment, minimum procedural norms and e-governance case management can strengthen these bodies.

Conclusion

Statutory and quasi-judicial bodies complement the judiciary with specialized justice and oversight, advancing the promise of timely, accessible justice under Article 39A.



9(b) What is social audit? What are its objectives and advantages?

10

Introduction

A social audit is a process in which communities, through Gram Sabhas, verify how public programmes and funds are used. It became mandatory under the MGNREGA Act, 2005, with Andhra Pradesh pioneering regular audits to detect misuse of funds. Andhra Pradesh's Society for Social Audit, Accountability and Transparency shows how it can be institutionalised.

Objectives of Social Audit

1. Transparency and Accountability: Verify proper use of public funds and services, reduce corruption and build public trust.
2. Community Engagement: Give citizens, especially marginalised groups, a platform to voice concerns and join decisions.
3. Programme Effectiveness: Identify gaps between policy goals and outcomes to improve delivery.
4. Regular Monitoring: Institutionalise continuous oversight and two-way feedback among stakeholders.

Social Audit Advantages vs Challenges

Advantages	Challenges
Enhances transparency, deters corruption	Limited to localized contexts
Empowers community participation	Requires skilled auditors
Improves program design through feedback	Often irregular and ad hoc
Facilitates public accountability	Action on findings delayed

Advantages of Social Audit

1. Deters Corruption: Audits uncovered fraud in Rajasthan's NREGA implementation, leading to fund recovery; Andhra Pradesh's MGNREGA audits also recovered misused funds.
2. Better Programme Design: Feedback improved nutrition services in Odisha.
3. Grassroots Democracy: The 73rd Amendment empowered Gram Sabhas, strengthening local oversight.
4. Institutional Model: Andhra Pradesh's dedicated society provides staffing and resources, and Meghalaya has enacted a specific law on social audits.

Limitations

1. Skill Gaps: A shortage of trained auditors with the requisite skills hampers the quality and consistency of audits.
2. Irregular Audits: Audits are often ad hoc, and action on findings may be delayed or absent.
3. Narrow Scope: Focus on specific localities limits how far findings can be generalised.

Way Forward

1. Auditor Training: Build a skilled cadre of social auditors in Andhra Pradesh through specialised modules.
2. Regular Audits: Formal schedules on state portals, with findings integrated with the CAG's oversight.

Conclusion

With trained auditors, regular schedules and digital tools, social audits can make governance transparent, accountable and truly participatory.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

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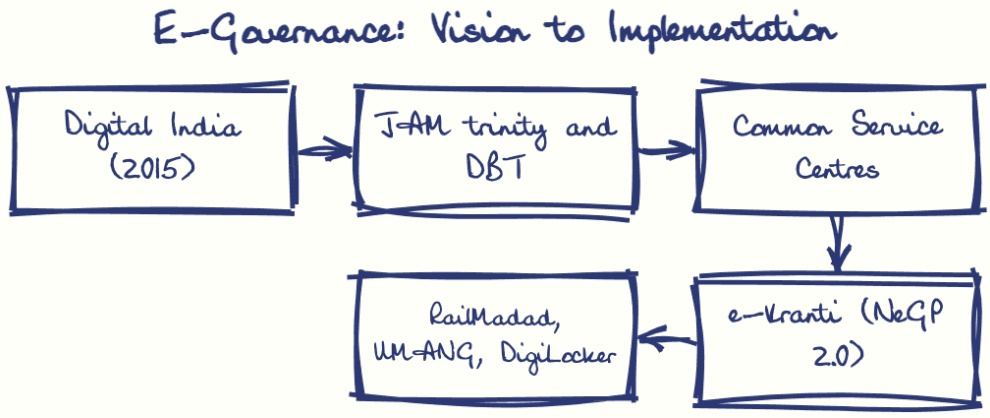
10(a) Why does the Indian Government make use of the e-governance strategy? Mention the several initiatives in the journey from e-governance vision to implementation. How can we say that the Indian government is accountable, responsive and legitimate government?

10

Introduction

The Indian Government adopts e-governance to enhance transparency, accountability and efficiency in public service delivery, in line with SMART governance (Simple, Moral, Accountable, Responsive, Transparent). It meets rising citizen expectations and bridges the urban-rural divide in access to services.

Journey from Vision to Implementation



1. Digital India (2015): Builds secure digital infrastructure, delivers services digitally and promotes universal digital literacy.
2. J-AM Trinity: Aadhaar covers over 141 crore people, with Jan Dhan and mobile it has enabled

direct benefit transfers of over Rs 43.95 lakh crore, reducing leakages.

3. Common Service Centres: Village-level points offer over 400 services, bridging the digital divide.
4. e-Kranti (NeGP 2.0): Drives citizen-centric delivery across governments, including Andhra Pradesh's e-District project for certificates and land records.

How Government Is Accountable, Responsive and Legitimate

1. Accountable: RailMadad and e-Taal enable real-time complaint tracking and service monitoring, raising official accountability and reducing opportunities for corruption.
2. Responsive: Integrated platforms like UMANG and DigiLocker have made driving licences and property registrations faster.
3. Legitimate: Inclusive, transparent delivery that reaches rural citizens through CSCs builds trust, so governance is seen as by and for the people.

Challenges

Andhra Pradesh's CFMS audit found Rs 968 crore in excess payments, and the digital divide and over 22 lakh cyber fraud incidents demand stronger

safeguards.

Way Forward

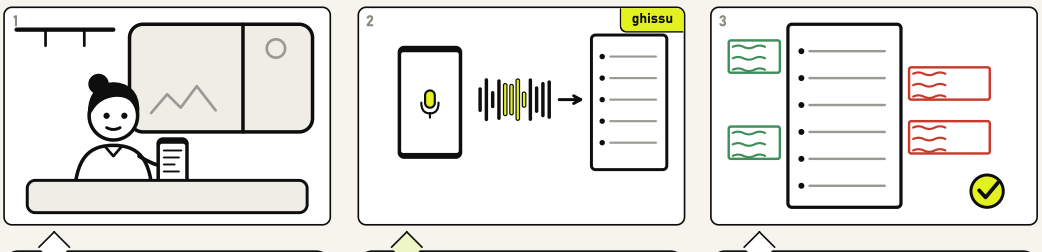
1. Interoperability: Unified platforms with standard protocols to avoid errors like those in Andhra Pradesh's financial systems.
2. Digital Literacy: Targeted training for rural and vulnerable groups through platforms like DIKSHA.

Conclusion

E-governance makes governance accountable, responsive and legitimate, ensuring it is truly by the people and for the people, in line with Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW QUICK OUTLINE — TYPE, SPEAK OR SCAN

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SCAN

10(b) Explain the major governmental interventions in the social sector with special reference to Health and education.

10

Introduction

The social sector, especially health and education, underpins human development and economic progress. The COVID-19 pandemic exposed systemic vulnerabilities, and government interventions now aim to improve accessibility, quality and equity.

Institutional and Policy Interventions

Interventions in Health and Education

Health	Education
National Health Policy 2017	National Education Policy 2020
eSanjeevani, digital health IDs	ICT in schools
Medical seat expansion (2025)	Article 21-A right
AP spends 3.11% on health	Secondary enrolment only 52.2%

1. Constitutional Mandate: Article 21-A guarantees free and compulsory education, while Directive Principles require promotion of public health.
2. Policy Frameworks: The National Education Policy 2020 and the National Health Policy 2017 guide

reforms.

3. Centre–State Roles: The Centre frames and funds schemes, states like Andhra Pradesh implement them through their departments, with bodies such as the UGC and National Medical Commission regulating.
4. Funding Mechanisms: Centrally Sponsored and Central Sector Schemes carry performance incentives, the medical seat expansion approved in 2025 is 68.5% Union and 31.5% state funded.
5. Digital Innovations: eSanjeevani telemedicine and digital health IDs (NDHM) widen access in underserved areas, education leverages ICT.

Outcomes and Challenges

1. Access Gaps: Secondary net enrolment is only 52.2%, and 44% of Anganwadi centres in Andhra Pradesh lack toilets.
2. Learning vs Enrolment: Learning levels lag enrolment, calling for teaching focused on digital literacy and life skills.
3. Health Gains: Fertility rates are declining and sanitation coverage rising.
4. Capacity Gaps: Audits show 22% vacancy in specialist posts and inadequate community health

centres in Andhra Pradesh.

5. Fiscal Constraints: Health spending grew at a CAGR of 15.8% between FY18 and FY24, yet Andhra Pradesh allots only 3.11% of its budget to health against an 8% target.
6. Digital Divide: Digital illiteracy still limits ICT gains in rural regions.

Way Forward

1. Accountability: Social audits and the JAM trinity can cut leakages.
2. Local Capacity: Training frontline workers improves last-mile delivery.
3. Preventive Approach: Integrating health, nutrition, sanitation and education improves long-term outcomes.

Conclusion

Interventions in health and education are pivotal for inclusive growth and human development. With innovation, accountability and capacity, they can ensure equitable access and quality, realizing "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas".

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

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SCAN

11(a) Define ethics, with reference to ethics in Indian tradition. Mention five principles to manage ethics in public service.

10

Introduction

Ethics is the cornerstone of public service, guiding civil servants to act with integrity and fairness in a diverse society like India. With rising public scrutiny, understanding ethics through Indian tradition and applying it in governance is crucial to sustain public trust.

Defining Ethics

1. **Moral Principles:** Ethics is the systematic study of right and wrong conduct, setting standards for how people ought to act, especially in public roles.
2. **Beyond Law:** Law sets minimum standards, while ethics demands higher ideals of honesty and selflessness.
3. **Administrative Ethics:** The 2nd ARC's report on Ethics in Governance (2007) linked ethics to accountability, transparency and fairness in managing public affairs.
4. **Dynamic Nature:** Standards vary with time, place and social expectations, demanding prudence and moral courage.

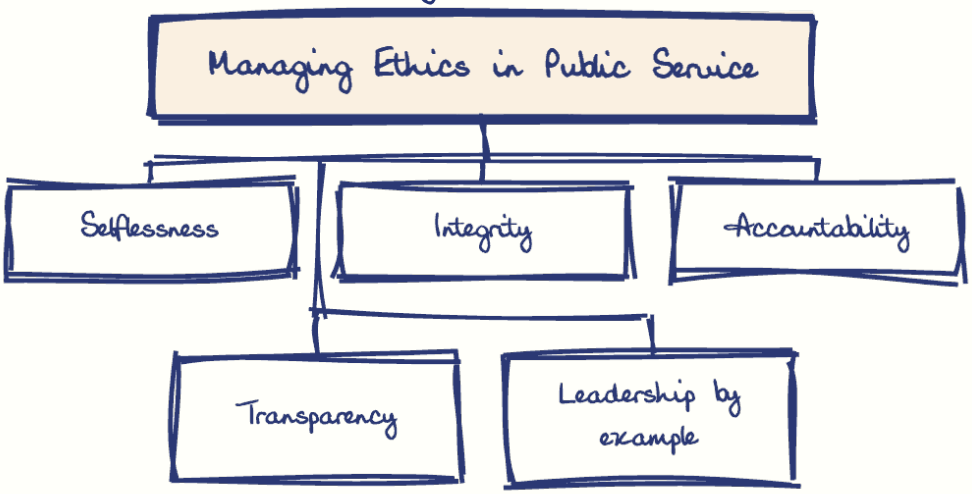
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Scan to practice

Ethics in Indian Tradition

1. **Philosophical Roots:** The Bhagavad Gita's **Lokasangraha** (welfare of all) and **Nishkama Karma** (selfless action) place duty for universal good above personal gain.
2. **Exemplars:** King Harishchandra upheld truth despite loss, and Gandhi insisted that unjustifiable means cannot justify ends.
3. **Private and Public Virtue:** Indian thought holds that public ethics must be grounded in private character.
4. **Constitutional Morality:** The Preamble and Article 51A enshrine justice, liberty, equality and fraternity.

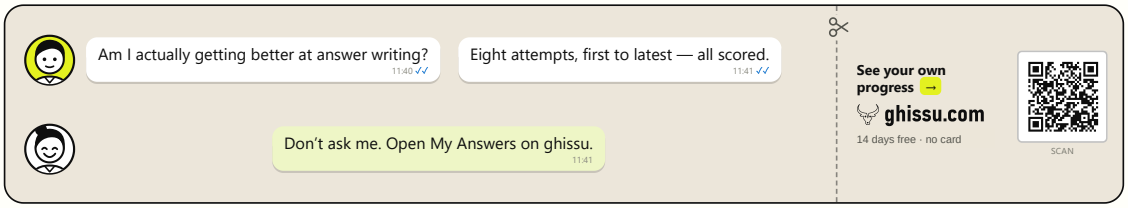
Five Principles to Manage Ethics in Public Service



1. Selflessness: Act solely in the public interest, as the Ndan Committee stressed, giving impartial advice.
2. Integrity: Stay honest under pressure, Andhra Pradesh's Vigilance Awareness Week uses integrity pledges to reinforce this.
3. Accountability: Answer for decisions, with the RTI Act enabling public scrutiny.
4. Transparency: Open decision-making, as through Andhra Pradesh's e-governance initiatives, prevents misuse of power.
5. Leadership by Example: Leaders like Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam show how personal ethics elevate public service.

Conclusion

Corruption and nepotism show that tradition alone is not enough. Values-based training under Mission Karmayogi, clear codes of conduct and ethical leadership can turn India's ethical heritage into everyday governance.



11(b) What are the necessity and importance of labour laws? Are India's labour law reforms only a gift for factories or do workers benefit too?

10

Introduction

Labour laws in India have aimed to balance the interests of workers and employers by ensuring fair wages, safe conditions and social security. The consdidation of (29) central laws into four Labour Codes simplifies compliance and supports recovery from COVID-19, while addressing a large informal workforce, including in Andhra Pradesh's industrial hubs like Visakhapatnam.

Necessity and Importance of Labour Laws

1. Modernised Framework: Codes on Wages, Industrial Relations, Social Security and Occupational Safety streamline oversight, as the Second National Commission on Labour recommended.
2. Universal Minimum Wage: A statutory floor wage across organised and unorganised sectors ensures a baseline income.
3. Social Security: For the first time, unorganised workers get health insurance and maternity benefits, vital in Andhra Pradesh's informal sectors like aquaculture.

4. Transparent Enforcement: The Labour Inspection Scheme and Labour Identification Numbers for over 27 lakh units curb corruption.

Only a Gift to Factories?

1. Employer Flexibility: A higher retrenchment threshold and longer permissible overtime hours give business flexibility.
2. Worker Concerns: These may erode job security in labour-intensive sectors like Andhra Pradesh's garment industry.

Who gains from the Labour Codes

Employers	Workers
Higher retrenchment threshold	Universal floor wage
Longer overtime hours	Social security for unorganised
Four simpler Codes	26 weeks maternity leave

How Workers Benefit

1. Gender Inclusion: Night shifts for women and 26 weeks maternity leave promote equity.
2. Formalisation: Wage floors and social security coverage bring informal workers into the protective

net.

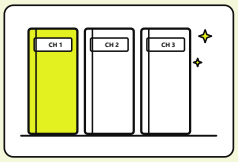
3. Employment Trends: Unemployment has declined and formal workforce participation has risen, showing reforms can serve both sides.

Way Forward

1. Awareness: Andhra Pradesh should intensify outreach to MSMEs and workers through digital platforms like the Shram Suvidha Portal.
2. Fair Inspections: Technology-enabled inspection and grievance redressal without harassment.
3. Social Security Enrolment: Easier registration for informal workers in aquaculture and horticulture in Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

The reforms are not merely a gift to factories: universal minimum wages, social security and gender-inclusive provisions benefit workers too. Implemented well, they can combine economic dynamism with social justice, in the spirit of Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

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SCAN

12(a) What do you understand by the values of an entity? What is the need for value education? Discuss how gender inequality came to be recognised as inequality in the Indian context and the kind of responses that this recognition produced.

10

Introduction

Recognising gender inequality as a social injustice in India evolved over time, producing legal, social and institutional responses. Values and value education underpin this change.

Values of an Entity

The values of an entity are the core principles and beliefs that guide the behaviour and decisions of an individual or organisation, shaping its identity and purpose.

Need for Value Education

1. Ethical Citizenship: It builds ethical awareness, social responsibility and respect for diversity, needed for harmony and sustainable development.
2. Challenging Stereotypes: Family and school socialisation often reinforce traditional roles; value education promotes mutual respect and dignity against patriarchal stereotypes.

How Gender Inequality Was Recognised

Gender Inequality: Recognition and Response

Recognition	Responses
Articles 14, 15, 16, 39, 42	Beti Bachao Beti Padhao
Vishaka (1997), POSH Act (2013)	PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana
Justice Verma Committee (2013)	Janani Suraksha Yojana
Value education against stereotypes	Mission Shakti awareness

1. **Constitutional Guarantees:** Articles (13, 14) and (15) prohibit discrimination, while Articles (16), 39(b), 39(c) and (42) secure fair employment and humane work.

2. **Judicial Intervention:** Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan (1997) produced guidelines against workplace sexual harassment, later the POSH Act (2013).

3. **Committees:** The Justice Verma Committee (2013) urged stricter laws on gender-based violence and gender sensitisation.

Responses Produced

1. **Empowerment Schemes:** Beti Bachao Beti Padhao raised girls' enrolment by (8%) in targeted

districts, including in Andhra Pradesh; MUDRA Yojana backs enterprise.

2. Skills: PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana trained over 1.2 million women, though turning skills into equal jobs lags.
3. Enforcement: Women's police stations and fast-track courts in Andhra Pradesh enforce gender-related laws.
4. Health: Janani Suraksha Yojana raised institutional deliveries to 85%, though reproductive autonomy remains uneven.
5. Awareness: Mission Shakti reached 10 million women, challenging stereotypes.
6. Persisting Gaps: Low labour force participation, wage gaps and patriarchal norms remain.

Conclusion

India has built a strong constitutional and institutional framework for gender justice. Value education, grounded in constitutional morality, must turn equality from a legal mandate into a lived reality, advancing inclusive growth and social justice.

Wrote the answer. Now what?
Upload it — every line marked, in minutes.
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12(b) Explain the Lokpal and Lokyukta Act.

10

Introduction

The Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013 is a landmark law to combat corruption and maladministration in public offices. Enacted amid public demand after high-profile scandals, it establishes independent ombudsman institutions at the central and state levels to investigate and prosecute corruption.

Institutional Design

1. Statutory Establishment: A Lokpal at the national level, with states required to enact their own Lokayukta laws within a year, allowing local adaptation.
2. Composition: A Chairperson and up to eight members, at least 50% judicial, with half the members from SC/ST/OBC, minorities or women.
3. Jurisdiction: The Prime Minister (except national security, foreign affairs, atomic energy and public order), Union Ministers, MPs, Group A to D officials, government-funded bodies and NGOs with significant foreign donations.
4. Autonomy and Accountability: Its budget is

charged to the Consolidated Fund of India, and annual reports to the President are tabled in Parliament.

Implementation Challenges

1. Delayed Operationalisation: The first Lokpal came only in 2019, and states like Andhra Pradesh faced Lokayukta vacancies.
2. Limited Powers: Without suo motu powers, it depends on the CBI and CVC, with key inquiry posts vacant.
3. Restrictive Complaints: Anonymous complaints are barred and false ones heavily penalised, deterring whistleblowers.
4. Jurisdictional Gaps: The judiciary is excluded, inquiry against the Prime Minister is limited in sensitive areas, and state Lokayuktas vary widely in powers.

Lokpal: gaps and reforms

Gap	Reform
No suo motu powers	Grant suo motu powers
Anonymous complaints barred	Allow anonymous reporting
State Lokayuktas vary widely	Uniform Lokayukta framework
Risk of political interference	Constitutional status

Way Forward

1. **Constitutional Status:** Shield the Lokpal from political interference and boost confidence in its impartiality.
2. **Suo Motu Powers:** Allow it to begin inquiries without waiting for formal complaints.
3. **Uniform Lokayukta Framework:** Common standards for state Lokayuktas, including Andhra Pradesh, for consistent enforcement.
4. **Simpler Complaints:** Allow anonymous reporting and reduce procedural rigidity to encourage whistleblowers.

Conclusion

The Act upholds constitutional morality by promoting transparency and accountability. Fully empowered and effectively implemented, these institutions can deter corruption, restore public trust and advance the constitutional vision of a corruption-free India.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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SCAN

13(a) Define moral attitude and explain the four qualities of moral attitude. What are the factors that shape political attitude?

10

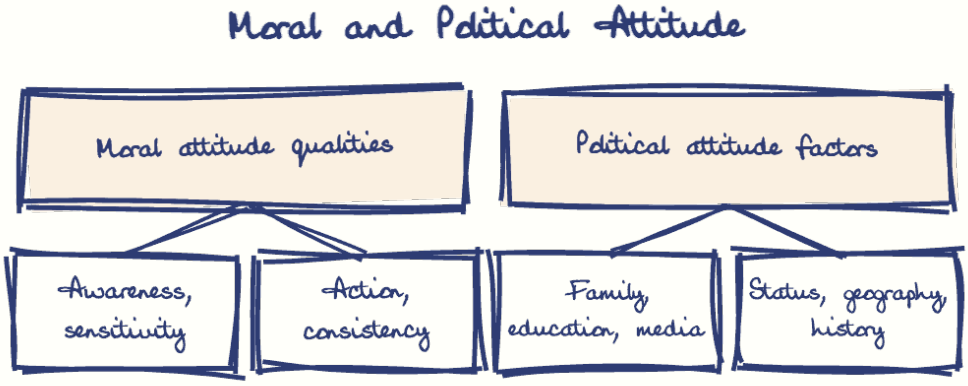
Introduction

Moral and political attitudes shape the ethical functioning of individuals and societies, especially for civil servants handling complex governance. Amid rapid social change and political polarisation, understanding them is crucial for integrity and democratic stability.

Moral Attitude Defined

A moral attitude is a settled disposition of approval or disapproval towards right and wrong, guiding a person to act ethically even under pressure or temptation. It reflects internalised values like truthfulness, justice and compassion.

Four Qualities of Moral Attitude



1. Moral Awareness (Cognitive): Recognising ethical issues, as an environment ministry official sees the conflict between industrial growth and conservation.
2. Moral Sensitivity (Affective): Empathising with suffering, as a bureaucrat running housing schemes feels compassion for the homeless.
3. Moral Action (Behavioural): Practising ethics consistently, such as transparent Direct Benefit Transfer to prevent corruption.
4. Consistency and Integrity: Aligning values, attitudes and actions over time, even at personal cost, which makes such people role models.

Factors Shaping Political Attitude

1. Family and Upbringing: Children often inherit parents' political leanings.
2. Education and Media: Civic awareness and ideologically biased media in Andhra Pradesh shape opinion.
3. Socio-Economic Status and Geography: Rural Rayalaseema prioritises agriculture differently from urban Visakhapatnam.
4. Religion and Culture: These shape views on gender rights and minority protection.

5. Personality and Generation: Openness and shared historical experience mould political consciousness.

6. Historical Context: The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh and the Special Category Status demand fostered strong regional identity.

Conclusion

Civil servants often face political directives that clash with constitutional duty. A firm moral attitude helps them ensure political attitudes never override constitutional morality, so justice and equality guide governance.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

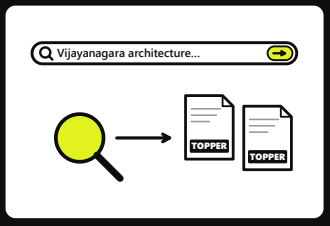
Read a topper copy like an examiner

Don't read a topper's answer for its facts. Read it for its moves — they transfer to any question.

1. **First two lines** — How does the intro frame the demand?
2. **Headings** — How is the body split — by dimension, by actor, by time?
3. **Proof** — Which fact, report or case holds up each paragraph?
4. **Last two lines** — What way forward, and how specific is it?

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SCAN

13(b) Explain the concept of emotional intelligence with special reference to the three main models of emotional intelligence. How are emotional intelligence applied in administration and governance?

10

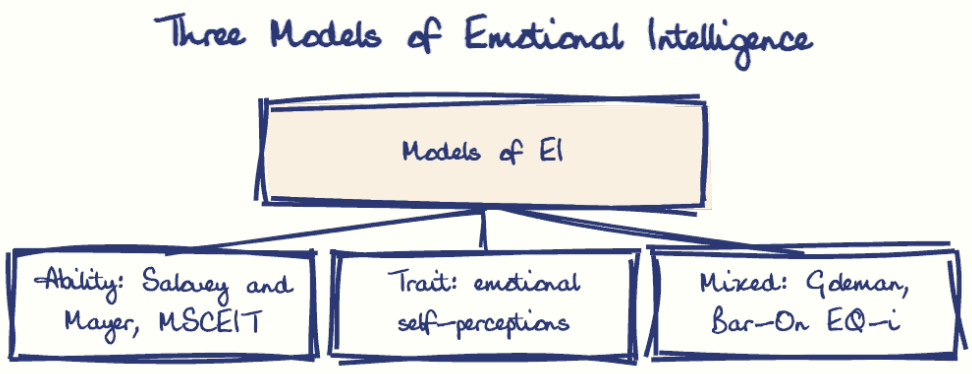
Introduction

In today's complex administration, technical skill alone is not enough. Emotional intelligence (EI) has become a critical competency for public servants to handle interpersonal dynamics, manage stress and make ethical decisions, as citizens expect transparency, empathy and responsiveness.

Concept of Emotional Intelligence

EI is the ability to recognise, understand and manage one's own emotions and those of others. Daniel Goleman popularised it, arguing it shapes success beyond IQ, through self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy and social skills.

Three Main Models



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1. Ability Model: Salovey and Mayer treat EI as cognitive abilities to perceive, use, understand and regulate emotions, measured by the MSCEIT.
2. Trait Model: EI is a set of emotional self-perceptions at lower levels of personality, stressing dispositions over cognitive ability.
3. Mixed Model: Goleman combines abilities with traits and competencies like motivation and social skills, widely used in leadership; Bar-On's EQ-i assesses it.

Application in Administration and Governance

1. Leadership and Decisions: Officers who regulate emotions avoid impulsive choices; as Marcus Aurelius said, "You have power over your mind, not outside events." In the Polavaram project, EI helped balance technical and stakeholder concerns.
2. Service Delivery: Empathy and social skills make Andhra Pradesh's grievance redressal more effective.
3. Team Cohesion: Self-awareness and social skills build morale and reduce burnout.
4. Conflict Diffusion: Perspective-taking helps district officers defuse communal tensions.
5. Ethical Conduct: EI supports impartiality, integrity

and accountability, helping officers keep ethical standards under pressure.

Way Forward

1. Institutionalise Training: EI modules in induction and continuous development under Mission Karmayogi.
2. Empathetic Outreach: Community outreach and feedback to build trust and participation.
3. Resilience Support: Systems to help officers manage stress and emotional setbacks.
4. Assessment: Validated tools like MSCEIT to measure progress.

Conclusion

EI complements technical competence. Embedded in training and practice, it turns rules into responsive, humane governance, strengthens ethical conduct and builds lasting public trust.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

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SCAN

14(a) Define public service broadly. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. Suggest three preventive measures of corruption.

10

Introduction

Public service is the cornerstone of democratic governance: government exists to serve the public interest, not private gain. With fragile public trust and persistent corruption, the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude are essential for integrity and resilience in administration.

Public Service Defined Broadly

Public service covers all activities of government and administrative bodies that provide healthcare, education, sanitation and justice, treating office as a public trust. Kautilya held that the ruler's happiness lies in the welfare of subjects. The Nolan Committee's seven principles, from selflessness to leadership, form its ethical backbone, while the CVC, Lokpal and RTI Act enforce accountability and transparency.

Trustworthiness and Fortitude in Practice

1. Trustworthiness: Rooted in veracity and reliability, it shows when officials act transparently and honour commitments, raising team morale and

Two Virtues of Public Service

Trustworthiness	Fortitude
Veracity and reliability	Courage against resistance
Honouring commitments	Upholding justice under pressure
Community policing in Andhra Pradesh	Swift justice in Visakhapatnam cases

citizens' faith. Andhra Pradesh's public–police partnerships in community policing improved credibility and cooperation.

2. Fortitude: The courage to uphold justice despite adversity or resistance, seen in rigorous investigation and swift justice in high-profile criminal cases in Visakhapatnam and in the steadfast implementation of demonetisation.

3. Exemplars: Lal Bahadur Shastri and E. Sreedharan combined personal integrity with public welfare, setting institutional standards.

4. Synergy: Together these virtues help officials keep integrity, accept necessary change and deliver justice, reinforcing the spirit of service.

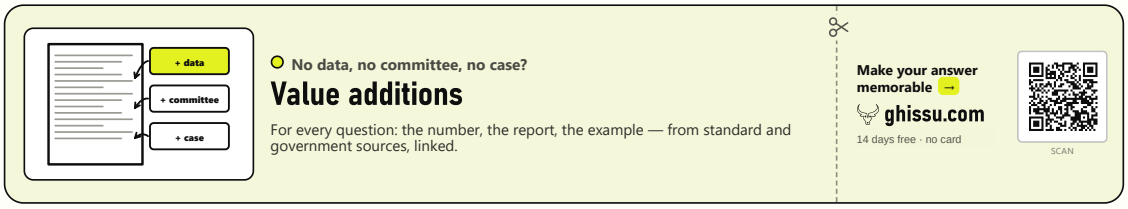
Three Preventive Measures against Corruption

Corruption erodes legitimacy and fosters inequality; the CVC's 2023 report recorded over 74,000 complaints.

1. Ethics Codes and Training: Comprehensive codes and values-based training through Mission Karmayogi from induction.
2. Transparency and Accountability: Citizen charters, social audits and RTI in letter and spirit; social audits of DBT in Andhra Pradesh reduced leakages.
3. Legal and Institutional Reform: Amend the Prevention of Corruption Act for faster trials and whistleblower protection, and strengthen vigilance bodies.

Conclusion

Public service is a trust held for citizens. Trustworthiness earns their faith and fortitude protects it under pressure. Backed by ethics training, transparency and strong laws, these virtues keep public servants true custodians of public welfare and restore faith in institutions.



14(b) What is the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating values?

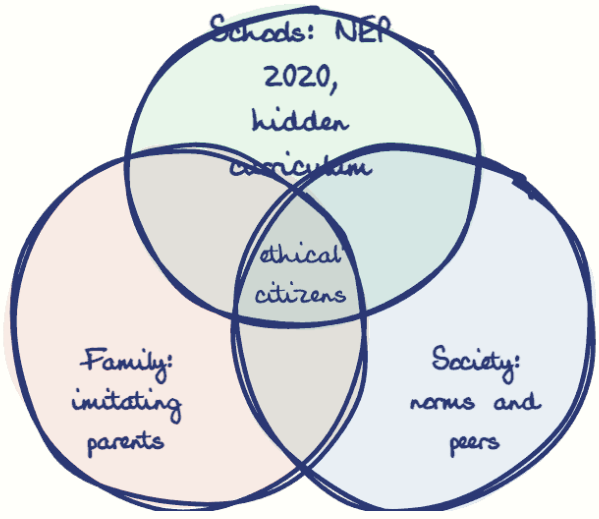
10

Introduction

Inculcating values is fundamental to shaping ethical individuals and a harmonious society in a diverse country like India. Family, society and educational institutions form the primary triad that transmits moral principles, social norms and civic responsibilities. Their role is more critical as rapid social and technological change challenges traditional values.

Role of the Family

The Value Triad



1. Primary Socialisation: Children learn honesty integrity and compassion by observing and

imitating parents and elders. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam held father, mother and teacher as key to a corruption-free society.

2. Changing Structures: Working parents' limited time and generation gaps weaken this rde, so schods and communities must support it.

Rde of Society

1. Reinforcement: Cuttural norms, peers and collective attitudes reinforce ethical conduct, a society permissive of wrongdoing fosters subcuttures of crime and intderance.

2. Dynamic Values: Judicial pronauncements promoting gender inclusivity and care ethics show society adopting progressive values.

3. Negative Influences: Withait vigilance, society may spread mob justice or discrimination.

Rde of Educational Institutions

1. Structured Learning: Schods teach discipline, respect and civic responsibility. NEP 2020 stresses value-based, experiential learning.

2. Hidden Curriculum: Teacher behaviour and peer interaction transmit unstated norms.

3. Partnerships: The Delhi Happiness Curriculum and

Andhra Pradesh's value education efforts link schod and family to build emotional intelligence.

4. Countering Ills: Critical thinking counters materialism, corruption and intolerance.

Challenges

India's pluralism, including Andhra Pradesh's diverse heritage, can create value conflicts, while social media shapes values both ways, making media literacy essential.

Way Forward

1. Family–Schod Partnerships: Parenting calendars and community programmes to align efforts.
2. Inclusive Norms: Community dialogues that challenge harmful practices and promote equality and care.
3. Responsible Technology: Digital literacy on ethical social media use.

Conclusion

When family, society and schods work in synergy, they nurture citizens committed to justice, equality and compassion, fulfilling the Fundamental Duties and Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.

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Scan to practice

15(a) Explain the different types of cybercrimes and the importance of cyber laws in India.

10

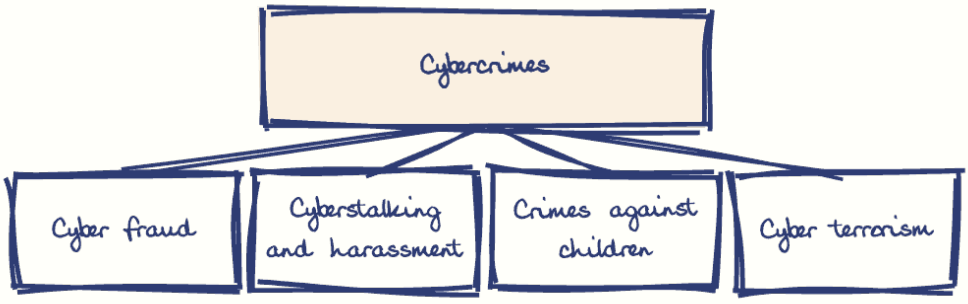
Introduction

India's digital transformation, with over 969 million internet users by March 2025, has sharply raised exposure to cybercrime. A 33% rise in cyberattacks in 2024 and the 2023 leak of about 81.5 crore Indians' personal data show why robust cyber laws are needed to protect rights, critical infrastructure and trust.

Types of Cybercrimes

1. Cyber Fraud: Phishing, identity theft and online banking frauds cause major economic losses.
2. Cyberstalking and Harassment: Sextortion, harassment and defamation target women and children; the CCPWC scheme offers awareness and support.
3. Crimes against Children: Child pornography and cyberbullying rose 32% from 2021 to 2022.
4. Cyber Terrorism: Attacks on power grids, hospitals and government networks threaten national security.

Types of cybercrime



Importance of Cyber Laws and Institutions

1. IT Act, 2000: The backbone, defining hacking, identity theft and cyber terrorism with penalties and procedures.
2. Policy: The National Cyber Security Policy, 2013 aims to train 500,000 professionals.
3. Agencies: CERT-In handles incident response and I4C coordinates agencies, while the reporting portal allows anonymous complaints.
4. Data and Platforms: The DPDP Act, 2023 creates a Data Protection Board; the IT Rules, 2021 curb harmful content.

Challenges

1. Underreporting: Low awareness, fear or mistrust in police keep crimes hidden, especially in rural Andhra Pradesh.
2. Capacity: Over 25,000 officers have been

trained, but continuous capacity building is needed as threats evolve.

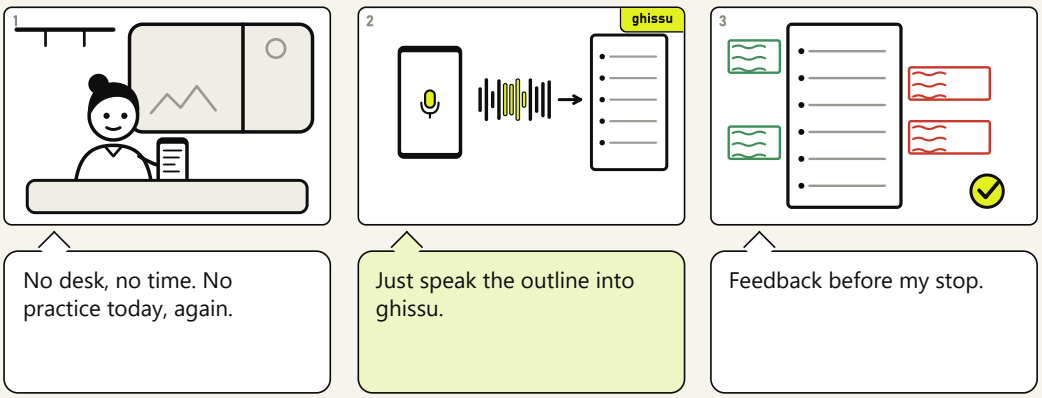
3. Jurisdiction: India stays out of the Budapest Convention; the 2024 UN Cybercrime Convention offers a framework.

Conclusion

Cyber laws protect citizens' rights, secure critical infrastructure and sustain trust in a growing digital economy. They must keep evolving with AI and IoT, backed by skilled enforcement and digital literacy to keep Andhra Pradesh's expanding digital services safe.

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SCAN

15(b) How does time and space effect ethics in private and public relationships? Illustrate.

10

Introduction

In an era of rapid social and technological change, time and space shape ethics in private and public relationships. Historical shifts and geographical contexts demand a nuanced framework that respects both tradition and modernity, especially in Andhra Pradesh, where cultural heritage meets modern administrative challenges.

Effect of Time on Ethics

How Time and Space Shape Ethics

Time	Space
Live-in relationships recognised	Rayalaseema drought, mutual support
Marriage and Domestic Violence laws	Formal rules in cities
Youth autonomy, elders' duty	Trust-based village mechanisms
COVID-19 oxygen allocation	Krishna-Godavari water disputes

1. Evolving Social Norms: The rise of live-in relationships and greater female workforce participation challenge traditional marriage norms;

the Supreme Court's recognition of live-in relationships reflects this shift.

2. Legal Reform: The Hindu Marriage Act (1955) and the Domestic Violence Act widened divorce access and protected women, shaping how officials act in family welfare.

3. Generational Shift: Youth in Visakhapatnam value emotional compatibility and autonomy, while elders stress duty and conformity, creating dilemmas for officials.

4. Crisis Ethics: Oxygen allocation in Andhra Pradesh hospitals during the COVID-19 second wave showed urgency weighed against procedural fairness.

Effect of Space on Ethics

1. Regional Culture: Drought in Rayalaseema fosters mutual support and sacrifice in families, while aquaculture shapes different dynamics in Krishna district.

2. Urban and Rural Contrast: Cities like Amaravati demand formal rules, while villages rely on trust-based mechanisms.

3. Gendered Public Space: Spatial norms constrain women's access to public spaces, raising questions

of safety, respect and autonomy.

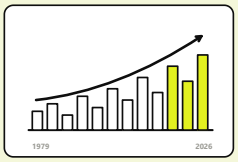
4. Regional Disputes: The Krishna and Godavari water disputes require impartial governance balancing regional interests with national unity.

Way Forward

1. Context-Sensitive Training: Modules for civil servants on temporal and spatial sensitivity.
2. Legal Awareness: Region-specific campaigns on evolving laws on relationships and public conduct.
3. Gender-Sensitive Policy: Safe, equitable access to public spaces for women through urban planning.

Conclusion

Time and space shape norms, laws and social expectations. Civil servants who uphold constitutional morality while adapting to change and diversity foster trust, justice and social cohesion, advancing liberty, equality and fraternity.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

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SCAN

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2017

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P-II
11(a)

The Indian Constitution provides for a democratic system in India. In this backdrop, briefly analyse the constitutional provisions with regard to tyranny of majority and appeasement of minority.

10

Introduction

The Constitution, adopted in 1950, established a democratic framework that balances majority rule with protection of minority rights. In a society of many religions and languages, it seeks to prevent tyranny of the majority while addressing concerns of minority appeasement.

Provisions Preventing Tyranny of the Majority

1. **Fundamental Rights:** Articles 14, 19 and 21 guarantee equality, free speech and life and liberty to all, including minorities.
2. **Judicial review:** The basic structure doctrine of Kesavananda Bharati prevents laws that violate rights.
3. **Independent Election Commission:** Articles 324–327 ensure free and fair elections, protecting minority representation.
4. **Articles 29 and 30:** Minorities can preserve their culture against imposed homogeneity.

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Provisions Addressing Appeasement Concerns

1. **Backwardness, not identity:** Articles 15(4) and 16(4) favour socially and educationally backward classes, promoting inclusion without undermining merit.
2. **Secularism:** Articles 25–28 guarantee religious freedom and bar religious discrimination.
3. **Asymmetric federalism:** Article 371 and the erstwhile Article 370 gave special autonomy to address unique concerns.
4. **Minority commissions:** The National Commission for Minorities and bodies in Andhra Pradesh address grievances.

Balancing Majority Rule and Minority Rights

1. **Franchise with morality:** Universal adult franchise enables majority rule, but constitutional morality protects minorities.
2. **Directive Principles:** Welfare schemes reduce disparities.
3. **Decentralisation:** Panchayati Raj lets minorities share local governance.
4. **Strains:** Communal conflicts and demands like Andhra Pradesh's special category status show the balance remains a challenge.

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Two-sided constitutional balance

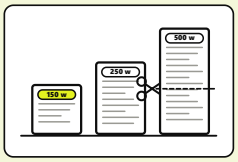
Against majority tyranny	Against minority appeasement
Fundamental Rights	Backwardness, not identity
Judicial review, basic structure	Secularism
Independent Election Commission	Asymmetric federalism
Articles 29 and 30	Minority commissions

Way Forward

1. Judicial capacity: Timely protection of minority rights against majoritarian laws.
2. Inclusive politics: Parties should respect minority concerns without appeasement politics.
3. Constitutional literacy: Awareness programmes reduce mistrust and majoritarian fears.

Conclusion

These provisions create a delicate balance in which the majority governs but cannot oppress, and minorities are protected but not privileged.



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SCAN

P-II
11(b)

"In spite of unitary features of the Constitution, federalism survived in India." Comment.

10

Introduction

The Indian Constitution, adopted in 1950, blends federal and unitary features to manage India's vast diversity and maintain national unity. Despite its unitary bias, federalism has endured as a dynamic process, adapting to changing political realities.

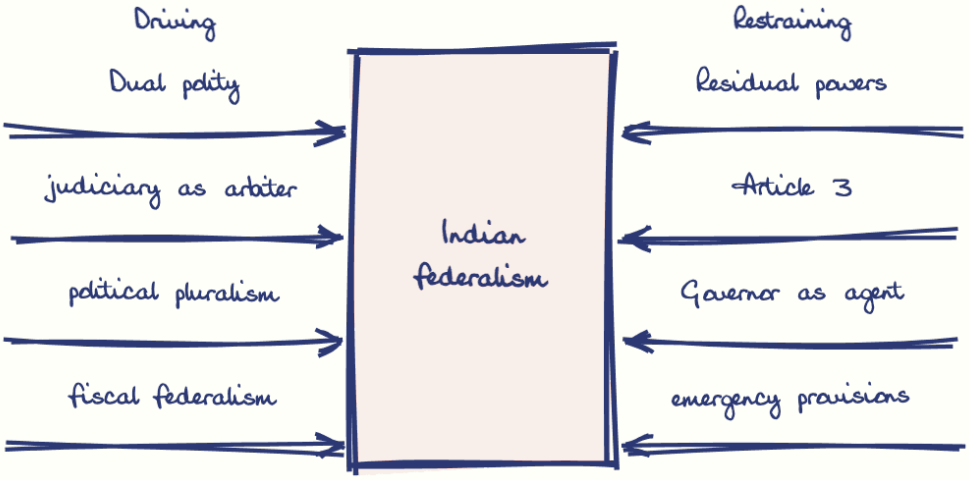
Unitary Features of the Constitution

1. **Residual Powers with the Centre:** Article 248 vests residual legislative powers in Parliament, ensuring central dominance in unforeseen areas.
2. **Power over State Boundaries:** Article 3 lets Parliament alter state boundaries without state consent.
3. **Governor as Centre's Agent:** Governors appointed by the President enable central oversight of state affairs.
4. **Emergency Provisions:** Articles 352, 356 and 360 allow President's Rule and central takeover during crises.

How Federalism Survived

1. **Dual Polity:** The **Seventh Schedule** demarcates Union, State and Concurrent Lists, letting states legislate independently.
2. **Independent Judiciary:** The **S.R. Bommai case (1994)** curbed arbitrary use of Article 356 and protected elected state governments.
3. **Political Pluralism:** Diverse governments such as the Telugu Desam Party in Andhra Pradesh show operational federalism.
4. **Fiscal Federalism:** The Finance Commission and the **GST Council** show cooperative federalism, with states like Andhra Pradesh receiving grants and sharing pooled taxation.

Federalism versus unitary pull



Interaction of the Two

1. Unitary Bias as Cohesion: Unitary features were designed after Partition to prevent secession and preserve unity.
2. Continuing Negotiation: Disputes over the Krishna and Godavari waters and Andhra Pradesh's demand for special category status show a persistent federal impulse.

Way Forward

1. Institutions: Strengthen the Inter-State Council and the Finance Commission.
2. Article 356 Safeguards: Stricter safeguards against misuse of Article 356.
3. Competitive Federalism: Encourage states like Andhra Pradesh to innovate in governance and economic development.

Conclusion

Indian federalism has survived because of its flexible design, judicial safeguards and political pluralism. The unitary bias is a cohesion mechanism, while federalism remains the backbone of India's democratic governance.

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P-II
12(a)

What is office of profit ? Critically analyse the developments in India on this issue.

10

Introduction

The office of profit is a constitutional safeguard that preserves the independence of legislators by preventing conflicts of interest from remunerative government posts. Frequent disqualification controversies and an expanding list of exempted offices have raised questions about balancing governance efficiency with legislative integrity.

Meaning and Constitutional Provisions

1. **Definition:** It is an office under the government capable of yielding pecuniary gain, such as salary or allowances. Articles 102(1)(a) and 191(1)(a) disqualify legislators holding one unless exempted by law.
2. **Judicial test:** The test is whether the office is capable of yielding profit, not whether profit is actually received; honorariums and rent-free accommodation count.
3. **Exemptions:** Legislatures can exempt offices, such as parliamentary secretaries and advisors, by law.
4. **Purpose:** It prevents executive influence over the legislature and upholds separation of powers.

Developments in India

Exemptions to Office of Profit: Two Sides

Exemptions help	Exemptions hurt
Legislators assist administration	Dilute Articles 102 and 191
Exempted by law, openly	Bypass the limit on ministers
Judicial checks restore balance	Reward political loyalty
Use legislative talent	Risk executive dominance

1. Judicial activism: In Umrao Singh v. Darbara Singh and Kanta Kathuria v. Manak Chand Surana, courts scrutinised the nature and independence of offices.
2. Expanding exemptions: States like Andhra Pradesh have exempted many posts to escape disqualification, diluting Articles (102) and (191).
3. Political manipulation: In Nagaland, Goa and Andhra Pradesh, such appointments bypassed the limit on ministers and rewarded loyalty.
4. Opacity: Vague definitions and indiscriminate exemptions weaken the legislature's watchdog role.

Critical Assessment

1. Positive side: Exemptions let governments use

legislators to assist administration.

2. Negative side: Blurring executive and legislature risks executive dominance, though judicial checks restore some balance.

Way Forward

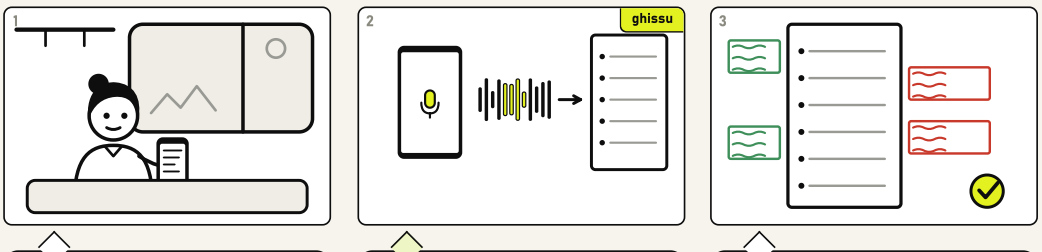
A clear legal definition with limited, transparent exemptions is essential.

Conclusion

The office of profit rule remains vital for legislative independence, but its dilution through exemptions demands reform.

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P-II
12(b)

Distinguish between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism and also cite the important decisions of the Supreme Court on the two subjects.

10

Introduction

The Indian judiciary safeguards constitutional governance through judicial review and judicial activism. Recent rulings, such as on the NJAC and the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, show their continuing relevance in checking executive and legislative excesses.

Distinction

Judicial Review vs Judicial Activism

Judicial Review	Judicial Activism
Constitutional mandate	Judicial philosophy
Validates or invalidates laws	Shapes policies and rights
Reactive role	Proactive role
Limited to legal scrutiny	Expands scope of justice

1. Judicial review: The power of courts to examine laws and executive actions against the Constitution and invalidate violations, ensuring constitutional supremacy.

2. Judicial activism: A proactive approach in which courts shape policy and expand rights to address social realities, often stepping into legislative or executive domains.

3. Key difference: Review is a constitutional mandate bound by text and precedent; activism is a philosophy of discretion, using PIL and expansive interpretation, sometimes to make law.

Decisions on Judicial Review

1. Kesavananda Bharati (1973): Laid down the basic structure doctrine, limiting Parliament's amending power.

2. S.R. Bommai (1994): Curbed misuse of Article 356, preserving federalism.

3. NJAC judgment (2015): Struck down the NJAC, upholding judicial independence.

Decisions on Judicial Activism

1. K.S. Puttaswamy (2017): Read privacy into Article 21.

2. Navtej Singh Johar (2018): Extended protection to LGBTQ+ rights.

3. Vishaka (1997): Laid down workplace harassment guidelines through PIL.

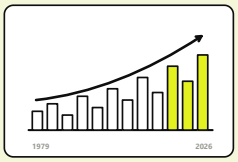
4. Singur (2016): Returned acquired land to farmers, filling a policy void.

Concerns

1. Overreach: Activism can encroach on policy domains, raising questions of democratic legitimacy, as debated in the Lok Sabha over interference in reservation policies.
2. Limits of review: Review stays bound by constitutional text and precedent and generally avoids policy-making.

Conclusion

Judicial review is a constitutional duty, while activism is its expansive use to advance justice. Both are vital, but activism must stay clear of judicial overreach to respect separation of powers.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

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SCAN

P-II
13(a)

Describe the formation and functions of Inter-State Council. State some of the important decisions taken by the Inter-State Council in the last 3 years.

10

Introduction

The Inter-State Council (ISC), established under Article 263 of the Constitution, is a vital platform for cooperative federalism. Its relevance has grown with inter-state disputes and the need for coordinated responses on water sharing, economic reforms and disaster management.

Formation of the Council

1. Constitutional Foundation: Article 263 empowers the President to establish the ISC to inquire into disputes and advise on matters of common interest.

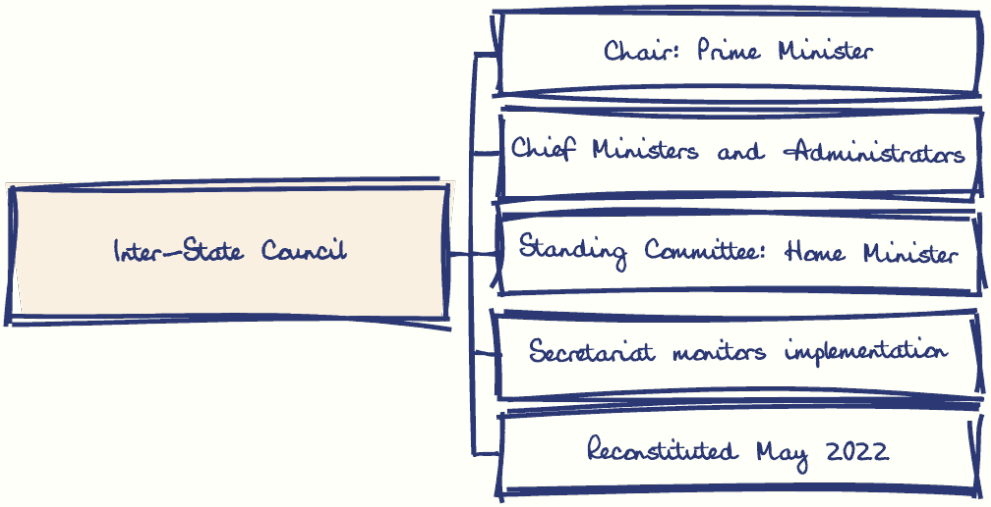
2. Composition: Chaired by the Prime Minister, it includes all Chief Ministers, UT Administrators, Governors of states under President's rule and six Union Cabinet ministers, including the Home Minister.

3. Flexible Body: It is reconstituted as needed, most recently in May 2022.

4. Secretariat and Standing Committee: A Secretariat monitors recommendations, and a Standing Committee under the Home Minister

prepares issues year-round.

Structure of the Inter-State Council



Functions

1. Policy Coordination: It discusses economic reforms, internal security and water disputes, and recommends better coordination.
2. Cooperative Federalism: It bridges trust deficits and acts as a safety valve in Centre-State relations.
3. Limitations: Its advice is non-binding, and a decade-long gap preceded the (2016) meeting.

Important Decisions in the Last (3) Years

1. COVID-19 Response: It harmonised Centre-State strategies on vaccine distribution and lockdown protocols.

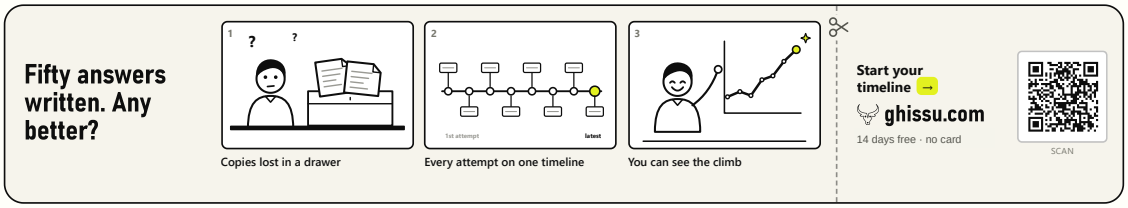
2. Water Disputes: It deliberated on Krishna and Godavari issues involving Andhra Pradesh, though resolutions remain pending.
3. Policy Alignment: It discussed GST implementation and coordinated disaster management policies.
4. Federal Dialogue: It stressed regular meetings and expert bodies, as the Punchhi Commission recommended.

Way Forward

1. Statutory Backing: Make its recommendations binding to resolve disputes effectively.
2. Regular Meetings: Meet at least thrice a year with agendas prepared in consultation with states.
3. Expert Secretariat: Build an independent secretariat with experts in law and management.

Conclusion

The Inter-State Council is a cornerstone of federal harmony. Strengthening its capacity will make its decisions count in Centre-State relations.



P-II
13(b)

Briefly describe the recommendations of 14th Finance Commission with regard to devolution of funds to rural local bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions). What measures have been implemented by the Government of India for monitoring and audit of the finances of Panchayati Raj Institutions ?

10

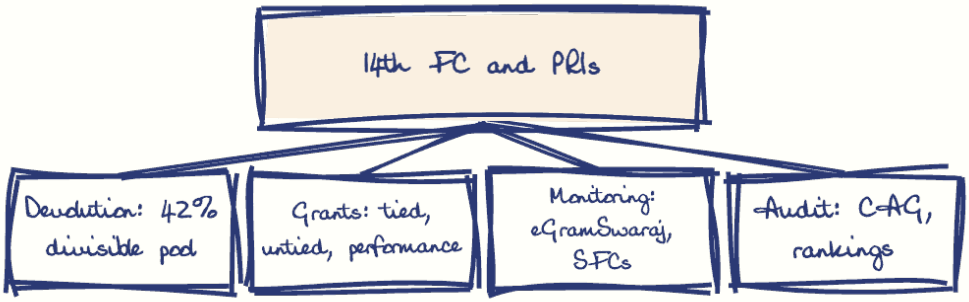
Introduction

The 14th Finance Commission (FFC) reshaped the fiscal base of Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) by recommending enhanced devolution, vital for the 73rd Amendment's vision. Given weak fund utilisation and accountability, the Government of India has also introduced measures to monitor and audit PRI finances.

Recommendations on Devolution to PRIs

1. **Higher Devolution:** 42% of the divisible pool to states, with a substantial portion earmarked for PRIs.
2. **Gram Panchayat Focus:** Rs. 2,00,292.20 crores over five years to Gram Panchayats, but little for intermediate and district Panchayats.
3. **Tied and Untied Grants:** Tied grants for sanitation and drinking water, untied ones for flexibility, balancing accountability and autonomy.
4. **Performance Incentives:** Performance grants reward good governance and effective fund use.

14th Finance Commission and PRIs



Monitoring and Audit Measures

1. eGramSwaraj Portal: GPDPs and financial statements are uploaded for real-time monitoring.
2. State Finance Commissions: Article 243-I mandates them every five years; 25 of 28 states had constituted them by 2025.
3. CAG Audits: The CAG audits Panchayat accounts; Andhra Pradesh's 2025 audit revealed gaps in welfare and education schemes.
4. Capacity Building: Training improves officials' financial management.
5. Rankings: Performance grants and ranking systems reward well-run Panchayats.

Challenges

1. Delayed Transfers: Funds move late from the Union to states and on to Panchayats, delaying projects.

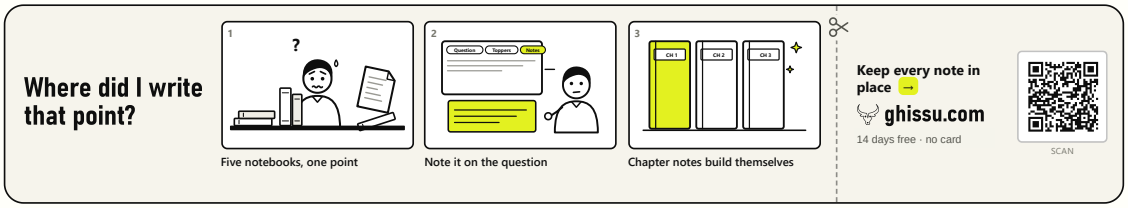
2. Neglected Upper Tiers: Intermediate and district Panchayats remain underfunded.
3. Rigid Tied Grants: Unused tied grants cannot be reallocated after saturation.
4. Audit Gaps: Weak internal audits, Andhra Pradesh's CFMS audit found excess payments.

Way Forward

1. All Tiers: Fund intermediate and district Panchayats too.
2. Flexible Grants: Convert unused tied grants into untied funds for local priorities.
3. Stronger Audits: Institutionalise regular internal audits and enhance the CAG's capacity.

Conclusion

The 14th Finance Commission strengthened Panchayat finances, and the monitoring tools add accountability, extending funds to all tiers and strengthening audits will complete the reform.



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P-II
14(a)

What is the difference between a National party and a Regional party, in case of parties recognised by the Election Commission of India ? Explain the features of the Indian party system.

10

Introduction

The distinction between National and Regional parties is key to India's federal democracy. The Election Commission of India (ECI) recognises parties by electoral performance, and this classification shapes a party system marked by diversity, regional aspirations and coalitions.

Difference between National and Regional Parties

1. **Recognition Criteria:** A National party needs six per cent of valid votes in four or more states and four Lok Sabha seats, or two per cent of Lok Sabha seats from three states; a Regional party needs six per cent in one state with two assembly seats, or three per cent of seats.
2. **Symbols:** National parties get a reserved symbol across India; Regional parties only within their states.
3. **Legislative Presence:** National parties show presence across states; Regional parties dominate state assemblies.
4. **2019 Amendment:** Recognition rests on performance,

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not on being a splinter group.

National Party vs Regional Party

National Party	Regional Party
Pan-India presence	State or regional presence
Reserved symbol nationwide	Reserved symbol within state
Broad social base	Specific cultural/linguistic base
Contest multiple states	Contest primarily in one state

Features of the Indian Party System

1. Coalition Politics: Regional parties have challenged Congress and BJP dominance, raising their bargaining power at the Centre.
2. Regional Aspirations: The Telugu Desam Party in Andhra Pradesh voices special category status and Polavaram.
3. Factionalism: Splits and defections reflect personalised politics.
4. Weak Opposition: Regional parties lack national unity, fragmenting opposition.
5. Centralised Leadership: Limited internal democracy affects candidate selection.

6. Opaque Funding: Electoral bonds favour major parties.

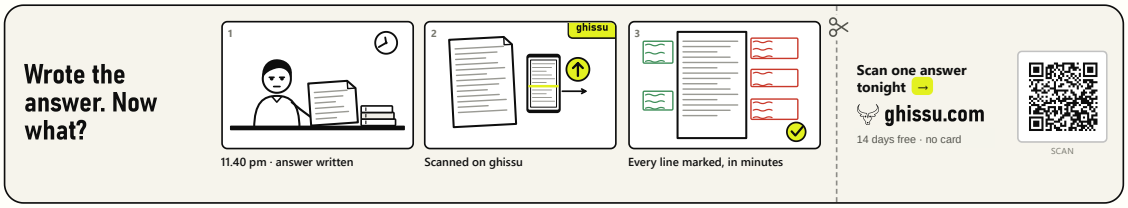
7. Volatility: Splits, mergers and defections cause instability, as the post-poll Congress-DMK split in Tamil Nadu showed.

Way Forward

1. Internal Democracy: Transparent, democratic leadership and candidate selection would reduce factionalism and enhance accountability.

Conclusion

India's party system blends pan-Indian National parties with assertive Regional parties, producing a federal, coalition-based democracy. Internal democracy and transparent funding would make it more accountable.



P-II
14(b)

Mention the important events in usage of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) in elections in India. Analyse the recent allegations on tampering of EVMs and suggest solutions.

10

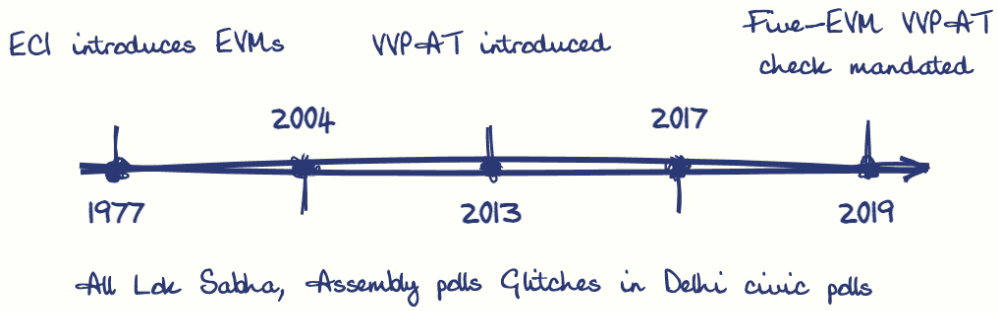
Introduction

The Supreme Court in April 2024 reaffirmed the integrity of Electronic Voting Machines under Article 324. Introduced in 1977 and universal since 2004, EVMs improved efficiency and cut invalid votes, but tampering allegations and glitches have challenged public trust.

Important Events in EVM Usage

1. **Introduction and Adoption:** The ECI introduced EVMs in 1977 and has used them in all Lok Sabha and Assembly elections since 2004.
2. **Technical Safeguards:** Standalone machines with software by BEL and ECIL, one-time programmable chips and vote time-stamping, tested and stored securely.
3. **VVPAT:** Introduced in 2013, in 2019 the Supreme Court mandated slip verification from five EVMs per Assembly constituency.
4. **Andhra Pradesh:** The state ran smooth EVM-VVPAT elections after bifurcation.

EVMs in Indian elections



Analysis of Allegations

1. **Tampering Claims:** Parties alleged pre-set manipulation after polls in Goa and Punjab, these remain unproven.
2. **Technical Glitches:** Heat and humidity caused sensor paralysis in the 2017 Delhi municipal polls and in Kairana and Noorpur.
3. **Audit Concerns:** Without 100% paper trail verification, sceptics doubt transparency, and booth-wise results risk secrecy.
4. **Misinformation:** Social media rumours about hacking deepen mistrust.

Solutions

1. **Enhanced VVPAT Verification:** Count more slips than 5% through statistically sound sampling.
2. **Totalizer Machines:** Aggregate booth votes to protect anonymity, as the ECI recommended.

3. Training: Hands-on training for officials to avoid failures.
4. Public Awareness: Hackathons, SVEEP and the cVIGIL app dispel myths.
5. Independent Audits: Third-party audits of software and hardware.

Way Forward

1. Technological Upgradation: Make EVMs and VVPATs resilient to heat and humidity, with battery-independent VVPATs.
2. Law Against Misinformation: Penalise deliberate campaigns that undermine electoral processes.

Conclusion

EVMs remain secure and efficient, as the Supreme Court has affirmed. Wider VVPAT checks, independent audits and better hardware will restore full public trust.

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SCAN

P-II
15(a)

"The Right to Information Act is meant only for providing information but not grievance redressal." Comment.

10

Introduction

The RTI Act, 2005 was enacted against entrenched government secrecy that bred corruption and arbitrariness. It empowers citizens to access information from public authorities. Whether it also covers grievance redressal matters for citizen empowerment; in law, the statement is largely correct.

RTI: Primarily an Information Tool

What RTI Does and Does Not Do

RTI does	RTI does not
Discloses information on time	Redress service grievances
Penalises non-disclosure	Order corrective action
Exposes irregularities (CFMS)	Replace grievance portals, tribunals
Opens way to courts, ombudsmen	Work as a complaint forum

1. Transparency Mandate: Its preamble and wide definitions of information and public authorities aim at timely disclosure so citizens can hold

government accountable.

2. Exposing Irregularities: RTI has helped uncover corruption, as with the Rs 968 crore excess payments found in the CAG audit of Andhra Pradesh's CFMS between 2018 and 2021.

3. Disclosure Machinery: PIOs and Information Commissions settle disputes over access, not complaints about services or decisions.

4. Balanced Exemptions: Section 8(1) balances transparency with privacy and security, protecting sensitive information without undermining the public's right to know.

Why It Is Not a Grievance Forum

1. No Corrective Power: The Act creates a legal right to access information, not a formal system to resolve administrative or service-related disputes or enforce corrective action.

2. Limited Jurisdiction: Commissions can penalise officials for non-disclosure but cannot address service delivery grievances.

3. Misinterpretation: Some authorities and officials mistakenly treat RTI as a grievance forum, which overloads the information machinery, dilutes the Act's effectiveness and leaves

applicants dissatisfied.

Indirect Role in Redress

1. **Gateway to Remedies:** Information lets citizens approach courts, ombudsmen or tribunals; in Andhra Pradesh it helped challenge welfare irregularities.
2. **Clarity and Efficiency:** A focused scope keeps RTI legally enforceable and prevents administrative overload, letting authorities focus on timely and accurate disclosure.
3. **Need for Complements:** Public grievance portals and administrative tribunals must work alongside RTI; if citizens expect redress and get none, their trust in the Act may erode.

Conclusion

Keeping RTI focused on information preserves its clarity of purpose, yet it is a gateway to redress. Strong complementary grievance mechanisms, such as state-level grievance cells working in tandem with RTI, can turn transparency into justice. Information and redress must work as partners, not substitutes, in citizen-centric governance.

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P-II
15(b)

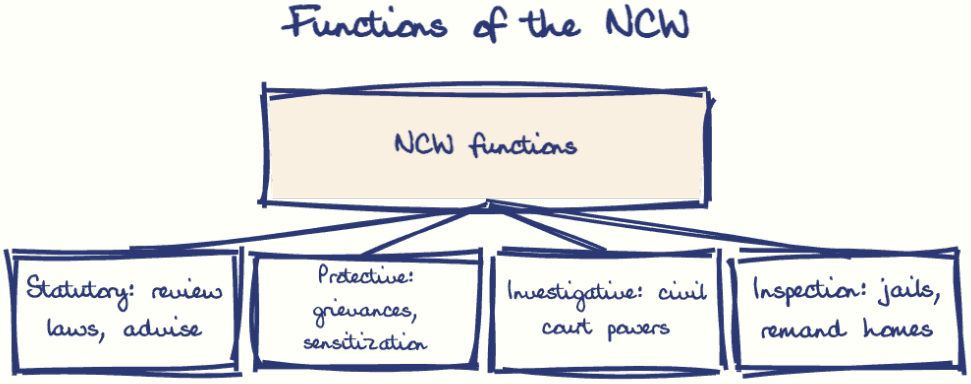
What are the functions of the National Commission for Women ?

10

Introduction

The National Commission for Women (NCW), established in 1992 under the National Commission for Women Act, 1990, is a statutory body that bridges the gap between constitutional guarantees and their implementation. Its role is vital where women face violence, discrimination and socio-economic marginalisation.

Statutory and Advisory Functions



1. **Reviewing Legal Safeguards:** It studies constitutional and legal safeguards for women and recommends amendments to laws that are outdated or have gaps.
2. **Monitoring Implementation:** As a watchdog, it checks whether laws and schemes on women's

safety and welfare are enforced, highlighting female foeticide, trafficking and domestic violence.

3. Advising Governments: It advises central and state governments on policy and new laws for gender equality.
4. Autonomous Composition: A Chairperson, five expert members and a Member Secretary run it, with autonomy over its procedures.

Protective and Investigative Functions

1. Grievance Redressal: It receives complaints and takes suo moto cognizance, supporting victims even where neglect or abuse involves no direct legal violation.
2. Sensitization: It trains police, judiciary and officials to respond better to gender-based violence.
3. Research and Advocacy: It sponsors studies that influence policy and public opinion.
4. Quasi-Judicial Powers: With civil court powers, it summons witnesses, requires documents and examines evidence on oath.
5. Inspection: It inspects jails, remand homes and institutions holding women to protect their rights and dignity.

6. Recommendations after Inquiry: Its investigative reports often lead to legislative or administrative action.

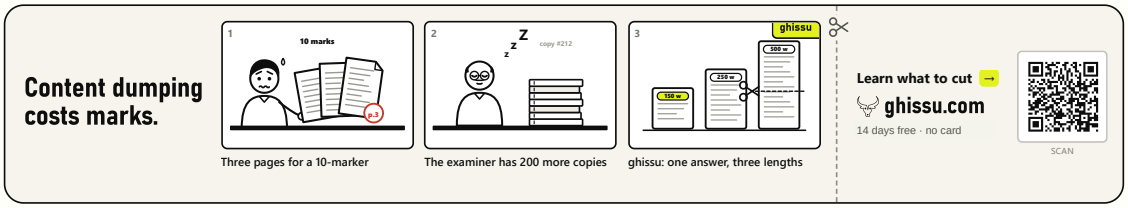
7. Regional Collaboration: In Andhra Pradesh it works with state welfare departments and supports Mission Shakti, which empowers women economically and socially.

Limitations

Limited enforcement authority and dependence on government action to implement its recommendations restrict it; as a statutory body it cannot compel compliance, so critics call it a "toothless tiger".

Conclusion

Through review, monitoring, advice, redressal and inquiry, the NCW is a key guardian of women's rights. Constitutional status, closer state coordination and regular training of police and judiciary would make it more decisive.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2016

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P-II
11(a)

"The Indian constitution is federal in form but unitary in spirit" - Discuss.

10

Introduction

The Constitution, adopted in 1950, is often described as "federal in form but unitary in spirit". This reflects its attempt to balance India's diversity and size with a strong national government. Centre-state debates, like the 2014 bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh and the demand for Special Category Status, keep this dual character relevant.

Federal Features

1. Dual polity: The Union and states have separate jurisdictions under the Seventh Schedule, with their own legislative and executive powers.
2. Written and rigid Constitution: Powers are clearly divided, and amendment needs a special procedure under Article 368.
3. Supremacy of the Constitution: Both levels derive authority from it, and the Supreme Court adjudicates disputes under Articles 245–263.
4. Bicameralism: The Rajya Sabha gives states a voice, though not equal representation.

Federal form, unitary spirit

Federal form	Unitary spirit
Dual polity	Strong Centre, residuary powers
Written, rigid Constitution	Single citizenship
Supremacy of Constitution	Centre's financial dominance
Bicameral legislature	Emergency and Article 356

Unitary Features

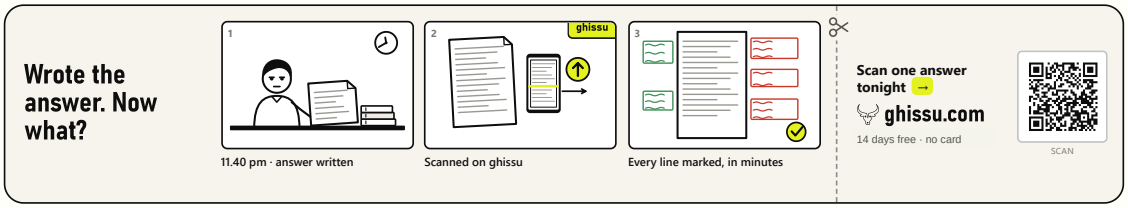
1. Residuary powers: Vested in the Centre under Article 248, with Union law prevailing on the Concurrent List.
2. Single citizenship and indestructible Union: Article 1 makes India a "Union of States" with no right to secede.
3. Financial dominance: The Centre controls major resources, as Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit grants show.
4. Article 356: President's Rule allows direct control, though subject to review in S.R. Bommai.

Interplay of Form and Spirit

1. **Unity and autonomy:** The federal form accommodates diversity while the unitary spirit secures integration, central intervention is often needed in disputes like the Krishna and Godavari waters.
2. **Cooperative federalism:** The Inter-State Council and GST Council let the Centre and states collaborate, reducing tensions from central dominance.
3. **Judicial safeguards:** Kesavananda Bharati made federalism part of the basic structure, though political centralisation persists.
4. **Adaptability:** Dr. Ambedkar noted the Constitution can be federal or unitary as circumstances demand, the 2014 Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act balanced state demands with national interest.

Conclusion

The Constitution is a pragmatic blend: federal in structure, unitary when unity demands. Stronger fiscal federalism can deepen its federal spirit.



P-II
11(b)

Analyze the effectiveness of implementation of the Directive Principles of State Policy and suggest ways to improve it.

10

Introduction

The Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP) in Part IV are non-justiciable guidelines for social, economic and political justice. They have shaped India's welfare policies since independence, yet their implementation remains uneven, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh with persistent socio-economic challenges.

Effectiveness of Implementation

1. Welfare schemes: MGNREGA, ICDS and the Right to Education (Article 21-A) reflect DPSP. ICDS in Andhra Pradesh expanded nutrition coverage for women and children, in line with Article 47.
2. Land reforms and Panchayati Raj: Zamindari abolition and land ceilings, inspired by Articles 39 and 40, redistributed land; the 73rd and 74th Amendments empowered local bodies.
3. Judicial recognition: Kesavananda Bharati and Minerva Mills upheld the harmonious interpretation of Rights and DPSP, and this judicial backing encouraged welfare legislation and executive action.
4. Social justice: Affirmative action and welfare

schemes uplifted SCs, STs and women, though declining female labour force participation shows uneven progress.

DPSP implementation: gains and gaps

Achievements	Shortfalls
MGNREGA, ICDS welfare	Resource, administrative constraints
Land reforms, Panchayati Raj	Incomplete fiscal decentralisation
Judicial harmonisation	Weak political will
Social justice gains	Persistent disparities

Challenges and Gaps

1. Resource and administrative gaps: Limited finances and inefficiency hinder delivery. The Andhra Pradesh CAG (2025) audit found underused funds and poor Anganwadi infrastructure, undermining child nutrition goals.
2. Incomplete decentralisation: Delays in State Finance Commission reports and fund transfers weaken local bodies; in Andhra Pradesh, PRIs lack devolved funds and functions.
3. Political will: Lack of sustained political commitment and public awareness lowers the priority

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of DPSP, while Centre–state conflicts over resources and policy further complicate implementation.

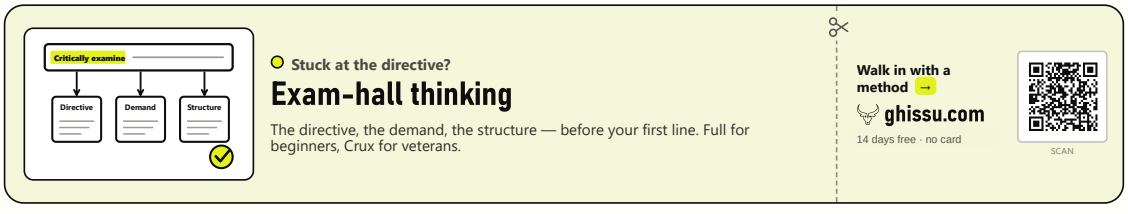
4. Persistent disparities: Rising wealth concentration and regional disparities show that economic democracy remains elusive.

Ways to Improve

1. Fiscal federalism: Timely State Finance Commissions and greater devolution to Panchayats.
2. Administrative capacity: Management Information Systems and regular audits, as CAG recommends.
3. Political commitment: Clear targets and civil society engagement.
4. Justiciable rights: Convert key principles into rights, following the Right to Education.

Conclusion

DPSP have profoundly shaped India's welfare framework, but resource, administrative and political constraints keep their potential unrealised. Fiscal decentralisation, better governance and political will can turn these ideals into outcomes.



P-II
12(a)

What is concept of cooperative federalism? Does it exist in Indian polity?

10

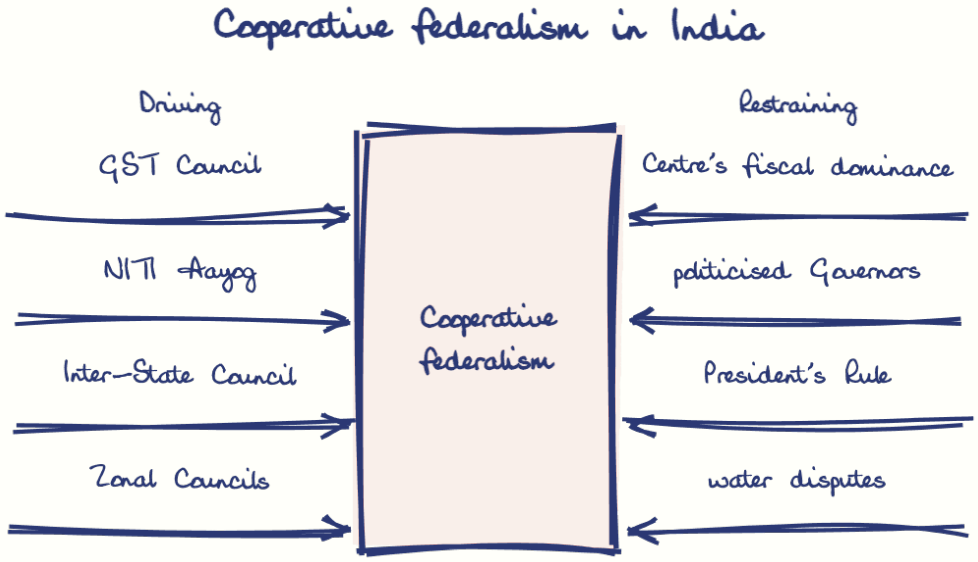
Introduction

Cooperative federalism has gained renewed importance in India after the introduction of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) and the establishment of NITI Aayog. Unlike classical federalism, which stresses independent spheres, it emphasises collaboration and shared governance.

Concept of Cooperative Federalism

1. **Collaborative Governance:** The Centre and states work as partners, sharing responsibilities and resources, unlike K.C. Wheare's classical model of separate jurisdictions.
2. **Constitutional Mechanisms:** Article 263 enables the Inter-State Council, Article 261 mandates full faith and credit across states, and Article 249 lets Parliament legislate on state subjects.
3. **Financial Cooperation:** In the GST Council the Centre and states, including Andhra Pradesh, jointly decide tax rates, symbolising pooled sovereignty. Centrally Sponsored Schemes use conditional grants.
4. **Cooperative Initiatives:** NITI Aayog replaced the

Planning Commission and includes Chief Ministers, the Damodar Valley Project and Polavaram show administrative cooperation.



Does It Exist in Indian Polity?

1. Evidence in Practice: GST needed unprecedented Centre-state collaboration, and the 14th and 15th Finance Commissions increased states' financial autonomy.
2. Institutional Support: The Inter-State Council and Zonal Councils promote dialogue and dispute resolution, and the post-1991 reforms pushed federalism towards cooperation.
3. Centralising Tendencies: Central dominance in finance, politicised Governors, President's Rule and Krishna-Godavari disputes reveal confrontational

federalism.

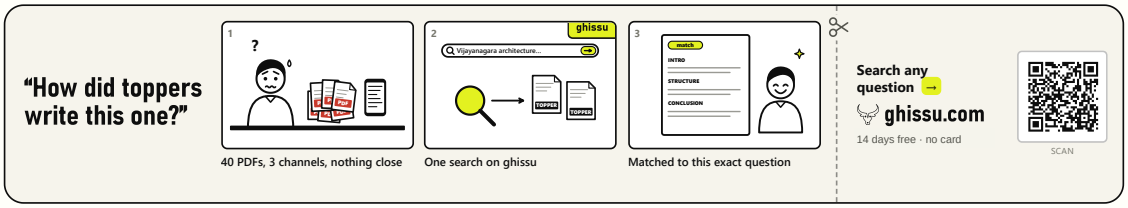
4. Competitive Federalism: States compete for investment, as in Vibrant Gujarat, and for performance-based grants.

Way Forward

1. Stronger Councils: Give the Inter-State Council and GST Council more authority and regular meetings.
2. Fiscal Autonomy: Increase untied grants and reduce conditionalities in CSS so states like Andhra Pradesh can address local priorities.
3. Inclusive Policy-Making: Involve states fully in national policy through NITI Aayog.
4. Dispute Resolution: Set up permanent mechanisms for inter-state resource conflicts to prevent confrontation.

Conclusion

Cooperative federalism in India is a dynamic and evolving reality that balances the Centre's leadership with state autonomy. Practised well, it strengthens democratic governance, fosters national integration and ensures equitable growth across regions.



P-II
12(b)

Comment briefly on the financial relations between the Union and the States in India. What are irritants generally encountered?

10

Introduction

Financial relations between the Union and the States are a cornerstone of Indian federalism, ensuring both levels have resources for their constitutional duties. Persistent fiscal imbalances and demands for state autonomy keep them in focus, especially for Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation.

Framework of Financial Relations

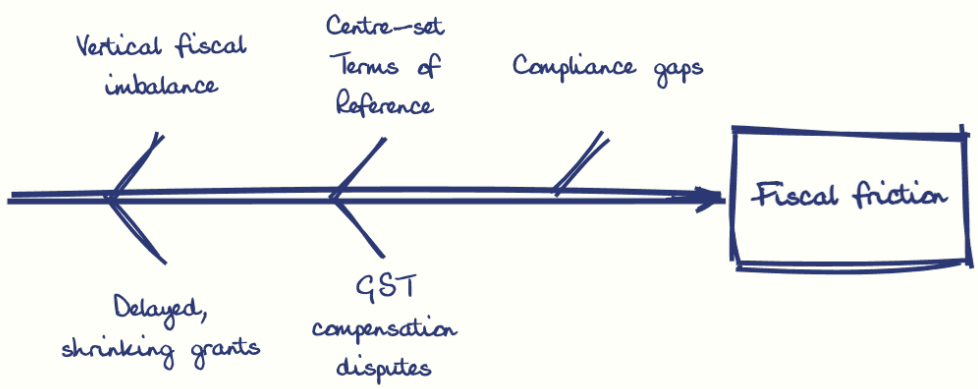
1. **Division of Tax Powers:** The Seventh Schedule gives the Union inter-state and elastic bases like income tax and customs, while States levy stamp duties and excise on liquor.
2. **Finance Commission:** Under Article 280 it recommends sharing of the divisible pool; States' share has risen to about 41%.
3. **Central Transfers:** Tax devolution and grants under Centrally Sponsored and Central Sector Schemes are budgeted at 26.21 lakh crore in 2026–27, and Andhra Pradesh relies heavily on them.
4. **GST Council:** The Centre holds one-third of

the votes in deciding rates and compensation for states' revenue losses under the unified indirect tax regime.

Irritants Generally Encountered

1. Vertical Fiscal Imbalance: States bear larger spending duties with less buoyant taxes, causing dependence, rising debt and revenue deficits, as in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Inadequate, Delayed Grants: Grants fell from 1.95 lakh crore in 2015–16 to 1.65 lakh crore in 2023–24, intensifying stress.
3. Terms of Reference: Set by the Centre, they rely on outdated population data.
4. GST Compensation and Compliance: States demand timely compensation; Andhra Pradesh's CAG audit found a 1,806 crore revenue impact.

Irritants in Union–State finance



Way Forward

1. More State Taxes: Transfer stamp duties and excise on medicinal and toilet preparations to states.
2. Finance Commission Reform: Include state representatives and update the ToR.
3. Federal GST Council: Raise states' voting power and pay compensation on time to maintain trust.
4. Compliance: States like Andhra Pradesh should use technology and audit findings to plug revenue leakages.

Conclusion

Balanced fiscal federalism needs adequate, predictable transfers and stronger own revenues for states, so that they can meet their responsibilities with genuine autonomy.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

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SCAN

P-II
13(a)

What is meant by "judicial activism"? What is its impact on Indian polity?

10

Introduction

Judicial activism has been a major feature of the Indian judiciary since the 1970s. It reflects a proactive stance in protecting citizens' rights and delivering justice where the legislature or executive falters, a role made more relevant by legislative inaction and executive overreach.

Meaning of Judicial Activism

1. Proactive role: Courts interpret laws and the Constitution assertively to protect rights and promote social justice, enforcing constitutional duties on other branches.
2. Departure from restraint: Unlike judicial restraint, it favours progressive interpretation, as in Maneka Gandhi (1978), which expanded Article 21.
3. Judicial law-making: Courts fill legislative gaps, as with the Vishaka Guidelines (1997) on sexual harassment, later codified into law.
4. Instrument of social change: It addresses environmental protection, gender justice and transparency, in Shayara Bano (2017), the Court abolished triple talaq.

Impact on Indian Polity

Impact of Judicial Activism

Gains	Concerns
Stronger Articles 14, 19, 21	Overreach into legislative domain
Fills gaps (Vishaka, climate)	Strains separation of powers
Checks arbitrary executive action	Risk of judicial populism

1. Strengthening rights: It has reinforced Articles (14), (19) and (21) so that executive or legislative lapses do not violate liberties, ADR v. Union of India (2024) advanced electoral transparency.
2. Filling governance gaps: In M.K. Ranjitsinh (2024), the Court made the government responsible for addressing climate change.
3. Check on the executive: It curbs arbitrary executive action, preserving democratic accountability in a federal polity where executive excesses can upset the constitutional balance.
4. Judicial overreach: Courts sometimes encroach on legislative and executive domains, as in the National Anthem directive (Shyam Narayan Chouksey), straining separation of powers.

5. Mixed outcomes: Gains in rights and accountability come with risks of judicial populism and strain on Centre–State relations.

Way Forward

1. Accountability: A National Judicial Council, as the Law Commission's 195th Report proposed, without compromising independence.
2. Restraint: Courts should defer in areas of legislative or executive expertise, preserving separation of powers.
3. Responsive branches: Timely legislative and executive action on social issues would reduce over-dependence on courts.

Conclusion

Judicial activism has deepened rights and accountability in Indian polity and acted as an instrument of social change, but it must be balanced by judicial restraint and responsive legislatures to preserve democratic governance.

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SCAN

P-II
13(b)

What is the relative position of the Rajya Sabha as compared to the Lok Sabha in our political system?

10

Introduction

The Rajya Sabha, the Upper House of Parliament, has faced debate since its inception in 1952 over its relevance relative to the directly elected Lok Sabha. Designed to represent states and act as a revising chamber, it is praised for its federal role but criticised for democratic deficits and legislative delays.

Constitutional and Legal Status

1. **Distinct foundations:** The Rajya Sabha is a permanent body of up to 250 members, including 12 nominated by the President, while the Lok Sabha has up to 552 members directly elected for five years and subject to dissolution (Articles 80 and 81).
2. **Indirect vs direct election:** Rajya Sabha members are elected by state legislative assemblies through proportional representation, while Lok Sabha members come from territorial constituencies, making it the forum for government formation.
3. **Continuity:** Staggered six-year terms, with

one-third retiring every two years, give the Rajya Sabha stability during political upheavals.

Comparison of Powers and Functions

Rajya Sabha vs Lok Sabha

Rajya Sabha	Lok Sabha
Permanent, up to 250 members	Dissolvable, up to 552 members
Elected by state MLAs	Directly elected by people
Equal on ordinary bills	Equal on ordinary bills
Only recommends on money bills	Final say on money bills
Articles 249 and 312 powers	Ministers answer only here

1. Equal legislative powers: Both Houses equally introduce, amend and pass ordinary and constitutional amendment bills (Article 107), preventing hasty legislation.
2. Financial supremacy of Lok Sabha: It alone introduces and finally approves money bills; the Rajya Sabha can only recommend.
3. Special powers of Rajya Sabha: It alone can authorise Parliament to legislate on state subjects by a two-thirds resolution (Article 249) and create All India Services

(Article 312).

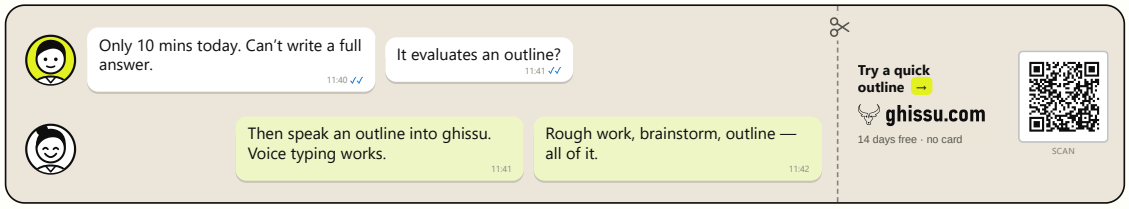
4. Executive accountability: Ministers answer only to the Lok Sabha through the no-confidence motion, though the Rajya Sabha shares in electing and impeaching the President and in electing and removing the Vice-President.

Practical Implications

1. Legislative gridlock: Its power to delay non-money bills can stall governance when the ruling party lacks an Upper House majority.
2. Federal dialogue: Andhra Pradesh's demands for Special Category Status and the Polavaram project have been voiced there.
3. Expertise: Members like Dr. Manmohan Singh have enriched legislative scrutiny.

Conclusion

The Rajya Sabha is subordinate to the Lok Sabha in finance and executive control but equal in ordinary law-making, making it a vital federal and deliberative chamber.



P-II
14(a)

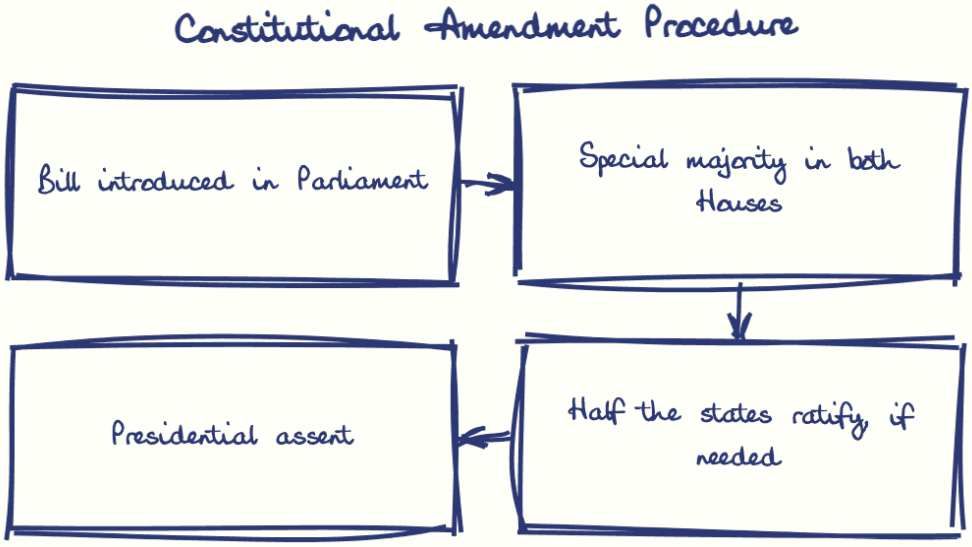
Describe the procedure for amending the constitution? What is the criticism against it?

10

Introduction

The amendment procedure keeps the Constitution relevant to changing political, social and economic needs. Since 1950 it has been amended over a hundred times through Article 368, which balances rigidity with flexibility but is criticised for gaps on federalism and legislative checks.

Procedure for Amendment



1. **Initiation:** A bill can be introduced only in Parliament, in either House, by a minister or private member, without the President's prior permission.

2. **Special majority:** Each House must pass it by

a majority of total membership and two-thirds present and voting, there is no joint sitting.

3. State ratification: Amendments to federal features, such as the election of the President, Union-state legislative powers or the courts, need ratification by half the state legislatures, with no time limit.

4. Presidential assent: The President cannot withhold or return the bill.

The Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) affirmed that the process preserves core principles.

Criticism

1. No special amending body: Unlike the US Constitutional Convention, only Parliament amends, raising concerns of Union dominance.

2. Limited role of states: States cannot initiate amendments, except resolutions on legislative councils, and only half the states must ratify, unlike three-fourths in the US.

3. No time frame: Indefinite ratification delays cause uncertainty.

4. No joint sitting: Deadlocks between the Houses can stall reform.

5. Sketchy provisions: Brief rules invite controversy, as with the 42nd Amendment 's attempt to curtail judicial review.

Way Forward

An independent Constitutional Amendment Commission with state representatives could build broader consensus, and a fixed period for state ratification of federal amendments would end uncertainty. Public and state consultation through parliamentary committees before major amendments would widen participation.

Conclusion

Article 368 keeps the Constitution adaptable, but stronger state participation and clearer procedure would deepen federal consensus.

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SCAN

P-II
14(b)

What according to the Supreme Court constitutes "the basic structure" of our constitution? Please name a couple of important judgements of the Supreme Court on this issue?

10

Introduction

The doctrine of the "basic structure" emerged as a judicial safeguard against misuse of Parliament's amending power under ~~Article~~ 368. In Kesavananda Bharati (1973), the Supreme Court held that Parliament can amend most of the Constitution but cannot alter its essential framework.

What Constitutes the Basic Structure

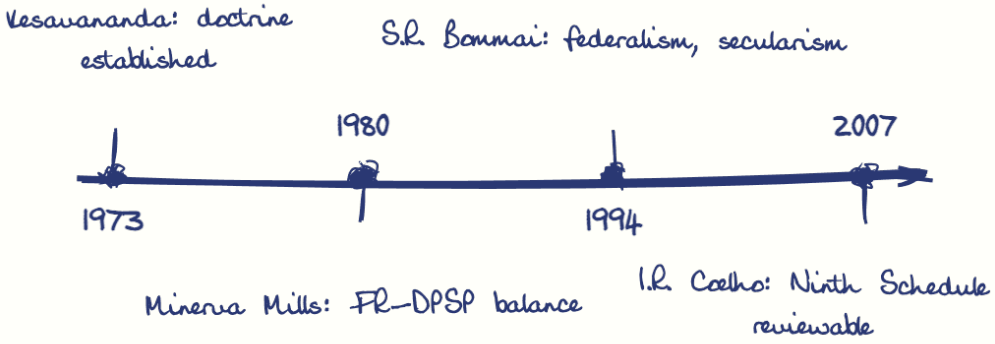
1. Core framework: Supremacy of the Constitution, republican and democratic governance, secularism, federalism, separation of powers, and the unity and integrity of the nation.
2. Further elements: Judicial review, rule of law, independence of the judiciary, the parliamentary system, fundamental rights and socio-economic justice.
3. Judiciary as guardian: The Supreme Court can invalidate amendments that threaten the Constitution's identity, a judicial veto protecting constitutional morality.
4. No exhaustive list: The Court decides contextually

in each case, which gives flexibility but creates uncertainty.

Important Judgements

1. Kesavananda Bharati (1973): A 13-judge bench established the doctrine and limited the amending power.
2. Minerva Mills (1980): The balance between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles is part of the basic structure.
3. S.R. Bommai (1994): Emphasised federalism and secularism.
4. I.R. Coelho (2007): Upheld judicial review over laws placed in the Ninth Schedule.

Evolution of the basic structure doctrine



Practical Significance

1. Amendment without erosion: The doctrine does not

freeze the Constitution, it allows transformative change while protecting foundations.

2. Federal relevance: For Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation, it safeguards the Union's integrity and state interests.

3. Backlog: Around 1.82 lakh pending cases can delay constitutional adjudication.

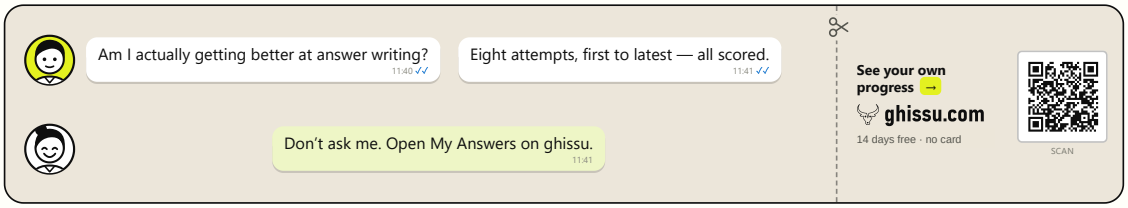
Way Forward

1. Clearer guidelines: A more precise framework would reduce ambiguity and make amendments more predictable.

2. Judicial capacity: Fill vacancies, including in Andhra Pradesh High Courts.

Conclusion

The basic structure doctrine is the bedrock that preserves India's democratic, secular and federal identity against arbitrary amendments, while keeping the Constitution a living document.



P-II
15(a)

Describe the various special provisions in the constitution relating to scheduled castes, scheduled tribes, backward classes and Anglo-Indians.

10

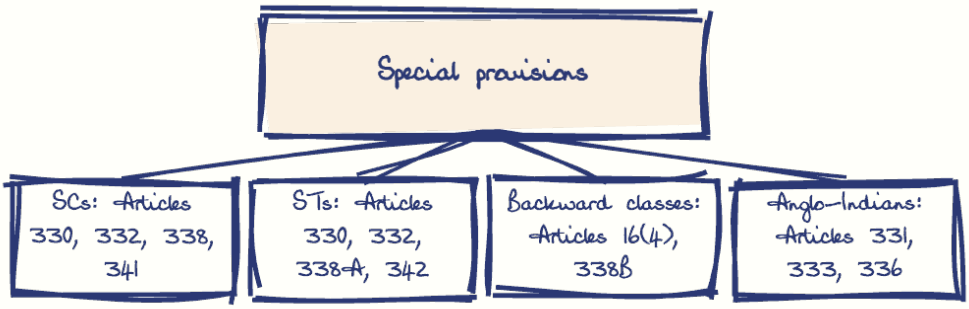
Introduction

The Constitution makes special provisions for SCs, STs, Backward Classes and Anglo-Indians to promote social justice as mandated by the Preamble. Contained mainly in Part XVI (Articles 330 to 342-A), they protect these historically disadvantaged groups and aid their development.

Scheduled Castes

1. **Legislative reservation:** Articles 330 and 332 reserve seats in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies in proportion to population.
2. **Services:** Article 335 requires their claims to posts to be considered.
3. **Specification:** Under Article 341 the President specifies SCs after consulting the Governor; changes need Parliament.
4. **Commission:** Article 338 sets up the National Commission for Scheduled Castes to monitor safeguards.

Special provisions at a glance



Scheduled Tribes

1. **Reservation:** Articles 330, 332 and 335 give STs seats and service benefits.
2. **Specification:** Article 342 lets the President specify STs, with Parliament approving changes.
3. **Commission:** Article 338A creates the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes, covering tribal areas of Andhra Pradesh.

Backward Classes

1. **Article 16(4):** Allows reservation for backward classes not adequately represented, the basis of OBC quotas.
2. **102nd Amendment, 2018:** The President specifies socially and educationally backward classes.
3. **Commission:** Article 338B establishes the National Commission for Backward Classes.

4. Identification challenge: Unlike SCs and STs, backward classes have no fixed schedule, so commissions like Kalelkar and the Backward Classes Commission collected socio-economic data.

Anglo-Indians

1. Representation: Anglo-Indians, persons of European descent domiciled in India, could be nominated to the Lok Sabha and Assemblies under Articles 331 and 333.
2. Special provisions: Articles 336 and 337 provided further special provisions for the community in services and education.

Conclusion

Together these provisions combine political representation, reservation in services, constitutional identification and monitoring commissions. They remain vital to address persistent inequalities, including in Andhra Pradesh, through affirmative action and welfare.

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P-II
15(b)

Explain the concept of minorities with reference to the Indian constitution and the safeguards available for protection of their rights.

10

Introduction

In a diverse democracy where many religious, linguistic and cultural groups coexist, the Constitution recognises minorities mainly through religious and linguistic identity. Their safeguards prevent majoritarian dominance and ensure social harmony.

Concept of Minorities

1. Identification: "Minority" is not defined in the Constitution, the National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992 notifies Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Parsis and Jains.
2. State-level determination: In T.M.A. Pai Foundation, the Supreme Court held that minority status is decided at state level, not nationally.

Constitutional Safeguards

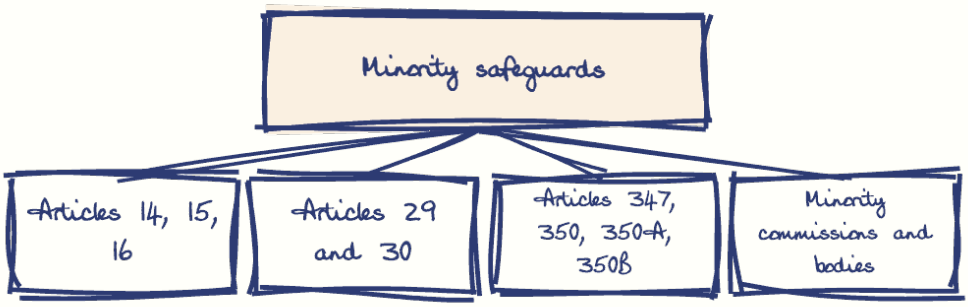
1. Equality: Articles 14, 15 and 16 prohibit discrimination on grounds including religion and language.
2. Cultural and educational rights: Articles 29 and 30 let minorities conserve language, script and culture and run educational institutions of their

choice.

3. Linguistic minorities: Articles 347, 350, 350-A and 350B allow grievances in their language, mother-tongue primary instruction and a Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities.

4. Institutions: The National Commission for Minorities, the National Commission for Minority Educational Institutions and the National Minorities Development Finance Corporation.

Constitutional safeguards for minorities



Challenges

1. State variations: Muslims are a minority nationally, but Hindus are a minority in Jammu and Kashmir.

2. Autonomy versus justice: Exemption from reservations has sparked demands for Dalit quotas in institutions like Jamia Millia Islamia.

3. Exclusion: Non-Hindu Dalits are excluded from

SC status under Article 341, limiting their access to affirmative action benefits.

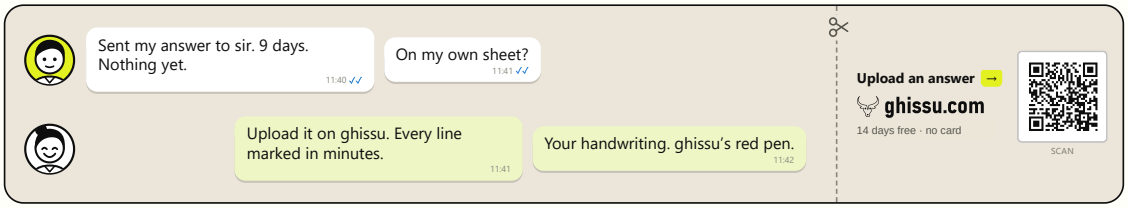
4. Appeasement charge: Safeguards are sometimes seen as anti-secular, so they must foster security without privileging minorities politically.

Way Forward

1. State monitoring: Strengthen Special Officers and state commissions for local implementation.
2. Inclusive policy: Address intra-minority inequalities, balancing autonomy with social justice.
3. Legal literacy and dialogue: Awareness of rights and inter-community dialogue reduce mistrust.

Conclusion

These safeguards are foundational to India's democratic and secular ethos. Effectively implemented, they sustain "Unity in Diversity".



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2012

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P-II
11(a)

Explain the Right to Equality guaranteed under the Constitution of India in the light of the doctrine of reasonable classification.

Introduction

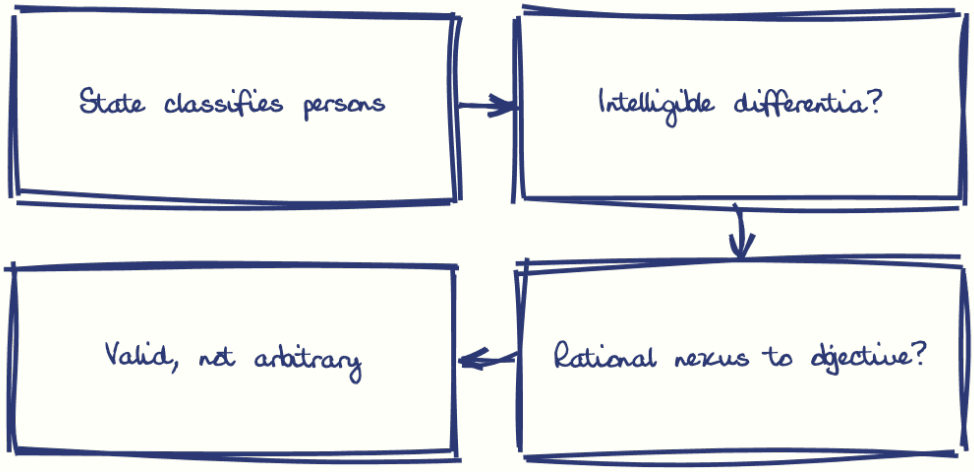
The Right to Equality, in Articles 14 to 18, ensures all are equal before the law and prohibits arbitrary discrimination. The judicially developed doctrine of reasonable classification reconciles equality with the practical need to treat unequals differently, vital in a diverse society.

Right to Equality under the Constitution

1. **Article 14:** Guarantees equality before law and equal protection of laws, so no one is above the law and like cases are treated alike.
2. **Articles 15 and 16:** Prohibit discrimination on grounds such as religion, caste, sex or place of birth and ensure equal access to public employment.
3. **Special provisions:** Articles 15(4) and 16(4) permit reservations for socially and educationally backward classes, SCs and STs, to secure substantive equality.
4. **Sub-classification:** The Supreme Court now permits states to sub-classify SCs and STs by backwardness, relevant for Andhra Pradesh's

regional disparities.

Test of reasonable classification



Doctrine of Reasonable Classification

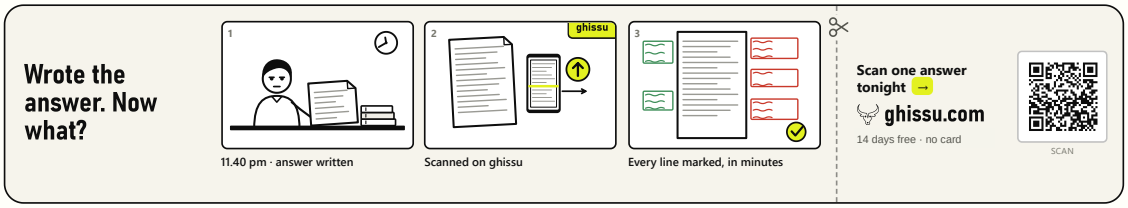
1. Twin test: Classification must rest on an intelligible differentia and bear a rational nexus to the objective.
2. Judicial tests: It must include all similarly situated persons and serve a legitimate interest like social justice.
3. Affirmative action: M. Nagaraj (2006) required quantifiable data to justify reservations, balancing equality with efficiency.
4. Andhra Pradesh: Reservations address backwardness in Rayalaseema and tribal areas without violating Article 14.

Interrelation

1. Balancing uniformity and diversity: The doctrine lets the State treat unequals differently and enact social justice laws without breaching the equality clause.
2. Preventing arbitrariness: Classification must rest on objective criteria and a legitimate purpose, not whim.
3. Judicial safeguard: Courts scrutinise classifications to prevent misuse of power, balancing affirmative action against arbitrary discrimination.

Conclusion

Reasonable classification is not an exception to equality but the instrument through which Article (14) achieves real equality. It enables affirmative action for the disadvantaged, while courts ensure that differential treatment never becomes arbitrary.



P-II
11(b)

Analyse the concept and importance of Directive Principles of State Policy. Explain the relationship and difference between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles.

Introduction

The Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP), in Part IV, guide the state to build a just social, economic and political order. Fundamental Rights guarantee enforceable freedoms, while DPSPs embody the state's positive duties of welfare.

Concept of DPSP

1. Constitutional foundation: Articles (36) to (51) are non-justiciable guidelines reflecting the Preamble's ideals.
2. Positive obligations: Securing livelihood, equitable distribution and protection of weaker sections, towards a welfare state.
3. Socio-economic vision: Free legal aid, workers' rights, environment and a uniform civil code, creating economic democracy, as M.V. Pylee noted.
4. Moral force: Though not enforceable, Article (37) makes them fundamental in governance, as in Andhra Pradesh's Housing for All and Mission Indradhanush.

Importance

1. Policy continuity: They give a stable framework that guides reforms across political changes, as in Andhra Pradesh's welfare schemes.
2. Complementing rights: They reduce socio-economic inequality so rights like equality and dignity become meaningful.
3. Accountability: A benchmark for judging governments, empowering citizens and opposition parties to demand welfare governance.

Fundamental Rights vs Directive Principles

Fundamental Rights	Directive Principles
Justiciability	Non-justiciability
Negative obligations on state	Positive obligations on state
Enforceable by courts	Moral and political guidelines
Political democracy	Economic and social democracy

Relationship

1. Organic unit: Part III protects individual liberty and Part IV guides welfare policy; they work together, as recognised in Kesavananda Bharati.

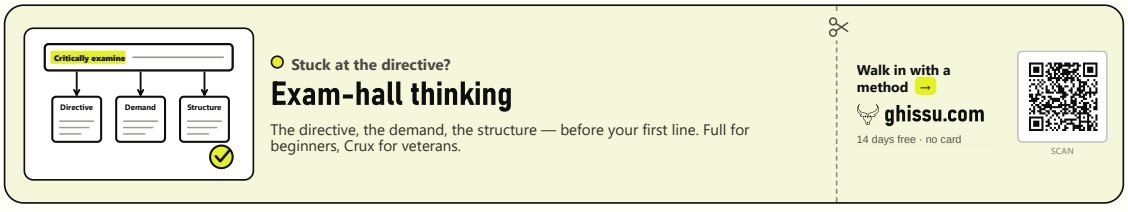
2. From conflict to balance: Champakam Dorairajan (1951) prioritised Rights, but Minerva Mills (1980) made their balance part of the basic structure.

3. Nature of obligations: Rights are prohibitive duties on the state, DPSPs are affirmative duties to act for social justice, so they are complementary.

4. Implementation: Rights are enforced through writs, while DPSPs need legislation and political will

Conclusion

Rights and Directive Principles are complementary, not contradictory: one secures political democracy, the other builds the social and economic democracy that sustains it.



P-II
12(a)

Discuss the administrative relations between the Union and the States. How are the Inter State Water Disputes resolved in India?

Introduction

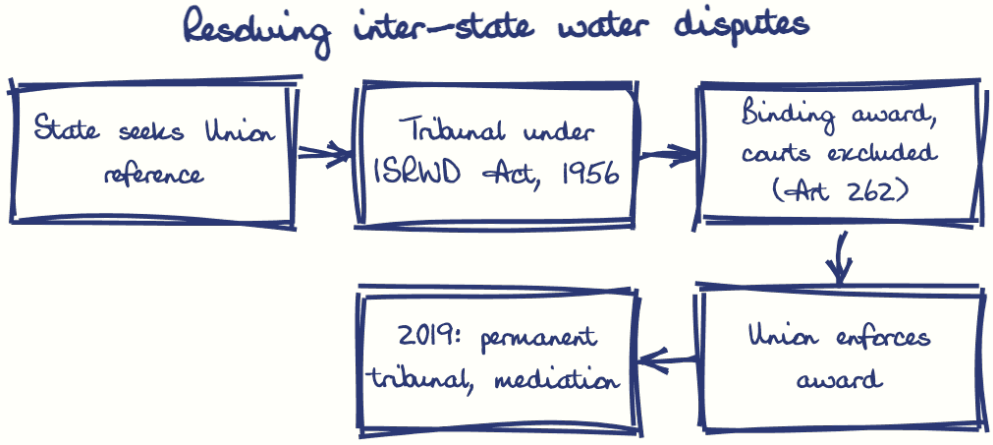
Administrative relations between the Union and the States are crucial for federal balance and cooperative governance. They are tested most by shared resources like interstate rivers, where prolonged conflicts such as the Cauvery and Krishna disputes affect regional development and harmony.

Union–State Administrative Relations

1. Federal Division of Powers: The Union regulates interstate rivers in the public interest under Entry (56), List I, while States manage water within their boundaries under Entry (17), List II.
2. Cooperative yet Conflictual: States retain control over water use and resist central intervention, producing conflictual federalism.
3. Inter-State and Zonal Councils: They aid coordination but lack binding authority.
4. Andhra Pradesh Context: The (2014) bifurcation and Krishna water disputes with Karnataka show how politics and resource sharing intersect.

Resolving Inter-State Water Disputes

1. Article 262: Parliament can provide for adjudication and exclude Supreme Court jurisdiction.
2. ISRWD Act 1956: States may ask the Union to refer disputes to tribunals of Supreme Court judges, whose binding awards exclude other courts.
3. River Boards Act 1956: It allows advisory boards for interstate rivers, though seldom used.
4. 2019 Amendments: They sought permanent tribunals with fixed timelines and mediation committees, since the Cauvery Tribunal took (17) years.



Challenges

1. Delays: Complex data, politics and adversarial processes stretch disputes over decades.

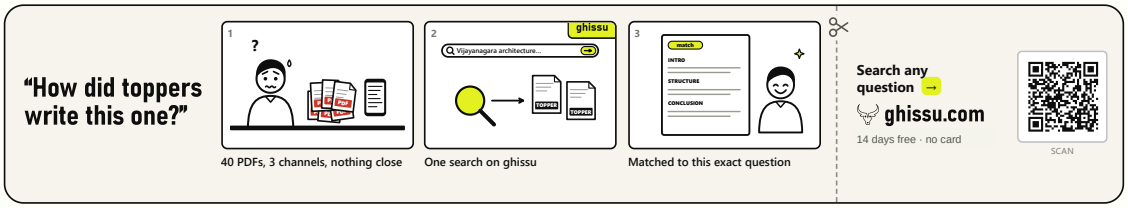
2. Data Deficiency: No mutually accepted water data exists.
3. Weak Enforcement: Awards depend on the Union's political will.
4. Positive Signs: The Mahanadi tribunal uses Jal Shakti and the Central Water Commission for mediation.

Way Forward

1. Basin Governance: Integrated river basin authorities with Union–State shared planning.
2. Data Infrastructure: A transparent water data system acceptable to all states.
3. Empowered Tribunals: Stronger enforcement powers and fixed timelines.

Conclusion

Cooperative Union–State relations, supported by these reforms, can turn water from a source of conflict into shared development.



P-II
12(b)

Discuss the powers and functions of the Election Commission of India and explain its role in protection of representative democracy in India.

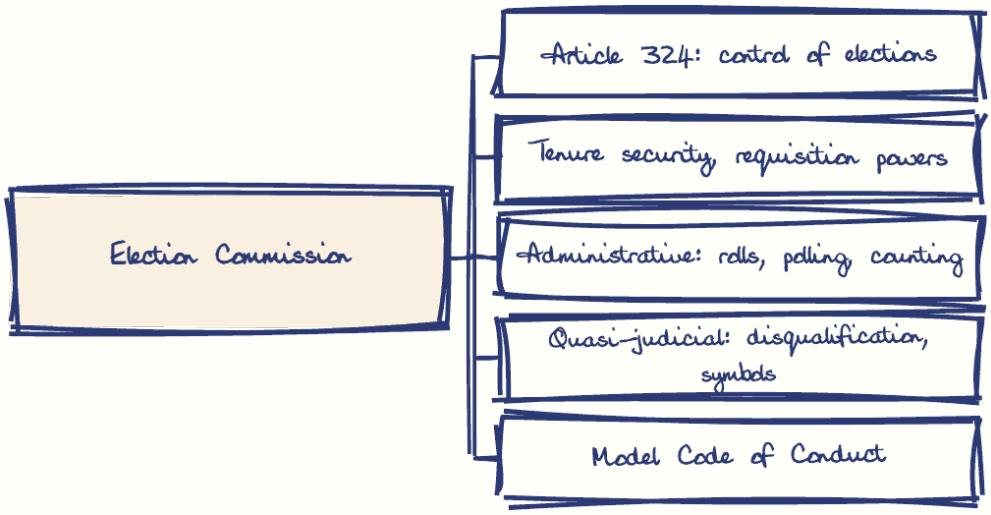
Introduction

The Election Commission of India (ECI), established under Article 324, is a cornerstone of representative democracy. Amid rising electoral complexity, technology and malpractices, its powers and functions ensure free, fair and transparent elections that give governments legitimacy.

Powers of the ECI

1. Supreme Authority: Superintendence, direction and control of elections to Parliament, State Legislatures and the offices of President and Vice-President.
2. Independence: The CEC enjoys tenure security like a Supreme Court judge, a principle stressed by B.R. Ambedkar.
3. Requisition and Discipline: It can requisition government personnel and act against negligent officials.
4. Limitations: It cannot deregister parties or exercise contempt powers.

Powers and functions of the ECI



Functions of the ECI

1. Administrative: Updating electoral rolls, conducting the full election process and appointing Chief Electoral Officers and Returning Officers.
2. Advisory and Quasi-Judicial: Its advice on disqualification of MPs and MLAs under Articles (103) and (192) is binding, it settles recognition and symbol disputes.
3. Model Code of Conduct: It enforces the MCC for a level playing field, upheld in Union of India vs. Harbans Singh Jalal (2001).
4. Reforms: EPIC, EVMs and VVPAT raised confidence, in (2019) no VVPAT-EVM mismatch occurred.

Role in Protecting Representative Democracy

1. **Free and Fair Elections:** Impartial supervision upholds political equality and prevents fraud.
2. **Inclusive Participation:** SVEEP and National Voters' Day including in Andhra Pradesh, raise awareness and turnout.
3. **Democratic Legitimacy:** Binding disqualification advice and power to cancel rigged polls protect integrity.
4. **Accountability:** Allegations of partisanship have prompted calls for reform by the Law Commission and the Tarkunde Committee.

Way Forward

1. **Legal Powers:** Allow deregistration of parties and stricter penalties.
2. **Appointments:** A transparent, bipartisan selection mechanism.

Conclusion

The ECI is the guardian of India's representative democracy. Stronger powers and independence will keep elections credible.

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P-II
13(a)

Explain the privileges and immunities of legislature under the Constitution of India. How far can the judiciary interfere with such privileges and immunities?

Introduction

The privileges and immunities of the legislature safeguard its independence and let legislators work without undue interference. Yet they are not absolute: the judiciary can scrutinise legislative action where fundamental rights or constitutional provisions are at stake, balancing autonomy with constitutionalism.

Privileges and Immunities

1. Freedom of speech: Article 105(2) gives members absolute freedom of speech in the House, protecting them from legal action for statements or votes.

2. Immunity from civil arrest: Members cannot be arrested in civil cases during and around sessions, but this does not extend to criminal cases (K. Anandan Nambiar, 1951).

3. Regulating proceedings: Each House regulates its procedure, excludes strangers and punishes breach of privilege or contempt.

4. Protection of internal proceedings: Articles (122) and (212) bar courts from questioning

proceedings on grounds of procedural irregularity.

Constitutional Basis

1. Articles 105 and 194: These cover Parliament and state legislatures and allow privileges to be defined by law, though they remain uncodified.
2. Limits under fundamental rights: Privileges cannot override Articles (20) and (21) of the Constitution.

Extent of Judicial Interference

Where Courts Defer and Where They Intervene

Courts defer	Courts intervene
Speech and votes in House	Bribery (Sita Soren, 2024)
Procedural irregularity (Articles 122, 212)	Violation of fundamental rights
House regulating its procedure	Action exceeding constitutional authority
Merits of expulsion and contempt	Habeas corpus pleas heard

1. No immunity for crime: The PV Narasimha Rao case (1998) protected speech but not bribery; in Sita Soren (2024) the Court held legislators accused of bribery cannot claim

immunity. The Kerala MLAs case (2021) excluded vandalism too.

2. Beyond procedure: Courts intervene if an action violates fundamental rights or exceeds constitutional authority (Raja Ram Pal, 2007).

3. Two-fold test: Courts examine whether a privilege is linked to the House's collective functioning and necessary for its duties.

4. Expulsion and contempt: Courts can hear habeas corpus petitions but generally defer to the legislature on merits.

Way Forward

Parliament should codify privileges to enhance transparency, and an independent commission, like the UK's Committee on Standards, could review privilege claims impartially.

Conclusion

The judiciary respects legislative privileges but will not let them shield crime or violate rights, preserving a balance between autonomy and constitutionalism.

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P-II
13(b)

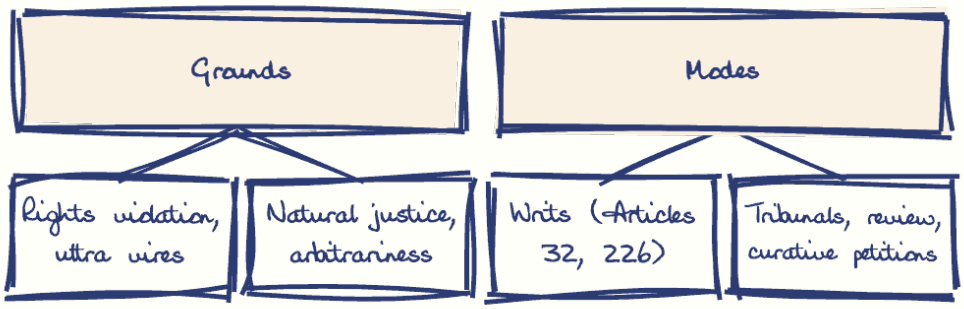
Discuss the grounds on which administrative action may be reviewed by the judiciary, and the various modes of such judicial review.

Introduction

Judicial review of administrative action ensures that executive decisions conform to the Constitution and law. Though not named in the Constitution, it flows from Articles 32, 136, 226 and 227, which empower the Supreme Court and High Courts to check administrative excesses and protect the rule of law.

Grounds of Judicial Review

Judicial Review of Administrative Action



1. Violation of fundamental rights: Actions infringing Part III rights, such as equality (Article 14) or life and liberty (Article 21), can be reviewed; the Sabarimala case tested administrative orders against constitutional morality.

2. Excess or lack of jurisdiction: Courts check whether an authority acted ultra vires or failed to exercise its power, without reappraising facts, as in State of W.B. v. Shivananda Pathak.

3. Breach of natural justice: Denial of a fair hearing or biased decision-making makes an action liable to be quashed.

4. Arbitrariness and unreasonableness: Under Article 14, irrational or disproportionate action can be struck down; E.P. Royappa held that arbitrariness violates equality.

Modes of Judicial Review

1. Writ jurisdiction: Certiorari quashes illegal orders, mandamus compels duty, prohibition prevents excess jurisdiction, habeas corpus protects liberty and quo warranto questions authority.

2. Articles 32 and 226: Courts directly hear petitions against administrative action that violates rights or legal provisions; High Courts under Article 226 are especially accessible to citizens in Andhra Pradesh.

3. Statutory appeals and tribunals: Tribunals under the Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985,

decide disputes such as service matters.

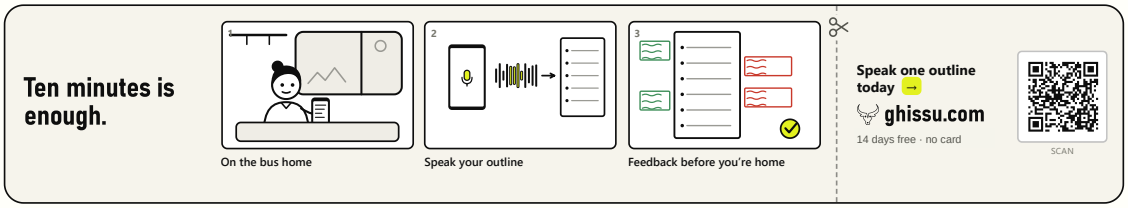
4. Review and curative petitions: The Supreme Court can review its judgments under Article 137 and hear curative petitions, as in Rupa Ashok Hurra v. Ashok Hurra.

Way Forward

1. Capacity: Technology and more manpower in courts and tribunals can reduce pendency.
2. Awareness and mediation: Legal awareness and alternative dispute resolution can speed remedies.
3. Restraint: Courts must balance activism with judicial restraint to respect the separation of powers.

Conclusion

Judicial review of administrative action upholds constitutional supremacy, protects fundamental rights and ensures accountable governance under the rule of law.



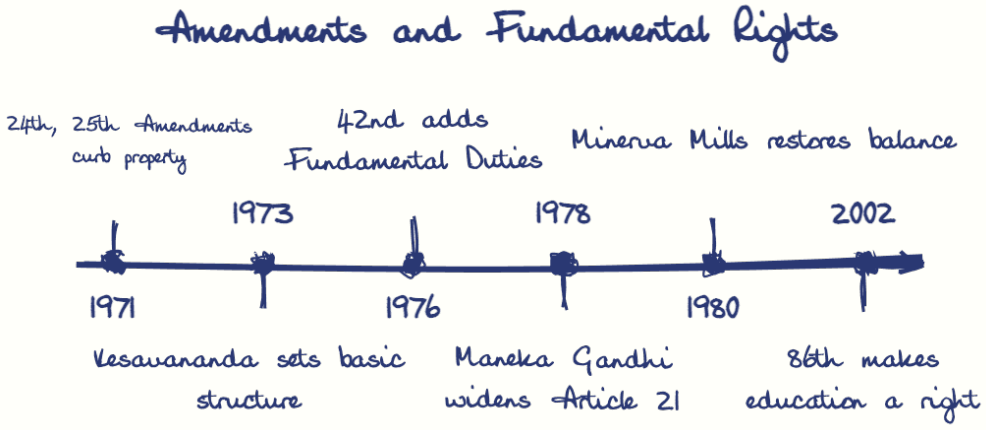
P-II
14(a)

Analyse the Constitutional Amendments made so far in relation to the Fundamental Rights guaranteed under Part III of the Constitution.

Introduction

Constitutional amendments have shaped the scope and enforcement of Fundamental Rights under Part III. Over a hundred amendments since 1950 reflect the need to balance individual liberty with social progress, while the Basic Structure Doctrine from Kesavananda Bharati has limited Parliament's power to amend these rights.

Nature of Amendments Affecting Fundamental Rights



1. Restrictive amendments for social goals: The 24th and 25th Amendments (1971) empowered Parliament to amend rights to implement Directive Principles, enabling land reforms but curtailing property rights under Article 31.

2. Balancing rights and principles: The 25th Amendment let laws implementing Directive Principles override certain rights, reflecting a shift from individual rights towards public welfare and social equity.
3. Expansion of rights: The 86th Amendment (2002) turned free education (Article 45) into a Fundamental Right under Article 21-A.
4. Indirect influence: The 42nd Amendment (1976) added Fundamental Duties and expanded Directive Principles, affecting how rights are enforced.

Judicial Response

1. Kesavananda Bharati (1973): The Basic Structure Doctrine prevents amendments that destroy the essence of Fundamental Rights.
2. Minerva Mills (1980): The Court struck down provisions that excessively subordinated rights to Directive Principles, reaffirming balance.
3. Maneka Gandhi (1978): Article 21 was expanded to include dignity and fair procedure, so rights evolved in substance, not just form.
4. Ninth Schedule: Attempts to place laws there to shield them from judicial review are scrutinised

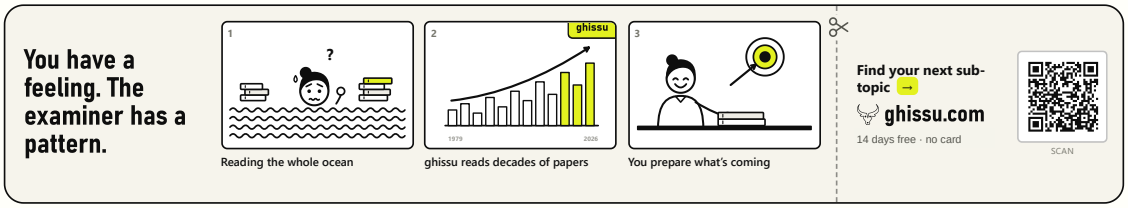
under the doctrine.

Implications

1. **Social justice:** Amendments enabled affirmative action and welfare, strengthening equality.
2. **Risk of dilution:** Amendments curbing speech or property rights raised concerns, which judicial review has tempered so that rights are not unduly compromised.
3. **Article 32:** The Supreme Court's power to enforce Fundamental Rights remains the key safeguard against unconstitutional amendments.

Conclusion

Amendments have both expanded and restricted Fundamental Rights, but judicial review ensures their core remains inviolable, keeping the Constitution a living document that adapts without compromising its core values.



P-II
14(b)

Write a critical note on the Emergency Powers under the Constitution and their misuses, if any.

Introduction

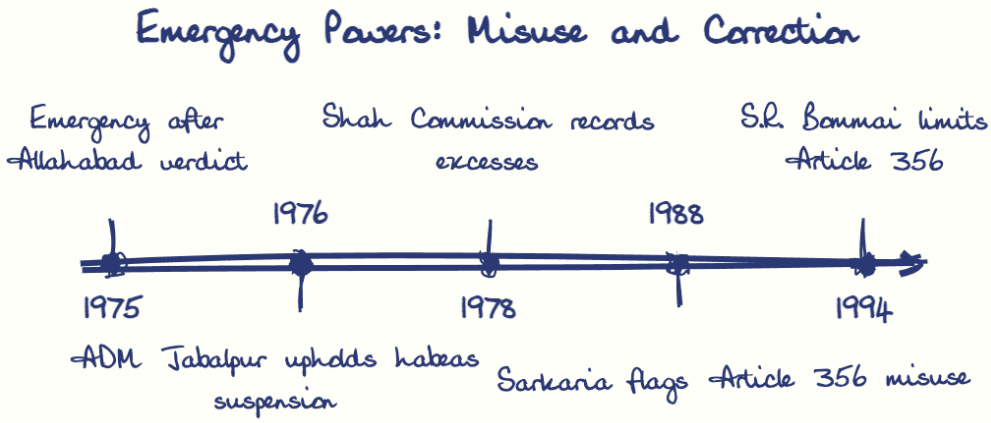
Emergency powers in Part XVIII (Articles 352 to 360) are extraordinary provisions that let the Centre assume greater control during war, external aggression, internal disturbance or financial instability. Their invocation, notably in 1975, has sparked intense debate over constitutional morality, federal balance and civil liberties.

Constitutional Framework

1. Three types: National Emergency (Article 352), State Emergency or President's Rule (Article 356), and Financial Emergency (Article 360) let the Centre override normal federal arrangements.
2. Unitary shift: During a National Emergency, Article 19 rights can be suspended and the Centre assumes legislative and executive control over states.
3. Safeguards: The 44th Amendment required the President to act only on Cabinet advice and mandated parliamentary approval within a month.
4. Use in reorganisation: During the 2014 bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh, the Centre's role under

Article 356 was critical in managing transitional governance.

Instances of Misuse



1. Political exploitation of Article 352: The (1975) Emergency, declared after the Allahabad High Court verdict, was widely criticised as a move to suppress dissent and retain power rather than meet a genuine crisis.
2. Frequent misuse of Article 356: The Sarkaria Commission (1988) documented its use to dismiss opposition-led state governments, undermining federalism.
3. Violation of rights: The Shah Commission (1978) recorded preventive detentions, press censorship and forced sterilisation.
4. Judicial complicity and correction: ADM Jabalpur (1976) upheld suspension of habeas

corpus, but S.R. Bommai (1994) laid down strict guidelines on the use of Article 356 by the Centre.

Critical Assessment

The powers are necessary for national security, but vague grounds and executive dominance allowed misuse; the 44th Amendment and judicial review have since narrowed that space.

Way Forward

1. Stricter grounds and scrutiny: Clearer limits on grounds and fast-track judicial review can protect rights.
2. Federal dialogue: A stronger Inter-State Council can foster cooperative federalism and reduce Centre–State tensions.

Conclusion

Emergency powers protect India's unity and security, but their misuse threatens democratic values and federal balance. Robust safeguards, judicial oversight and cooperative federalism can prevent authoritarian excess and uphold constitutional morality.

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P-II
15(a)

Analyse the aims and objectives of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 Explain whether such objectives have been achieved.

Introduction

Despite safeguards under Articles 14, 15, 16, 17 and 46, atrocities against SC/ST communities continued. The SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 was enacted as a dedicated framework to ensure their dignity, justice and protection.

Aims and Objectives

1. **Preventing atrocities:** It criminalises violence and humiliation, such as forcing victims to consume obnoxious substances or wrongful dispossession of land, to end caste oppression and untouchability.
2. **Special courts and police:** Special courts and special police cells aim to reduce delays and raise convictions.
3. **Relief and rehabilitation:** Victims receive relief and protection, including arms for self-defence in atrocity-prone areas.
4. **Balanced safeguards:** Preliminary inquiry and sanction for arresting public servants were debated after the 2018 Subhash Kashinath Mahajan judgment and later amendments.

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PoA Act: aims versus reality

Aims	Reality
Prevent atrocities	Atrocities rising (NCRB)
Special courts, police cells	Low conviction rates
Relief and rehabilitation	Inadequate relief, low awareness

Evaluation: Have Objectives Been Achieved?

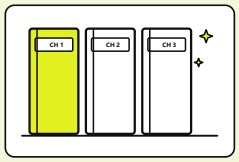
1. Persistent atrocities: NCRB data shows crime against SC/ST communities rising despite the Act, so its deterrent effect remains limited in practice.
2. Low conviction rates: Failures in investigation, prosecution and trial, noted by the National Commission for Scheduled Castes, undermine justice.
3. Weak rehabilitation and awareness: Many victims lack support, victims and police know little of the Act.
4. Andhra Pradesh: CAG audits reveal gaps in welfare schemes and law enforcement mechanisms that indirectly affect SC/ST protection and rehabilitation, calling for better governance and resources.

Way Forward

1. Capacity: Strengthen and train special courts and police units for timely, sensitive handling, cutting pendency and raising convictions.
2. Awareness: Targeted campaigns in atrocity-prone areas through Panchayati Raj institutions and civil society.
3. Rehabilitation: Financial aid, counselling and protection to restore dignity.
4. Data monitoring: State-level systems, including in Andhra Pradesh, to track cases and identify patterns.

Conclusion

The Act embodies the constitutional commitment to eradicate caste-based violence, but its objectives are only partially achieved because of implementation gaps and systemic inertia. Victim-centric implementation can realise its transformative potential.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

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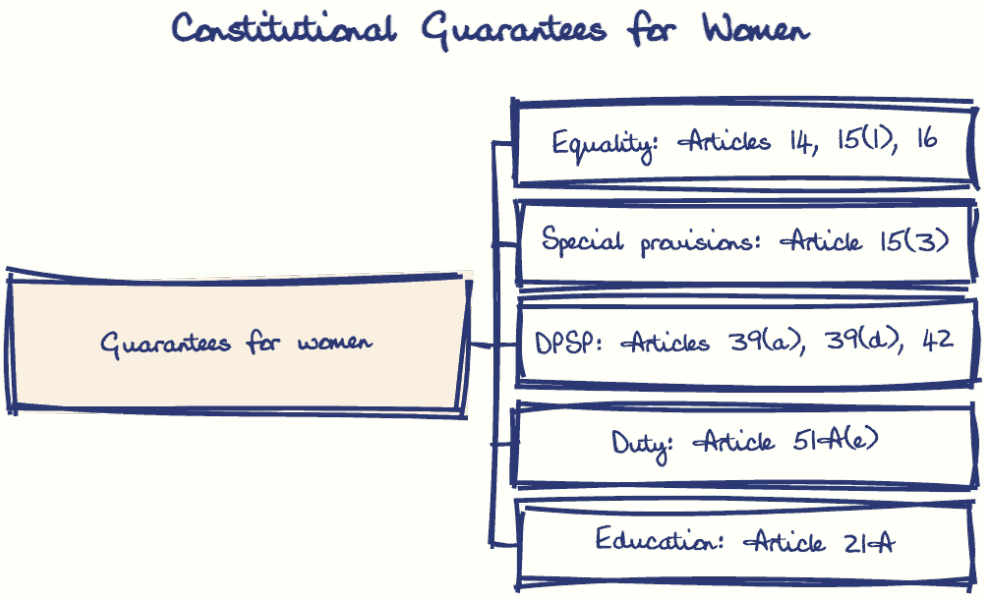
P-II
15(b)

What are the Constitutional guarantees given to women? Explain the role of the National Commission for Women in protecting the rights of the women.

Introduction

The Constitution of India enshrines several guarantees for women's dignity, equality and welfare, reflecting a commitment to gender justice. Their implementation, however, needs robust institutions, among which the National Commission for Women (NCW) plays a pivotal role, including in Andhra Pradesh.

Constitutional Guarantees for Women



1. **Equality and Non-Discrimination:** Articles 14 and 15(1) guarantee equality before law and prohibit discrimination on grounds of sex.

2. Special Provisions: Article 15(3) allows special provisions for women and children, enabling affirmative action.
3. Equal Opportunity: Article (16) bars gender discrimination in public employment.
4. Directive Principles: Articles 39(a), 39(d) and (42) direct the state to secure livelihood, equal pay for equal work, just working conditions and maternity relief.
5. Fundamental Duty: Article 51-A(e) asks citizens to renounce practices derogatory to women's dignity.
6. Education: Article 21-A guarantees free and compulsory education, including for girls.

Role of the NCW in Protecting Women's Rights

1. Monitoring Safeguards: Set up under the NCW Act, (1990,) it oversees constitutional and legal safeguards and recommends remedies to the Centre.
2. Grievance Redressal: It handles complaints of domestic violence, trafficking and harassment and takes suo moto cognizance of media reports, as in its support during the Bhateri gang rape case and advocacy for maintenance rights in

Muslim personal law.

3. Research and Policy: It studies women's conditions and proposes reforms, such as regulated hours and weekly offs for domestic workers.

4. Awareness: Legal awareness camps and campaigns against female foeticide, child marriage and vidence, run with state bodies including Andhra Pradesh's women's organisations.

5. Limitations: As a statutory body dependent on grants and lacking binding authority it is weaker than the commissions for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

Way Forward

Granting the NCW constitutional status, stronger coordination with state women's commissions and wider rural legal awareness can improve protection.

Conclusion

Constitutional guarantees lay the foundation of gender justice, an empowered NCW can turn them into real protection for women.

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2011

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P-II
11(a)

The constitution postulates in its Preamble that India shall be a Secular Republic. What are the constitutional provisions consistent this declaration?

10

Introduction

Through the 42nd Amendment in 1976, the Constitution explicitly declared India a secular republic in its Preamble. In a diverse society where many religions coexist, this commitment to religious neutrality is backed by provisions reflecting a model of secularism distinct from Western notions.

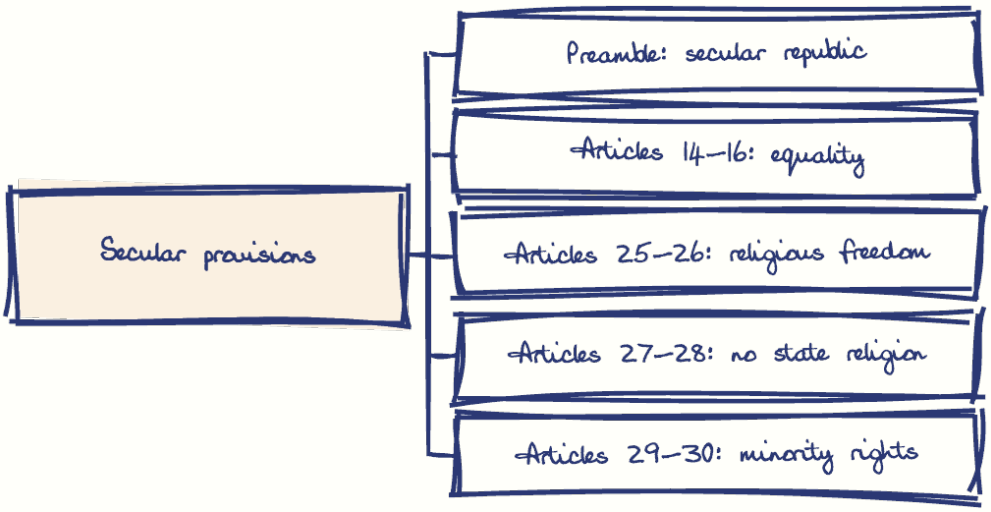
Constitutional Provisions Upholding Secularism

1. **Preamble:** Declares India "secular", so the state neither favours nor discriminates against any religion.
2. **Equality (Articles 14, 15, 16):** Equality before law, no discrimination on grounds of religion and equal opportunity in public employment.
3. **Freedom of religion (Articles 25, 26):** Freedom of conscience and to profess, practise and propagate religion; denominations may manage their own affairs.
4. **No state support (Articles 27, 28):** No taxes to promote any religion and no religious instruction in fully state-funded educational

institutions.

5. Minority rights (Articles 29, 30): Minorities may preserve their culture and run educational institutions of their choice.
6. Fundamental duty, Article 51A(f): Citizens must value and preserve India's composite culture.
7. Uniform Civil Code (Article 44): The state shall strive to harmonise personal laws, a sensitive, gradual process.

Secular provisions of the Constitution



Judicial Interpretation and Practice

1. Basic structure: S.R. Bommai (1994) made secularism a basic structure feature, preventing any government from favouring a religion.

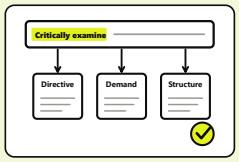
2. State-led reform: Unlike Western strict separation, India permits the state to reform regressive practices, as in the Hindu Code Bills and the Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act, 2019.

3. Balancing rights: Courts ensure religious practice does not disturb public order or the rights of others, as in rulings on personal laws and conversions.

4. Practice: In Andhra Pradesh, protecting minority rights while keeping communal harmony, especially in regions with significant minorities and heritage sites, is an ongoing challenge.

Conclusion

These provisions build a distinctly Indian secularism of equal respect rather than strict separation. Judicial vigilance against misuse of religion in politics, secular education, inclusive policy and interfaith efforts like Sarv Dharma Samvad of the National Commission for Minorities can keep it strong.



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Exam-hall thinking

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SCAN

P-II
11(b)

Trace the genesis and development of Uniform Civil code in India. Cite authoritative judgments on this issue.

10

Introduction

The Uniform Civil Code (UCC), anchored in Article (44), aims to unify personal laws across religions for gender justice and national integration. With states legislating and the Supreme Court reiterating the need, it remains pivotal yet contentious in a pluralistic society.

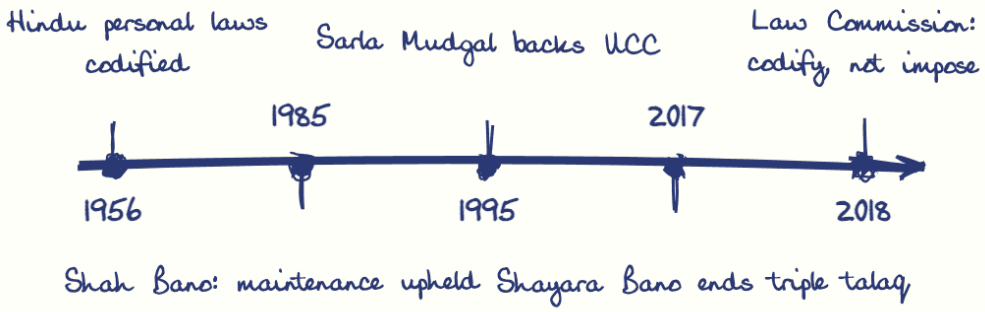
Genesis of the UCC

1. Constitutional directive: Article (44) directs the State to endeavour to secure a UCC throughout India.
2. Constituent Assembly: Nehru and Ambedkar supported it for gender justice and unity, but minority opposition made it only a Directive Principle.
3. Colonial legacy: The British codified separate personal laws to avoid unrest, entrenching legal pluralism.
4. Post-independence: Hindu personal laws, including Sikhs, Jains and Buddhists, were codified in (1956); other communities kept theirs.

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Development of the UCC debate



Development over Time

1. **Shah Bano and after:** The 1985 judgment and Parliament's 1986 law diluting it reignited the debate.
2. **State initiatives:** Uttarakhand became the first state to implement a UCC, and Assam's UCC Bill shows growing momentum.
3. **Law Commission (2018):** Recommended codifying personal laws on fairness and justice, through gradual reform.
4. **Obstacles:** The vast diversity of personal laws, religious sensitivities, fears of alienating minorities and vote-bank politics have slowed a national UCC.

Authoritative Judgments

1. **Shah Bano (1985):** Upheld maintenance under Section 125 CrPC and urged Parliament to

legislate.

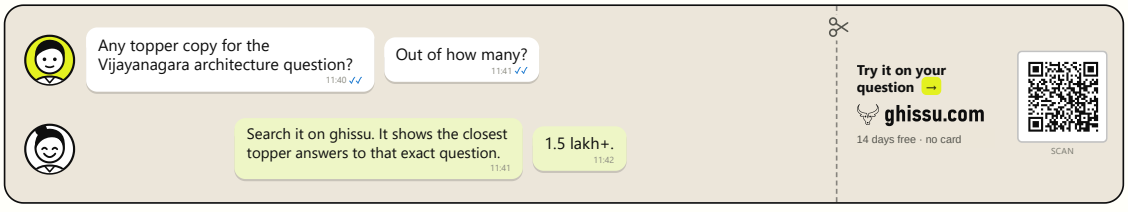
2. Sarla Mudgal (1995): Strongly advocated a UCC to resolve conflicts over marriage and bigamy.
3. Shayara Bano (2017): Declared triple talaq unconstitutional, reviving the debate.
4. Fatwas: Fatwas of Shariat courts that infringe fundamental rights have no legal sanctity, so personal laws must conform to the Constitution.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive dialogue: Engage religious groups, civil society and women's organisations to build consensus.
2. Phased reform: Codify personal laws on universal principles of justice.

Conclusion

A UCC built on inclusive dialogue and phased reform, as the states' experience suggests, can reconcile equality with India's diversity.



P-II
12(a)

What are the principles adopted by the Courts in an irreconcilable conflict between a law made by the Parliament and a law made by the State legislature?

10

Introduction

Conflict between laws of Parliament and State legislatures is a recurring challenge in India's federal structure. Article 254 addresses repugnancy in the Concurrent List, and the Supreme Court has developed principles to resolve irreconcilable conflicts while balancing parliamentary supremacy and state autonomy, amid tensions like the Polavaram project disputes in Andhra Pradesh.

Constitutional and Judicial Principles

1. **Primacy Rule:** Under Article 254(1), if a State law conflicts with a Parliamentary law on a Concurrent subject, the Parliamentary law prevails and the State law is void to the extent of repugnancy.
2. **Presidential Assent Exception:** Under Article 254(2), a repugnant State law reserved for the President and assented to prevails in that State, but Parliament can later override it.
3. **Tests of Repugnancy:** Courts ask whether there is a direct conflict, whether Parliament intended to occupy the entire field, and whether both

laws occupy the same field.

4. No Repeal by Implication: Repugnancy needs clear inconsistency; if both laws can operate without collision, both remain valid.

5. Union List Override: The non-obstante clause in Article 246(1) gives Parliament overriding power when Union List laws affect State matters.

How courts resolve Union–State conflict



Judicial Balancing of Federalism

1. Harmonious Construction: In *M. Karunanidhi v. Union of India* and *Ch. Tika Ramji v. State of U.P.*, the Court preferred harmonising laws and struck down State laws only on clear conflict.

2. Federalism as Basic Structure: *S.R. Bommai* held federalism to be part of the basic structure, protecting State legislative space.

3. Practical Complexities: Presidential assent is political and slow, as Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status showed, and the Krishna and Godavari tribunals show friction.

Way Forward

1. Dialogue: Use the Inter-State Council to pre-empt conflicts.
2. Timely Assent: Streamline consideration of reserved State laws to reduce legislative uncertainty.
3. Cooperative Lawmaking: Coordinate lawmaking on Concurrent subjects, adopting model laws where feasible.
4. Judicial Capacity: Build judicial expertise in federal interpretation for nuanced adjudication.

Conclusion

Courts uphold constitutional supremacy while respecting federal balance through principled tests of repugnancy, enabling States like Andhra Pradesh to legislate meaningfully within the Union.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

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SCAN

P-II
12(b)

Give instances wherein the Constitution provides control of the Union over the States.

10

Introduction

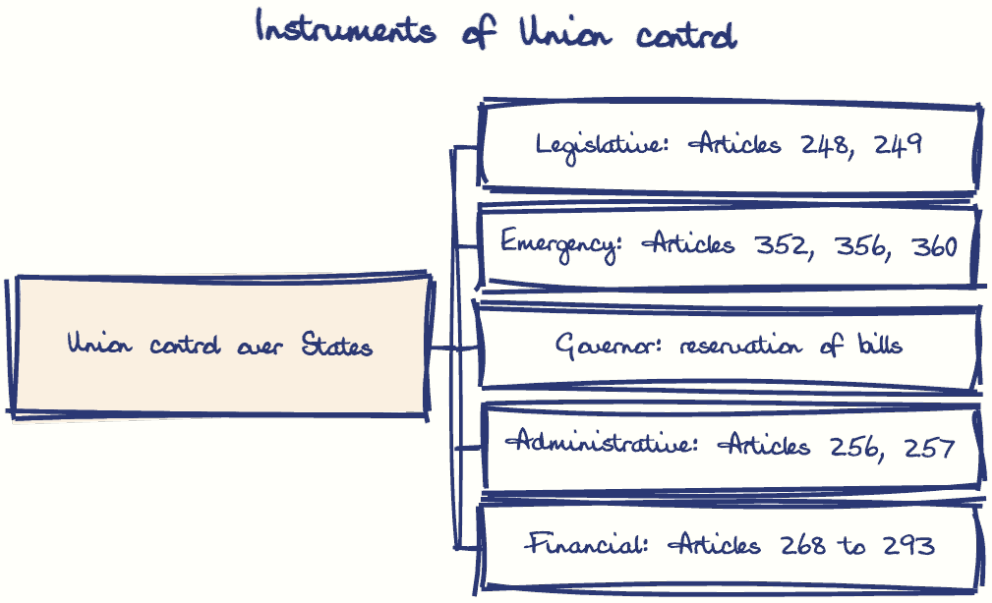
The Constitution creates a federal structure with a strong unitary bias, giving the Union wide control over states to protect national unity and uniform governance. Issues like the Polavaram project and Krishna-Godavari water disputes keep these provisions relevant.

Legislative Control

1. **Seventh Schedule:** Parliament has exclusive power over the Union List and residuary subjects (Article 248); Union law prevails on Concurrent List conflicts (Article 254).
2. **National interest:** Under Article 249, Parliament may legislate on State List matters after a two-thirds Rajya Sabha resolution.
3. **Governor as Union agent:** The Governor, appointed by the President, can reserve state bills for Presidential assent (Article 200) and report breakdowns.

Administrative Control

1. **Binding directions:** Articles 256 and 257 let



the Union direct states to comply with Union laws.

2. All-India Services: The IAS and IPS under Article 312 integrate state administration with Union oversight, ensuring uniform standards of governance.

Financial Control

1. Revenue and grants: The Union controls major taxes and grants under Articles 268–293, with the Finance Commission distributing resources.

2. Dependence: Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status highlights fiscal dependence.

Emergency Control

1. **Emergencies:** Articles 352, 356 and 360 let the Union override states.
2. **President's Rule:** Article 356 has been used in Andhra Pradesh too, and has been misused to dismiss state governments.

Implications

1. **National unity:** These controls maintain integrity and policy coherence in diverse and sensitive regions.
2. **Centralisation tension:** They cause friction with states seeking autonomy as in Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation.
3. **Risk of misuse:** Overuse of Article 356 breeds distrust and undermines federalism.

Conclusion

Union control is a safeguard for national integrity. Strengthening the Inter-State Council and guarding against misuse of Article 356 can keep it within the spirit of cooperative federalism.

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SCAN

P-II
13(a)

Explain the conflict resolution mechanism in case of deadlock between the two houses of a State legislature on a piece of legislation.

10

Introduction

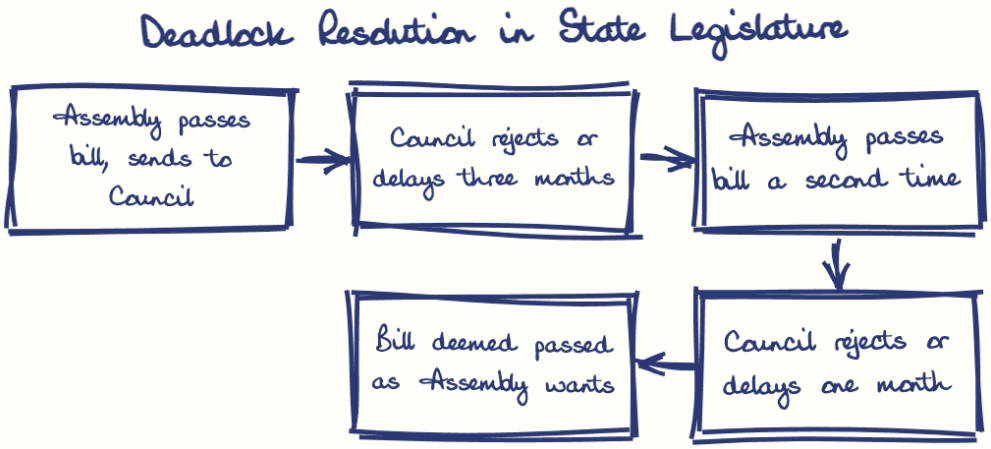
Deadlocks between the two Houses of a State legislature challenge lawmaking. Unlike Parliament, where Article 108 provides a joint sitting, the Constitution envisages no such mechanism for State legislatures, which underlines the primacy of the Assembly in state lawmaking.

Constitutional Provisions

1. No joint sitting: Unlike the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, the Legislative Council and Assembly cannot convene jointly to settle disagreements on bills.
2. Assembly override: Under Article 197(2), the Assembly can override the Council by passing an ordinary bill a second time.
3. Time limits: The Council must act on a bill within three months, preventing indefinite delay.
4. Money Bills exception: The Council can only recommend amendments within 14 days, which the Assembly may reject, so no

deadlock arises on fiscal legislation.

Procedural Steps



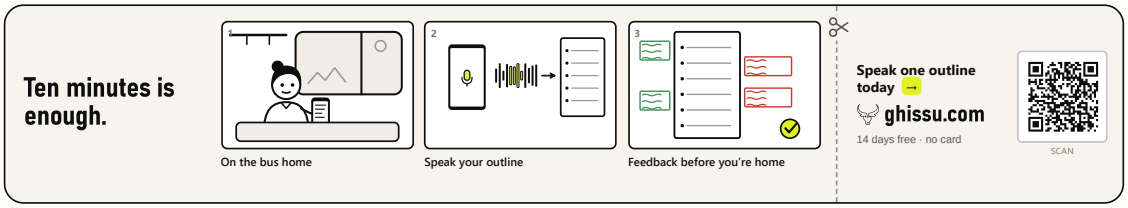
1. **First passage:** The Assembly passes the bill through three readings and sends it to the Council.
2. **Deadlock:** If the Council rejects it or proposes amendments unacceptable to the Assembly, a deadlock arises.
3. **Second passage:** The Assembly passes it again, with or without changes, triggering the override.
4. **Final consideration:** If the Council again rejects it or does not act within one month, the bill is deemed passed by both Houses in the Assembly's form.

Role of the Governor

1. **Assent:** The deemed-passed bill goes to the Governor under Article 200, whose role is largely formal.
2. **No joint sitting power:** Unlike the President, the Governor cannot summon a joint sitting.
3. **Practice in Andhra Pradesh:** In Andhra Pradesh, which has a Legislative Council, this mechanism has ensured that deadlocks do not stall governance.

Conclusion

The mechanism lets the Council act as a revising chamber that can delay but never permanently block legislation, ensuring the will of the directly elected Assembly prevails and preventing legislative paralysis.



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P-II
13(b)

"There is no constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings." Explain with reference to leading cases.

10

Introduction

Articles 105 and 194 give Parliament, State Legislatures and their members privileges such as freedom of speech and immunity from court proceedings for anything said or any vote given in the House. These privileges are functional, meant to protect free debate, and the courts have repeatedly held that they are not absolute.

Leading Cases

1. **Searchlight case (1959):** In M.S.M. Sharma, the Supreme Court held that privileges prevail over free speech under Article 19(1)(a), and found Article 21 satisfied only because the House acted under its own rules.
2. **Keshav Singh (1964):** The Court ruled that a legislature cannot be the final judge of its own privileges when a citizen's fundamental rights are invoked; courts can examine such cases.
3. **Raja Ram Pal (2007):** The expulsion of

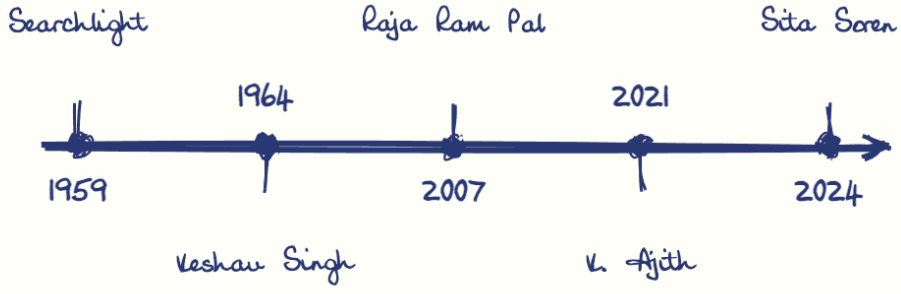
MPs in the cash-for-query case was upheld, but the Court held that the exercise of privilege is open to judicial review for illegality or unconstitutionality.

4. Kihoto Hollohan (1992): Even the Speaker's decisions on disqualification under the Tenth Schedule were held open to judicial review.

5. K. Ajith (2021): Vandalism inside the Kerala Assembly was held not protected; privilege does not shield criminal acts.

6. Sita Soren (2024): A seven-judge bench overruled P.V. Narasimha Rao (1998) and held that legislators taking bribes to vote or speak enjoy no immunity.

Narrowing immunity



Why Immunity Is Not Absolute

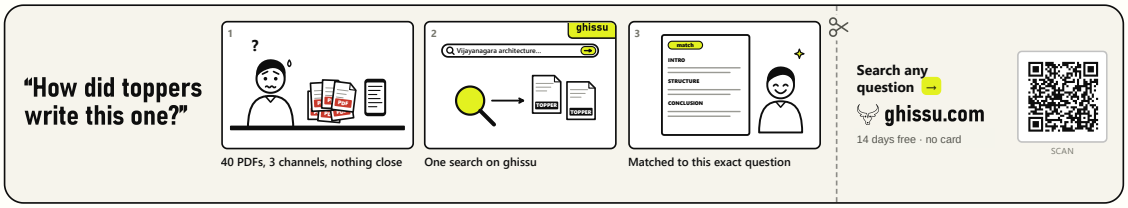
1. Functional test: Immunity covers only what

is essential to the House's functioning.

2. Constitutional supremacy: Privileges must yield to the Constitution and Part III.
3. Limits on Articles 122 and 212: These bar inquiry only into procedural irregularity, not illegality or unconstitutionality.
4. No cover for crime: Bribery and violence are not part of legislative business, so ordinary criminal law applies.

Conclusion

The Constitution protects free debate, not wrongdoing. By testing privileges against constitutional supremacy and the rule of law, courts have made legislative immunity accountable rather than absolute.



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P-II
14(a)

Explain the Constitutional guarantee to the Right to property in the light of the 44th Amendment Act.

10

Introduction

The Right to Property was originally a Fundamental Right. Persistent conflicts between the judiciary and legislature over land reforms led the 44th Amendment Act, 1978 to remove it from Part III and make it a legal right under Article 300-A.

Guarantee Before the 44th Amendment

1. **Fundamental Right:** Article 19(1)(f) let citizens acquire, hold and dispose of property; Article 31 barred deprivation except by law, with compensation and public purpose.
2. **Judicial safeguards:** Courts struck down laws violating compensation or public purpose, including zamindari abolition laws in Andhra Pradesh and other states, causing confrontations with Parliament.
3. **Shielding land reforms:** Amendments such as the 1st, 4th and 17th added Articles 31A, 31B and 31C to protect land reform laws from invalidation.
4. **Compensation:** It was a constitutional obligation, reflecting the Constituent Assembly's consensus

to protect owners while enabling redistribution.

Changes by the 44th Amendment

1. **Abolition as Fundamental Right:** Articles 19(1)(f) and (31) were repealed, ending protection under Article (32) writs.
2. **Article 300-A in Part XII:** No person shall be deprived of property except by authority of law, but without guaranteed compensation.
3. **Shift in remedy:** Aggrieved persons must use Article (226) in High Courts or civil suits.
4. **Exceptions retained:** Compensation remains for minority educational institutions (Article (30)) and land within ceiling limits for personal cultivation (Article 31-A).

Right to property: before and after the 44th Amendment

Before 1978	After 44th Amendment
Fundamental Right, Articles 19(1)(f), 31	Legal right, Article 300-A
Part III	Part XII
Article 32 writ remedy	High Court, Article 226
Compensation mandated	No compensation guarantee

Implications

1. Easier reforms: A major legal obstacle was removed, facilitating land reforms and acquisition for public welfare projects like Polavaram irrigation in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Less judicial oversight: The Supreme Court can no longer strike down laws on property grounds, shifting the balance towards legislative supremacy.
3. Limited protection: Article 300A guards against arbitrary executive action, not legislative encroachment, and without guaranteed compensation owners may face state excesses.

Conclusion

The amendment prioritised social justice and public interest over absolute property rights. Clear laws on fair, timely compensation, with judicial oversight against arbitrary acquisition, are needed to protect owners, especially in agrarian regions of Andhra Pradesh.

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SCAN

P-II
14(b)

"The basic structure of the Constitution in effect limits the amending power of the Parliament." – Discuss.

10

Introduction

The basic structure doctrine emerged as a judicial innovation to balance Parliament's power to amend the Constitution under Article 368 with the need to preserve its core identity. It was laid down in Kesavananda Bharati (1973), and debates such as the Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025, keep it relevant today.

Origin and Meaning

1. Implied limitation: The Court held that Parliament has wide amending powers but cannot alter the Constitution's basic structure.
2. Unclear definition: The basic structure is not exhaustively defined, but courts have identified supremacy of the Constitution, secularism, federalism, separation of powers, judicial review and the parliamentary system.
3. Change with continuity: The Constitution remains a living document capable of change without losing its foundational identity which protects constitutional morality and democratic governance.

How It Limits Amending Power

Limits on the Amending Power

Parliament can	Parliament cannot
Amend almost every provision	Alter the basic structure
Amend under Article 368	Exclude judicial review
Legislate on rights	Pass laws inconsistent with rights
Adapt a living document	Reduce it to a mere statute

1. Judicial review of amendments: In Minerva Mills (1980), the Court struck down provisions that sought to exclude judicial review itself.
2. Fundamental rights: In I. Coelho v. Tamil Nadu, laws inconsistent with fundamental rights were struck down.
3. No absolute sovereignty: The amending power is not unlimited, so Parliament cannot reduce the Constitution to a mere statute.
4. Contemporary test: The 130th Amendment Bill, which proposes removal of ministers under certain conditions, is critiqued for possibly violating separation of powers and federalism.

Implications

1. Constitutional identity: Core values and minority rights are protected against majoritarian excesses.
2. Institutional balance: Parliament's democratic mandate is balanced by judicial guardianship of constitutional principles.
3. Judicial overreach: Critics argue that unelected judges gain excessive power to decide what counts as basic structure, and this ambiguity may stifle democratic reforms.
4. State interests: It shields federalism and the autonomy of states like Andhra Pradesh, especially in resource allocation and governance after bifurcation.

Conclusion

The basic structure does limit Parliament's amending power, but to preserve the Constitution's identity, not to freeze it. Parliament can still reform almost every provision, while the judiciary guards the essential features. A clearer definition of those features would make this balance more predictable.



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P-II
15(a)

Explain the powers and functions of the Human Rights Commission.

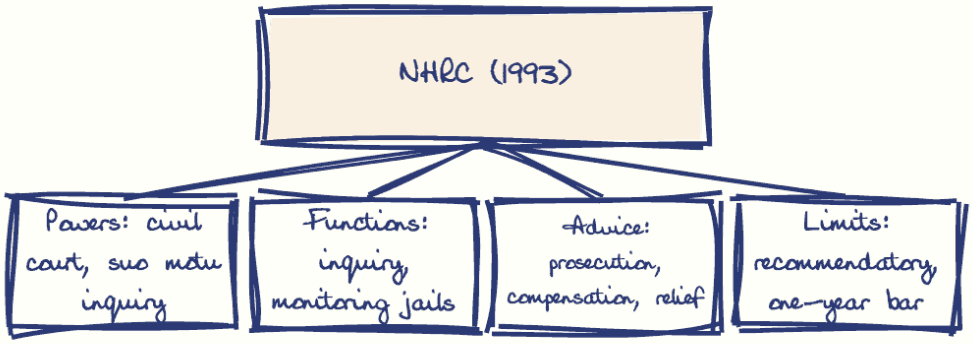
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Introduction

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) was established in 1993 under the Protection of Human Rights Act as an independent statutory watchdog. It addresses violations by public servants and complements the judiciary in safeguarding fundamental rights.

Powers of the Commission

NHRC at a Glance



1. **Statutory Composition:** It is a statutory, not constitutional, body chaired by a retired Chief Justice of India or Supreme Court judge, with members appointed by the President on a committee's recommendation.

2. **Civil Court Powers:** Under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908, it can summon witnesses,

demand documents and receive evidence on affidavits, giving it a quasi-judicial character.

3. Inquiry and Investigation: It can inquire suo motu or on petition into violations or negligence by public servants, and call for reports from central and state governments.

4. Jurisdictional Limits: It cannot inquire after one year of an alleged violation, and for the armed forces it can only seek reports from the Centre.

Functions of the Commission

1. Inquiry and Intervention: It investigates custodial deaths, torture and atrocities against vulnerable groups, and may intervene in court proceedings.

2. Monitoring and Recommendations: It reviews constitutional and legal safeguards and monitors jails and detention centres, suggesting reforms.

3. Promotion and Awareness: It undertakes research and spreads human rights literacy through seminars, media and NGOs.

4. Advisory and Legal Recourse: It can advise

prosecution, compensation or interim relief to victims, and approach the Supreme Court or High Courts.

Limitations

1. Recommendatory Nature: Its decisions are not binding; governments report action within a month, but compliance is optional.
2. Resource Constraints: Inadequate staff and financial autonomy delay investigations.

Way Forward

1. Autonomy: Grant full financial independence and more sanctioned posts.
2. Wider Jurisdiction: Allow direct inquiry into the armed forces.
3. Binding Recommendations: Make its recommendations legally binding.

Conclusion

The NHRC is a vital guardian of human rights. Greater autonomy and enforceable powers would make it a stronger pillar of rule of law in India.

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Scan to practice

P-II
15(b)

Examine the classification of Scheduled Castes within the constitutional scheme.

10

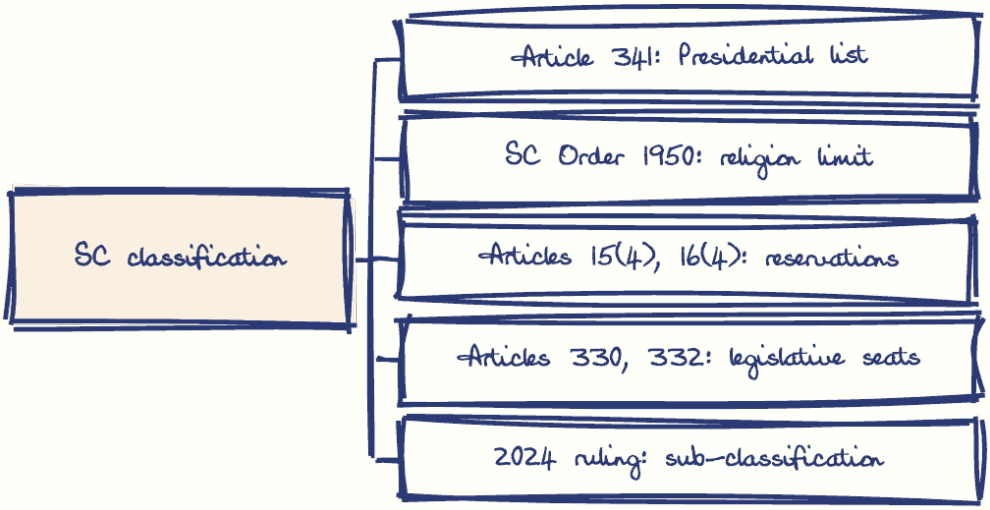
Introduction

Classification of Scheduled Castes is a critical part of India's affirmative action framework. The Supreme Court judgment of August 1, 2024, permitting sub-classification within SCs, has refocused attention on their heterogeneity and internal disparities. The scheme must balance redress for historical discrimination with equitable distribution and social cohesion.

Constitutional Provisions

1. Article 341: The President specifies castes deemed SCs for each State or UT, so classification is jurisdiction-specific.
2. Religious restriction: The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 limits SC status to those professing Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism.
3. Reservations and safeguards: Articles 15(4), 15(5), 16(4), 330 and 332 provide for education, jobs and political representation.
4. Judicial evolution: The 2024 ruling upholds sub-classification, letting states target benefits.

Constitutional scheme of SC classification



Criteria and Process

1. **Backwardness:** Historically low social status, economic and educational deprivation, and political under-representation, as reflected in the 1950 Presidential Order.
2. **State lists:** States propose lists on survey evidence; Presidential approval is a constitutional check.
3. **Creamy layer:** States must exclude economically advanced individuals so benefits reach the most disadvantaged.
4. **Andhra Pradesh:** The 1996 Justice Ramachandra Raju Commission recommended sub-categorisation.

Implications and Challenges

1. **Internal equity:** Acknowledges heterogeneity and

prevents dominant sub-castes from monopolising benefits, targeting the most marginalised.

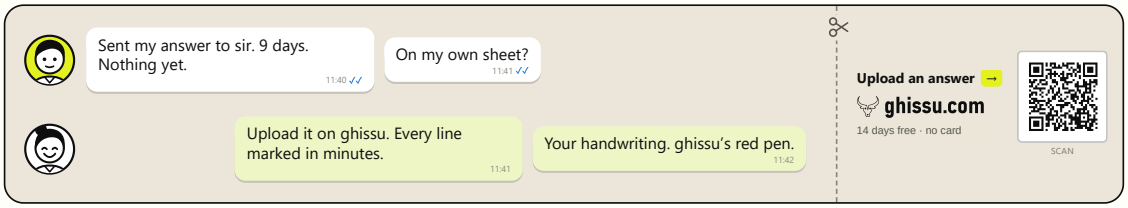
2. Fragmentation risk: Critics argue it may divide SCs and weaken their collective political voice and social solidarity, undermining the broader goal of empowerment.

3. Federal complexity: States seek autonomy, the Centre retains approval.

4. Data deficiency: Absence of caste-level data, beyond surveys like SECC, hampers objectivity.

Conclusion

The constitutional scheme has moved from treating SCs as one category to seeking justice within SCs. Reliable data, transparent criteria and care for solidarity will decide whether sub-classification fulfils its promise of reaching the most marginalised.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER III

2008

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P-II
11(a)

"Preamble is a part of the Indian Constitution." — Comment.

10

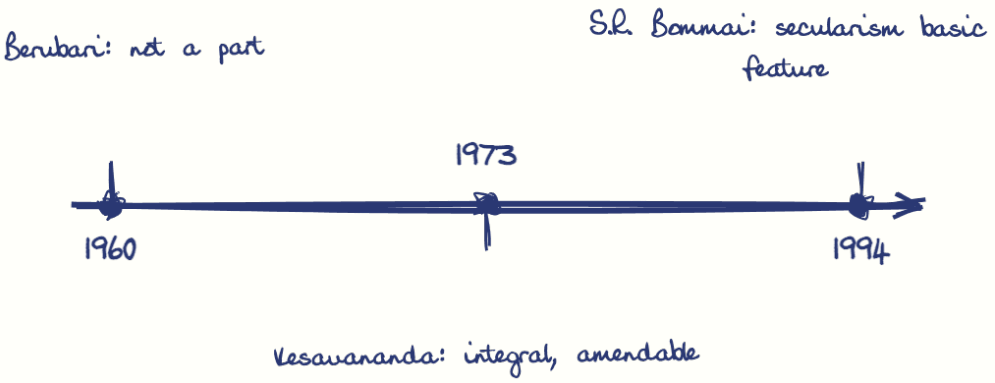
Introduction

The Preamble encapsulates the fundamental values and vision of the Indian nation. Its constitutional status was long debated until the landmark Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) affirmed its integral role.

Constitutional Status of the Preamble

1. Adopted as part: The Constituent Assembly adopted it after the rest of the Constitution, with the explicit motion that it "stands part of the Constitution".
2. Not merely an introduction: Unlike preambles to ordinary statutes, it names the source of authority, " We, the People of India ", and defines the state as sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic and republican.
3. Amendable under Article 368: It can be amended, but not to alter the basic structure, the 42nd Amendment added "socialist", "secular" and "integrity".
4. Non-justiciable: It is not enforceable in court and neither confers powers nor imposes prohibitions.

Preamble before the Supreme Court



Judicial Interpretation

1. **Berubari Union (1960):** Held it was not part of the Constitution, but an aid for ambiguous provisions, a "key to the minds of the makers".
2. **Kesavananda Bharati (1973):** Overruled Berubari, declaring it an integral part and reading the Constitution in its light.
3. **S.R. Bommai (1994):** Reaffirmed its importance in upholding secularism as a basic feature.

Significance

1. **Popular sovereignty:** It commits the state to justice, liberty, equality and fraternity.
2. **Guiding vision:** A beacon for lawmakers, administrators and judges.

3. Social transformation: Its ideals inspire affirmative action and protection against caste discrimination, relevant in Andhra Pradesh.

4. Interpretative aid: As former Chief Justice Dipak Misra highlighted, it helps courts resolve ambiguities in cases on fundamental rights and directive principles.

Way Forward

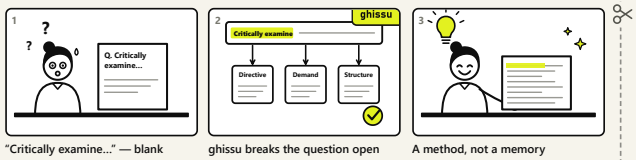
1. Judicial use: Courts should consistently invoke it in social justice cases.

2. Awareness: Educational initiatives in Andhra Pradesh can deepen constitutional literacy.

Conclusion

The Preamble is a part of the Constitution. Though it grants no enforceable rights, it remains the ethical compass for interpreting the Constitution's spirit.

You know the topic. You still freeze.



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SCAN

P-II
11(b)

Is India a Federation ?

10

Introduction

Scholars have long debated whether India is a federation. The Constitution never uses the word, calling India a " Union of States ", yet it creates a federal structure with distinctive features. The answer matters as India balances regional autonomy with national integration.

Federal Features

1. Division of powers: The Seventh Schedule divides subjects into Union, State and Concurrent Lists, with Articles 245–263 giving a constitutional basis.
2. Supremacy of the Constitution: The Constitution is supreme, and the Supreme Court acts as a federal court resolving Centre–state disputes under Articles 131–136, safeguarding the federal balance.
3. Cooperative institutions: The Inter-State Council and Finance Commission enable dialogue and fiscal transfers; the 15th Finance Commission enhanced devolution to states and local bodies.
4. Pooled sovereignty: The GST Council embodies cooperative federalism, though tensions persist

over states' taxation autonomy.

5. Regional assertion: Regional parties, including in Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation, demand greater accommodation.

Federal and unitary features

Federal features	Unitary features
Seventh Schedule division	Residuary powers with Centre
Supreme Constitution and judiciary	Single citizenship
Inter-State Council, Finance Commission	Emergency and Article 356
Regional parties' assertion	Fiscal centralisation

Unitary Features

1. Residuary powers: Unlike classical federations, Parliament legislates on unlisted subjects under Article (248), a centralising tendency.
2. Indestructible Union: Article (1) makes India an indestructible Union of destructible states, and Article (3) lets Parliament alter boundaries or create states.
3. Single citizenship: Article (5), unlike the US model.

4. Emergency powers: Articles 352–360 give the Centre sweeping powers, and frequent use of Article 356 (President's Rule) has been a source of tension.

5. Fiscal centralisation: Vertical imbalance, as in Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status.

Assessment

K.C. Wheare and Ivor Jennings call India quasi-federal, a unitary state with federal features, because the Centre is strong and states have no sovereignty or right to secede. Yet India's diversity needs flexibility, seen in special provisions for Telangana and other regions, so its federalism keeps evolving.

Conclusion

India is a federation of its own kind: a flexible, cooperative union with a strong Centre. Strengthening the Inter-State Council, reforming Article 356 and ensuring equitable fiscal transfers can deepen it.

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Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

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SCAN

P-II
12(a)

Do you agree with the view that functions are given to the States while resources are with the Centre ?

10

Introduction

The distribution of functions and resources between the Centre and States is foundational to Indian federalism. Yet States, including Andhra Pradesh, argue that their responsibilities outrun their fiscal capacity. Largely, the view holds, though constitutional mechanisms partly correct it.

Functions with the States

1. Constitutional Allocation: The Seventh Schedule and Article 246 give States key social sectors like health, education and police, intending functional autonomy.
2. Heavy Expenditure Duties: States bear the primary responsibility for social sector spending, which is large and rising with developmental demands.

Resources with the Centre

1. Tax Powers: The Centre retains income tax and customs, while States depend on less buoyant sources like excise, creating a vertical fiscal imbalance.

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2. Conditional Transfers: Article 275 grants and centrally sponsored schemes are discretionary and tied, and the Centre sets the Finance Commission's Terms of Reference.

3. Corrective Mechanisms: Article 280 provides for devolution, and the Sarkaria Commission (1988) urged a permanent Finance Commission.

Consequences of the Mismatch

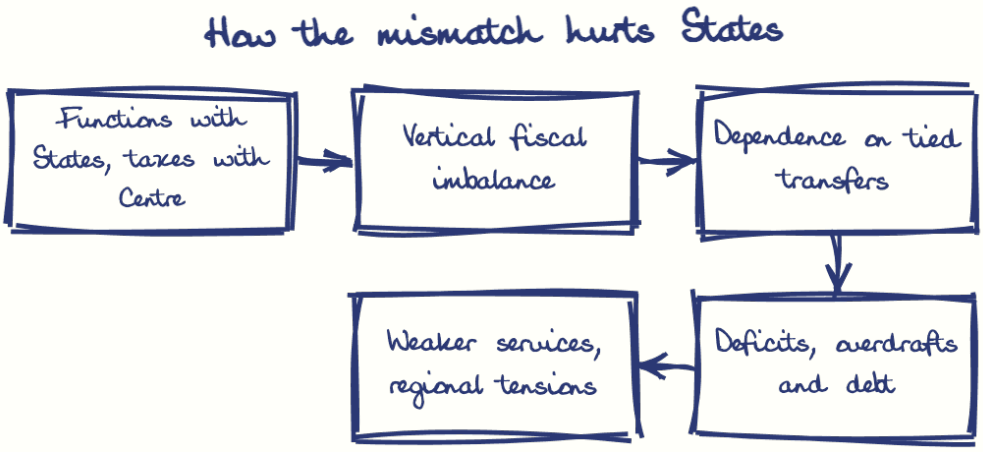
1. State Dependence: Delays and conditions in fund releases weaken autonomy and bargaining power.

2. Strained Cooperation: Control over resources is seen as political leverage, as in Andhra Pradesh's demand for Special Category Status.

3. Poorer Services: Andhra Pradesh's CAG 2025 audit found gaps in welfare, education and health linked partly to delayed funds.

4. Debt Burden: Shortfalls push States to overdrafts and borrowing, cutting capital investment, as Andhra Pradesh's audits highlight.

5. Unitary Tendencies: Article 356 and All India Services add to central dominance.

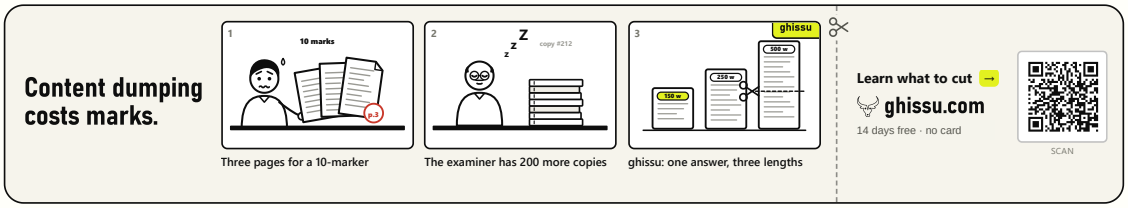


Way Forward

1. Permanent Finance Commission: Make it a permanent, independent body with State participation in setting its Terms of Reference.
2. Predictable Transfers: Reduce conditions and delays in fund releases so States can plan and budget with certainty.

Conclusion

The Constitution is "federal in form but unitary in spirit" in finance. Matching resources to functions through fairer, predictable transfers is essential for genuine cooperative federalism.



P-II
12(b)

"The Comptroller and Auditor-General of India is a friend, philosopher and guide of Public Accounts Committee." — Discuss.

10

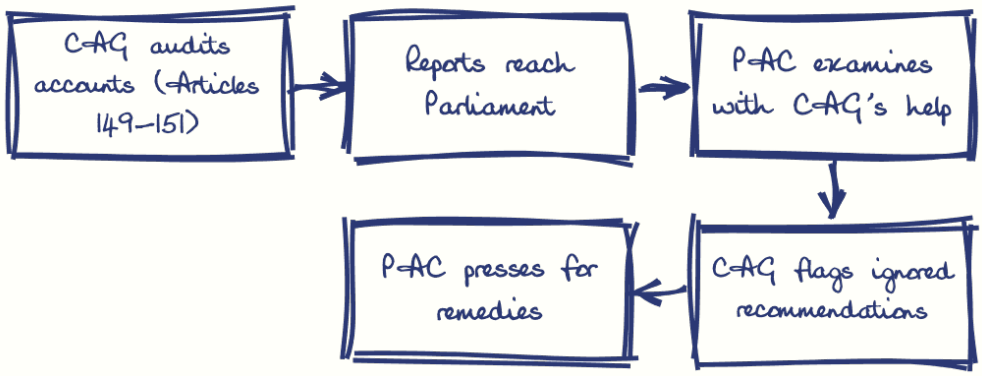
Introduction

The Comptroller and Auditor-General (CAG), appointed under Article 148, is crucial for transparency and accountability in public finance. Its relationship with the Public Accounts Committee (PAC) is the key mechanism through which Parliament scrutinises government spending, making the CAG truly the PAC's friend, philosopher and guide.

Constitutional and Statutory Role of the CAG

1. Independence: The CAG has tenure security like a Supreme Court judge, ensuring impartial audit at Union and state levels.
2. Audit and Reporting: Articles 149 to 151 empower audit of the Consolidated Fund, Contingency Fund and Public Account, with reports to the President or Governors.
3. 1971 Act Powers: Discretion to select subjects, inspect offices, examine transactions and call for documents.
4. Limitations: Resource constraints and delayed documents; Andhra Pradesh reports show excess payments and compliance gaps.

C&AG and PAC: the accountability chain



C&AG as Friend, Philosopher and Guide

1. **Guide:** Audit reports form the basis of PAC's examination of expenditure.
2. **Philosopher:** The C&AG explains complex irregularities and suggests corrective action.
3. **Friend:** It clarifies findings so audit observations become parliamentary questions and government responses.
4. **Follow-up:** Ignored recommendations are reported to the PAC, which presses for remedies.

Significance and Limits

1. **Accountability:** The nexus ensures funds are used economically, efficiently and effectively.
2. **Checks and Balances:** It lets the legislature oversee the executive through independent audit.
3. **Reforms:** Findings lead to better accounting

standards and expenditure controls.

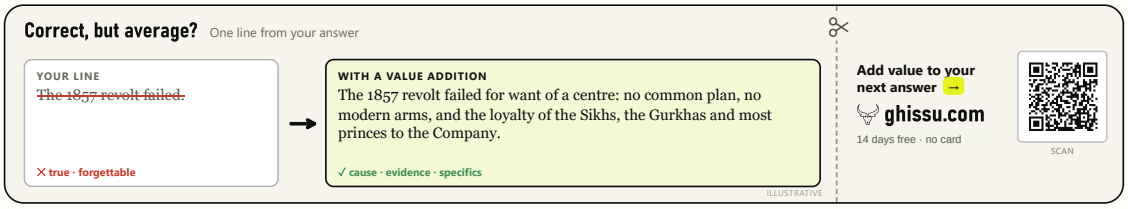
4. Dilution: Delayed reports, weak follow-up and poor public dissemination limit impact.

Way Forward

1. Resources: More manpower and technology for the CAG.
2. Timelines: Mandatory timelines for government action on CAG and PAC recommendations.
3. Public Engagement: Wider dissemination of audit reports through media and digital platforms.
4. Statutory Protection: Recognition for Indian Audit and Accounts Department officials.

Conclusion

The CAG equips the PAC with the knowledge to hold the executive to account. Strengthening this partnership will deepen democratic financial governance.



P-II
13(a)

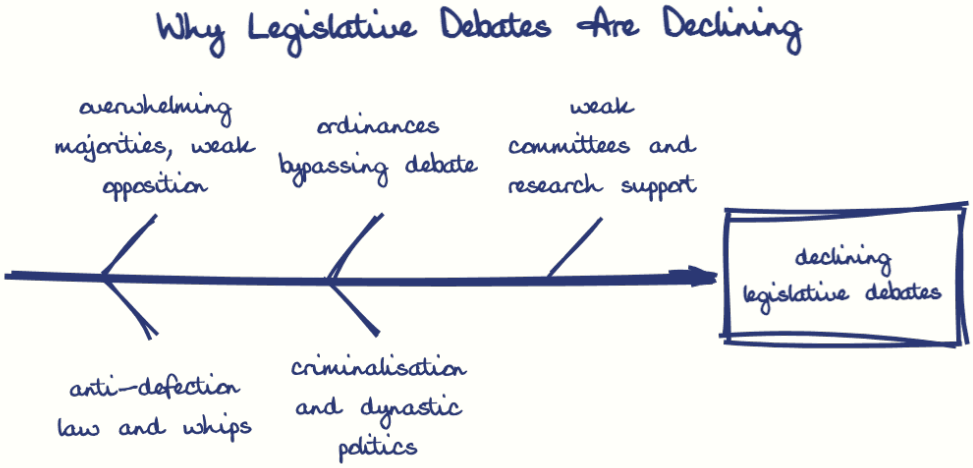
Comment on the declining trend of legislative debates.

10

Introduction

The decline of legislative debates in India's Parliament and state legislatures is a pressing concern. Though legislatures have become more representative, their effectiveness as forums of deliberation and accountability has fallen, undermining their constitutional role of scrutiny, lawmaking and oversight.

Causes of Decline



1. **Single-party majorities:** Overwhelming majorities weaken the opposition; bills referred to committees fell from 71% in the 15th Lok Sabha to 25% in the 16th.

2. **Anti-defection law:** Strict party whips force

members to toe the party line, since dissent risks disqualification.

3. Ordinances and executive dominance: Over (35) ordinances in recent years bypassed debate, and the government controls the legislative schedule.

4. Criminalisation and commercialisation: Legislators with criminal backgrounds and dynastic politics erode professionalism, as seen in Andhra Pradesh where political families dominate.

5. Weak committees and research support: Fewer bill referrals and inadequate research staff reduce the depth of debate.

Consequences for Democratic Governance

1. Erosion of accountability: Reduced scrutiny weakens checks and balances over the executive.

2. Policy vacuum: Delays invite judicial or executive orders, disturbing separation of powers; the delayed GST Bill cost an estimated (4%) of GDP.

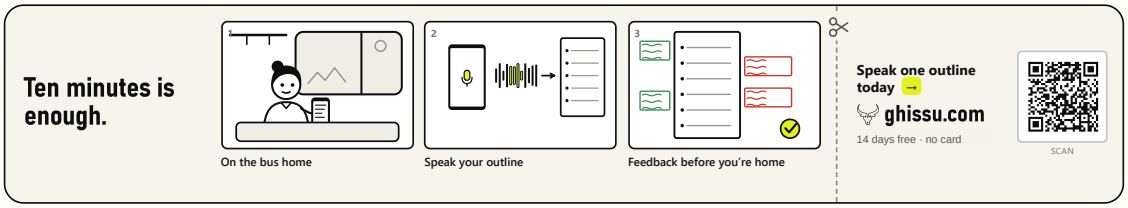
3. Declining public trust: Disruptions, low attendance and few sittings, as in the Maharashtra Assembly, erode faith in legislatures.

Way Forward

1. **Minimum sittings:** At least (120) Lok Sabha and (100) Rajya Sabha sittings a year, as recommended by the National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution.
2. **Stronger committees:** Higher mandatory referral of bills and regular performance review.
3. **Research support:** Independent research staff to reduce reliance on bureaucrats.
4. **Reform anti-defection law:** Allow MPs and MLAs to express dissent without fear of disqualification, encouraging independent debate.

Conclusion

Declining debate threatens constitutional morality. Adequate sittings, stronger institutions and empowered legislators can restore the legislature as a forum of accountability and lawmaking, in the spirit of Article (79).



P-II
13(b)

What are the novel trends in Judicial Review ?

10

Introduction

Judicial review in India has evolved with changing governance challenges. In the 2020s, courts increasingly focus on transparency, environment and digital rights under Article 21, expanding the judiciary's role in ways that need careful balance.

Novel Trends in Judicial Review

Novel Trends and Their Risks

Trend	Concern
Climate, digital rights reviewed	Technical competence questioned
Creative remedies (Nautej Johar)	Acting where Parliament has not
Assertive activism	Judicial adventurism (liquor ban)
E-filing, virtual hearings	AI-fabricated precedents

1. **Expansion of subject matter:** Review now covers complex areas like climate and digital privacy; in M.K. Ranjitsinh (2024), the Court made the government accountable for climate change, though its technical competence is questioned.

2. **Innovative remedies:** Courts fill policy gaps creatively;

Navtej Singh Johar (2018) decriminalised Section 377 IPC in the absence of parliamentary action, advancing LGBTQ+ rights.

3. Activism–restraint dynamics: Assertive interventions protect victims' justice, but the line is thin; the 2016 liquor ban near highways shows the risk of judicial adventurism, as former CJI A.S. Anand cautioned.

4. Use of technology: E-filing and virtual hearings improve access and efficiency, but safeguards are needed against AI-fabricated precedents.

Implications

1. Rights protection: Expanded review strengthens constitutional morality, as in Andhra Pradesh's interventions on issues like the Polavaram project.

2. Separation of powers: Overreach risks blurring boundaries; the NJAC judgment (2015) shows tensions over appointments.

3. Accountability and trust: The Law Commission's 195th Report (2006) proposed a National Judicial Council.

4. Policy dialogue: Vishaka prompted the POSH Act (2013), showing courts can spur legislation rather than substitute for it.

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Way Forward

1. Judicial accountability: Institutionalise oversight mechanisms, as the Law Commission recommended, to raise transparency and ethical standards.
2. Clear guidelines: Limit PIL scope to fundamental rights violations to prevent overreach while preserving activism's social justice role.
3. Responsible technology: Expand e-Courts with safeguards against AI misuse.
4. Legislative engagement: Stronger dialogue between judiciary and legislature can close policy gaps collaboratively, reducing the judiciary's burden of policymaking.

Conclusion

These novel trends reflect an adaptive judiciary protecting rights amid new challenges. Balanced with restraint and accountability, they strengthen democratic governance and the rule of law, in the spirit of Article (21) and SDG (16).

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SCAN

P-II
14(a)

"Article 356 is more misused than used." — Comment.

10

Introduction

Article 356 empowers the President to impose President's Rule in a state when its constitutional machinery fails. Intended as a safeguard and a "dead letter" to be used sparingly, its frequent invocation has sparked intense debate, highlighted by the S.R. Bommai judgment (1994) and the Sarkaria and Punchhi Commissions.

Intended Use and Safeguards

1. Last resort: It was designed to maintain constitutional governance, with mandatory parliamentary approval and judicial review as safeguards against arbitrary use.
2. Sarkaria Commission: It should be used only after exhausting alternatives like Article 355, in severe crises such as political deadlock or internal subversion.
3. Punchhi Commission: It called for strict guidelines and conventions to protect federalism.

Why It Is Seen as More Misused

1. Frequency: It was invoked over 126 times, peaking under Indira Gandhi, often to dismiss

Article 356: Design vs Practice

Intended use	Actual practice
Last resort, a dead letter	Invoked over 126 times
After Article 355 options	Dismissing opposition-ruled governments
Majority tested on the floor	Floor tests denied
Constitutional safeguard	Centre–State distrust

non-aligned state governments without letting them prove majority.

2. Denial of floor tests: The Karnataka cases (1989, 1990) and Uttarakhand (2016) bypassed the legislature, violating constitutional morality.
3. Political expediency: It was often used to destabilise opposition-ruled states rather than to respond to any real breakdown of governance.
4. Strained federalism: Misuse created distrust between the Centre and states like Andhra Pradesh, which demand respect for elected governments.

Checks That Have Reduced Misuse

1. S.R. Bommai: The Court made presidential

satisfaction subject to judicial review, requiring objective evidence and floor tests.

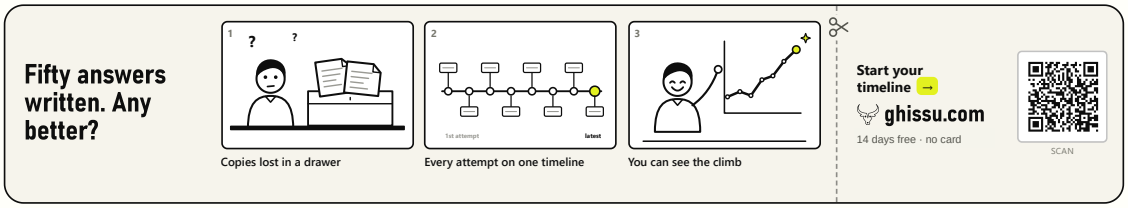
2. Changed politics: Judicial scrutiny, coalition politics and a vibrant civil society have reduced impositions since the mid-1990s.

Way Forward

1. Conventions: Mandatory floor tests and clear protocols for Governor's reports.
2. Clarity: A precise definition of "failure of constitutional machinery", as the Punchhi Commission suggested.
3. Cooperative federalism: Dialogue through the Inter-State Council can resolve Centre-State conflicts without President's Rule.

Conclusion

Article 356 has historically been misused more than judiciously applied, undermining federalism. Bommai has curtailed arbitrary use, but a mature political culture that respects elected state governments must complete the reform.



P-II
14(b)

Panchayati Raj is a "God that failed." — Evaluate.

10

Introduction

The 73rd Amendment (1992) made Panchayati Raj the cornerstone of democratic decentralisation, aiming to give rural bodies political, administrative and financial autonomy. Decades later, persistent governance problems lead some to call it a "God that failed". The record is mixed rather than a failure.

Framework

1. **Constitutional Structure:** A three-tier system with regular elections, SC/ST and women's reservation and Gram Sabhas at the base.
2. **Devolution and Support:** Panchayats were to plan and implement schemes, backed by State Finance Commissions, while RGSA and SVAMITVA build capacity and property rights.

Evidence of Shortcomings

1. **Lack of Political Will:** States and bureaucracies withhold real powers, reducing Panchayats to implementing agencies, as with delayed elections and funds in Andhra Pradesh.
2. **Financial Dependence:** Reliance on grants weakens accountability, as the Standing Committee on Rural

Development (2023) noted.

3. Elite Capture and Proxies: The pradhan-pati syndrome and politicisation dilute democratic potential.

4. Conceptual Ambiguity: Competing views of Panchayats as administrative, democratic or developmental bodies cause inconsistent implementation.

Evidence of Success

1. Democratic Deepening: Competitive elections have created local leadership in states like Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh.

2. Improved Access: Villagers now approach Block Development Officers without fear.

3. Development Role: Panchayats implement MGNREGA and Swachh Bharat Mission, though results vary.

4. Corrective Efforts: The Supreme Court acted against proxy participation, and the Advisory Committee on Women's Representation (2023) promotes inclusivity.

Evaluation

1. Failure of Implementation: The shortfalls come from withheld powers and funds, not from the idea of

Panchayati Raj: failure or unfinished task?

Why it seems failed	Why verdict is harsh
Weak political will	Democratic deepening
Financial dependence	Improved access
Elite capture, proxies	Development outcomes
Conceptual ambiguity	Accountability potential

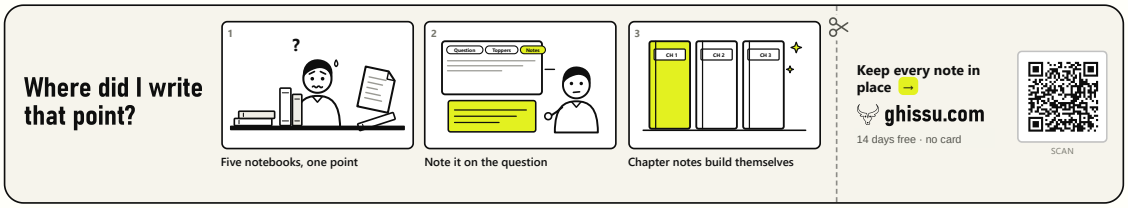
decentralisation.

2. Lasting Gains: Political awakening, inclusion and better access are real achievements.

3. Untapped Potential: Gram Sabhas remain underused instruments of social audit due to unclear procedures and interference.

Conclusion

Panchayati Raj is an unfinished promise rather than a "God that failed". Genuine devolution, fiscal autonomy and active Gram Sabhas, free of political interference, can fulfil its original vision.



P-II
15(a)

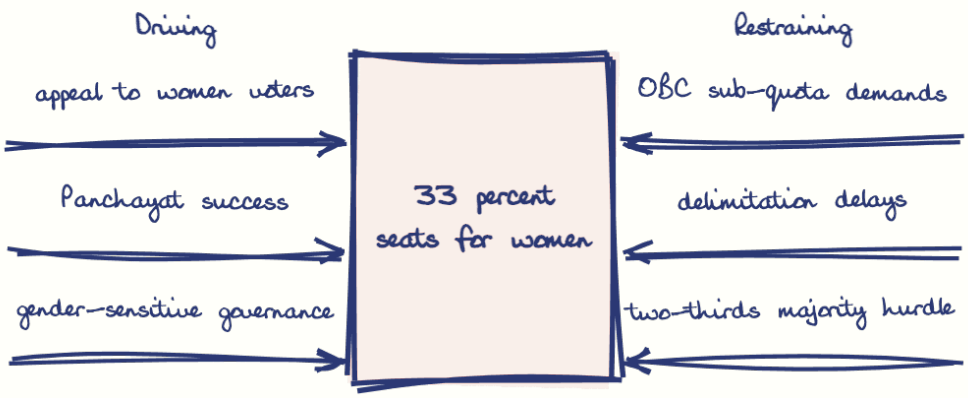
Bring out the politics of Women's Reservation Bill.

10

Introduction

The Women's Reservation Bill seeks to reserve 33 percent of seats in Parliament and state legislatures for women. Despite passage in the Rajya Sabha in 2010 and the 2023 bill, implementation remains delayed by political disagreements and delimitation, reflecting deep challenges to gender equality in a society marked by caste and community cleavages.

Political Motivations and Opposition



1. **Electoral strategy:** Parties publicly support the Bill to appeal to women voters, yet field few women candidates, revealing limited commitment.

2. **Demand for sub-quotas:** Opposition parties

sought sub-quotas for OBC and minority women, a demand that stalled the Bill in the Lok Sabha in 2010.

3. Fear of segmentation: Critics argue caste sub-quotas would fragment women's representation along caste and religious lines, creating sectoral leaders.
4. Delimitation delays: Implementation is linked to the census and delimitation, frozen until 2026, so reservation is unlikely before the 2029 elections.

Role of Parties and Stakeholders

1. Congress and BJP: Congress adopted a 33 percent internal quota in 1998, and the BJP helped introduce the Bill, yet both nominate few women.
2. Samajwadi Party and BSP: Their sub-quota demands reflect their social justice base but caused deadlock.
3. Women's movements: They cite Panchayat success, where women hold about 43–47 percent of seats, including in Andhra Pradesh, while warning against tokenism.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Impact on Representation

1. Parliamentary gap: Women form only about 15 percent of the Lok Sabha and 10 percent of the Rajya Sabha.
2. Transformative potential: More women in legislatures can make governance gender-sensitive.
3. Elite capture: Without careful design, benefits may flow to women from dominant castes and political families, sidelining marginalised groups, a concern echoed in debates over party ticket distribution.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive design: Considering sub-quotas for OBC and minority women can make the reservation reflect India's social diversity.

Conclusion

The Bill's politics show that genuine gender equality needs inclusive design and real party commitment, not merely symbolic support.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
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P-II
15(b)

Analyse the functions and functioning of National Commission for Scheduled Castes.

10

Introduction

The National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) is a constitutional body under ~~Article~~ 338, reflecting the state's commitment to SC rights and welfare. Its evolution from a Special Officer to a multi-member Commission shows the need for institutions against caste discrimination and deprivation.

Functions of the NCSC

1. Constitutional Mandate: It investigates and monitors all constitutional and legal safeguards for SCs.
2. Complaint Inquiry: It inquires into deprivation of rights as a quasi-judicial body with civil court powers to summon witnesses and documents.
3. Advisory Role: It advises the Union and states on planning SC socio-economic development.
4. Reporting: Annual and special reports to the President are laid before Parliament with government responses.

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NCSC: mandate and means

Functions	Functioning gaps
Investigate safeguards (Article 338)	Vacancies, scarce resources
Complaint inquiry, civil court powers	Complaint backlog
Advise governments	Consultation bypassed
Report to President	Recommendations unenforceable

Analysis of Its Functioning

1. Monitoring Laws: It tracks the Prevention of Atrocities Act, 1989 and highlights enforcement gaps, though impact varies by region.
2. Complaint Backlog: Backlogs and limited field presence delay redressal; in 2023 the Supreme Court intervened to expedite appointments.
3. Advice Ignored: Recommendations often go unimplemented; CAG audits in Andhra Pradesh show gaps in SC education and nutrition.
4. Political Constraints: Politically motivated appointments and inadequate funding curb autonomy.

Challenges

1. Vacancies: In 2023–24 all posts were vacant for months.
2. Scarce Resources: Low budgets and manpower restrict investigation.
3. Bypassed Consultation: Governments skip mandatory consultation, reducing it to a formality.
4. Social Realities: Stigma and exclusion persist beyond legal remedies.

Way Forward

1. Transparent Appointments: Merit-based, time-bound selection.
2. Autonomy: Financial independence and power to enforce recommendations.
3. Field Presence: Regional offices in SC-concentrated areas like Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

The NCSC has the mandate but lacks the means. Filling posts, funding it and heeding its advice would make it an effective guardian of SC rights.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

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